UNLOCKING THE SUPERPOWER WITHIN

FOURGAME DYNAMICS
COACHING & PERSONAL DEVELOPMENT

Dan Jones

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FIRST EDITION

For Jamie – It has been a privilege to be able to work with you on developing the FourGames approach over the last 15 years.

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WHY FOURGAMES?

There are many different models for success which can often appear to be conflicting. Over the course of my twenty-plus years working in the therapy industry, I am aware that there are over 400 different approaches to therapy (Zarbo et al., 2016), each with its own advocates who claim that their approach is the best. These approaches address different elements of a problem and its solution, whether it be a psycho-analytic approach which seeks to uncover root causes from childhood, a gestalt approach which looks at the big picture, an interpersonal approach which focuses on relationships, a cognitive approach which examines thinking styles, a behavioural approach which looks at behaviour, a solution-focused approach which concentrates on the client's desired future and the steps to achieve it, a residential therapy approach, or other therapies which aim to change the client's environment. Additionally, there are spiritual therapies and many other therapeutic directions.

While some therapeutic approaches have generally better outcomes than others, research shows that three factors have the greatest impact on therapeutic outcomes regardless of the therapeutic approach: the relationship between the therapist and the client (Hilsenroth et al., 2018), the therapist's belief in their treatment approach (Arnold, 2017), and most importantly, the therapist's ongoing engagement in feedback-informed

deliberate practice (Miller et al., 2008).

This is a fascinating insight that ties in perfectly with FourGames. It demonstrates that it doesn't matter where you begin when addressing a problem, whether it be by examining the environment, a client's thought patterns, or their desired future. All methods can lead to resolving the issue at hand. This means that no therapeutic approach is inherently correct or incorrect, but simply a different direction to take, and some clients may prefer certain approaches over others. The challenge for therapists is to be adaptable and able to change their approach to best suit the client's needs, should the current approach not be working for them.

The same principle applies to coaching. There are many ways to coach people, whether it be by analysing their thoughts and feelings about a situation, setting goals and tasks, identifying what is preventing them from making changes, or helping them to focus on their desired future and the steps needed to achieve it.

The beauty of FourGames is that it provides a shared language that can be used to work with clients, whether they are entrepreneurs seeking to grow their businesses or individuals looking to achieve personal goals, such as losing weight or getting fit and healthy. This shared language contains all approaches to change work in a simple map, and it doesn't matter where you start on that map to create change.

So, FourGames isn't about saying that any specific approach to coaching or therapy is wrong, it's about saying that they all fit on this one map. This allows coaches and therapists who already have an approach they like and find works well for them to use their approach, whilst at the same time, with clients who perhaps aren't shifting as they would like, the coach can clearly see which areas haven't been addressed and look at addressing these areas. For those who don't have coaching experience and are reading this to learn how to help people make changes, it will give you a framework and a language to use to help yourself and others make life changes.

FourGames is like a Rosetta stone (Thorne, 2017). The Rosetta

stone was a stone tablet found in 1799 which contained essentially the same text in Ancient Egyptian hieroglyphs, Demotic script and Ancient Greek. Scholars understood Ancient Greek and some of the Demotic script, which led them to realise that the writing was the same in these different languages, so they were able to translate the rest of the Demotic script and decipher the Ancient Egyptian hieroglyphs.

FourGames is a powerful tool for anyone working in the field of coaching or therapy. It provides a shared language and framework that can be used to work with clients from different backgrounds and with different goals. It allows coaches and therapists to use their existing approach whilst also being able to see and understand other approaches, making it easier to adapt and change to meet the needs of the client. Additionally, it's a user-friendly and flexible tool that can be used by both experienced professionals and those new to the field. FourGames can be thought of as a Rosetta stone for the coaching, therapy and personal development industry, unlocking a whole new world of possibilities for personal growth and change.

THE DEVELOPMENT OF FOURGAMES

Before delving into the specifics of FourGames, I'd like to provide some background on its origins. FourGames was created by Jamie Combs, co-founder of Natural Balance Foods. Jamie's background before starting Natural Balance Foods was in personal training and promoting clean eating and living. He observed that what often hindered people from achieving their goals was a lack of alignment between the FourGames. Jamie also noticed that people often became overwhelmed by complexity and would make poor choices or no decision at all. He came up with the concept of "what would Captain Simple do?"

Through his study of Eastern and Western philosophies, psychology, neurology, and observing human behaviour, Jamie realised that things can be deceptively simple if viewed through the lens of "what would Captain Simple do?" This is how he developed Nakd wholefood bars, with a focus on simplicity.

In today's fast-paced and complex world, where technology is advancing rapidly and we are constantly bombarded with an overwhelming amount of information, Jamie realised that simplicity is key. By taking a step back and looking at how to create a healthy snack, he discovered that all you need to do is squish together the ingredients with a little natural juice. This approach led to the creation of Nakd wholefood bars, which

are simple, healthy, and delicious.

Maintaining a focus on clean, green living and promoting happiness and health, Jamie continued to develop his FourGames model. He used it to guide the direction of Natural Balance Foods, to help staff understand their roles, to shape the company's vision for the present and future, and to ensure that meetings were productive and effective.

As the company grew, Jamie continued to refine and test his FourGames model. He shared it with others who were interested in coaching and personal development, and found that it stacked up well against what was known about how the mind works. He looked at what philosophers had said about personal growth, what therapeutic researchers had discovered about personal change in therapy, and how the model applied to those who had achieved success in business. Everywhere Jamie looked and everyone he talked to, he found that he could map what they were saying onto his FourGames model. He realised that he had a robust model that could be used as a common shared language.

Some key principles were the recognition that complexity needed to be removed in order to strive for simplicity, and that the emphasis should be on wholism rather than separatism. Jamie discovered that the FourGames model was all-encompassing, providing a multi-dimensional perspective on the issue at hand. It wasn't a model specifically created by Jamie, but rather one that emerged from his learning and understanding of the combined wisdom of centuries of Eastern and Western philosophies, as well as his scientific knowledge. Jamie found that once people knew how to use his FourGames model, they were empowered and able to achieve much more.

My involvement with FourGames began in 2008. I had taken a hypnotherapy training course, as I wanted to meet the instructor. The instructor hadn't taught hypnotherapy since the 1990s and wasn't sure if he would be teaching again in the future, so I booked myself on his course as soon as I had the opportunity. Jamie was also on the same course, and we had interacted a little during the online portion of the training.

Eventually, in the summer of 2008, we met in person.
We first spoke face-to-face when the instructor set the class a training exercise. We were paired up, and in our pairs, we had to come up with and write down a list of double binds - a hypnotic language pattern.
Jamie and I hit it off straight away, so for the duration of the exercise, we just chatted. We ran out of time and didn't actually come up with any double binds. At the end of the exercise, we were all called back into the main training room, where the instructor started going around the room asking each pair to say the double binds they had developed. Jamie leaned over to me and quietly said "we don't have anything written down!" I just smiled and didn't say anything.
When it was our turn to say the list of double binds we had written down, I looked down at the blank sheet of paper and just recited a list of double binds. It helped that I had been studying hypnosis since 1992 and teaching it since 2004. This impressed Jamie, and our relationship began. Jamie shared about his FourGames model, and over the coming years, we regularly met up. When we couldn't meet in person, we would chat over the phone for hours at a time to discuss FourGames and FourGames projects, including the writing of this book, the idea of having different courses available, and the possibility of developing a FourGames retreat.
From that point on FourGames has gone from strength to strength. Jamie has introduced many people to FourGames and I incorporated FourGames into my clinical hypnotherapy practitioner training courses to share the approach with a wider audience of those interested in coaching and psychological therapy

WE STAND ON THE SHOULDERS OF GIANTS

All great advances are built on the shoulders of the giants that came before. In pre-history Humans led basic lives, lives of simplicity within a complex world. Those Humans that survived and thrived did so by instinctively understanding the game they were a part of. They developed synchronicity between their Short-Game, Mid-Game, Long-Game and Deep-Game.

Early humans faced many challenges and lived difficult lives. Their development was slow for a couple of million years (Douglas, 2012). Despite this, they were able to create basic stone tools by chipping them into useful shapes. As time went on, these tools became more refined, but they remained basic in nature and purpose.

Around 30,000 - 50,000 years ago (Metcalfe, 2020) or possibly as early as 100,000 years ago (Pringle, 2013), human behaviour and culture began to shift. Humans started to have a deeper understanding and appreciation for creativity, expressing a sense of wonder for the world around them, and seeking to understand it on a deeper level. They also developed more advanced rituals, such as burying the dead with ceremonial items and creating jewellery and clothing as a form of self-expression. They began to create art and music and share messages through cave paintings and intricate designs on jewellery and carvings.

Humans were beginning to develop spirituality and practices for accessing consciousness and healing themselves and others (Bourzat & Hunter, 2019) through the use of rituals, trance, rhythm, and beliefs in something greater than themselves (Fuentes, 2020).

By 10,000 years ago Humans had begun to develop agriculture and domestication of animals (Madden, 2022). These advances showed a great leap forward in understanding the game these Humans were playing. Suddenly they were able to work less to achieve more, they were able to develop a consistent level of food all year round and in doing this they were able to free up time for other tasks.

Around 10,000 years ago, these humans no longer had to be nomadic and could focus on other aspects of life. This led to an increase in roles for them to fill, no longer being solely focused on hunting, foraging and caring for their young. They could now focus on the future, developing their agricultural and domestication practices, as well as art, creativity, social interactions and planning for the future. This created more time for them, resulting in further progress and development in a positive feedback loop.

For the following few thousand years, these early humans continued to improve their ability to plan and anticipate the future, developing astronomical skills and understanding messages from the heavens (Carter, 2022) and improving their communication abilities (Alex, 2018).

By 5,000 years ago, cultures had begun to emerge in Mesopotamia (in the region of Syria, Iraq and Turkey) and North-eastern Africa, displaying significant advancements in understanding the world and forming ideas about reality and societal roles. Hierarchical systems and rulers were becoming prevalent in these societies.

These humans constructed temples for healing, with many cultures developing "medicine men" or shamans. Early structured religions began to form (Bhardwaj, 2022) with teachings based on truth, love and shared experiences. Many belief systems were created that emphasised mind-body healing

practices, such as meditation, chanting, movement, music, specific diets, sleep temples and other activities that induced a trance-like state.

As Humans progressed, they became skilled in art, design and creation. They built 'wonders of the world' that were unparalleled for hundreds, and in some cases thousands of years. The Great Pyramid, for example, was the tallest man-made structure for nearly 4,000 years from around 2,600 BC until 1,311 AD when the Lincoln Cathedral took the title.

Over the last few thousand years, advances continued at a steady pace, with various technical, artistic and philosophical developments. Between around 800 BC and 1,200 AD, the Romans and Greeks made significant contributions to fields such as philosophy, mathematics, science, and art.

Notable Greek thinkers of the time included Aristotle, Archimedes, Democritus, Plato, and Hippocrates, while prominent Romans included Trajan, Marcus Aurelius, and Marcus Sergius. The Romans had a practical approach to problem-solving, while the Greeks were known for their mastery of the mind.

From the 1300s through to the 1500s, the Renaissance period began in Italy, marked by great works of art, literature, and forward-thinking. It was during this time that Leonardo da Vinci (1452-1519) emerged as a true master of his craft, demonstrating the full potential of one who understands the game they are playing and achieves harmony between their Short-Game, Mid-Game, Long-Game and Deep-Game.

The wisdom of da Vinci was unparalleled during his time. He understood the world around him and how he fit into it, creating designs and inventions for the time as well as understanding the world of the future. He was also a master of focus and an expander of reality. His works of art, designs, and teachings continue to reveal new information to us even 500 years later. Other notable figures of the time include Johannes Gutenberg, who invented the printing press, and Nicholas Copernicus, who questioned the belief that Earth was at the centre of the universe.

The 1600s became known as the "Age of Reason," with pioneers such as Isaac Newton, René Descartes, Gottfried Leibniz, and Blaise Pascal making significant advancements in science, philosophy, mathematics, and various other areas of society. These pioneers shared the same traits as Leonardo da Vinci, the great Greek and Roman minds before them, and all other trailblazers who pushed society and human evolution forward.

Following the 'age of reason', came the era known as the 'age of enlightenment'. During the 1700s, building on the work of Newton, Descartes, Leibniz, Pascal, and other thought leaders, came a new generation of individuals who understood the game and excelled at synchronising their Short-Game, Mid-Game, Long-Game and Deep-Game.

These thinkers, or thought leaders, included Benjamin Franklin, Immanuel Kant, and Jethro Tull. They played a crucial role in the beginning of the industrial revolution and the furthering of modern thought and practice. During the 1700s, there was also a development within psychology and mind-body healing. Notable figures such as Franz Anton Mesmer and Abbé Faria advanced the scientific study of how mind-body healing, whether for a psychological problem or a physical or psychosomatic problem, takes place. These were the early days of understanding how healing occurs, which sparked interest in the mechanisms behind it.

During the 1800s, there was a surge in advancements in various fields including science, the arts, mathematics, engineering, philosophy and progressive thinking. New ideas were being developed and those who understood the game were contributing to the advancement of society, laying the foundation for the world to change with the next generation of thought leaders. In music, Beethoven stood out and there was a resurgence of inventors and individuals who could combine ideas from different disciplines to create something new and innovative, such as Michael Faraday, Thomas Edison, Nikola Tesla, and Isambard Brunel. In addition, Charles Darwin and Louis Pasteur made significant contributions in their respective

fields. In the field of psychology, mind-body healing, and personal development, figures like William James, John Elliotson, James Esdaille, and James Braid stood out.

During the 1900s, the foundations laid by previous thinkers paved the way for great minds to contribute to the development of various areas including the arts, sciences, and philosophy. These pioneers brought about fundamental shifts in perception, leading to a world that was vastly different from anything that had come before. They took what was already known and made tremendous leaps, often with simple, previously unthought-of ideas and insights that had far-reaching consequences. Notable figures from the 20th century include Albert Einstein, Milton Erickson, Niels Bohr, Alan Watts, Aldous Huxley, Ernest Rossi, Ludwig Wittgenstein and Arthur C. Clarke.

Now we have arrived in the 21st century. We stand on the shoulders of giants and have a rich heritage to guide us in building the future. Many of the individuals who have advanced society throughout history have had a deep and often intuitive understanding of the game. There has been a persistent belief that there must be a better way. This drive has propelled mankind for thousands of years in the pursuit of a utopia, or a more perfect world.

Advances have come when individuals or groups have undergone a fundamental shift in perception. They have observed the beauty and wonder of nature, learnt from it, and aligned themselves with it, understanding that we are a part of nature, not separate from it. In this state of flow with nature, these pioneers have approached the question of what would lead to a better life holistically, for themselves, their friends, families, the wider community, and others. They have also considered what would lead to passing on a legacy of increased health, wellbeing, success, happiness, and achievement to future generations.

We are that distant future generation, and it is up to us to decide what we will do next. Many of the great leaps forward have been based on simple ideas, where looking back reveals a

truth that was always known, yet people at the time didn't realise they knew it.

All great leaps have been inclusive and connecting, both in bringing people together and by connecting with nature and the world around us. The dreams of many pioneers have come from striving to be rich, happy, healthy, and successful, doing what they love often without it feeling like work. They have wanted a rich social life, freedom from self-imposed chains, health, and happiness for themselves, their friends, and family, and to enjoy life.

The pace of change and progression has followed a hockey stick-shaped curve, from prehistory through to the present day. Progress started slowly with gradual developments, this gradual progression continued over thousands of years before beginning to curve more steeply over the last few thousand years, and then more dramatically over the last couple of hundred years (Gregersen, n.d.). Each step has advanced humanity. By working together, humans were able to bring down larger animals. With the harnessing of fire, we were able to extend our days, keep warm, and spread to new environments. By finding new ways to keep warm, like making and wearing clothes, allowed humans to move to live in colder climates. When we developed tools out of bone, and then stone, we were able to manipulate our environment to a greater extent; humans could cut down trees, fashion effective spears, cut food and materials for clothing.

For thousands of years, progress was slow and incremental, with stone tools being refined over time. But even these small developments increased lifespan, health and wellbeing. The next big leap came with agriculture and domestication, allowing for quicker travel, larger communities, and greater consistency in health and wellbeing. As these communities grew, so too did the rate of invention and thinking about how things could be improved, as ideas spread between different groups of people.

As humans became more experienced in this way of living, and communities grew larger, life spans continued to increase and people became healthier. This led to advances in mathematical

and spiritual understanding, and in the arts, as people sought to understand the deeper workings of the world around them. This in turn led to new discoveries in astronomy, which improved farming practices and navigation, and new understandings about the human psyche, propelling society forward.

By the last couple of thousand years, philosophy and mathematics had become major fields of study, building on what came before to advance society to a whole new level throughout the modern age. Humans are living longer than ever before; contrary to news reports, there is less violence in the world today, fewer people being murdered (Jabr, 2011). People are able to maintain health, wellbeing, and fitness well into old age. People can take time to focus on the future and how they contribute to it, and look back to the past and understand more about it than any previous generation. The world has become a smaller place, with people being able to connect with vast numbers of other people and share messages and learning with all these people, rather than just their tribe or village.

The question is, if so much has been achieved and it has all been achieved for the greater good of humanity, what has gone wrong? Why do so many people struggle with stress on a daily basis or feel unsatisfied with their lives? If we have always looked to nature and focused on being in harmony with it, why are humans the greatest disaster known to nature (Begum, 2021), other than extreme events like super volcanoes, large meteorites, and giant earthquakes?

For thousands of years, knowledge and wisdom spread slowly. But with the explosion of knowledge over the last couple of hundred years, many people have not known what to do with it. They haven't understood it, and as a result, many have got their priorities wrong. Some just want more - more money, more land, more time - and these people control the game as most people see it. They rig the game and promote a state of reality blindness in others, giving them the map they want them to follow. Many people are unhappy with this map, without realising that the map is not the reality it represents. They are

fed news stories and information that support the map they have been given, particularly in the era of social media and targeted advertising.

Here, we offer a new map and an invitation to a new world. If you are given a road map, it will help you get from A to B using the roads. Places and businesses that the map makers think you may be interested in will be marked on the map. But how did they decide this? Were they paid by any of the businesses marked on the map? The map will not tell you about everything you could discover on your journey, and it may well miss out on great discoveries that you will never be aware of.

If you are given a map of the contours of the land, you will know where the high ground is, where the low ground is, and the easiest routes between them. You will be able to intuit additional information, such as where rain will fall and run towards low ground, carving a stream or river over thousands of years. You will recognize where these rivers and streams are likely to be, and as you become familiar with the map, you will begin to recognize features that hint at rivers, streams, cliffs that would be too steep to climb, and inclines that would be manageable. You will also know where the best vantage points would be to get the best view over the land.

If someone had put in the effort to create a detailed map, it could show you forests, woodlands, streams, rivers, hills, valleys, marshlands, settlements, roads, and much more. They could even indicate how the map may change over time, for example, from season to season or with the tides. These maps with their non-judgmental details would be far more useful than one created for a single purpose by someone with one goal in mind.

The map we offer here exposes the games we play and how to master them. It reveals how to get the most out of life while maintaining integrity and connection with nature. It simplifies complexity and uncovers the hidden simplicity behind success, happiness, health and wellbeing. It teaches a fundamental shift in perception, opening your eyes to a world of discovery and wonder, expanding your consciousness and human potential, following in the footsteps of ancient pioneers, through to the

likes of Plato, Trajan, da Vinci, Copernicus, Newton, Franklin, Edison, Esdaile, Einstein, Erickson, Watts and now us.

We'll delve into how to master your Short-Game, how you direct your attention, your Mid-Game, how you engage with and interact with the world around you, your Long-Game, the role you play, and your Deep-Game, your identity, your perception of reality and how you can shape your future. This is a revolutionary approach to achieving success, gaining power and finding fulfilment. When Milton Erickson was asked about his therapeutic methods and how he appeared to be so innovative and what theories or systems he used, he would respond that he was simply using common sense psychology. Often, from very simple principles, complexity arises. Most people focus on the complexity and try to learn and master it, without peeling back the layers of complexity to reveal a hidden world of simple rules. A few, over the centuries, have uncovered these simple rules for themselves and achieved greatness in their own lives, as well as touching and enriching the lives of many others. With this common-sense approach, you too can uncover a world that has always been right in front of your eyes.

When I was young, my mother began working for a frozen food delivery company. Before that, I had never seen the company's delivery vans around, but once my mother started working there, I saw them everywhere. The company had been around for years, but until it had significance to me, I was blind to it. This is a common experience, where we only notice something when it has meaning to us. For example, how many people have purchased a new car thinking they will be driving something different, only to find that they see that same car everywhere once they buy it? This book aims to give you and your clients the freedom to notice different realities and choose which one you would like to exist in.

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AN OVERVIEW OF THE FOURGAMES

The FourGames model encompasses four worlds that we all exist within, which are referred to as "games" in the language of FourGames. These include the Short-Game, Mid-Game, Long-Game, and Deep-Game.

The Short-Game represents the inner intangible world, which encompasses our thoughts, feelings and behaviours. The Mid-Game is the first layer of the outer world, which includes the physical environment, or what people may think of as the 'real world'. The Mid-Game has four components: environment, systems, gadgets, and style. The Long-Game is the story, the role taken in that story, and the goal or path chosen to be followed. So, the Long-Game is the narrative. The Deep-Game is the sense of identity and belief system. The Deep-Game has four realms: mystery, identity, magic, and metaphor, and exploring these can help with understanding identity and beliefs.

As you can probably recognise, this model covers all elements that make up human experience, and different therapies and coaching models just start in different places across the FourGames. However, without using the FourGames model, they may miss some areas that could lead to clients not moving forward as expected. For example, a coach working on a spiritual level to help someone develop their Deep-Game could

still find that the person doesn't have an optimal Short-Game, and so they may behave incongruently with the Deep-Game they desire. Or, a cognitive therapist could work on the Short-Game, helping a client to look at changing their thinking style, but the client may still struggle because of their Mid-Game. It could be that they are being helped to address over-eating junk food, but there is just too much temptation in the environment they live in, so they keep finding themselves failing despite trying hard to change.

It could also be the case that someone has most of their games aligned and only needs to make changes in one or two areas. This model allows coaches and therapists to start anywhere in the model and move around as they wish. It could be that this is led by the client, their needs, and where they start, or it could be led by the coach or therapist, perhaps starting with their preferred modality before moving to explore other areas.

In the coming chapters, we will be breaking down the FourGames model to show how to navigate each one with a client, as well as how they can link together.

The FourGames Model

The FourGames model is a useful starting point for coaches and therapists because it covers all aspects of a client's situation. In this chapter, you will have all areas of the FourGames model explained, highlighting the importance of each section of the model. As mentioned, there is the Short-Game, which is the inner world - thoughts, emotions, and behaviours; the Mid-Game, which is the physical world - environment, gadgets, systems, and style; the Long-Game, which is the narrative of our life - stories, roles, goals, and path; and the Deep-Game, which is the 'who am I really?' - mystery, magic, metaphors, and identity.

Short-Game

The Short-Game in the FourGames model is composed of physical, behavioural, emotional and mental aspects. When working with a client in this area, it's important to address how

they think, feel and behave. A unique aspect of the FourGames model is that it allows coaches and therapists to help clients transform their lives without necessarily knowing what they want to change. This is because everything is interconnected.

For example, someone seeking to lose weight may be asked about their thought patterns and whether they are working for them. They may discuss worrying about work, bills or their relationship, but haven't mentioned weight loss. This provides an opportunity to explore what kind of thinking would be more beneficial for them. Research has also shown that using the 'as if' principle (Schiller, 2014), where a client 'tries on' a different way of being and notices the difference, can be effective. They may try a different way of thinking and responding to situations and as a result, reduce their worrying. This could lead to them stopping emotional eating, without ever having addressed weight loss directly.

It's important to bear in mind when working with a client's Short-Game that they are part of a larger system, so it may be necessary to explore other games as well. As the client speaks, it's important to listen out for when different games are mentioned, such as their Mid-Game, where their environment may be having an impact on them, or their Long-Game, where they may have taken on a parental role where they support everyone else, but find they develop burnout due to lack of support for themselves.

Physical/Behavioural

When working with the physical or behavioural elements of the Short-Game, you want to explore how the client's behaviour works for them in relation to what they want to achieve. What we do behaviourally is linked to our mental world, so if someone doesn't get enough sleep, they won't just feel tired, it will have an impact on their neurology and psychology, among other things, it will affect how well they learn and retain information, their concentration, and their willpower (Sampson & Minnis, 2021).

If you are coaching the client to help them address an issue,

whether this is personal or professional development or addressing a problem they would like to overcome, then you will want to know what behaviours they are currently doing that relate to the issue they are seeking coaching for and whether these behaviours are working for them or not, and if not, what behaviours do they need to be doing instead. If you are doing general coaching, what may be seen as wellbeing or personal growth coaching, where you are helping someone to align their FourGames, then you will ask about their behaviour and whether it works for them and whether the behaviour they are doing increases their wellbeing or not, and if not, what do they need to be doing differently.

I have worked with many parents offering parenting coaching. I wasn't working with them on depression treatment or anxiety treatment, although I could tell they were depressed or suffered with anxiety, what I was supporting them with was how to parent in a way that encouraged their children or teens to improve their behaviour. Something I noticed was that these parents often had very messy homes. Although I wasn't supporting them to improve their mental health, I would notice that their physical environment improved as visits went on. Parents would end up changing their mid-game, their environment, as they changed their thinking and behaviour around parenting. Not only did they start thinking about aspects of parenting differently, and so being willing to behave differently to influence an improvement in their children's behaviour, but they were also tidying up and improving the home environment. Myself and others doing similar work used to say you could tell when a parent was making progress towards no longer needing support because they would end up with a clean house.

From changing thinking and behaviour related to parenting, many parents would feel empowered, and would increase their confidence. They would also start to make other changes in their lives, which would help to lift them out of depression, despite the fact that we were not working on this, or on what was causing the depression. Often, the poor behaviour of the

children was a result of the parent being depressed, rather than the cause of the parent's depression. However, by improving one area of the parent's life, not only were relationships between the child and parent improved, but also wider relationships, and other areas of the parent's life, which in turn lifted their overall wellbeing.

For most changes, there will be a requirement for behaviour changes. It is a truism that if one always does what they have always done, they will get what they have always got. Some people may already have the appropriate thinking or emotions in place to allow them to make changes, but most people will need to get the right mindset and feelings about things before they are comfortable making changes.

For example, someone hoping to lose weight and get fit and healthy may currently lead a lifestyle of sitting down most of the day, eating junk food, and driving to places that are within walking distance. They know they need to be more active throughout the day, change the food they eat, and walk more instead of driving, but if they don't have helpful thoughts or feelings about behaving differently in life, they are unlikely to change their behaviour, even if they know what they should be doing.

Part of the problem with getting the correct thinking and feelings could be due to Mid-Game issues like having a poor environment that impacts the person's thinking or feelings, and thus prevents them from making the necessary behavioural changes. So, while the coach is identifying what behaviours need to happen for the client to achieve their goals, they will need to explore other areas of the FourGames to look at the client's situation holistically.

Emotional

The next realm within Short-Game is emotional. The latest neuroscience using fMRI scanners is showing that the emotional parts of our brains respond to environmental stimuli before our thinking or most behaviour kicks in (we do have automatic behaviours which happen faster than our emotional

response) (Kincaid, 2013).

This idea is often contrary to many psychotherapeutic approaches which work on the assumption that emotions can be changed by changing our thoughts. You can change emotions with thoughts, but you are changing the emotion which has already started, so someone that suffers anxiety who is entering a situation where they expect to feel anxious can decide to think differently as they enter the situation, they can run different thoughts through their mind and do different behaviour, like breathing calmly before and as they enter that situation to keep their emotional level down, or they can start to feel anxious, recognise the anxiety growing within them and then work on thinking relaxing, calming or empowering thoughts and breathe deeply and calmly to prevent the anxiety from taking hold.

Doing these different thinking and behavioural strategies are either reactive, or they are consciously having to put effort into preventing the automatic response from happening, so if someone is afraid of public speaking but they consciously make themselves calm before public speaking, and they continue to focus on consciously remaining calm while public speaking they have to maintain that effort and focus. What can happen is they can do this often enough that their story, or Long-Game shifts based on repeated experience of public speaking in this new way.

Emotions are the connection between our Long-Game and our Short-Game. We develop stories about ourselves and how we expect to experience the world around us, these stories become our non-conscious drivers for how we navigate the world. Every moment contains emotion, even if that emotion is very slight. When the person with anxiety of public speaking thinks about public speaking, or is about to stand up and give a presentation they will be feeling anxious because of a story they have. We will get into stories more when talking about long-game, but for now it is useful to know that when the coach is working with someone to help them feel differently about something, that feeling is tied to a story, and to have the best chance of changing

the feeling you will need to change the underlying story which is causing certain Mid-Games to lead to an unhelpful response.

Thinking

Modern therapists often focus on the thinking that clients do, they focus on how the client can change their thinking as a way of helping them to make changes in their life. This seems reasonable, very few things are easily under our conscious control, we have some control over our behaviour and breathing, and we can decide what to think. Most other processes are automatic and difficult to consciously control.

Thinking can be controlled consciously, but it isn't easy to make our conscious choices about how to think non-conscious. If someone is depressed because they feel trapped doing a job they don't want to be doing, and perhaps they are being bullied or discriminated against at work, they may well be able to understand that they need to think differently. That thinking about how they can change jobs, or what they can do about the bullying or discrimination, and perhaps focusing on the positives that they have a job which pays enough to cover their bills, and gives them enough income to have some money to spend on holidays and other things they would like would be helpful thinking.

But while they are feeling depressed, and while they have their Long-Game story behind the depression, they are unlikely to change their thinking and make that changed thinking automatic so that it happens without any thought. They will have to put in conscious effort until the thinking has been done frequently enough to become automatic. In therapy and coaching some people give up and drop out before they see lasting results because they don't have the motivation to stick with it, and keep putting in the prolonged effort, this is often where work on the clients' Long-Game is needed to help them to alter the underlying story and beliefs they have, and to perhaps work on ensuring they know what they hope to achieve. Some people are very good at putting in effort even when it is hard work, others need to find something that

motivates them.

An example of this is that it is common for people who get lung cancer due to smoking to then decide to quit smoking, they will have tried to stop smoking perhaps dozens of times beforehand and each time they failed to stop for any length of time. What often happens is that once the strong motivation is there they quit easily, and they find that they have almost no cravings.

Another example is speaking up in public. Many people feel uncomfortable complaining about their food being a little cold, or taking slightly too long to be served, they complain to whoever they are with, but when the waiting staff come to the table and asks "is everything alright?" they reply "it is lovely, thanks", and then carry on complaining to their friend about it not being very good and how they won't be coming back to this restaurant. Yet there is a point where something annoys the person enough for them to complain without a seconds thought. It could be that if they wait for 15 minutes to be served, they will get annoyed but won't complain, but if they have to wait for 30 minutes to be served, the restaurant looks quiet and they then have to wait another 30 minutes before their food arrives, they are so angry by this point that they complain to the waiting staff, and perhaps get the manager over.

Another example is having an argument with a partner, most people will feel embarrassed and self-conscious arguing and shouting at each other in public, but once someone is angry enough, they stop being self-conscious and they will argue and shout and won't even be thinking about what others may be thinking. This is an example of the story changing, once the situation reaches a certain intensity or level of anger and annoyance the person's story changes from one of this is how people should act in public, and people should be respectful and kind to each other and you shouldn't upset other people, to a story of feeling justified, feeling that you have to say something, you have to assert your views and opinions.

What leads people to change and then find thinking differently easy is unique to every individual, I worked with someone who smoked 10 cigarettes per day, they wanted to quit smoking, they

had tried many times in the past, they already had the right kind of mind-set around smoking, but they kept finding themselves smoking, and then felt guilty with each cigarette they smoked. I asked about what they ultimately wanted, how did the stopping smoking fit in with their other games, how did it fit with how they thought, felt, behaved, how did it fit with their mid-game, with their long-game and Deep-Game. They told me about how they wanted to become a mother and would feel guilty if they got pregnant and smoked while pregnant before they realised they were pregnant.

They were sure they would stop smoking if they were told they were pregnant, but obviously would have then been smoking for a while whilst pregnant. I asked them about their role in the life of their child that they would like to take, and then we explored the 'if nothing changes what could be the worst-case outcome?' The client and myself spoke about how she could end up dying young and having an unpleasant death, and her child may have to witness this, and would know that she had selfishly put her own addiction above the love of her child, and she chose to inflict these distressing memories upon her child.

Following this single session, the client left assertively saying she will never smoke again, she will never put a child through that kind of future. She quit smoking that day and now over 15 years later she has two children and has never smoked since, and didn't find it difficult to stop smoking because smoking wasn't a part of her story, so all of her changed thinking came naturally and easily to her. This is the same story I have heard from many people who have tried to make changes, and then when they were 'in the correct frame of mind' they found making changes easy.

Mid-Game

The mid-game is the world of real things, things which can be touched and experienced, it is the environment we live in, the gadgets we have around us, the systems we live within, and the style. What you are addressing in the mid-game is how and where the client lives. Some therapies and coaching approaches

neglect this aspect of their clients' experience and then wonder why someone isn't making the necessary changes when in sessions they seem to have the correct attitude, they seem to be thinking about things in a way which looks like change should happen, they seem to have a helpful emotional response, they seem willing to make all of the behavioural changes, yet every session they arrive and appear to be back at square one again. Some therapists and coaches will just continue to plod along trying to create change without knowing why change isn't happening, what can often be behind this lack of change is a mid-game problem which hasn't been identified.

Some examples of this can be; the mother who isn't supported by her husband when trying to put in place a new parenting approach to try to address their child's poor behaviour, so every session she says she is doing everything asked, she is trying her best, but her son isn't changing his behaviour. What can be preventing the change is the husband not being on-board with the changes, so he is giving in to the son, undermining the work the mother is doing. Or perhaps the problem stopping change is that the mother is a single mother with four children of a variety of ages and she is so busy having to do housework, cooking, looking after the other three children that she does her best to implement the new parenting approach but sometimes forgets or doesn't get a chance to do so because she is preoccupied dealing with other things, so this leads to a lack of consistency which makes the child aware that his mother isn't always doing as she says.

Another example can be a smoker who goes home from therapy or coaching to quit smoking to a home which smells of smoke, has ashtrays everywhere, perhaps cigarettes in the house, and maybe even a partner who still smokes and has no intention of stopping smoking, so during the week between smoking cessation sessions the client starts smoking again.

What is needed in these examples is for the coach or therapist to address the client's mid-game during the session to see how conducive it is to change, and what changes perhaps need to be made to a client's mid-game to help make changes.

Many people talk in mid-game language all the time, they don't talk about their emotions, or thoughts, or behaviours unless it is in reference to their mid-game, they also set their long-game around their mid-game. These people will talk about things they own, things they hope to own, success (or failure) they have, how this came about, and the image they present.

Environment

The environment is the first component of the mid-game, the environment is where you exist, this can be the office environment you work in, or your home environment, or the environment you spend your leisure time in. The environment can be conducive to health and wellbeing, or it can have a negative impact on health and wellbeing.

An example of this could be spending six to eight hours per day working in a dimly lit office with very little natural light, and very little access to the outside world. It is common for staff not to take breaks away from their desk and instead eating at their desks. This obviously has a different impact on the individual compared to when an individual takes time away from their desk to go outside, stretch their legs, and get some fresh air.

People often don't realise how bright it is outside compared to in an office, even when it seems the office is well lit it is usually still many times dimmer than being outside even on a cloudy day. Being up and moving around is hugely beneficial, even walking up and down stairs and going for a short walk during a lunch break can have positive health benefits (Sianoja et al., 2018).

If an environment is cluttered and untidy this can make it difficult to find things, and for some people this can feel uncomfortable. Some people find that they are restless when they are in an untidy environment, especially when they are feeling ill.

As a coach or therapist, it is important to find out about a client's environment. This will help to find out how the environment is impacting on the client and the issue they hope to address, it also helps the coach to find out more about the

type of person the client is and any challenges which may be faced when helping the client. For example; if a client wants to lose weight but their environment is full of junk food in the fridge and freezer and cupboards, and they have chocolates or biscuits out on display then they will be in an environment which isn't conducive to achieving the goal they want.

The coach will have to explore this with the client to look at how they can change the environment. This may impact on others in their environment, they may have to stop buying chocolates, sweets, cakes and treats so that these items aren't in the house. There could be some resistance to this if the sweets, chocolates and treats are also for the children or a partner who wants them in the house.

I have seen this many times, when clients identify that they have a problem – like wanting to lose weight, but they don't see the connection with the environment and health, and with the impact the environment is likely to also have on their children's health. They will talk of not wanting to deprive their children of sweets and treats, rather than focusing on how they can also help their children to improve their health when there is easy access to unhealthy food, and difficult access to healthy food.

Environment can be so important for whether someone is likely to achieve success or not. If a smoker seeks coaching to stop smoking, and then after the session gets back into a car which smells of smoke and probably has cigarettes in the glove compartment, or gets home to a house which smells of smoke, with ashtrays and other smoking gadgets dotted around they are going to find it difficult to quit.

We are pattern-matching creatures, it is natural for us to follow patterns, especially established patterns, so if a smoker can smell smoke still in their environment this constant reminder of smoking makes it difficult not to smoke.

If the smoker wants to stop smoking, they should thoroughly clean their environment before they have their coaching session. The idea is that if their car smells fresh and clean, their clothes smell fresh and clean, their home smells fresh and clean, if they don't have any ashtrays out on view, have the walls

of their home cleaned (for example if they are stained from years of smoking), and all cigarettes are thrown away, then following the coaching session they go back to an environment which could well be the environment of a non-smoker.

As this environment doesn't have the same triggers as their old environment, they are less likely to return to smoking. They may still have triggers, but they don't have easy access to cigarettes, so when they wake in the morning they may want a cigarette with a morning coffee, and they could change the coffee for another drink which may help break this trigger, but it is also difficult to get hold of a cigarette to have with the morning coffee because they don't have cigarettes in the house or car, so they would have to get dressed and go to a shop to buy cigarettes, all before they can have that morning coffee. This can take a lot of effort first thing in the morning before having that morning coffee, so it is more likely the client will decide to have the coffee and not the cigarette. Each time they make these new decisions they are learning a new pattern of behaviour.

So, making a mid-game change – changing the environment and gadgets, can increase lasting success of desired changes. This also applies to achieving other types of success. If someone wants to write a novel and they decide to try to write the novel at home sat in a messy flat with noisy neighbours, with pets jumping up on their lap every five minutes, with only views of walls and if they look outside the flat all they can see is a busy road, noisy traffic, and the buildings across the street, they may struggle to get into a mental zone where they can comfortably and effectively work.

Some people may say this environment helps them because they feel more compelled to escape the 'real-world' to become absorbed in the story they are writing, but most authors are likely to say they struggle to focus and they often feel restless and uncomfortable.

So, there are some environments which are likely to help and to inspire the author. It could be sitting by the sea, or in a park, or out in the countryside. Some authors check-in to a nice hotel

room once per week while they are writing, and they write from the time they can check-in, late into the evening, and then continue the next morning until check-out time. Others will sit in cafés in nice, relaxing locations to write, this is something I frequently do, and am doing now while writing this.

If someone is trying to achieve business success then they are likely to work better in an environment which helps to promote creativity, which has spaces for mixing with other staff as well as spaces for working quietly alone, and pleasant outdoor spaces. They are likely to be less effective and less able to achieve success with business projects, creativity and personal development if they are working like battery hens crammed into a small office with poor lighting.

Gadgets

The second realm of the mid-game is gadgets. Gadgets are the physical things which feature in our environment, so for example the Nakd wholefood bars are the gadgets of Nakd's mid-game. Our mid-game is full of gadgets, it is important for coaches and therapists to explore what gadgets a client has in their mid-game and whether these are helpful or a hindrance to wellbeing and growth. Gadgets can be helpful, for example; if someone is unable to get an opportunity for an appropriate level of physical exercise they may have an exercise bike, or may have a computer console with fitness games which they use, these aren't as good for our wellbeing as going for a cycle or a run outside in countryside, but they are better than doing nothing. Likewise, if parents decide they want to change the diet of their children, and their children have grown up only eating junk food and the parents don't believe their children will eat fruit and vegetables they may swap chocolate bars and other current snacks with healthy snacks like Nakd bars which has then improved a large part of the children's diets, and then over a period of weeks introducing healthier food at main meal times.

Deciding to drive rather than walk to local places where doing the opposite would be preferable is another area where we can

fall into using a gadget when not using the gadget would be better for us. I worked in a family therapy setting for a number of years. Over this time, I was the only member of the team who was a non-driver. I used to walk about 45 miles per week at work. I saw as many clients as the other staff, I did all the same amount of work as the other staff, and I worked the same number of hours as the other staff. I was also far more organised than other staff, and often far more relaxed. I would schedule all of my visits to see families who lived near each other all in the same day, whereas the car drivers wouldn't do this, they would have a visit in one town, and then 30 minutes after that visit they would have a visit scheduled in a town 8 miles away, and then 30 minutes after that visit they would have another visit in another town, again perhaps 8-10 miles away, and then maybe a visit back in the initial town.
I would have 6 visits during the day, all in the same town, all perhaps a maximum of 1-2 miles apart from each other. Because I didn't have to focus on driving, I would get a bus or train to the town the home visits were in. While on the bus or train I could complete paperwork and catch up on cases I was going out to, and think about what I would be doing. Then once in a town I would walk between all visits, and while I walked, I would be calm and relaxed, I would think about the visit I had just come out of and what I needed to think about for the next session, and had time to then also think about what happened at the last session with the client I was heading to, and what I needed to think about or consider when I go into that session. I would enjoy noticing wildlife, walking down country lanes, and having time to relax and think, as well as taking time to read and listen to podcasts.

Style

The third mid-game realm is style. Style is the label you would give to describe your environment, it could be that your description of the environment is: chaotic, organised, or relaxing, or any other label a client can give. These labels can be telling of how the client perceives their environment and the

impact it has on them. Two different people could give very different labels to the same environment. Part of this helps to see whether the environment is a problem or not, and also can reveal about how the client thinks. So, if a client labels their environment as chaotic it could be that they are disorganised, that they think chaotically and struggle to focus attention on one task, and stick at creating change or getting things done.

As has been mentioned before it is interesting how interrelated our different games are. When someone starts improving their thinking and emotions their environment often improves, and the same is often true the other way. When a client improves their environment, this can impact on their short-game by improving how they feel, how they think and how they behave.

There was an experiment carried out in New York where graffiti was constantly removed the day it appeared (Sloan-Howitt & Kelling, 1990), where underground train windows were covered with a plastic sheet which could be removed and replaced if the windows were scratched, rather than the scratch actually happening on the glass. At the end of every day any windows with scratched graffiti had the graffiti removed. Streets were also kept clean and clear, and any damaged windows were quickly replaced with new windows.

What happened was that crime significantly reduced in the areas where the environment was kept looking crime free. When there were smashed windows, and messy streets, and graffiti, this encouraged more behaviour of 'doing the same', where crime would increase because the environment looked like a place crime took place in. When the environment looked crime free and well looked after crime decreased, and as time passed where graffiti was being constantly cleaned up those doing the graffiti reduced how much they were doing because it didn't serve a purpose when it was gone by the next day. So having a 'style' of environment as clean and crime-free encouraged a change in the behaviour of those who had previously committed crime in that area, it had probably also influenced their thinking and feelings.

This is something which occurs in children's homes as well.

When the children or teenagers damage the property, if the damage isn't quickly repaired then the children's behaviour can get worse. When it is repaired and their environment is kept looking like a nice place to live the children start taking pride in their home, they begin to feel more comfortable in the home and feel safer in the home, and their behaviour improves. It is sometimes easier to create change by changing the environment because then the changes the individual makes are changes which come from within them in response to the environmental changes, rather than having the client feel they are having to put effort into changing.

Systems

The last mid-game realm is systems. Systems are the mechanics which make the environment work. Sometimes systems could rub against each other. It could be that an environment is used for more than one thing, like a dining room being used by someone as an office, and yet it is also used for having the family sit down and eat together. This could create problems if it is needed for both uses at the same time. Or a gadget could be straddling more than one system, like having a computer which is used by the children for their homework, and by a parent for doing their accounts, and there may be times when these clash which could cause problems.

There are other systems also like relationships with others. If someone tries to quit smoking but has a partner who wants to continue smoking, or if someone quits drinking alcohol but has a partner who has a drink every night this can create a systems conflict. The client is a partner, but also a non-smoker, or non-drinker. The environment they want is perhaps one which doesn't have any trace of cigarettes or smoking, or alcohol or drinking behaviour, but they are stuck in an environment which has a system putting it in conflict with how they would like the environment to be.

We can't escape the fact that we are a social species, we don't exist in isolation from others, we exist in relationship with others. We can't ethically force others to change their

behaviour, we can only change ours. Systemic therapy looks at therapeutic treatment through systems that we live in. It works on the understanding that when one part of a system changes the whole system must change (Sutton & Nash, 2021). It is often described as being like a child's play mobile hanging over the child's bed. If you gently move one part of it the whole thing ends up moving. You don't necessarily know what the final outcome will be when you change a system, but change will occur. The aim as a coach is to encourage clients to make changes which will be in a positive direction towards the future they want even if you and the client don't know exactly how things will shift.

An example of this is if someone seeks coaching because they are struggling to sleep and the coach recognises that one of the reasons for the client struggling to sleep is because they are worrying about some work they need to complete, but they are procrastinating and not getting the work done, it can be suggested that if they are awake fifteen minutes after going to bed they get up, go to another room and do that work they have been putting off all night long without going back to bed, and this can be the consequence they are to give themselves any night they are awake when they should be asleep. If the client agrees to carry out this task, then they are likely to improve their sleep and resolve their sleep problem.

The coach doesn't know exactly what will happen, but they do know the client needs to get that work done, and they keep putting it off, and this is causing them stress and worry. The coach also knows that the client wants to sleep and that they currently get very little sleep through the night, so they won't lose much sleep by staying awake all night. The coach also knows that if the client stays awake all night long doing the work they are putting off, then once they have completed this work, they will be free from the stress and worry this was causing which may improve sleep, but at worst it will remove a worry and reduce stress, and staying awake all night every night that the client isn't asleep within fifteen minutes will make the client very tired.

Even if they were sleeping just two hours per night, they will feel much more tired when they haven't slept at all, so they are increasingly likely to fall asleep quickly when they get the chance to sleep purely due to physical tiredness. The coach doesn't know how quickly this will happen for any given client. They could fall asleep straight away by night two, or they may not fall asleep through the night until night seven, but what the coach is doing is encouraging a change in the system, changing how the client interacts with the environment in a positive direction which is likely to lead to improvement even though the coach and the client don't know exactly what new changes will happen and how those changes will happen.

Another example is having clients cleaning when they aren't asleep, and often once their environment is clean and tidy, they feel more comfortable and so sleep better, and it is almost like once they have tidied and sorted out the environment they have also tidied and sorted out their mind and whatever was playing on their mind. Or in family therapy when a parent complains about the state of their child's bedroom and how they are always arguing with their child about the bedroom, and they always end up having to clean the bedroom. Having the parents accept that they will stop cleaning the bedroom and stop telling-off the child about the state of the bedroom, and they will leave the responsibility for the cleanliness of the bedroom in the hands of the child.

Some parents initially find this difficult, and they don't necessarily see how this task is going to help with the problem. What often happens is that the child ends up wanting certain items of clothing, but they are dirty on the child's bedroom floor not washed, they end up losing things among the mess in the bedroom and start getting annoyed with this, they don't want friends visiting anymore due to the state of their bedroom, and they feel less comfortable sleeping in their bedroom. They initially like the improved relationship with their parents because they aren't always arguing, they feel the parent is respecting them more by allowing them to be responsible for their own space, conversations with parents' start being about

other things, like interests the child has, or what the child is getting up to rather than all about the bedroom.
After a while they often start complaining at the parents about their lost items, or dirty clothes, and they blame the parents for this, but the parents can just reply that they are responsible for their bedroom, that is what they wanted. After some more time passes when the parent hasn't been tidying the bedroom, and the child hasn't been tidying the bedroom they usually reach a point where they decide it needs doing and they start tidying the room or ask the parent to help them tidy their room – which if they do, the parent supports the child in tidying the room, they don't do the tidying for the child, so they may help by taking the laundry away that the child gives them to wash, but they are letting the child take the lead in doing most of the work.
What is important here again is that the client and the coach don't know what the exact outcome is going to be. So, it could be the child is happy to live in a messy bedroom, and so they never tidy it because to them it isn't a problem, and the parent may have to just take cups and plates and some clothes and bedding out of the room from time to time just to ensure the room remains hygienic, but other than this they leave the room as it is. They may say to their child that they aren't having friends in their room while the room looks like this, but for the child as they currently are, and at the age they are, none of this may be important to them. But what still happens is that the relationship with the parent improves due to no longer having arguments, the child feels more respected, and feels they have a greater sense of autonomy. Often there will be reduced stress for the parent and child.

Long-Game

The long-game is all about story and narrative. We all have a past, present and projected future. This process of having a place in time is something which isn't tangible, you can't grab hold of your story, of who you are, yet we are all the product of our story. This becomes evident at funerals when friends and family are describing the deceased person, and they describe

the person through story or narrative, they describe what the person was like, they were what they were like due to their personal history. If they were described as hardworking this is likely to be something they learnt to be as they grew up, and as time went on this trait became internalised and became a part of who they were. It may have been something they placed importance on, or it may have been something they didn't really pay attention to or notice about themselves.

If they were described as shy and quiet, there is likely to be some story behind how they became shy and quiet. Nobody is specifically born shy or quiet, it is something that develops as we grow up. This could be something that developed from a bad childhood which made them become introverted, or from a positive childhood where they developed humility and a humble nature where they didn't feel particularly ego driven, they didn't feel that they needed to 'prove' anything to others, so they were comfortable with silence, comfortable with letting others do all the talking while they sit back and observe what is going on around them. They may not have been shy at all; this may well have just been the interpretation those specific people gave to the fact the person was quiet. Another group of friends may have seen evidence which made them feel the deceased most definitely wasn't shy. So, our stories are often complex and detailed, and everyone around us would be likely to see a different aspect of our story, and we will have our own views and beliefs on our story.

Long-game can be long-term or short-term. It could be the story or narrative someone tells themselves about who they are and where they have come from and where they are going with their life, or it could be who they are, where they have come from and where they are going in relation to a specific part of their life or goal. So, someone who is just starting out with healthy eating may focus on finishing a banana as their long-game, or they may be looking further into the future and thinking about achieving a specific fitness level as their long-game, and eating the banana may just be one step on that path to achieving that improved fitness. The long-game can give motivation, emotion,

desire and focus.

Within this story there will be challenges and defining moments, there will also be goals, and everyone plays a role within their own story, and weaving all of this together will be a path.

There is an interplay between the long-game and the short-game. The long-game stories will influence the short-game instinctive thoughts, behaviours, emotions, and beliefs. The long-game sets up the foundations of our identity. We are all born into our own unique environment, within this mid-game environment we observe the adults around us, and learn from them how we should respond within different situations, we develop language and behaviours based on the significant adults and perhaps older siblings we see in those early years. We are all born as individuals with some innate settings preparing us for the expected world we are about to face, so if our mother is stressed during the last few months before birth the stress hormones in the mother's body influence the hormones within the womb, which in turn influence the epigenetic expression of the genes of the unborn baby to prepare the unborn baby for a potentially threatening world (Miller, 2022). When born the baby will likely be more reactive to stress meaning they may well be a more difficult child, or maybe hypervigilant, or hyperactive, and they may demand more attention because they want to be in the company of the significant adult figure for safety. The child may also be born likely to respond quicker with anger or anxiety than perhaps a child born from a mother who was calm and relaxed during the last trimester before birth because these are behaviours which help get you safe from threats - either running away or fighting.

This can be turned around by being in the company of a calm and caring parent that teaches them to relax and helps them to learn how to handle stress well, and even when much older it can be turned around by having the teenager or adult learning how to relax and how to be calm, and how to handle stressful situations in a calmer way. But these early experiences prior to birth can begin to shape the story someone may have.

They may say 'I have always been an anxious/angry person'. They may well have the belief that they were born this way so they can't change, and because they believe they can't change they have never tried to change, and where they have tried, if it has been difficult, they have used this as evidence to support the idea that they can't change – because it is proving to be difficult, and so they quit trying. So, their story from the outset contains beliefs which are limiting, which give them an unhelpful path, and the role they have taken within their story is one of helplessness and defeatism. They also may not have any positive goals. They may constantly say 'I wish I didn't feel anxious all the time' or they may constantly give themselves negative self-hypnotic suggestions to support their story like 'I feel anxious, I feel angry, I'm a failure, I never succeed, I can't do anything right'

Others can recognise turning points or defining moments that have contributed to their story. The advantage of the long-game is that the story of our past no longer exists. How we thought about things in the past, how we behaved in the past, what we believed in the past about past situations are all in our mind because we are in the present. Everything in our past has already happened, it is now only a perception which contributes to your story.

Our brains don't work like computers despite computer analogies being some of the most used analogies for how the brain works. A computer stores things exactly as they were at the point they were saved. If a photograph is taken of Tower Bridge in London using the webcam on a laptop that image will be stored in the computer looking as it does based on the information the laptop's webcam was able to perceive when taking the photograph. If the file for the photograph is opened now it will look the same as it did at the time the photograph was taken and the image was saved, it will look the same as it did if it was opened shortly after it was taken, it will look the same if it is opened in ten years' time.

This isn't how our memories work. If you do an internet search now for a photograph of Tower Bridge, while looking at the

image draw what the bridge looks like. The more time you spend over this the more detailed you are likely to be able to make the image you draw, but if you give yourself a one minute time limit – much longer than the computer's camera took, and much more time spent over a single item than your memory does in everyday life where you give most things just a passing glance, then once you have drawn the bridge close the image so that you can't see it, and put the image you have just drawn somewhere out of sight. Now draw the bridge again from memory, and then label that drawing so that you know it was the second one you drew, then tomorrow draw the bridge again from memory.

What you will notice is that all the drawings are different, most likely less detailed as time went on, and if you kept drawing the bridge from memory every few days you are likely to notice bridges you draw are more similar to the previous bridge you drew than they are to the original 'real' bridge.

This is how memory works, not like a computer, but rather it gets an approximation of something with a focus on what was felt to be important at the time, and then every time the memory is recalled it is changed based on how it is recalled (Bridge & Paller, 2012) – for example which bits of the memory were recalled first, what emotion is being experienced as the memory is recalled, what the reason is for the recall, and a number of other factors. These changes are often fabrications.

A common example of this is that many people 'remember' events that are in photographs, like a photograph of them as a two year old in a bathtub smiling at the camera, and they will say they remember when that photograph was taken, they will recall things people were saying and other details, and usually they have no real memory of the photograph being taken, what they remember is seeing the photograph and hearing parents or others talking about the photograph and about when the photograph was taken.

There have been scientific false memory studies (Garry & Gerrie, 2005) where people are shown photographs which are fake but plausible, for example of them at specific events or in

specific situations, and participants are told that 'we have some photographs your parent gave us of you and we want to ask you about the photographs and see what you remember about the different times in the photos'. They get shown the photographs and give a story to the fake photos without realising the photographs are fake.

This ability to believe our past story, yet have the past story as something which is fluid and changeable is helpful for a coach to know because regardless of what is in the *reality* of the past, all that is left now is a representation of that past, and this representation isn't fixed in stone, even if the client is living as if their story is a fixed immovable aspect of themselves which they are responding to here in the present as if it has power of them. It is possible to alter aspects of the represented past in helpful ways.

For example; in therapy sessions with long term depressed clients who have experienced depression and anxiety through much of their lives and who claim to be 'natural born worriers', I have had clients imagine going back to key past memories and adding themselves into the memory as a helpful trusted friend, and had them tell themselves what they needed to be told and needed to hear back then to help them to handle those situations differently. I have had clients 'meet' me in the past having me help them through difficult parts of their lives 're-writing' their past, I have also had them think about memories and then replay the memories with those situations going differently – not changing the outcome, but having them focus on the memory in different ways.

For example; they may focus on the strength they had not to respond in a certain way, or respond by thinking about how it was an isolated situation, or focus on what they are learning from the situation. If it is memories for example which have led to a belief that they are a failure and always will be a failure I may have them focus on what those memories can teach them about their own success, or on how those people who instilled the idea that they were a failure aren't important to listen to about those things, and who in the past can they listen to

instead, so that in the future when they think about that person who was always calling them a failure they feel neutral about those memories and don't *buy into* what that person was saying, instead they think about how they know that person was wrong, and instead they focus on the memories which empower them, which teach them about their ability to achieve success.

Deep-Game

Deep-game is your sense of identity, as Jamie says, "your deep-game is the Zen Master question of 'who are you REALLY?'"
Deep-game has four realms: Mystery, Identity, Magic and Metaphor. Each of these attempts to deepen your understanding of your identity. It is possible to help someone without addressing their deep-game, and it is possible for people to do well in life without paying attention to their deep-game, but those who do take a look at their deep-game can begin to truly understand themselves and their identity. That awareness can help us to interact better with the world from a place of volition rather than just reaction.
The deep-game is an area which can be difficult to put into words because it is often made up of concepts and ideas and deeper understandings about who we are.

Mystery

The first realm is mystery. Mystery can be difficult to explain because it is a summation of the human condition – who are we REALLY. It is having a wonder about ourselves, who we are in all completeness. Many clients with 'problems' may not be seeking deep-game understandings within brief coaching, whereas clients who seek coaching for personal development and improvement may seek deeper awareness and understanding of themselves.
At the top of Abraham Maslow's 'hierarchy of needs' (Mcleod, 2022) is self-actualisation. This can be something to strive for but not something everyone is focused on. According to Maslow's work people meet their most basic needs first and foremost, that is their needs for shelter (including clothing to

keep warm and dry), food and water – and obviously air to breathe. Once they have these immediate survival needs met then they will seek to get longer term survival needs met like sleep and safety.

If they feel safe and secure and aren't struggling for basic physiological and biological needs then they will usually seek out belonging needs like forming relationships, and continuing the survival of the species needs like sex, this can help with feeling secure and supported which is a great starting block for seeking esteem needs, in the same way a teenager who feels they have a secure and safe loving family is more likely to feel comfortable and supported in seeking employment and then leaving home.

These esteem needs are about gaining a sense of achievement and status. If you didn't feel safe at home and didn't have others supporting you and didn't feel you were able to get enough food to survive you wouldn't be focusing on trying to achieve status or hold down a job. If you are hungry you may steal to survive, whereas if you are well-fed with shelter and support of loved ones most people are unlikely to decide to steal.

Once esteem needs are met people generally seek cognitive needs, they start focusing on increasing knowledge, on gaining meaning and self-awareness. As the cognitive needs are met and we feel we are able to learn and gain knowledge about ourselves it is natural to start to relax and focus on aesthetic needs, this can be gaining individuality and our own sense of style. For most people even with challenging backgrounds and life stories they have their survival and safety needs met, they belong to a family or friendship group, or religion, or shared interest group of some kind, they feel some sense of esteem, although some people may lack esteem in specific areas, they have cognitive needs met by having some self-awareness and knowledge, and most people will look to form a style and image of who they are and will start to appreciate the beauty in the world, but not many people move beyond this to self-actualisation where they achieve a sense of personal growth and self-fulfilment, and

achieving their full potential.
Often, they reach a level of having a 'good enough' life where they get stuck and stop progressing, they reach a level where their life is about the same today as it will be tomorrow, as it was last year and will be next year. Very few people show interest in taking that next step to focus on their deep-game and achieving their full potential, this seeking is searching within mystery with a sense of curiosity.

Identity

The second deep-game realm is identity – the 'who do YOU think you are?' There are really only two starting points for this – *a part* of, or *apart* from everything else. Most people think they are apart from everything that isn't their short-game, they are just interacting with everything else. Many spiritual traditions strive towards helping people recognise they are a part of everything else rather than apart from everything.
When someone operates from a perspective of being apart from everything else conflict can occur and change can be more difficult. If someone wants to stop smoking and they develop a non-smoker's mind-set, and they now feel that smoking is disgusting and not something they want to do, they will have changed their thinking, emotions and behaviour. If they go and get into their car which smells of smoke, with cigarettes in the glovebox, and they have a long-game of believing they always fail, and their deep-game is one of being apart from everything else, then their mid-game and long-game will be in conflict with their short-game because they never look to address these areas from their perspective of being a part of them.
Being a part of these areas, rather than apart from these areas the smoker will recognise they aren't an island, if they are in a relationship, they are the couple, if they have children, they are a family, they may be son, brother, grandson, father, uncle, friend, and more. All of these are part of their identity. Some people will say 'home just isn't home without you here with me'. The type of person making this statement will also see that by implication home also isn't home unless they are part of that

home too, they make home 'home' as much as their partner makes home 'home'.

The smoker who is a part of their wider world will recognise that the environment is an extension of who they are, the gadgets they have are extensions of them as a person, they are intimately connected with their story, with their role and path. Having this awareness, they will consider the influence these other areas have on them in relation to what they hope to achieve, they will also explore how to be true and congruent to themselves. Someone not being congruent and true to themselves may make changes which aren't in-line with their identity, or with the role they generally feel they have, and they may then feel guilt or shame or anxiety because of decisions they have made.

This can be seen when people have affairs and, in the present, they convince themselves it is alright, they justify it to themselves, they feel excited perhaps about the affair, and their behaviour is carrying out the affair. This is a *trance* problem. They are in a trance, or specific perception of reality so they don't pay attention to other aspects of reality. In this case while they are in the company of the person they are having the affair with they aren't thinking about their partner and the impact on that partner, they aren't thinking about their mid-game, about the environment beyond having the affair and they aren't thinking about their long-game.

Most people who have affairs aren't horrible, nasty people, they are ordinary people. They don't think of themselves as mean or horrible, and the affair doesn't match with the image they have of who they are, or of who others think they are. They are acting from an identity of being apart from everything else, rather than a part of everything else.

It is difficult to have an affair when your focus is on being a part of a family, being a husband or wife, mum or dad, being part of an environment where you recognise problems which need addressing to improve the environment and your role in that environment and in the issues which need addressing, and you feel a part of your long-game, striving to have a specific role,

and even more so if your identity is inclusive and *wholistic*. Even when we aren't immediately connected to other things we can feel the connection, like our personal history 'where we came from', which can either be seen as a part of us, or apart from us.

The only limit to your identity is where you set the limit. The question becomes one of separatism or wholism. Often being separate from everything else can create isolation, fear and vulnerability, whereas being connected offers freedom, growth, inclusion, security, and comfort.

Magic

The third deep-game realm is Magic. Magic can be nature, food, existence. We are all magic. When Jamie is teaching children, he will start with 'you are the magic part, you are the unexplainable thing, you have got all of these super powers, you can think, feel and move – it's amazing.'

We are all the product of an unbroken line of magical occurrences, our parents met, the correct sperm and egg met and survived to create us, both parents had the same story with their parents, and that story goes back each generation to the beginning of life on Earth, and since the beginning of life on Earth your ancestors have managed to survive long enough to create the next generation, and even before life began something magical happened to turn non-life into life, and going back further the Earth's creation story is a violent story, but one which contributed to the Earth becoming suitable for life to develop, grow, and thrive, and this magic can be followed right back to the beginning of the universe and the laws of physics being just right for matter to form in just the way it does, and in a way which allows us to exist to ponder all of this magic.

Metaphor

The next deep-game realm is Metaphor. Because we are meaning thinking human beings surrounded by mystery which language is unfit to capture, by definition, we need a metaphor which is in the form of an image or a 'kindalike' description, as

Jamie describes it, because it is not like anything else and there is no edge to it, so it sums up rather than explains. That is what the metaphor is and there are no wrong answers.

The reason that the metaphor matters is because everyone's Long-Game, whether they are conscious of it or not is always going to be in relation to their metaphor, fundamentally it is the basis that you non-consciously build everything on, so the metaphor of your life will shape the life you lead.

As Jamie says "If my metaphor is kindalike a cosmic judgement; if I play my cards right in this life, I will be okay in the next one, then you can see that that affects what my goals in life are, that affects my roles in life. It affects my story, it affects who I think I am, it affects what I think in my head, it affects how I change my environment."

Cultures and religions have implicit metaphors. In the history of religions there have only been about three or four metaphors that have really dominated. In the East there was a king dominating at the top, with lieutenants and angels, a feudalistic metaphor. The Chinese had organism metaphors; two basic things coming in and out of positive and negative, whereas the Hindus say it's more like a drama; a god head playing all the parts – playing hide and seek and discovering himself as he goes.

Knowing your deep-game can give confidence, and greater fullness or richness to life. Without a deep-game people can feel soulless or like something is lacking, and without the depth, or foundations to who they are they can find life superficial just focusing on possessions, money, or trying to achieve fame, rather than focusing on being true to themselves and perhaps working towards wholism and fulfilment.

FOURGAMES COACHING

To apply the FourGames model to coaching or therapy I am going to teach a 7-step process. As your skill develops you will become increasingly naturalistic with how you apply the model, but it is useful to have a structure to start with which you can follow to ensure you are covering all bases. Before covering the model itself I will share about scaling, establishing goals, and gathering the relevant information.

Scaling and Goals

Wherever you start on the games wheel you will want to know what the client wants. Sometimes clients will tell you what they don't want rather than what they do want. Like a smoker saying 'I don't want to smoke'. What you want to know is what they want.

One way to get this if the client is struggling to give you an answer is to ask 'If I was following you around with a video camera after you no longer have that problem, how will I know you no longer have that problem, what will I see on the TV screen that lets me know you don't have that old problem anymore?'

This is often a very effective way of shifting a client's mind-set from focusing on the problem to focusing on the solution. So, a smoker may say 'I would be breathing quietly and clearly, I would be moving faster due to having more energy, my skin

would look clear and fresh' etc.
Once you know what a client wants you can move into the FourGames because you now have a Long-Game reference point. It is possible to use FourGames without knowing or asking anything about any problems, just asking for example about the client's thinking in their Short-Game and whether it is working for them, or asking about their environment in their Mid-Game and whether this is conducive for who they want to be and how they want to be.
When working in this way you can help clients to optimise many areas of their life and help them achieve harmony among their games. If someone generally worries but this is how they have 'always thought' and so they don't see that there is an alternative way of thinking, this worrying could be behind many problems they have which they think are all different and unconnected – like lacking confidence public speaking, suffering anxiety at work, and drinking heavily. Yet once they address their thinking, and create alignment between their FourGames all these problems may cease to exist because at the heart of all of them was the worry thought process and that was being impacted on by the FourGames being misaligned.
Stopping the worrying and developing a positive success oriented mind-set focusing on what will go well, what issues could occur and how to minimise or remove these issues, and suddenly they don't drink to quieten their mind and relax, they stop suffering anxiety at work because they now handle workload and work interactions from a different perspective, and they are confident public speaking because they now focus on what is in their control and are aware of what isn't, they prepare and plan and have an idea for how they will handle difficult situations like someone heckling, yet the FourGames coach hasn't specifically addressed any of these issues, they have just helped the client to look at how they interact with the world through their FourGames.
When coaching it is useful to use scaling - for example; 'on a scale of 0-10 with 0 being the worst it could be, and 10 being the best, where are you now'

Once you have established what a client wants to achieve it is useful to scale in relation to that – 'on a scale of 0-10 with 10 being that you have achieved 100% of the goal you want, and 0 being the opposite, where are you now?'

By doing this you get a marker of where they are now and how much progress is needed. It also gives you useful information because often clients are already part of the way towards what they want to achieve, they perhaps just haven't thought about it. So, a client could say they are 3 out of 10 currently, so the coach can ask 'what makes you a 3, rather than a 2, what is already happening in the right direction?' This is the first step to getting useful information which the coach can map onto the FourGames mandala. Following this question, it is useful to ask 'what would make you a 4 instead of a 3?' What you are looking for is what small changes would they need to make to get one point closer to achieving the overall success they want to achieve.

Although we have it that 10 is achieving the goal fully, in reality many people don't need to have coaching all the way to 10, many people are also happy to get close to their ideal goal, and will be happy even if they don't fully achieve their goal. This is actually a healthier attitude, because achieving 100% success and thinking of anything less as failure is a mind-set which can lead to unrealistic expectations. Many people who think like this end up experiencing depression as they are often not happy with the success they achieve because it isn't to the level they wanted.

A coach can ask 'what number would you be happy with, that would make you think "you know what, I'm happy with what I have achieved, I don't need to stay in coaching anymore, I can make any continued progress on my own"?'

This is ultimately what an ethical coach will always want to know, they will want to know when their clients no longer need to be coming for coaching. The role of a coach is to focus on 'how quickly can I help you achieve what you need to achieve so that you no longer need to come and see me?'

In my experience with hundreds of clients over the years the

average scaling numbers given are often 3 for 'where are they now', and 7 for 'what they would be happy to achieve to no longer need support'. I always try to follow up six months after support has ended to see how clients are getting on. When I contact them, I ask them this scaling question again and the average number given at the last session is usually 8 which is above the average number clients often want to achieve to end support, and at six months follow up the average number is still 7. With some clients I have tracked them over as much as 3 years asking this scaling question and the average answer I get is still 7.

This question is a good one to use when you first see a client and also at the beginning and end of each session, this lets the coach and the client track progress. There are other scaling questions which are really useful to use.

'Scale 0-10, how confident are you that you can make the necessary changes, with 10 being 100% confident and 0 being not confident at all?'

This question helps the coach to know whether there are any blocks stopping the client from making the necessary changes. If the client says for example that they are 5 out of 10, then they can be asked 'what makes them a 5 and not a 6?' or 'what stops you being a 6?' so that the coach can identify what the client needs to change to increase their confidence at making changes. If the client isn't confident that they can make the changes then there is a very good chance they won't make any changes, which in turn means their situation will remain the same.

'Scale 0-10, how motivated are you to make the necessary changes, with 10 being 100% motivated and 0 being not motivated at all?'

This may sound like an odd question because if someone is seeking coaching you would think they are motivated to make changes but this isn't always true, people seek support for many different reasons, sometimes people will take up coaching or therapy because someone else has told them they need to – like someone telling their partner they need to go to see a coach or therapist to quit smoking, so the person goes to coaching but

isn't really motivated to quit smoking because they don't really want to quit.

As with other scaling questions, once the coach gets an answer to establish where they are at now on the scale 0-10 the coach can look at what is needed next, so if a client says they are a 3 currently then the coach can ask 'what would make you a 4?', or 'if you were a 4, what would be different?'

The coach could even ask 'hypothetically, if you were a 10 how will you know, what will be different?' if the client answers this they will be revealing what needs to change between where they are now and being fully motivated.

What this type of question does is it helps to make sure the coach isn't rushing off ahead of the client. If the client isn't motivated to change and they say to be a little bit more motivated they would perhaps (taking smoking as an example) be aware of some negative consequences of smoking which they actually care about, then part of the coaching will be to help the client find negative consequences they care about. To do this the coach will approach it differently than someone wanting to know what negative consequences there are to smoking. Telling the client what negative consequences there are will have very little, if any, impact because this isn't what the client is after, whereas finding what is important to the client – like a child of theirs, and finding that they love their child and want to spend as long as they can with their child gives something which can be used and focused on in context with the smoking to show how the smoking may not only lead to shortening their life and impacting on their fitness, but it can also lead to the child suffering if they have to see the parent dying slowly and painfully of the smoking, and that they decided to do this themselves, etc. This is far more powerful and impactful, and would be done because that individual needed to increase their motivation to make changes, and said this is something which would increase their motivation.

There are many other ways in which scaling can be used in coaching sessions, both therapeutically and helpfully, and to measure progress and success, and scaling can be used to lead

into any of the FourGames, or it can be used within any of the FourGames.

7-Step FourGames Coaching Process

In this chapter we will take you through a process for applying the FourGames approach to coaching. Once you become adept with the FourGames approach you will apply this freeform, but for learning and first applying this approach it is useful to follow a structure so that you can cover each stage of the FourGames model.

One question which is really useful to keep in mind is 'what would captain simple do?'

This may sound like an odd question, but it is surprising how common it can be to ask a question and people come up with detailed and complex answers which can tie them up in greater confusion, when they should be seeking simplicity. Sometimes people will answer that they 'don't know' because they are still answering from within their current perspective of the world and what they believe.

Sometimes it is helpful to take on a different persona for a time when thinking or doing something where we hope to behave or think differently. In therapy when clients say they don't know, I will often say "imagine if you did", and surprisingly, this will encourage clients to take on different thinking and come up with solutions and answers they didn't think about before that simple sentence.

When having clients think about doing things differently in the future, I will often ask them to think of someone who has the traits they want to have in a situation, so if they say they can't imagine being confident public speaking, I will ask them to imagine someone they think is confident public speaking, who behaves and thinks how they would like to behave or think. Once the client has seen that person go through the situations they hope to go through in the future being confident, I will then say "now replay that movie in your mind, only this time imagine what it is like to be that person, imagine seeing what

they see, hearing what they hear, hearing their internal dialogue in your head, feeling what they feel, and behaving as they behave", and they will then 'try on' what it is like to fully experience being how that person would be in situations.
To achieve balance and harmony within the FourGames it is preferable to address each of the 7 steps outlined below. These seven steps cover each aspect of the Short-Game, Mid-Game, Long-Game and Deep-Game.

The seven steps are:

1. Goal, Role, Path
2. Tame Your Mind
3. Learning to Control Your Physical Space and Body
4. Understand and Harness Your Space, Optimise Your Environment
5. Systems That Surround You
6. Gadgets
7. Mystery

Step 01 – Goal, Role, Path
The place that is most useful to start is on the Long-Game, looking at the goal that the client wants, the role they play in getting what they want, and the path towards that goal. It is useful to do scaling and find out what the goal is for the client first as these will give you a baseline of where things are at now and where the client would like things to be.
With scaling to get a baseline of where the client is at now and where they would like to be you can ask:

- What is it you would like to achieve from the coaching? (You are asking them to say what they will be doing differently; not what others will be doing differently. It is what they would like to achieve, not what they would like others to do differently. The answer needs to be what they want

to be doing, thinking, feeling, saying to themselves differently – you don't necessarily need to get all this information right now, you will explore it more fully in a future step of this process)

- What would you like to have achieved by the end of this session? (This question can help to see what a client would like to be achieving straightaway)
- How long do you feel it would take you to achieve what you would like to achieve?
- On a scale of 0-10, with ten being where you have the perfect outcome, where are you now in relation to where you would like to be?
- What number would you be happy with on that scale of 0-10, for you to feel you no longer need coaching support? (Many clients would be happy with less than perfection, like achieving 7/10 rather than expecting 10/10)

Throughout this outline of the 7-step process there will be a single case study from my private practice of how each step applied to that one client. The case study is of a client who wanted to quit smoking. She was only going to have a single session; she was in her late twenties.

When asked where she was at now, she responded that she smoked about 10 cigarettes per day. She feels stupid for smoking these because she thinks of herself as intelligent and so knows that cigarettes are harmful and that she shouldn't smoke, but this doesn't stop her from smoking. She said in the future she would like to have a few children with her husband, and sees smoking as something which isn't compatible with the future she wants.

She said she was a 10 on a scale of how motivated she was to make necessary changes to quit smoking, so very motivated. She said she was a 3 when asked to scale where she is now in relation to where she wants to be, with ten being totally smoke free. Her goal was established – being a non-smoker. This was fleshed out to what that life as a non-smoker meant to her,

which included having children, being fitter and healthier, likely to lead a longer life.
We established what life could be like in the future if she continues as she is now without making any changes, this helped to have a towards and an away from motivation. Having just 'away from' motivation people often lose motivation as they progress from the thing they are moving away from, but they may not have yet achieved what they would like. So, someone who wants to lose weight may start well, make some progress, decide they are no longer a problem weight and so stop the changes they have made, and then slowly creep back to where they were. If they have somewhere they are going they will notice they are getting closer to their goal and so be more likely to keep going. If they only have a goal of being a certain weight or fitness level then if they don't see the changes happening quick enough, they can lose focus and motivation.
Whereas with both they are likely to notice initially that they are making progress away from where they were, even though initially they don't feel much closer to the goal, but as time goes on they are far enough away from being 'fat' that they stop being motivated by trying to move away from being fat, but now they notice they are getting noticeably closer to being fitter, or the size they want to be, so the towards motivation kicks in and keeps them motivated, driving them forward.
Once you have an idea of the goal that the client would like to achieve you can then ask them to give this goal a single word or short phrase which sums up what they hope to achieve. This word then encapsulates everything about that goal.

Next you can ask about the role they will be playing in getting the goal they want to achieve:

- What will be your role in achieving that goal?
- How would you define your role?
- What word (or short phrase) would sum up your role?

There are many roles people take on. If you think about life as a series of stories in a collection of stories – like *The Lord of the Rings* trilogy, you can see how each story has its own beginning, middle and end, but all are just stories or chapters of a larger story. We all have roles, it could be rescuer, hero, sage, responsible parent, carer. In the therapy session the client wanted to be a responsible parent. She didn't like the idea of harming her children due to her smoking, she wanted to have a role of being an intelligent person and felt that her smoking didn't fit this role. Her current role in life was as an intelligent person, she liked being seen as intelligent and sensible, and this role fit with her beliefs about herself. The only part of her life which didn't fit was smoking. Her future role of being a responsible parent was only congruently possible if she stopped smoking.

The roles we play shape how we go through life. If someone has a role as an unlucky person, they are likely to miss opportunities, and highlight times when things don't work out, if someone takes on a role as a lucky person, they are likely to notice opportunities and highlight how they have been lucky.

I was involved in a road accident a number of years ago. I was cycling round a roundabout when a truck struck me. I landed in the middle of the road with ten breaks and an open fracture in my right arm. I had to go to hospital and spent over a week in hospital, and months unable to do much due to my injuries. I lost my job because of the injuries, and still have pain and reduced mobility and strength in my arm now almost 20 years later, yet I see my situation as lucky.

Everyone says to me how unlucky that was, how horrible it was that I was involved in a road accident. It wasn't a pleasant experience, but it was a lucky experience. I didn't have a cycle helmet on, so if I was hit by a car my legs would have been swiped from under me and I would have landed on the bonnet, likely hitting my head on the window screen which would have been likely to cause far worse injuries.

Being hit by a truck meant I was pushed away from the vehicle, and the truck didn't have bull-bars fitted, so I didn't sustain any

significant injuries to my left leg which was struck by the truck. It was 7am so the roads were quiet. If I was hit many metres into the middle of a roundabout an hour later the road would have been much busier, I would have been likely to get run over where I landed. There was an ambulance car just about to head onto the roundabout moments after the accident, so as a member of the public telephoned the emergency services medical professionals arrived on the scene because they were passing by.

Because of how I was hit all of my injuries were in a single arm – my right arm. I am left-handed, so it didn't impact the use of my dominant hand, and I had no other significant injuries. I lost my job, but that taught me about being unemployed, and opened up new opportunities, like working on research projects and a TV programme filmed in Dubai.

It isn't all about positive thinking, or lying to yourself, it is about how the roles we have shape us and our perspective of the world around us. If someone has grown up where all male role models were abusive, they may grow up with a role in relation to men that they will be abusive, and they may then non-consciously be drawn towards relationships with abusive males.

If someone has had parents telling them their whole childhood that they are a failure, then they may well grow up taking on the role of a failure, and so they manage to keep failing, and noticing failures, but overlooking successes, or waiting for successes to end in failure – like being in a relationship and deciding it will end, and eventually being proved right because the person keeps doing things to sabotage the relationship despite not noticing that is what they are doing.

It is important that goals and roles are well formed. A well-formed goal will be clear and specific, and having a well-formed role allows for the client to see how that role can be used to help achieve the goal. So, with my client she had a well-formed role of being an intelligent person. This role meant there were clear things which are compatible, and other things which are incompatible with that role, so I was able to have the client take a look at the path using this role as the guide for what the path

is for an intelligent person. She was able to identify how she could use intelligence to address quitting smoking, and intelligence to stay stopped. If she had said she felt her role was that of a hero for example, then she may have developed a different path, she may have looked at how a hero would quit smoking and how quitting smoking would feed into her 'hero' role.

With your client's you want to identify the path which needs to be taken to get from where the client currently is, to where they hope to be. Scaling is an incredibly useful way to do this. If a client has said on a scale of 0-10, with 10 being where they have totally achieved what it is they hope to achieve and 0 being the opposite, that they are currently a 3, you can ask the client what would make them a 4? You want the sensory specific details of what a 4 would be like, what would they see, think, do, differently.

When you ask your client how much success they want – if 10 is having 100% success, what number would they be happy to reach to feel they can stop attending these coaching sessions? For some goals they may say 10, that they only want 100% success, and nothing less. It is then down to the coach with the client to judge whether this is a realistic expectation, and whether they need to have definitely reached this level by the time they leave coaching, or whether they could leave coaching sooner, perhaps when they are a 7 out of 10.

The coach would have these discussions with the client. Most of the time expecting perfection isn't helpful. My client wanted 100% never smoking again, but life throws curve-balls, how can anyone guarantee they will never smoke again? So, I had this conversation with the client about how an intelligent outcome would be ideally not to smoke again, but if it happens, to be able to have it as a one-off isolated incident which could be due to an unexpected stressful event happening, or some other reason.

The question with a smoker would be how long do they have to go, while remaining in coaching before they feel they have achieved 100% success? They could be in coaching for three

months, having not smoked for most of those three months, is this enough for them to accept they have achieved 100% success? Do they need six months? Do they want to pay to see a coach when the coach has nothing new to contribute because the client isn't smoking currently? Do they want to see a coach until they no longer have cravings, or until they feel in control of the habit?

These are all questions to explore. For my client they were only going to have a single session, they wanted 100% success, but settled on having the right mind-set, so they wanted to know they had the knowledge and skills to handle cravings, to understand that a relapse is just a relapse, not a step back to being a smoker again. Once they felt armed with this knowledge and skills then they were going to do everything they could to remain smoke free, but if they did have a relapse, they weren't going to let it ruin their progress (they haven't had any relapse, and it is now over ten years that they have been smoke free).

In my experience the most common response from clients to what number would they be happy to reach which would let them know they don't need to keep seeing a coach, and they can make the rest of the journey themselves is for clients to say 7 out of 10. At this point you want to ask the client what a '7' looks like, what are they doing, thinking, feeling as a 7? What is life like as a 7?

As you can see, just from these few simple steps you will have established where the client was at the beginning; for example, a 3, you have established what would be different for them to say things have improved by one point – say to a 4, you will have established what their ideal outcome '10' is, and what number they would be happy with, say 7, and what this point looks like. So very quickly you have established the first few steps the client needs to take to achieve what they hope to achieve, and a step where coaching involvement can end, and the final outcome. You can also ask what would be different for you to have said two points higher? And you can ask what would things be like when you begin thinking 'you know what, I think I'm nearly ready to stop having coaching sessions, say one point

before the time you are ready to no longer need the support of a coach? In this example that would give you a description of a 5 and 6, meaning you now know what steps the client needs from where they are – 3, to where they are ready to stop having coaching – 7, and aware of what their ultimate goal of a 10 is.
Sometimes you may have a client who says they are currently a 1, or a 0. One way to tackle this is to say 'at least things can't be any worse?'
Usually at this point the person can tell you many ways things could be worse. This can then be an opportunity to revise their scaling answer up a point or two.
It can also be helpful to ask what parts of what they want are already happening? So, someone who wants to stop smoking could say they already don't smoke in their car, or they don't smoke during work hours. Someone who wants to lose weight may say they already go for a walk once per week. Someone who wants to set up a business may say they have bought some of the equipment they need specifically for their business.
What this does is it helps the coach to help the client make connections between where they are at and the goal they want to achieve. All of this together gives things which the coach can use as tasks for the client to do before the next session. What the coach is aiming for is helping the client to gradually do more of what is needed to make that future outcome a reality.
So, the coach can suggest tasks for the client to do some of the bits they said they would do when they have improved one point, and to keep doing those things they are already doing from their goal. This means when they return for their next session, they are at least doing those things which moved them up one point, because they were asked to do those things. If they aren't doing those things, then the coach can explore why not, what has stopped them doing those small steps.
An example from my work in family therapy is that parents may say they want their child to behave. I will then establish what the parents' role in this is, and what they will be doing differently when their child is behaving – remember, you can't make someone else change, you only have control over how you

behave and think, so wanting the child to behave can't be the goal, it has to be when the child is behaving how will things be different, what will *they* be doing differently in relation to their child.

Often parents will say that they will be spending time with their child, they will be talking calmer to their child, smiling more with their child, doing more with their child. So, I will ask about what out of these things is already happening now. The parents may say that they always kiss their child goodnight and tell their child at the end of the day that they love them, and that they always sit down for dinner together as a family.

So, I will suggest to the family to continue to do these things. The parents may say that a one-point improvement may be that they are being calmer around their child, and doing more with their child – like playing games with their child, and going to the park with their child. So, I will set these as the task to do between this session and the next session. So, when the parents come in for the next session, I can ask them about games they have played with the child and trips to the park they have had. If the parents haven't done this I want to know why not, what stopped them doing this? Because if that blockage to them taking action and making changes isn't addressed, no progress will be made. If they have done this but they feel the behaviour of the child hasn't yet improved, the behaviour being improved to the level they would be happy with is something they want from the overall coaching, not something necessarily which is a part of just a single point improvement, so this is explained with the parent, that it is about taking steps. But what is part of this single point improvement is them doing the tasks which were set, so if they are doing these, then they have made that one-point improvement. The end of each session would be for the parents to carry on with the changes they have made, and add new changes. What happens usually is that after each session the parents make new changes while maintaining current changes and they move up the scaling, and home life and the child's behaviour improves as the child starts to respond to the changes the parents are making.

So, because the parents are being calmer around the child, and spending time with the child, and doing things with the child, and not focusing on how the child is bad, or naughty, or always shouting at the child, and taking things away from the child, or not letting the child do anything, the child improves their behaviour because they like this new home life, compared to the stressful and difficult old home life which may have made them feel unloved.

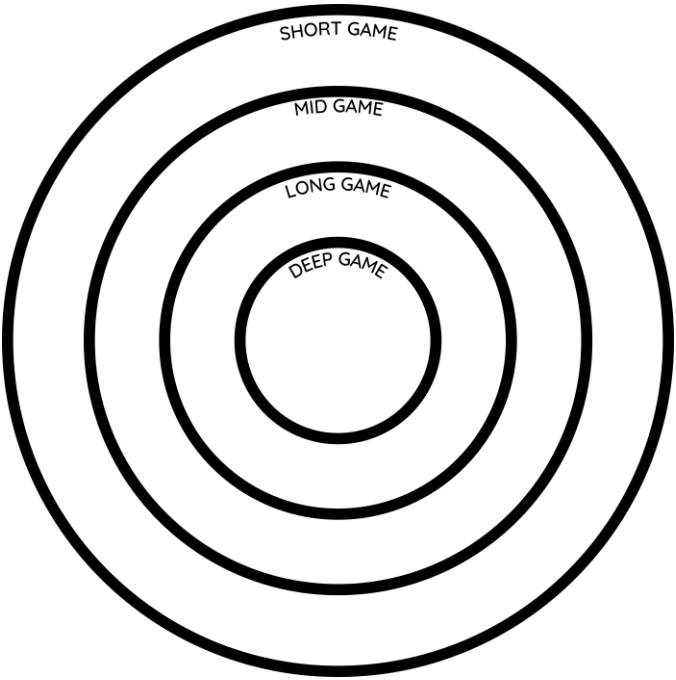
Step 02 – Tame Your Mind

Once you have established the goal, role, and path, the second step looks at the thinking and feelings. What you are doing now is filling in some of the details. So, the client will have current thinking and feelings in relation to the goal they hope to achieve. The question is whether that thinking and feeling is helpful and aligned with the goal, or not. And whether it is congruent with their role. In this step you will ask clients about what they think in relation to what they hope to achieve:

- Is that thinking working for them?
- Does their thinking help towards what they want?
- Does their thinking hinder achieving what they want?
- What thinking would be helpful?
- How do they feel currently in relation to what they want to achieve?
- Is their current feeling helpful?
- Does the way they currently feel hinder achieving what they want to achieve?
- What feeling would be helpful?

What you are aiming to do is to establish what their current thinking and feeling is, and what thinking and feeling they need. It is useful to use the FourGames mandala as you talk with the client. You can then write on the mandala what key word sums up their thinking, and their feeling that they want to have. It

could be that this is the same as the thinking and feeling that they currently do have, or it could be different.
If the thinking and feeling that they want is different, then you can help to identify what needs to happen to make it so that they have that thinking and feeling instead. To do this you can ask them what needs to happen to have that thinking and feeling, what would help them to have it? Some clients may say that they don't know. When this happens it Is useful to ask what if they did know, or what would someone who does know say?



THE FOURGAMES MANDALA

With my quit smoking client, she described her thinking as certainty. She had come into the smoking cessation session

having already set her mind into a 'this is it' mind-set. She was certain she was going to quit smoking, she was focused, the sorts of things she was saying to herself were 'I will quit', 'I am going to be a good parent', 'I can do this', 'I want to do this', 'I will succeed'. All of her thinking let me know she already had thinking which was congruent with her role as an intelligent person, and with the role she hoped to have in the future as a responsible parent, and was going to help her on her path. It was also aligned with the goal she wanted to achieve.

Her feelings in relation to the goal were excitement, and confidence or assuredness. She was excited about the future she was going to have as someone who doesn't smoke, and confident and assertive about how she was going to succeed, and was going to have the future she wanted. I know over ten years later, her current feelings are happy, both with herself and her success, and happy with her situation as a non-smoking mother of a couple of children.

Many clients are likely to enter the coaching sessions with a mind-set which isn't aligned with what they hope to achieve or the role they want to take. In these cases, the coach needs to identify what thinking would be helpful, what sorts of sentences would the client be saying to themselves. One way to do this is to have the client imagine going through a day in their mind as if they have achieved success already, starting first thing in the morning, what are they saying to themselves. Then take them through the whole day. When doing this, do it in real-time, and ask the client to imagine this is happening right now. So, you will say 'what is the first thing you **are** saying to yourself?' rather than 'what is the first thing you **would** say to yourself?'

What you are doing by doing it this way is you are making the client get into the role of being this person. Often you notice the client's responses start out 'what I would say to myself is...' and you reply 'so what you **are** saying to yourself firstly is...', and after a short period of time the client begins to speak the way you are speaking, and so begins to really take on and own this role as the person who has achieved success and who thinks in this way. Some clients' need some more direct prompting, but

most will catch on to this way of thinking just because it is the way you are communicating with them.

The thing about feelings is that they aren't something we have direct conscious control over. We can control our thinking, and we can control how we behave, but we can't easily control our feelings. Feelings come from a deeper, more innate part of ourselves, so they are automatic. Feelings occur as a direct response to our sensory perception of the world around us along with automatic behaviours, and then the thoughts that we have grow out of the underlying feeling and can shape the nuance and interpretation of the feeling. These thoughts can then fuel further feelings, so if someone feels anxiety within a situation, this can lead to anxious thinking, and this anxious thinking is then a stimulus which can fuel further feeling of anxiety.

So, the thoughts that the client has can determine whether a feeling will continue or not. This goes for helpful and unhelpful feelings in a situation. Generally, the stronger the feeling, the easier it is for all thoughts to flow naturally within that feeling. So, someone feeling a little bit anxious could have a friend make them laugh about something to do with the situation which in turn can snap them out of the anxiety feeling. Whereas, if the person was feeling scared – like having a fear or phobia, then the friend trying to make them laugh is unlikely to work because they are thinking purely from within the fear, with no room to dilute that fear with the laughter.

Likewise, someone feeling really happy doesn't lose any of the happiness when something small happens which scares them a little, they are likely to be scared for a moment and then once they realise there isn't any real threat they laugh about it, but something life-threatening can snap them out of the happiness and make them anxious.

So, the question is what can you do if someone has unhelpful feelings which need to change?

One way to do this is to use mental rehearsal, have the client close their eyes a moment and relax. You can ask them to focus on slow relaxing breathing, or guide them on a relaxing inner

experience, like walking along a beach or through the woods, then once they feel relaxed have them see a TV screen in their mind with movies playing of things they hope to do, but to be aligned they need to be feeling differently.

They can watch themselves doing what they need to do while feeling the feeling they need, and you can ask them how they know that them is feeling that preferred way, what behaviour is that person on the screen doing that lets them know they are feeling the desired feeling, what are they saying to themselves because they are feeling that way. Once they have watched themselves having this different feeling you can then ask them to restart the movie, and this time, step inside themselves on that screen and experience what it is like to have this new feeling in those future situations, and to notice how they are behaving and thinking and what that feeling feels like.

There are many other ways this can be done. You can have your client stand up and see themselves a few paces in front of themselves with that feeling, and have them notice what that version of themselves is thinking and what their body language is like and their behaviour is like, then once they have done this fully and are confident that version of them is how they would like to be, they can take a few steps forward into that version of them to 'try it on' and see what it is like to be that version of themselves, and then they can do a technique called anchoring, where they bring a thumb and finger together to link this action with experiencing that version of themselves. They can then step back to where they were and trigger the anchor by bringing the thumb and finger together and notice themselves becoming that version again, and practice keeping hold of that feeling as they open their eyes. This is something the client can practise and reinforce at home or in many other situations.

For my client, she imagined feeling good every morning when she woke up, and feeling confident and excited for the day ahead. She then imagined going through the day with these feelings at times when she would have smoked in the past, and feeling these feelings when she was in situations she used to smoke, when she responded without smoking, like declining

cigarettes, and when she identified parts of her life which she was in that were enhanced because she didn't smoke, as a reinforcing thought about her decision not to smoke.
Another way to alter the feelings to the desired feeling is through the body, which is what we will cover next in step three.

Step 03 – Learning to Control Your Physical Space and Body
There will be certain behaviours which are conducive to achieving success. Behaviour has an impact on the clients' fitness and physical wellbeing as well as how they feel, which in turn can impact on their thinking and future behaviour.

Some questions to ask are:

- What do you need to do to achieve what you want to achieve?
- Does the behaviour you are currently doing help towards achieving that goal?
- Does the behaviour you are doing help you feel how you want to feel?
- What behaviour do you need to do to feel how you want to feel?

There are certain behaviours the client will need to do to achieve success, these will include facial expressions, posture, levels of activity, behaviours towards others. The client will need to look at what behaviours they are currently doing and what behaviours they need to be doing to achieve success. Behaviour can influence feelings, so when someone intentionally smiles, and holds that smile, it leads to an increase in happiness, when someone stands tall with their shoulders back and chest out with their arm beside them and palms open this increases feelings of confidence. When people are hunched over with arms crossed over their body and their head down, this can lead to feeling vulnerable and reduce confidence. There are specific behaviours associated with all our different emotions, so people who are angry will behave

differently to people who feel calm and relaxed.
The coach can ask the client to give the desired behaviour a word which can be written onto the FourGames mandala. This word will describe the behaviour, so it could be active, sedentary, confident, calm, or any number of other descriptions.
My smoking cessation client described her behaviour that she wanted to do as healthy. Part of this behaviour was stopping smoking, but also generally leading a healthier lifestyle. She generally led a healthy lifestyle apart from the smoking which she hoped to stop as it was incompatible with the rest of her behaviour.
To help a client identify the behaviour that they want to be doing you can use mental rehearsal and have them mentally rehearse waking up and leading the ideal day. This is the same process as having the client mentally rehearse for practising having the desired feeling in situations in the future. They will practise waking up and running through a day, or running through doing what they hope to achieve, and watching what behaviour they are doing in the future when they are doing their ideal behaviour, and then stepping into that movie and replaying it experiencing doing this behaviour. They can also be set tasks to do some of the required behaviour.
If a client wants to lose weight or improve health, then they will identify what behaviour they need to be doing to achieve the desired weight loss or health gain. They will look at what behaviours they are currently doing and which of those behaviours are conducive to improved health, and which behaviours aren't, so that they can change the behaviours that don't help achieve what they are trying to achieve. They may need to increase levels of activity, this could be walking more, or it could be taking up exercise.
If a client wants to set up a business, then they may identify that they need to dedicate more time to the new business idea, and may identify that they currently spend more time watching TV after work rather than giving some of this time to working on their new business. If someone wanted to write a novel, or start

blogging with the intention of making a living from blogging, or from YouTube, and they have a full-time job, then they will have to dedicate time to make this a reality, and that means changing behaviour, and sticking with this changed behaviour.
If a client wants to improve their child's behaviour then they will need to behave differently, they may come to coaching because they want the child to change their behaviour, rather than thinking that they need to change their own behaviour, but to increase the chances of the child changing their behaviour the parent will need to make changes, they will need to make sure they are behaving calm, talking without blaming the child, spending time with the child and displaying behaviours of love. If they currently handle situations with shouting or getting angry, or they take things away from their child, or don't spend time with their child because the child is behaving poorly, then these behaviours will need to change.

Step 04 – Understand and Harness Your Space, Optimise Your Environment

Once the client has worked on their Short-Game addressing their thoughts, behaviours, and feelings and tamed their mind, they can move on to addressing their Mid-Game. In step four the coach helps the client to look at their environment. Is the environment generative, does it help the client to achieve success in what they are hoping to achieve, or does it make achieving success more difficult?
If someone is trying to be successful as a writer, but the environment they currently try to write in is noisy and distracting, and uncomfortable then they will struggle to be successful. If a parent is trying to improve the behaviour of a child and the environment doesn't have any stimulation for the child, or it is too crowded, then these can make it more challenging to help the parent make changes, and for the child to make changes.
When my smoking cessation client came for their coaching session they described their environment, they smoked and their husband smoked, they both smoked inside the house,

smoking also took place in the car. One of the first changes they had to make to their environment was to make it the environment of a non-smoker, they had to clean the walls, and furniture in their home to get rid of the smell of smoke, as well as clearing away everything in the home and car to do with smoking.

For the client to have lasting success they needed to have an environment which supported that. If they didn't make the environment an environment of a non-smoker soon after the session they were likely to have so many environmental associations, from gadgets in the environment, like ashtrays, to the smell of smoke, the sight that the walls have changed colour due to smoke, to everything encouraging them to have feelings of wanting to smoke, encouraging them to have cravings, and they would have been driving in a car which reminded them that they are a smoker, even when they have mentally and physically decided to become a non-smoker.

They cleaned the environment, their partner wanted to carry on smoking, so he was told he had to smoke outside at the end of the garden, there was no smoking allowed in the car, at work the client decided she wouldn't stand in the smoking area to talk with the other smokers because that environment isn't a non-smoking environment, she didn't want to end up lonely at work due to isolating herself from colleagues, so she found other things she could do on her breaks, including meditation which was taking place in the company, and some breaks she would take the time to relax and read, or she would go for walks with other non-smoking colleagues. All of these environmental changes helped her to remain a non-smoker.

Questions the coach will be likely to ask their client are:

- Is your environment generative to helping you to achieve what you want?
- What needs to change in your environment to help you achieve success?
- What environment do you need to help you to

achieve success?

- What aspects of your environment will already be able to help you achieve success?

Sometimes people need to make changes in their environment, other times they need to change their environment completely, or they may need to add new environments. For example; if someone wants to achieve business success, they may well need to attend networking meetings, or maybe industry specific events, or other environments they don't normally find themselves in.

These environments could be unsettling for someone who has never been in these different situations before, so they may need to learn some skills before they are ready for these environments, this will require revisiting the Short-Game to look at how they think, feel and act in these situations, and ensuring that their Short-Game for this situation is aligned with their Mid-Game.

Environment is more important than people realise. For example; people are less depressed and anxious when they get outside, walk and take in plenty of natural greens and blues from things like plants, the sky, lakes, rivers, streams, and the ocean (Weir, 2020). Psychological wellbeing suffers more when people work in offices with poor lighting – so very little natural light, very little personal space, and unnatural or dull colours.

So, if someone is seeking coaching or therapy to overcome depression, or tackle anxiety, or low mood, or feeling unmotivated, or they want to increase creativity, they can achieve a lot just by getting outside in nature as much as possible.

If someone wants to achieve business success, they may need to seek environments where they can mix with potential customers, or influencers. If they want to lose weight or get healthy, they need to think about the environment they eat at home, and what food is on show, and perhaps the environments they eat out, and the environment they shop.

They may have to think about the environment they travel to or

from work and whether this is conducive to being healthy or not. If they drive past a fast-food outlet on the way home from work every day and they are often hungry when they are driving home, and prior to coaching they were purchasing something to eat from that fast food outlet perhaps a few times per week, then maybe they need to change their route home so that they don't pass that outlet.

Step 05 – Systems That Surround You

Step five is looking at the systems that surround the client. These Mid-Game systems include finance, communication, information, and interpersonal systems like family, friends and work colleagues. Some systems are generative and conducive to achieving success, others may impact negatively on the success someone is trying to achieve.

In my work with families, I have often found that families had no-one working, and a number of children who needed feeding. The parents often struggled with the behaviour of the children, the parents usually smoked and drank alcohol, and the family would have subscriptions to multiple TV and streaming services and would have all the latest gadgets, yet they had very little income, huge debts, very few friends or support networks, and didn't have the information they needed to understand their situation, and to understand an alternative experience for the family. The family weekly shop would comprise largely of unhealthy food which was having a negative effect on the children's health, and of cigarettes and alcohol.

My role was to help these families to understand payday loans, they saw them as easy money to get hold of, but didn't realise that £100 loan would lead to paying many times that amount back over the next few months adding to their financial difficulties, and these loan companies would target the families, trapping them in the system.

I helped the families to educate themselves with helpful information about nutrition and cooking skills so that they could prepare cheap healthy meals rather than buy the unhealthy meals they had been purchasing. I helped them look

at their spending to see where their income was going and the impact this was having on the family, and what could be done about it, and helped them to identify friends, family and professionals they could turn to for support on different issues.
These small changes often had a huge impact on the families, helping them to begin to get out of debt, changing their spending habits, and giving better health and wellbeing to the parents and the children. It also reduced how much others took advantage of them – like payday loan companies, and gave them the skills they needed to navigate different systems, like housing departments, benefits departments, and dealing with landlords.
In my smoking cessation case, the client had a partner who was supportive, but who wanted to carry on smoking. She had friends and family who were supportive of her decision to quit smoking, and they were able to be called on to talk to and help if she needed some help with motivation. She also saw the impact smoking had on her finances and how this would change when she quit smoking, and what her new financial situation was going to be, and what she would do with her money within this new financial situation. She knew all the information about the effects of smoking, and the benefits of quitting smoking. All of this made it much easier for her to quit and stay stopped because she had a clear grasp of the systems which surrounded her.

Coaches will want to ask clients about their systems in relation to what they are trying to achieve:

- What support network do you have?
- Who can you turn to for help?
- What is the best way you can communicate to help you achieve what you are trying to achieve (for example if it is a business goal it may be best to use the telephone or video calls, if it is parenting then face to face is likely to be better, if it is an online business then email and social media may be the

answer)?

- Are your systems aligned, or do you have any conflicting systems?

Another area of systems for the coach to consider with clients are life systems, so for example if someone wants to get fitter and they have an exercise bike or gym equipment, but the equipment has laundry hanging on it then two systems are conflicting – the cleaning system of having to do laundry, and the exercise system. The client is less likely to use their exercise equipment while it has laundry hanging on it, so as long as the two systems bump up against each other their goal is harder to achieve. What the client needs to look at is how to separate the systems out so that they are aligned and not bumping into each other.

This issue of systems bumping into each other can happen in relation to many different goals. Parents have many roles, all with different systems. They may want to keep the house tidy, but by putting all the toys away the child can't find their toys readily and so misbehaves because they have nothing to play with. A smoker may want to quit smoking and may smoke due to workplace stress, so they like to take a break at work and go outside, but the work area outside is also the smoking area, so the system for an outdoor space to relax, is also the system for a space to smoke, so they may need to find a different place to go to relax outdoors. Someone may want to start a YouTube, or online training business where they set a room up at home as a video recording studio, but the rest of the family may be too noisy getting on with normal family life making it difficult to have the quiet environment needed to film videos, so the family system is bumping into the filming system, and a different venue may need to be found, or the person doing the filming may need to find a way of doing the filming at a time of day when they house is quiet, but then this may bump into another system, if they start filming late at night their partner may want them to be in bed, so it may impact on the relationship.

A coach can explore these areas with the client to help them to

identify different systems, and to address systems which bump into each other. The client can then come up with a single word or short phrase which sums up the systems they have which are conducive to achieving their goal, and can add this to the FourGames mandala.

Clients may need to make changes within their environment to address systems which bump into each other, or they may need to make changes to what they are doing, or how they are thinking about things. The coach is likely to set tasks to look at changes which need to be made, or to make those changes.

Sometimes clients will learn from what came out of the coaching and implement it without the need for explicit instruction, but it is useful to round off sessions with tasks, even if this is done softly, rather than direct. The coach could say "so, between now and next session I want you to..." which is very direct, or they could sum up the session and as part of that summing up, they could say "so, you mentioned that these two systems were bumping into each other and causing a problem, and that you will be making these changes. I look forward to hearing how you get on with that in our next session"

Step 06 – Gadgets

Gadgets encapsulates all the stuff in our environment. Some of this can be helpful, other times it can go against what a client is trying to achieve. The coach can explore the gadgets with the client by asking about the gadgets in their environment relating to their goal. They may also want to ask more generically for the client to describe their environment, and what stuff they have in their environment.

So if the client wants to lose weight or get healthy then one important gadget to know about is the food they have, what food is available to them at home, do they have food in the car, when they go shopping where is this and what food is available for them there, if they go somewhere for the day what food do they have with them, or do they find somewhere to eat while they are out, and if so where do they find to eat and what food is available in that location. Are these gadgets helpful? Is the

food that is available in these different locations helpful to achieving their goal, or unhelpful?
With my smoking cessation client, she had ashtrays at home, cigarettes at home and in the car, lighters could be found within minutes in any of her environments. Smoking was a very easy thing to do. It took her no time to access cigarettes, find a way to light the cigarette, and smoke. After her session with me she cleaned her house and the car and removed all ashtrays, found all cigarettes and threw them away, and got rid of all but one of her lighters, feeling that she wanted to keep a single lighter because she likes having lit candles when she is has relaxing baths, so she wanted to have access to one lighter for that purpose.

Questions a coach may ask include:

- Describe the stuff you currently have in your environment?
- Does the stuff in your environment help you to achieve your goal?
- What stuff would be helpful to have in your environment to help you achieve your goal?

These questions help to identify the current stuff in the environment and what needs to be in the environment to help the client successfully achieve their goal. There will be certain gadgets which will help and other gadgets which can hurt progress towards the goal.
In today's technology rich world there are gadgets which can be a great help for some things, but can be distractions from achieving other goals. If an author wants to write a book, but social media notifications, and email notifications keep coming up on their screen they may struggle not to click through to see what the notification was about. In the past you had to actually go out of your way to check your emails or social media, now notifications can ping on your phone, on your tablet devices and on your computer, so the computer which may well be an

essential gadget for writing a novel is also a hindrance to writing the novel. I do a lot of writing and so this is why I don't have any logged in social media or email accounts on the computer I use for my writing.

Someone may try to achieve success in something, but find themselves stuck in front of the TV, or games console, and before they know it many hours have passed and they haven't got anything else done. With so many streaming services and TV channels to choose from as soon as one programme ends, you can nearly always find another one to watch, and many games for games consoles can now be played for hundreds of hours, rather than games you could play through in just a few hours, so a whole day can easily disappear with playing a game, rather than taking steps towards desired goals.

These areas need to be explored with the client to see if there are any gadgets which could cause a block to achieving success, and then looking at what the client can do about it. For some gadgets the client may decide to get rid of the gadget – like the smoking client getting rid of all the ashtrays. For technology gadgets which will be in use to achieve the goal, but have the potential to be a problem they may have to go into the settings on their computer for example and turn notifications off, or if possible, disconnect the device from the internet, and maybe turn off phones and tablet PC's. Other clients may need to change the gadgets in their environment, for example having healthier food in their home, and some may need to get new gadgets into their environment, like needing a specific camera and lighting system to film YouTube videos with, or exercise equipment, or specific items of clothing.

The coach will want to ask how the client will make these changes, how they will change what food they have in their cupboards, do they know what they need, and if not, then how will they identify what they need. Or how will they ensure they have the correct gadgets for business communication with their start-up business, or whatever other area their goal is in.

It is useful to give the gadgets they need in their environment a word or short phrase to add to the FourGames mandala, it

could be practical, or functional, or educational, or any other word the client says. This word will sum up everything you have discussed, so that you can say, "so how are you getting on with having those practical gadgets in your environment?"

Step 07 – Mystery, Magic and Metaphor

Much of the coaching can be done without focusing on step seven. I often end sessions with rounding up what has been discussed and what the next steps are that the client needs to take to move towards their goal. The advantage of doing step seven is that it helps to add depth and meaning to what the client hopes to achieve.

Step seven is all about the Deep-Game. The client will have started out establishing a goal, their role, and the path when they focused on the Long-Game in step one, then they would have used this as the destination with which they focus their Short-Game towards in step two for the thinking and feeling, and in step three for the physical/behavioural realm of the Short-Game, then in steps four, five, and six they flesh out the Mid-Game. All of this together done in this way helps to ensure that the Short-Game, Mid-Game, and Long-Game are aligned, that there is balance and harmony between all of these games. When there is harmony between the games there is a certain flow that can occur helping to make change easier because everything feels inevitable and right, and it all fits, everything becomes obvious.

What adding the Deep-Game does is it gives greater meaning. It helps to define identity, and can give purpose. Like with all of the other games, there are helpful games and unhelpful games. Society has certain metaphors, and views about how we should be. Some people have religious or spiritual beliefs which guide them and give them the Deep-Game they have, and some people may feel their life lacks purpose and meaning because they don't have a Deep-Game.

My smoking cessation client had religious beliefs about how she felt she should live a 'good life', and smoking wasn't compatible with this. Her Deep-Game fed into every step of who she

wanted to be, she wanted to be a responsible parent, she wanted to be healthy, her identity as a person was that of someone who does the right things, and smoking was something which went against this ideal. This was a really powerful motivator for her to make changes and keep the changes. Her Deep-Game gave meaning to her whole life, which helped her feel proud of progress she made towards her ideal way of being.

Often the Deep-Game can be difficult to put into words, but it is handy if the coach can help a client to come up with a word or short phrase which encapsulates the mystery, the magic, and a metaphor. Some Deep-Game perspectives are inclusive and whole, whereas others are divided and in parts. So, a metaphor of nature, or of love for example, is inclusive and promotes connection, both within the self, and with the environment, and the past and future. Whereas other metaphors or identity like powerful ruler, sets the person apart from everything else, it is an identity more likely to make the client be focused on what they can get and what they have in the present, they are less likely to focus on inclusive Mid-Game and Long-Game ideas, but instead on what gadgets they can get, on getting the environment they want. It is often about trying to control everything for their own end, rather than considering others and the wider world. It can be a very selfish perspective.

Questions the coach may ask the client include:

- Who are YOU really?
- What metaphor would you give to your life?
- What metaphor would you like to live your life towards?
- What do you find magical in life?

All of these questions help the client to explore their Deep-Game. The Deep-Game will be their overarching framework which everything else is driving towards whether they know what their Deep-Game is or not, so it is helpful to have clients

explore it.

In much of my therapy practice I use metaphors, magic and mystery extensively to communicate ideas to clients. I will tell stories to clients which lay down new ways of thinking and being, and new helpful patterns which I hope clients will internalise and live their lives to.

As a coach if you listen closely to clients, you will notice their metaphors which they lead life to even if they don't realise it. So, a client may use the metaphor of struggling up a mountain as being how they view life or their situation, they may use the metaphor of not seeing the wood for the trees, or a metaphor of 'drowning'. If you take the client's metaphors as their reality being expressed metaphorically you can then help them by using their metaphors and guiding the metaphors in a different way to broaden them and add alternative options.

This can be done by guided imagery. You can ask the client to close their eyes for a moment and you will talk to them, and then in a relaxed way you can guide them through their metaphors, but with helpful additions.

So, if someone says they are 'stuck in a rut' then this will be a metaphor which they are living their current problem or life from within, so they need a way out, so you can create a story or metaphor around being in a rut or hole and struggling to get out of the rut, before finding a way out successfully. I did this with a client who wasn't moving forward in therapy and kept referring to being stuck in a rut, so I did guided imagery of a car getting stuck in a rut in the pouring rain, and the driver tried to free the car, and struggled and failed. They tried pushing the car, they tried driving the car back and forward to get out of the rut, nothing worked. Eventually they took some time to stop and look at the situation, and they thought of a way out of the rut. They got some stones and some wood and wedged this under the back wheels and were able to use this surface to reverse out of the rut.

FOURGAMES COACHING DEMONSTRATION

This demonstration is shown on my FourGames eCourse. Here some of the wording has been cleaned up to make it more readable and to remove some of the filler words. 'D' is for Dan and 'C' is for when the client is speaking. This demonstration was recorded during one of my live Hypnotherapy training courses where I was teaching a class of students the FourGames approach. As this is during a training course, I get into the demonstration quicker than I would usually if I was working with a client where I would ask how they are, how things have been going and engaging with them to settle them in to the session, engaging in what in therapy speak is termed problem-free talk.

Throughout the session I am also doing a demonstration, so this limits some of the angles I perhaps would have taken or time I would have spent over certain questions or exploring specific answers. The target length of the demonstration was about 30 minutes to fit with the section of the course and the way I try to break things up into 90-minute chunks so that no section of the course goes on so long that students get restless and begin to struggle to focus.

When I do demonstrations during my training courses, I never know who will volunteer or what problem they will present. I explain what we will be covering next and then just ask who

would like to volunteer for the next demonstration and whoever volunteers is who I then do the demonstration with.

D: So, what would you like to achieve? How would you like to be?

> I start off directly asking a Long-Game question, trying to establish the goal the client would like from our interaction.

C: I can project self-confidence, but that's not how I feel. So, I'd like to feel confident, not get the anxiety thing.
D: So how would you know when you are feeling confident?

> I am exploring what the client's Short-Game will be when they have achieved their goal. I am also using a linguistic technique which can help to gently place their answer as a potential future reality. I start the sentence stating 'would' which is separate from the client and end it stating 'when you are' which is a part of the client's experience and also presupposing that what we are talking about will happen, rather than saying something like 'how would you know if you were feeling confident?' Which means it may or may not happen.

C: When I'm not feeling anxious.
D: How would you know that you're feeling confident? What sort of thoughts will you have? How will you know behaviourally in your body?

> I continue to focus on the Short-Game they will have and continue to imply it will happen as part of their future using the same structure as the previous sentence.

C: I'd like to not even consider it., that I'm feeling confident. I'd like it just to come naturally and not even be a thought that pops into my head.
D: So, what will you be doing? So, say right now, you suddenly were confident.

> As the client still seems to be keeping some distance from engaging in the experience in their mind of what it would be like to be confident. The client's answer shows signs she may be moving a little, but I want them to be experiencing confidence now to describe to me what they will be feeling.
> In normal sessions I can take more time over this, but here I'm being more direct to encourage them to think about the experience because it is a brief demonstration on a training course. My therapy or coaching sessions last about 90 minutes. I give two-hour time slots for clients, aiming to give the client about 90 minutes and then have about 30 minutes before the next client session starts for me to rest and think about the next client and to have any thoughts about the client I've just seen.

C: I'd not have my heart pounding. . .
D: So, your heart would be doing what?

> It is important that the client is focusing on what will be happening rather than on what won't be happening, and on what they want rather than what they don't want, so I push this.

C: Just normal.
D: So normal sort of 60 odd beats a minute, or whatever it is for natural.
C: Yeah
D: Yeah. So, what about how you are with your shoulders?

> I am trying to encourage the client to engage in the physiological experience of confidence, but they still aren't fully engaging. I know how a confident person would experience their shoulders, but I want the client to tell me that, rather than me tell them, because I want the experience to come from within them, not from me.

C: I'm feeling a bit hot.
D: That's the room, I think?
C: I wasn't feeling hot over there.
D: Okay. I was going to say, I'm feeling very hot over here.
C: Yeah. I wasn't feeling it over there, but I'm starting to feel it here. My elbows are getting a bit clammy.

> The client mentioned feeling hot. I felt that the room was hot and so mentioned that. Once they mentioned separation by saying they weren't feeling hot 'over there', I decided to use that separation by mentioning 'over here' to try to encourage deeper focus on being 'here' and not 'there'. Their response to me seemed like they were taking this idea onboard.

D: So how will you be feeling though? So, if you are confident, how will you be feeling in relation to you know, will you have tense shoulders?

> Following the last exchange, I get straight back to encouraging the client to experience confidence 'here' and now, emphasising 'you are confident'.
> In therapy and coaching I want clients to be experiencing the desired state in the present so that we can connect it with the future where it is wanted or needed.

> I also obviously know that the answer to 'will you have tense shoulders?' is going to be 'no', because you don't have tense shoulders if you are being confident, but by encouraging the client to say 'no' can begin to get the negative out of the way making it more likely they will then be more positive as they have a space for that negativity.

C: No, it would just be, normal, natural state. So, if I was at home quite comfortable, nothing going on that would test me in any way, that sort of thing.
D: So how will your shoulders be for that?

> I keep pushing on the same point to encourage the client to engage in the experience.

C: Loose. Yeah, not tense.
D: And your breathing? What will be different when you are breathing? When you're confident?
C: Again, you're not, it's just your subconscious controlling your breathing. It's not something you're thinking about.
D: So, you're not thinking about it and what kind of speed? Just normal?
C: Yeah.

> I make things a little easier on the client here due to time. I am still focusing on the Short-Game of confidence.

D: And so that's the state that you want. What sort of contexts do you want this confidence?
C: Public. Obviously,
D: It's like public speaking.
C: Yeah, I have no plans to stand up in front of a room of lots of people, but should the occasion happen, like networking things, for example, at some point in the future you have to do your bit, don't you? So, I'd like not to have the, I'd be

panicking, no, my turn is coming up, thing, I'd like it just to be all natural. Oh, it's my turn. I'm prepared. This is what I'm going to say.
D: So, I think one thing, confidence is always an interesting thing because one thing with confidence is in reality you want someone to only be confident about what they know. You don't want someone to just have an arbitrary kind of confidence because I can't drive. I've been in a car once with my mum and, it was a, I think a BMW and it was on some land that we had and she said, so you are approaching 16. Get in the car, have a little drive. I put my foot down and said, "when do I have to put my foot on the brake so that we stop before hitting that fence?" and while I was saying all that, she was screaming, "stop" at me. So, I had to put my foot on the brake and stop before hitting the fence, but because I can't drive, it would be very reckless if I suddenly said, "I'm going to confidently jump in this car and just drive". So, I think having confidence when you shouldn't be confident...
C: That's something else I'm not confident in. I do drive but it's driving to places I don't know, for example, we were discussing it earlier in the week. There is a course that I'd quite like to do. I don't actually have the funds for it at the moment, but the thing that's putting me off is I have to spend a day in Gillingham. And it's the driving to Gillingham the thing. It's actually putting me off doing the course that I want to do...

> I didn't know that the client also lacked confidence driving. I just chose this random example from my life to make my point. This is something which frequently happens, that a chosen example or metaphor or whatever it happens to be has meaning or resonates in some way with the client. Following the client's response, I obviously now integrate this into the session.

D: So, what about that is putting you off?

C: I don't like motorway driving. I've done it when I've been following someone else and I've had someone in the car with me. I don't have a very good sense of direction and I'm a bit rubbish with a sat nav because I find they give you the information a little bit too late for me. So, I've got no sense of distance there. So, 500 yards or whatever, turn left and I think, I don't know what 500 yards is, and then all of a sudden it goes, turn left and you're like there, so that sort of thing.

D: So, part of that obviously is understandable. If you, it is hard to judge distances and, I find that, obviously I'm a metric person and so I find when things are given in Imperial, I have no idea what you're talking about.

It could be any distance at all. I can't work it out. But then if it's metric and it's too far, I don't know, 500 metres from a thousand metres. It's just like it's off somewhere in the distance. It's, yeah, I think there is that sort of, but it's then being comfortable with that and then being comfortable with, it's okay to miss a turn.

It's okay to, on a motorway, it's inconvenient because you might have to go another three miles now or something before you can turn around. But it is okay to miss a turn and it's having that kind of, I think one thing a lot of humans seem to struggle with is, comfortableness with uncertainty.

That sort of, it's okay for things to be uncertain, I'm not good with uncertainty either, but it's that sort of, it is okay to be uncertain about how something's going to go. So, on a scale of 0 to 10, if 10 was when you give these talks or you network or you are in, we'll say the car as well, you're in the car driving somewhere you don't know, 10 is, you're perfectly comfortable, perfectly confident with it, 0 is the opposite of that. Where would you say you are now?

> Here I work at normalising some of the experience. I also repeatedly implant the suggestion or idea that it is okay for things to be uncertain and comfortable with uncertainty, then I move straight into scaling the current situation.

C: For all of those instances, or am I separating them out?
D: Yeah, we'll start with all of them, then if you think there's a significant difference between them, we can break it down.
C: In the car, I'd be nervous about making the commitment to go somewhere. I don't know. But if I thought, I'm going to do it, I probably wouldn't consider it too much. If it got a bit nearer. I'd try to work out the journey in advance, trying to prepare, but as it got nearer, I'd start to panic more. And on the day I had to do it, I'd be freaking out, so 0 is highly anxious, is it? In this case? Yeah. I'd probably be. One or two...
And then with the social situations, the sort of giving talks, networking, again, I'd know I wouldn't want to do it. I would prepare, and perhaps on the day I'd start to feel a bit anxious, but it would be as I'd be walking in because it's your turn coming up. With the networking you don't normally know exactly when your turn's going to be, do you? So, I'd be constantly on edge then waiting for my turn.
D: So, what sort of number would you give for that?
C: When I got to that stage, it would again be somewhere around the same region, I suppose about one or two. And I probably feel like I was waffling then and all that stuff I prepared. I wouldn't entirely be sure that was actually what was coming out of my mouth...

> Early in sessions I like to establish where someone would place themselves on a scale of 0-10. The scale doesn't have to be 0-10, it could be to 100 or it could be some other form of scale. It depends on the individual you are working with. For example, with some people, including some children I just draw a line on a sheet of paper and ask them to mark the line and then for my own measuring of progress I will measure the length of the line and divide this my 10 or 100 (depending on what scale I'm converting the line to) and then times this number by the distance to the person's

mark.
Or it could be something physical. For example, I worked with parents who liked to focus very heavily on demonstrating how intelligent they were and how much better educated than me they were. When I asked them a scaling question the mum replied that they would place themselves as the square root of pi, then the dad responded with something similar, so I then just said "if standing at the top of your stairs means you have fully achieved what you want and standing at the bottom means you haven't achieved anything, how far up the stairs would you climb?"
I like to know where someone is at the start of therapy or coaching and where they would like to reach and what one point higher would be and perhaps what is already going well which stops them from saying one point lower, and ideally establish sensory descriptions for these.

D: So, what would you be happy with? What would be a number that you'd be happy with?
C: So, we've got to go to the other end? I'd be happy with, ideally, I'd like not even to consider it, so the ideal would be a 10. But I realise that, whatever's going on in your life might make you feel a bit different on one day. And I think maybe that day that was going to happen. We're not really in the mood for this or whatever, but not overly happy, but know that I'm going to do it without it being too much of a problem.
D: And I think, one reason why I always ask where you'd like to be, is because logically I think people would think, obviously a 10. But the reality is life is good at slapping you in the face, a 10 in things is actually very unlikely. For most things. You have some anxiety there or you're going somewhere strange and new, even the most confident person should have some kind of, "I don't quite know where I'm going" so that they pay a bit more attention. Whereas if you are overconfident, you do get some

people that are overconfident. If you're overconfident, you have a tendency to make mistakes because of the fact that you don't bother analysing yourself.
You don't bother checking that you're doing things okay. You're too busy thinking, I'm somewhere, I'm not going to pay attention to road signs because I know exactly where I'm going. Or I'm going to give a hundred percent attention to the sat nav and believe whatever it says, or believe I have travelled 500 yards, so I'm now going to turn.
And that kind of, you get people turning down railway tracks and things and you think if you used your eyes, you would know that wasn't the turning to go down. But people do it. So, it's useful just to check that a client isn't wanting to over believe in themselves or expect so much of themselves.
And although I'm not going to ask you this here, in therapy, I often ask, how confident or what number would you want to achieve to know you don't need a therapist anymore? Because I like to know at what point do you think you can go the rest of the journey on your own? You don't necessarily always need to pay someone for support. You reach a point where you think, "you know what, I think I can make the rest of the improvements myself." Actual therapy where I'm going to see someone maybe more than once. I like to have that just so that it's not all about me, it's about you making the improvements and doing that work yourself.
So how would you define that sort of you who you want to be? So, if you woke up in the morning and, a solution focused question here, woke up in the morning, a miracle had happened overnight and no-one obviously told you because it's a surprise and you woke up in the morning and you are now that confident person, no-one's told you. So, the first you know about it is when you're in the car or when you are going to a networking thing or when you're giving a talk.

> The miracle question, from solution focused therapy, is a helpful question to ask to have a client explore and absorb themselves in

> experiencing a specific way of being in the future in the here-and-now.

C: Obviously I want to be the same person. I wouldn't want to come across as cocky, but maybe knowledgeable about my subject without being dull, and so people coming away knowing what, so in that networking case, what I do, what I can do, and remembering me.
D: Wear a silly hat, if you want to be remembered, stand out. Sean's very good at doing that, not with silly hats, but I'm surprised he isn't wearing his shirt today. Something else that you'll read on there later some questions I ask, what would be like a short word or phrase that would sum up who you'd want to be?
But that sort of depends on what the issue is that someone's working on. So, if it's someone trying to achieve something rather than working on a problem, sometimes it's quite nice to give yourself almost like a tagline or a catchphrase of this is who I am, because then it gives you something to almost believe in yourself by, businesses do it a lot. They give themselves a tagline that sums up hopefully the meaning of that business. As I say, Jamie's thing is 'happy, healthy, helpful'. It is a really easy, really quick, simple tagline of, this is who I am, this is what I do, this is how I live my life. And so sometimes it's quite nice to have something short and catchy, but obviously for confidence, I'm not going to do that right now.
But it is just one of those things that if someone can come up with it, I always remember happy, healthy, helpful when I think of Jamie because it is easy and catchy. And so just if you can get something like that, like this is who I am, this is how I summarise myself. So, what sort of thinking do you do currently? Say you are in a networking situation.

> I take a moment to educate the audience and the subject, who is also here to learn. This is something different between a pure session held privately with a client and someone from an

> audience of students who is volunteering to be a subject, but who also is there to learn.
> The trainer takes on two roles, one of working with the client and making sure they are the most important person in the room during the demonstration and that you are doing the best you can to help them, while also making sure to cover what needs to be demonstrated for them and the audience that the audience will be doing after the demonstration, and the other role is remaining a trainer, interspersing educational comments for the audience and the volunteer, especially if you deviate from what you are going to be expecting them to do.
> Something a trainer can also do though is to utilise the fact that you have an audience, so sometimes you may say things to the audience which are designed for the volunteer, where you want to indirectly communicate something to them while appearing to be actually communicating something with the audience.

C: I never put myself in one, partially for that reason.
D: Yep. Giving a talk or anything. Say you are going in to do that. What kind of thinking happens currently?
C: I've not, in any case, I haven't really put myself in those situations. For example, like you did when I met you, I could have, I've been going for years, I could have stood up there and talked but I chose not to and I could have got a lot of clients from that room, couldn't I? And the person that runs that meeting knows what I do. But no, I just haven't done it because I haven't wanted to stand there. And I do admire, like even when she stands there and talks every time. I think you know that, that's really impressive. You can stand in front of, I don't know how many people were there that night. A hundred, 150. That would never even cross my mind to attempt that. So yeah.
D: So, I was thinking a similar thing. But then I just think, my

way of looking at all these things, so when I give something like this or when there's rooms full of lots and lots of people, it makes no real difference to me. I think there's been one exception where for some reason my mind went blank and that was in a school with about a thousand people in the room, and students were getting up and doing all the talking. And then at the last minute, I was busy doing some parenting thing, talking about parenting and stuff, just at a desk, and so it was nothing major, and then someone just said, "oh, Dan, would you like to come up and give a talk?"
"No, not really."
"Yeah. But we'd love you to."
"Okay, then I'll come and do that."
And suddenly I was in front of a thousand people. Nothing prepared, no notes or anything. And that made me really uncomfortable because I suddenly thought, "actually, you know what I've got no idea what they want me to talk about. I've just said yes because they've said 'we'd really love you to'". So, I ended up just essentially saying how brave I thought the kids were that they got up and talked and that it's quite nerve-wracking and we are really proud of how well they're doing. But I just waffled because I really had no idea what to say because I had no notes or anything. I was just thrown in. Whereas I did Uncommon Knowledge's hypnotherapy diploma and Mark Tyrrell (one of the lead trainers for Uncommon Knowledge) said to me, "we're going to get you up. We're just going to get you up and you're going to have to do something in front of the audience. Are you happy to do it?"
"Yeah, it's fine". I had no problem with the idea there of, "I just want to get you up and you can do a hypnotic induction in front of everyone." Fair enough, because that was a nice, clear, "just do a hypnotic induction", whereas, "can you talk in front of this room full of people", don't know what about, or, it is a different context, but normally I just get that slight 'it is a bit nerve-wracking', but at the same time, if I know something, I'll talk about it. If I don't know it, I say I don't know it. I've no problem admitting my failures and admitting that I don't know things. I

think people respect you more when you say you don't know something than when you try and blag it and make out that you do know it and they know you don't because of the way you've just come across.

> I explained these examples as a way of presenting some therapeutic information as well as continuing to normalise the idea of occasionally being nervous and trying to contextualise times when it is natural to be more nervous and when it is natural to be less nervous, as well as sharing about being comfortable with not getting everything right or not knowing everything and trying to expand the client's thinking around this.

C: I suppose in that situation you could say, but I can find out for you...
D: Yeah. Or just tell them where they can find out or whatever. So, at that thing there, I turned up late because I was getting a lift over and I think we got lost or something. And, so I'd walked in pretty much when it was due to start, although I think we didn't actually start for a while after I'd arrived. The fact was we turned up with me just turning up with everyone already there. Whereas obviously I quite like to turn up before people and see people coming in because it doesn't feel so threatening when you turn up first and then the room gradually fills up and so the first row of people, you've nodded with or something. They're there, you are there, it's fine. And then gradually people fill up. It's nice and comfortable. Whereas when you walk in and it's "oh, there's 150 people in this room, that's great, let's try and talk in front of them all". It's a bit more nerve-wracking but it sounds like the sort of talking that you do to yourself or the kind of thoughts you have now are stopping you from even going there.
C: Yeah. And the same with driving. Yeah. I just don't do it unless I know, somewhere I've been before, I know where I'm going.

D: So, what sort of thinking do you think would be more helpful? So, let's say you woke up in the morning and you are going to set off on a journey somewhere you've never been before.
C: What would I like to think? I'd just like to get myself ready. Obviously, I've worked out the route or whatever, and not really given too much consideration to the facts of what I'm about to do. Just get in the car and go, you have some rough idea of what time you need to leave and allowing for traffic and whatever. So yeah, I'd just like to just do it without giving it an awful lot of thought, confident drivers.
D: And the same with standing in front of a group or networking. So, if you're about to head out of home and go to a networking event or a talk?
C: I think, in that case, you would've had to put in a lot more preparation to know exactly what you want to say and maybe have some idea of any questions that might be asked. So, it would require more preparation and obviously I take my notes with me to go off of, I don't have to feel 100% happy about it, but without the panic.
D: And I think notes are always an interesting one. Apart from this here (I show some paper with minimal notes), I don't have notes for anything I'm doing here. I prefer not to have notes. Maybe just bullet points, "I want to talk about this, and this."
C: Yeah. I don't have a very good memory though, so I would need prompting.
D: No. And that's why I have bullet points and timings next to the bullet points just to bring myself back. So, I gave a series of meditation talks just a couple of months ago. And I just had a couple of bullet points of, I want to talk about this. I want to talk about how meditation helped me with Asperger's and I want to talk about that and that. So, I just had a couple of simple bullet points and a couple of 'right, it's got my bit of talking has to take, say half an hour'. So, I broke it down. 'That will take that long' and as long as I hit those targets it doesn't matter what goes on around it.
In the old days I used to try and structure things and write

essentially a script of what I'm going to say and the trouble with doing that. And part of that, I used to go to Toastmasters, to look at trying to improve public speaking, and part of that was you write what you are going to say, and then you give your talk with this nicely configured speech.

The difficulty with that is that then if you lose your place, say you've just glanced up, you're looking around because you obviously don't want to stare at a bit of paper all day. So, you glance up and you're looking around and you're making a bit of eye contact and stuff, trying to make everyone feel like you're all together. You look back at the page and think I've just got words on this page and I have no idea where I'm at. So now you start falling over yourself because you think, I don't know where I was, but I've got to keep talking. So, part of you thinks, 'okay, just pause, find where I am and then start again from that point'.

And I had that on my wedding day when I gave my speech that I over-prepared had too many words on my page and so lost my place easily. And so decided to just throw it away, just, you know, it's not even worth trying to find it. I know roughly what I need to say. But I do find that an interesting one, the idea of how many notes, and I think that everyone's got their personal preference.

Some people are good at following notes. I think it's the same with PowerPoints, if you do presentations with PowerPoints, some people like PowerPoints with loads and loads of notes on them, but then that's boring for the audience. Others are very good, there's someone from Littlehampton Academy, he's brilliant at doing his PowerPoint presentations. He literally just has a picture for each slide. And he'll tell a story based on that picture and he'll talk about it, and then he'll just change the slide and then the next picture will be an evocative kind of picture. And he'll just tell something around that. And his talks are engaging and they're brilliant. And so, it's trying to aim, I think, more for that, ideally. But then you've got to think of yourself as well and what your personal style is. So, if you're a bullet point person, have bullet points.

> I felt that it could be helpful to share some education around using notes vs not using notes, and using bullet points. Also around presenting approaches and handling when you lose your place while presenting.

C: I think reading a complete script probably doesn't come across as natural sounding.
D: It doesn't for most people. Again, like when I write hypnotherapy script, I often say them first and then write what I said so that it hopefully comes across with my words that are natural words, even if it's not linguistically a hundred percent correct. Because writing that's a hundred percent correct linguistically doesn't necessarily translate to sounding like natural speech when you then come to say it. So, it's getting that balance. So, what about your environment? Does that help or hinder? When you get in the car when you're travelling somewhere. Do you have lots of distractions? Do you have music blaring?

> I now progress on to the next stage focusing on the client's environment as it currently is and the preferred environment.

C: If I was on my own, I'd have music blaring. I'd find driving really boring if I haven't got any music going. Obviously if there's someone in the car, then they want to talk or it's too loud for them and or yeah. And if it's my daughter in the car, she'll start fiddling, pressing buttons and whatever. That's distracting.
D: If you were travelling somewhere a long way and needed sat nav and stuff like that, would you be able to have an environment that's conducive to being confident? Because it sounds like some of that distraction would obviously knock confidence. Because you're going to miss things.
C: I'd have to, yeah, I'd have to turn that music right down, wouldn't I? And so the sat nav voice would need to be louder to

override the music.
D: Because again, as you say, there's nothing wrong with music and there's nothing wrong with chatting to somebody in the car, but it is having that balance between how much is okay and at what points in the journey do you say "can we just focus now?" Or even better "can you help me?" If there's someone with you, "can you keep track of directions you say, turn in just a minute or take the next exit." What is sometimes helpful is to have that person. So, what sort of support networks do you have around you? What kind of things help you? Something I didn't mention there, which I'll bring into this. What kind of things, like if you were doing speaking, what kind of environment? Like I always have a water with me. What kind of things help you or do you think would help you if you've never done it?
C: I suppose yes, you'd have to, if you're talking, you need water. Yeah, I'd need my prompts. Yeah. I suppose you make a decision whether you're going to stand or sit. Yes. You just have to put some thought into how it might work best.
D: And likewise in the car. What about. the support there, like how you've got it all set up in the car. You could have a friend with.
C: You can't always have that though. That would be better. Yeah, that would be better because yeah, you've got someone else to ask or did that just say whatever road sign.
D: You could have. Obviously, printouts of Google Maps or something where you've got your routes, marked up. You could even have; I love Street View. I think Street View, especially when I was doing a lot of home visits as work. Street View is brilliant to be able to actually see that last bit of route. As if I was really making that last bit of route. And you can obviously save some of them as images, as well, so that you can get an idea of, oh, when you are there, you can see that church there. Or when you're there you can see this. I remember when I was working in children's homes, one guy had to, my manager, had to go and pick up a child and they were told to turn left at the greenhouse and they hunted for a greenhouse and never saw a greenhouse and didn't realise it was a glasshouse that they were

looking for. So sometimes, language can be vague and unhelpful. And what sort of, obviously you've got gadgets. So that's one of Jamie's things is he loves gadgets, I think. What sort of gadgets? So, for example, it could be like a pen or, what would help you to give public speaking or...
C: Yeah, so you'd have your notes. That would be one. Item, like you're saying, prepared. So, water. I don't know, maybe you might want some, if you were going to stand, you probably want somewhere to rest it.
D: That's always an interesting one. I've given talks at places where you've got a podium thing and it's do you stand behind it, which gives you a sense of protection. It makes you feel like there's something between me and them. You've then got something you can rest your notes on there. I think if it's on a wooden thing there, you do naturally stand talking to everyone, knowing you can just glance down. Whereas if it's in your hands, I think you naturally seem to follow your hands and you look down at your hands all the time rather than looking out to the audience, but then you feel you're separate, the separation that helps you relax is also the separation that stops you feeling connected to the audience. So, it is sometimes, it's nice to then stand beside it. So, it's trying to get that balance, I think. And obviously everyone has their own. Some people are brilliant at presenting and can do it from behind something.
And as I think I did at the talk I gave; I sat on the back of the chair so that although I was standing so that people at the back of the room could see me, I was also sitting because sitting is a calming act. So, by sitting down about two inches lower than my height, at least I felt like I was sitting rather than standing. So, I felt more relaxed. And, your muscles are more relaxed when you're sitting. So having chairs obviously can be handy. So, I'm going to do a hypnosis bit. Everyone can have these notes later. So, let's do some hypnosis. I'm tempted to do a rapid induction on you, just because normally I don't do rapid inductions because I pretty much don't see a need for an induction. I just normally get on with it and people go with the process and get more absorbed and deeper as the process goes on. There

seems no point doing an induction full stop. But if we are going to do an induction just because there's a camera on us...
C: Just reminded me...
D: That can be a very good induction "remember, there's a camera on you." People get 'deer in the headlights' kind of thing, and it works brilliantly. So, if you're comfortable pushing down on my hand, push down on my hand, push harder and harder, keep pushing harder and harder and harder, keep pushing harder and harder, keep pushing harder, and sleep (clicking fingers at the same time). That's it. Relaxing deeper and deeper all the way down. That's it. And as you relax deeper and deeper into hypnosis so you can hear my voice and as you listen to my voice in the background so you can begin to make some changes on an unconscious level on that deep, instinctive level. You can begin to help yourself to feel calm and confident in a whole variety of different situations, and in a moment, you'll be able to have an opportunity to imagine yourself in those situations. But before you do, you can just have a sense of how calmness and confidence can flow through you. And I don't know whether calmness and confidence starts in the stomach or in the heart, or with an in breath or an out-breath or, whether it starts in the shoulders or the hands, or whether it starts in the way you stand or the way you sit. Or with a certain thought or idea, and you'll discover that for yourself. And it may be different for different situations.
And as you continue to drift deeper and more relaxed, I don't know whether you'll go deeper with each out-breath. or with each in-breath, and you can imagine yourself waking up one morning and imagine yourself getting ready for the day, brushing your teeth, perhaps having a drink, feeling calm and comfortable. And imagine yourself going out of your house, out the front door, and imagine yourself going on a long journey. And on that long journey can be a sense of wonder, a sense of discovery. And only you know what wonder and discovery feels and means to you.
And being comfortable with uncertainty and sometimes confidence is about what you focus on, and so you can imagine

a journey to a strange place somewhere you've never been before, but you want to go. You're looking forward to going, and as you make that journey. You can miss a turning and feel confident that you know that you'll find your way back to that turning and that you've given yourself enough time. To be able to get lost a few times and still find your way back on path. Find your way back on track. And you can continue that journey in the car. Sat nav giving you directions and you can comfortably make some mistakes and yet still find your way and keep on track.

And you can have a sense of arriving at your destination and as if you're watching through the eyes of say a famous trainer, you can have a sense of walking out in front of an audience of thousands. Feeling a buzz. Feeling the energy rushing around inside you, the excitement. All these people here are excited to hear from you, excited to learn from you, and you excited that all these people are here to learn from you. And you've got your notes and you can feel energy. It's flowing in your body, flowing in your hands, your arms flowing through your legs, and a smile coming to your face as soon as everyone claps when you're introduced. And the excitement as you start and then gradually calming down from that excitement as you get into what you're talking about. While everyone is fixated on enjoying what you're talking about, and you can always keep in mind what this feels like. And how this can happen any time in the future. That's it. And then at the end, everyone can give you applause and you can walk down and mix and mingle with people clamouring to come and talk to you. And there'll be times that you think, oh, I don't know the answer to that.

And no-one minds, you're allowed to not know things and your unconscious can make all the necessary changes for you to be appropriately confident in all of these different situations and other situations you want to be confident in.

And I don’t know whether that confidence, those changes will be made quickly or whether those changes will be made slowly over the next week or two as your unconscious embeds that in your neurology and into you as it being. And each twitch can

just let out a little bit of energy as change and improvement happens on an unconscious level. And you can continue working on this in daydreams in night-time dreams, times when your mind just wanders, working on this into the future. That's it. And then when your unconscious knows, that's it, that it'll continue that in the future so you can come back round to the room and allow your eyes to open. Thank you...

> To end the session, I demonstrate a rapid hypnotic induction. I don't normally do this in sessions, so this was something being done for the education of the group of students. I then go through what we have discussed and use mental rehearsal and hypnotic techniques like different language patterns (covered later in this book) as well as presenting therapeutic ideas we have discussed.
> Following this the group has the opportunity to ask the client and myself any questions and the client has the chance to ask any questions and to share any thoughts.

ADVANCED FOURGAMES TRANSFORMATION PROCESS

The FourGames process I use frequently in therapy and coaching is the Advanced FourGames Transformation Process. This process works with how our neurology works. It focuses on helping clients to develop new responses to environmental triggers at the level of the neurological pattern which precedes the automatic behavioural responses and the start of the emotional response, and any thinking.

The way we respond to the world around us is that our senses perceive the world. This continuously triggers neurological patterns of activity which evoke automatic behaviours and emotions. All of this happens below conscious awareness or involvement and uses the deeper more primitive parts of our brain and our spinal cord.

Usually, we don't pay attention or notice this, from things like adjusting our balance moment to moment to walk as we get sensory input from our feet and our eyes and ears, etc., to things like non-consciously scratching an itch or shifting in a seat to keep comfortable. But sometimes the response to an environmental trigger is strong enough that we become aware and the signal reaches the higher cortex and we have thoughts.

This could be walking through the woods, our eyes noticing a snake-shaped stick and so by default, we have an automatic behavioural response of recoiling, increasing heart-rate and

making other 'preparing to fight or flee' physical and behavioural changes. At the same time, we start to develop an emotional response. This is a slower response, too slow to be responsible for our behaviour and so is more about lacing this experience with an emotion that will be linked to this memory.
If we only respond with fear, then this memory laced with the feeling of fear will be a survival memory informing the neurological pattern of how we will respond if that pattern is triggered again in the future. If on the other hand we start having thoughts and directing conscious attention to the cause of the automatic response and emotion, and we notice that it is just a stick, the emotion can subside and we perhaps experience relief and the memory won't be stored as a survival memory. It is our consciousness which helps to add nuance to our emotions, by giving meaning.
Many therapies and coaching approaches try to address the thinking of a problem, or try to help people change their behaviours, but often from after the neurological pattern has been triggered. Here, the aim is to identify what is triggering the neurological pattern and then to disrupt the problem on the level of the underlying pattern or root cause, so that the environmental triggers don't lead to the old pattern being triggered which lead to the automatic behaviours and emotions and thoughts, but instead triggers a pattern which leads to preferred automatic behaviours, emotions and thoughts.

Outline of the process:

1. **Think about what you want to achieve** (what will you be doing, thinking, feeling, saying? What will others notice? What would someone notice if they had a video camera, what would they see and hear? Are there changes to your environment? How will you be ideally responding in situations?) And whether this aligns with who you are or want to be as a being and with your values. Make any adjustments to what you want to achieve, what you will be seeing, hearing,

doing, thinking, feeling and saying until it aligns with your values and who you want to be. - what is your Long-Game? Does it align with your Deep-Game?

Fill the boxes...

2. **In what situations do you currently respond in an unhelpful way?** (What are the triggers? What do you see, hear or experience in the environment which you are currently responding to in an unhelpful way?) - What is your Mid-Game? (BOX 1)
3. **What is the worst-case scenario of continuing to respond in the old way?** (What would you see, hear, feel, think, experience, what could be the impact on others etc) - What is your Long-Game if nothing changes? (BOX 2)
4. **Say 'No'** - Short-Game interrupt (BOX 3)
5. What is the best-case scenario of saying 'No' and responding in your ideal way? - What is your Long-Game if you make the necessary changes? (BOX 4)
6. Run through the boxes left to right, opening your eyes after box 4, closing your eyes again straight away and repeating 5-6 times, getting quicker each time. - Breaking the old pattern
7. **Disassociated Mental Rehearsal** - With your eyes closed imagine relaxing into the most comfortable seat with a large screen in front of you and as you go through this process, make any tweaks necessary to ensure it is congruent with who you are as a being, with who you want to be and that it aligns with your values (Deep-Game alignment).
8. On that screen see yourself experiencing the trigger and automatically responding in your desired way, finding that if you find yourself in a trigger situation then you respond in your desired way. - Notice what you can see and hear, what behaviours you are

doing, how it makes the situation go differently. Watch a few more different situations where you automatically respond in the desired way. Watch as the video moves forward in time and settles on future situations, noticing what you can see and hear, noticing what behaviours you are doing and what else you can notice that lets you know you have been automatically making progress for some time now. After viewing a selection of future situations, notice the scene change to a distant future scene, long after you have achieved your goal, perhaps to the ideal scenario, maybe to some other future situation that symbolises that you have achieved what you wanted to achieve. Notice what you can see, hear and what you are doing as you automatically respond in that situation that lets you know you have been successful and are continuing to be successful.

9. **Associated Mental Rehearsal** - Now, imagine that screen going blank and then the movie on that screen starting again, only this time, you stand up from that chair, walk to the screen and step into the 'you' in that movie. You step into yourself experiencing the trigger and automatically responding in your desired way, discovering that if you find yourself in a trigger situation then you will respond in the desired way. Noticing what you can see and hear, what behaviours you are doing, what inner dialogue you have and how that inner dialogue sounds, what feelings you are experiencing and how this makes the situation go differently. Then experience those other situations again, where you automatically respond in the desired way, noticing what you can see, hear, feel, what you are doing and what your inner dialogue is like, before experiencing the video moving forward in time again settling on those future situations, noticing what you can see, hear and feel, noticing what behaviours you are

doing, your inner dialogue and what else you can notice that lets you know you are automatically making progress and have been for some time now. Continue to experience these other future situations, before noticing the scene change to a distant future scene, long after you have achieved your goal, perhaps to the ideal scenario, maybe to some other future situation that symbolises that you have achieved what you wanted to achieve and notice what you can see, hear, feel, noticing your inner dialogue and what you are doing as you experience automatically responding in that situation and how this lets you know you have been successful and are continuing to be successful.

10. Once you have experienced this, have a sense of stepping out of the screen, heading back to that chair and relaxing deeply in the chair into a pleasant reverie as you.
11. Say to yourself 'If I find myself in a trigger situation then I will automatically respond in my desired way', say this three times.
12. When you have finished doing this inner work, you can drift asleep or awake in your own time.

You can use this process frequently as required with clients or with yourself. It is also helpful to use scaling at the beginning and end to monitor progress. Sometimes you might need to work on a few different triggers or situations, especially for more complex problems which may have multiple interconnected patterns and additional work may be required if someone needs to learn new skills or address specific aspects of the problem to be able to make lasting change.

For example, if someone smoked because they found it helped them manage stress, then if they quit smoking, but were still struggling with stress and didn't have an alternative solution, they may well return to the solution they already know and so start smoking again. In this situation you would want to have the

person taught alternative ways of managing stress and helped to address the stress before they quit smoking.

Example Wording of the Advanced FourGames Transformation Process

So, think about what it is that you want to achieve. Think about what you'll be doing, how you'll be thinking, what sort of things you'll be saying, and what you'll be saying to yourself. How you'll feel when you've achieved what you want to achieve. So, you want to give all of that a lot of thought. Really absorb yourself in the idea of having achieved your goal, having achieved what it is that you really want to gain from this experience.

What will others notice? So how will others know that you've achieved what it is that you want to achieve? What will be the first kind of thing that they perhaps notice? Are there changes to your environment perhaps?

There are things that today you've got in your environment that when you achieve your goal, those aspects of your environment will be different. Maybe there are things added to your environment that perhaps don't exist currently. Think about how you'll ideally be responding to different types of situations in the future, in line with that goal that you hope to achieve. And just check that what it is that you hope to achieve aligns with who you are, how you are, and who you want to be. Does it align with you as a being and with your values?

And then, if necessary, make any adjustments. So, make any changes to help it to align with who you want to be as a being and with your values and how you want to represent yourself. So that it is congruent. What you want is to make sure that the goal that you achieve is in line with who you are, and who you want to be is in line with your values. So, make any changes if you need to.

And then again, just run through what you will be doing when you've achieved that? How will life be different? What will you do? What will you see? What will you hear? What will you feel? What kind of internal dialogue will you have? Run

through that again and just keep running through that a few times. Just making any adjustments if you need to, because it's important that the goal that you strive to achieve is congruent with who you are, if it mismatches with who you are, so if somebody was trying to achieve a certain bit of success, but in doing so, they were neglecting their family, then that will make it very difficult because the goal isn't in harmony with something that's an important value for you as a being. So, you just want to make sure that your goal is in harmony with who you want to be and who you are as a person.

And now what I want you to do is think about what situations you currently respond in an unhelpful way in. So, what you're looking for is what are those Mid-Game kind of real-world situations that you find yourself in, where currently you end up responding in an unhelpful way, but you would rather respond in a new, more helpful way of being. Think about what those triggers are. What do you see? What do you hear in that experience? What's happening in that environment?

And now what we're going to do is we're going to start placing things into boxes. So, we're going to have you imagine four boxes in your mind. So, you'll have a box on the left and then a box next to that, and then a box to the right, next to that one, and a box on the end, on the far right.

And the process we're going to go through will have you go from focusing on that first box and that first box is going to have what you've just thought about, is going to have that trigger, that environmental situation that when it happens external from who you are, your Short-Game response to that is currently an unhelpful Short-Game response. So, you have that environmental trigger in the first box and there may be multiple triggers, and so all of that, you just have a representation of that in that first box. If there's one clear type of example that happens or one clear aspect of a situation, then you can focus on that as being in the first box. So, the idea is we're just creating a connection with these boxes to end up being able to break the old pattern, the old way of responding before we replace it with your new desired way of responding.

So, in the second box, what I want you to do is imagine the absolute worst-case scenario. So, it doesn't have to be one that is highly likely to happen. So, it's not the likeliest scenario, it's the worst-case scenario. The worst-case outcome that could happen if you continue to respond in that old way, that's in that box, that's triggered by box one. So, when box one happens, you respond currently in a specific kind of way. The way that you're trying to change, and there will be a worst-case scenario of what could happen.

So again, think about what you would see, what you would hear, what you would potentially feel, what your internal dialogue would be. Think about all the aspects of that worst case scenario. Is there an impact on others, for example, in that worst case scenario. So, give that some thought about what the worst-case scenario of responding in the unhelpful way to what's in box one would be.

And then in box three, just imagine the word 'no' or some other way of representing that sense of 'I do not want that, that will not happen, I do not accept that'. That kind of sense of that strength, whatever it is for you. Whatever language you use to represent that. So, for example, I worked with an alcoholic where for them their response in box three was, 'I don't drink'.

So, box one was the triggers, the things that like seeing alcohol, seeing a reference to alcohol, et cetera, or having certain life events that would all be in box one. Box two would be the worst-case scenario if they gave in and had that alcohol. Box three was them essentially dismissing, saying "I don't drink", stating that that future isn't something that's ever going to happen in their life, they do not accept that as part of their future. So, for them it was, "I don't drink", they were firm with how they said that statement. That was the statement that worked for them. So, you want something that represents that? A 'no' statement relating back to box two, some kind of strong sense of 'what's in box two, I do not accept, I will not have that as an outcome. I do not want that in my future'. So, you want whatever words represent that. So, for me it's normally just, 'no', it's a very blunt, very firm, assertive negative stating that I

am not having that as an outcome in my life. And then in box four, the one over on the right, what you want is the best-case scenario of not responding in the old way and instead choosing to respond in your new way.

So, you've said 'no' to that old way of responding and you're going to be focused on having this preferred outcome. Think about that best case outcome. So, it's going to be along the lines of the goal that we set up at the very beginning. So you want that best case outcome, telling yourself this is the sort of thoughts I'm going to have, these are the feelings I'm going to have, these are the behaviours I'm going to be doing, this is how I'm going to be talking to myself, this is what my internal dialogue is going to be, the sort of words I'm going to say to myself, this is how I'm going to say the internal dialogue to myself, this is what others are going to notice that lets them know I've achieved this best case outcome.

What we're doing with this process is we are breaking down the old way of responding, the unhelpful way of responding. We're breaking down that old Short-Game response to the Mid-Game environment around you, to what's happening external from yourself, those triggers. So, for example, if you wanted to exercise more, then perhaps when you see that it is time for you to exercise, you currently end up perhaps coming up with excuses or thinking, 'oh, but I don't feel like it', or however you respond, and then there'll be a worst-case scenario of continuing to respond in that way.

So, you say 'no' to all of that, and you open yourself up to the possibility of having this positive future instead. And so, we're just breaking down and knocking down that old way of responding while beginning to replace it with this new way of responding.

And so, to do this, we're going to go through these four boxes, but we're going to go through quickly, and then we're going to get faster. So, you only have to have a sense of this, and I'm just going to end up reaching a point of saying box 1, 2, 3, and 4 so that we get through it even quicker. But what you want is box one, is the trigger, is something happening in your life, box two

is the worst outcome of continuing to respond in that old unhelpful way, box three is your assertion 'No, I'm not going to have that future. That's not part of my future at all'. And then box four is the best-case scenario of not responding in the old way, and so instead, being able to respond in your new preferred way.

And we're going to go through this a number of times, and what we're going to do is go through box 1, 2, 3, 4, and you're going to have your eyes shut while you do this, and then I'm going to ask you to open your eyes after you've done box four, and then close your eyes. And I'm going to tell you to close your eyes almost straight away, and then we'll go through box 1, 2, 3, and 4 again. And we're going to do that about five or six times. And the idea is that this breaks that old way of responding while setting up a new way of responding. And then after the last time, your eyes will remain shut, and then we'll move into the final stage of this process.

So, make sure that you are comfortable. Make sure you don't have to pay your attention to anything else, you can just pay your attention to following this process, make sure that you won't be disturbed, and then allow your eyes to close and just focus on box one, on that trigger on the environment that happens that makes you suddenly start responding in a certain way. And then focus on box two, that worst case scenario of having responded in an unhelpful way to box one and then focus on box three, that 'No', that assertion, that you don't accept box two, you don't accept that as a part of your future reality.

And then focus on box four, that best case scenario, that best outcome of responding in a helpful way in line with your goal. Then open your eyes, then close your eyes, and then focus on box one and then on box two, and then on box three saying 'No', and then on box four. Then open your eyes and close your eyes, and focus on box one and then on box two, then on box three, and then on box four. And then open your eyes and close your eyes, then focus on box one, then box two, then box three, and finally box four. Then open your eyes and close your

eyes. Then focus on box one, focus on box two, focus on box three, saying 'No', and then focusing on box four. Then open your eyes and close your eyes, and then focus on box one, focus on box two, focus on box three and focus on box four. And then open your eyes and close your eyes. And this time allow yourself to imagine sitting down in the most comfortable chair. And as you imagine yourself sitting down in that incredibly comfortable chair, imagine a screen in front of you and it's a giant blank screen at the moment. And imagine on that screen is forming one of those situations where this time you respond in a helpful way and imagine yourself responding in that helpful way, responding in your desired way, carrying out what it is you want to achieve. Notice what you can see as you watch yourself achieving that on the screen. Notice what you can hear, what you can hear about yourself, and perhaps what you can hear in the environment. Notice what behaviours you are doing, perhaps noticing how others are interacting with you differently. Really paying attention to how you know that, that you on that screen is responding how you want to respond.

And as you go through this process, you can make any tweaks that you need to make to make it just right, just how you want it to be. Ensuring that this is congruent with who you are as a being with your values, making sure that it aligns with those values, with your being, making all those necessary changes and seeing that play out. Notice how the movie on that screen moves forward to another future point where you, again, are responding in that desired way, noticing what you can see, what you can hear, what happens that lets you know that you are responding just as you wish in that situation automatically, easily, and effortlessly. Always keeping this in mind. And then moving forward even further to another future situation, just allowing one to come to mind on that screen where again, you respond in that desired way. Doing that automatically, easily and effortlessly. Noticing what you can see, what you can hear, and noticing how others know that you are responding in this desired way. Perhaps noticing changes within yourself that let you know you are making progress as these situations go on.

Responding in that desired way across a period of time. And as you continue to watch yourself automatically responding in that desired way from one situation to the next, to the next, just allow the movie on that screen to move on to another situation and then another, each time seeing yourself growing, developing, and getting closer to that overall goal that you're aiming for. All the way off to a point, way off in the future, long after you've already passed your desired goal. And looking back on that and seeing that you, what you look like, how you know that, that you on that screen has achieved that desired goal, has been living, having achieved that desired goal for some time.
What do you see? What do you hear? What do others perhaps notice? Is there an impact on others because you have achieved that goal? How has life been for that you on the screen having achieved the goal? Just take some time to absorb yourself in all the ideas around that where you are automatically instinctively responding easily and effortlessly in that desired way and have been now for some time
And then have a sense of the screen going blank again. And then as an image appears on the screen, it starts at the beginning again, only this time you stand up out of that chair. You walk to the screen and you step into that screen, you step into the you in that screen and standing in the you in the screen, you go through these situations again. So go through that first situation, notice what you can see, what you can hear, but this time you can notice what you can feel, how things feel as you go through this situation. What emotions do you have as you respond in the desired way? What's your internal dialogue like? How do you talk to yourself? How do you express that internal dialogue? What kinds of words do you use? What do you notice about others around you?
And just experience this you responding in this desired way. And you can discover that if you find yourself in a trigger situation, in one of these situations or situations like these, you automatically and instinctively respond in this desired way, easily, effortlessly, instinctively. And you can always keep that in mind as you progress and notice the movie changing and find

yourself in that second situation. And again, going through that, seeing what you will see, hearing what you will hear, feeling what you will feel, doing what you will be doing, having the internal dialogue that you will have, going through that situation in the desired way, so easily, so effortlessly.

And then moving through that to a third situation, again, experiencing what it's like to respond in a desired way, and you are working your way through all these situations, responding in this new way, all the way to that time in the future where you look back having long achieved what it is you aim to achieve, and you're looking back at the progress you've made. And as you look back, having responded in the desired way now, for some time, notice what you see, what you hear, how you feel, perhaps any changes within you as a being, what internal dialogue you have, what sorts of things you say to yourself and how you say those things, perhaps the impact on others.

Just going through all of that. But now, from being in it and experiencing it, living it as if you have achieved that now, seeing what you will see, hearing what you will hear, feeling what you will feel, having the internal dialogue that you will have doing the behaviours that you will do. Always aware that you so easily and instinctively, anytime you're in one of those trigger situations, respond in the desired way, automatically and effortlessly.

And take a moment to notice what you can that lets you know that you have been successful and that you have been successful for a long period of time, behaving in this new desired way. And then begin to relax yourself a little more as you step out of that you in that screen and head back over to that comfortable chair. Relax yourself back down into the chair. Notice how you can relax deeper and even more comfortably, and while you relax even more comfortably, making all the necessary changes here and now knowing that you can always come back to this and do some further work in the future following this process if you need to, allowing it to help you deeper and more fully. With every use, you can find yourself almost drifting into a bit of a reverie in that chair. Your mind wandering perhaps as you

relax.
And I'd like to just have you say to yourself three times, 'if I find myself in a trigger situation, then I'll automatically respond in my desired way. If I find myself in a trigger situation, then I'll automatically respond in the desired way. If I find myself in a trigger situation, then I'll automatically respond in the desired way'.
That's it.
And then when you have finished doing this inner work, and you can take some time to relax further and allow the mind to just continue to update your neurology with the changes that you are making here, and once you know you've done the inner work you are going to do here today, you can find yourself drifting peacefully and comfortably asleep, or allow yourself to awaken, feeling refreshed and revitalised in your own time, knowing that you can use this process frequently as required.

Conclusion

The next step is to take time to practise applying FourGames. To begin to use it frequently in conversations and interactions with others. You can use FourGames on yourself, or on your businesses, or on what you want to achieve. The more you familiarise yourself with this model the better you will be able to help others.
The FourGames model is an all-inclusive model, it isn't about saying any other approach to coaching or therapy is wrong, it is just a model which can encapsulate all other forms of therapy and coaching. If you are a coach or therapist, you can see where your therapeutic or coaching approach fits within the FourGames model and what gaps are left when you have added your approach to the FourGames mandala.
This book is an introduction to the FourGames model based on my perspective of FourGames as a wellbeing coach and therapist. Others in the FourGames world will have their approaches based on how they incorporate FourGames with their backgrounds, so it is useful to explore different FourGames experts' perspectives and see what resonates most

with you and your background. FourGames is always evolving.
In this first section of the book, we have covered how the model was developed, my involvement with this, and explained each element of the model. We have also given you a 7-step FourGames coaching model as well as an advanced process which you can use when helping people to create change within their lives.
Learning this model is just the beginning. Once you know the model you can do more than just help people with coaching. You can use it to learn and develop yourself. For example, you can look to others who excel and distil what they do using this model, so for example; if someone excels at golf, you can find out their Short-Game, what thinking do they use, how do they feel when they are playing golf, how about as they approach playing golf, what behaviours do they do, what is their physicality, do they keep a certain level of fitness, how do they do that. What is their Mid-Game, what environment do they have when they are practising, when they are thinking about golf, when they are playing golf, what gadgets do they have, if they have some specific gadgets what is so special about these gadgets, are they necessary, what purpose do they serve, and what systems do they have. What Long-Game do they have, do they want to win, or to play their best, what is prioritised, what is their goal, what role do they take, what path are they on. What is their Deep-Game, what to them is their identity, their metaphor, mystery and magic.
You can do this same analysis with someone from business success, or artistic success, or any other success. If there is something you want to achieve, or something a client wants to achieve and you are stuck unable to think of the way forward, there will always be someone who has had success with that before, so you can distil what that person did, or is doing, and use that as a potential model to try on or adapt from to see if that works for you, or for the client, to achieve success. Later in this book we will be covering this FourGames of Genius approach to uncovering people's FourGames fingerprint.

USING THE FOURGAMES CARD DECK FOR COACHING

In this section we will be expanding on the therapeutic and coaching use of FourGames by exploring the use of FourGames with the FourGames Card Deck (available for purchase from the FourGames website).
So, in this chapter we're going to look at using the FourGames card deck in coaching, therapy, personal development, and therapeutic storytelling. This is just my way of using the deck. There's no right or wrong way of using this FourGames card deck, these are just my ways of using it when working in therapy coaching or teaching people to use these cards for personal development and when I use them for therapeutic storytelling.

What is the FourGames Card Deck?
The FourGames Card Deck comes in a box with a FourGames Playbook. The FourGames playing cards consist of cards from ace to king, FourGames jokers and modifier cards. The Playbook explains each card in detail and gives more information which can help you to use these cards in different ways. Here I will cover how I use the cards as an aid in therapy, coaching, training and therapeutic storytelling.
For what I do, I often use just five cards at a time, but as I'll cover while I go through this, it could be that you shuffle the cards or you just deal the cards out again, depending on what's

going on with the client that you are working with if the cards don't resonate or you get stuck.
Sometimes it could be that they can't think of something to say in relation to a specific card, or a card just doesn't stimulate the kind of thinking that's helpful, and so you work with the client and work from the client's perspective. The idea is that it works towards being able to start anywhere. And there's also no right or wrong way of doing this.
I find the FourGames card deck really lends itself to that idea of starting anywhere and to encouraging flexible thinking within the people that you're working with, as well as stimulating conversations, meaning that you can encourage people to take a look at things from an alternative perspective.
I'm not going to go through the FourGames Playbook book, there's lots of information in it that you can read if you are interested. This isn't so much about me teaching you what's written or contained within the deck or Playbook, but more about how I specifically use the deck when I'm working with people or for personal use.
What you'll notice about the deck is that there's a colour around the outside of the cards. Some of them have colours for the whole card, but for most the colour is just around the outside of the card.
The colour lets you know whether the card is to do with the Short-Game, Mid-Game, Long-Game, or Deep-Game. Orange cards are Short-Game cards, green cards are mid-game cards, blue cards are Long-Game cards, and purple cards are Deep-Game cards.

Five Card Coaching

For Five Card Coaching I just use the normal cards, not the jokers or modifiers. I deal out five cards from the deck in a row between myself and the client and then ask the client about each card dealt. So, if for example the Creativity card was dealt, this is a Mid-Game card, so you would ask about creativity from a Mid-Game perspective. So, say somebody wants to eat healthy and they've come to you for support because they're struggling

to just do it themselves. You deal out the cards and the first card dealt is the creativity card, you would ask something like "so in relation to creativity, how can you be creative with your environment to help you to be able to do better at eating healthy? What changes can you make in your environment?"
You explore their Mid-Game from the perspective of creativity. And you can use the card to explore other areas, for example can the client find ways of that creativity impacting on their Short-Game, for example? So, you can explore more. You are always led by the person you're working with and what comes out of the conversations. But it could be that you explore how they can have creativity in the environment to influence how they do their Short-Game or influence how they progress towards their Long-Game.
One thing could be that they realise that they could put something, say on a wall, that they can then chart their progress. I know now you can do everything on a mobile phone, on a calendar app or notes, but maybe having a big visual large squared calendar on the wall somewhere where they can track their progress of maybe what they're eating, when they're eating different things, whatever it happens to be, that's helpful for them that could then stimulate their Short-Game thinking about things, behaviours, and feelings and these other areas of their life. Maybe that could also influence their Long-Game because it's laid out on the wall like that where they can easily see where they are at week after week. They can then see what they are supposed to be eating on what days, what they have been eating, on what days, and can chart progress and so they can also see progress to their Long-Game, and maybe even have some Deep-Game quotes written up on the calendar to help keep them motivated.
So, you can turn the conversation into something broader if you want. It doesn't have to just be limited to the Mid-Game because it's a Mid-Game card, but you can then start anywhere. You can start with that Mid-Game creativity, and then you can build on that and talk about the next card, which could be say The Master card, so The Master is a Short-Game card, and

with the Short-Game you can then explore things like what's masterful kind of thinking, what's masterful behaviours, what's masterful feelings around this problem or thing they are seeking support for.

And I would explore that. I would explore, 'if you woke up tomorrow and you're a master of all this, how will life be different? What will you notice?'

And so, you are then exploring that through the perspective of that Master card, and then perhaps the third card is a Deep-Game card, The Sage. There are many ways that you can approach these cards. My first instinctive way when I see The Sage is to approach it almost as 'imagine way off in the future you encounter a sage...' And I would go into something a bit more metaphorical because it just lends itself to that. 'Imagine you encounter that sage, and when you're having this conversation with this sage, what wisdom can they impart having completed your journey, and what are you discovering, you know, you've got to the end of your journey and you've met this sage, what will they teach you? What inner wisdom will you gain from this?'

Obviously, the idea is that there are no right or wrong ways of doing this, it's about how we can stimulate therapeutic conversations here using the cards as the kind of focal point to cycle around the FourGames.

So, from The Sage where they may talk about how the sage can teach them some wise stuff around the importance of sticking with healthy eating, the importance of healthy eating for them over their lifespan, so beyond that Long-Game all the way through to their Deep-Game, who they would like to be remembered as by friends and family and who they want to be and what is important to them. They can explore their broader role, perhaps they have supported the environment or local businesses through buying local produce, all these different things that may be important to them, who they are or who they want to be remembered as being.

Perhaps the fourth card is the Duty card. So that is a Long-Game blue card, so you can explore that. What is their duty in

relation to what they are in coaching or therapy for? What is their duty around, eating healthy, sticking with this example. Why should they eat healthy? Why is that important to them? What does it mean to be the person who eats healthy in relation to duty? Who do they have a duty to, is it to themselves, to their family, to their children, to future generations? For example, epigenetic research shows that if a dad eats unhealthily, they can then create epigenetic changes which they can pass on to their children. If a grandmother eats unhealthily, she can pass on epigenetic changes to her grandchild. So, is it for future generations?

The card is giving an opportunity to open up exploring these kinds of conversations and seeing where the conversation leads, but always keeping the conversation focused on being helpful and moving the client forward and following the lead of the individual who you are working with.

And finally, you would have the fifth card, and say the fifth card is The Disciple, that is another Deep-Game card so you can explore that with the client. Again, sticking to this healthy eating client example, you may explore that Disciple card with them around areas like, 'are they a Disciple? Who are they a Disciple to in relation to this goal of eating healthy and that lifestyle change that they want to have? How would they interpret that Disciple card for themselves in relation to their goal?'

Here, obviously I'm giving my interpretations, my representations of how something could go, but without a real client present, it could go any number of ways because I don't know what a client would say in relation to their interpretation of the individual cards, and that's the beauty of this, that it mirrors real therapy in terms of you never know what someone will say and no two clients are alike.

If you're doing good therapy, you are always client led. You are not dictating *to* clients; you are being led *by* clients. And this just allows a way of facilitating that process of being led by a client without throwing your stuff in there and controlling them and directing them in a very rigid way based on a fixed therapy or coaching approach.

For example, in normal therapy, you would often have some kind of a structure and theories of how you do your therapy. When you do something like this, you can take away some of that structure while keeping a loose structure and work broader than a rigid therapeutic approach. So, you've got a bit of structure here in terms of, 'I'm just going to go through these cards and ask you questions, but I don't know which cards and which questions I'm going to ask you until we draw them and we work through them and we explore what they mean to you, and we explore how that resonates and how that can teach you something about yourself and move you forward and what you can gain from it'.

And it's something that the client can then go away and do for themselves multiple times. Just dealing out another five cards and then going through them themselves.

So, you explore the cards, however they're dealt. If the conversation does freeze up, because maybe they're stuck at a certain point, maybe some cards dealt don't resonate or stimulate thinking for that specific client. You can just gather the cards up and use different cards and then see what comes out from that arrangement of cards, or just turn a new card over onto the card which you are stuck at.

There are two ways which I do this therapeutically with people where I will have the cards dealt out either five cards like this, or three cards with the two modifiers, and I also have the jokers mixed in as well as I will cover next.

I nearly always end with some kind of an eyes closed process and as part of this eyes closed process having the client recap in their mind what we have discussed and experiencing the future they hope to achieve, and their role in that future.

Five Card Coaching with Modifiers

The idea of using the cards is to be able to help people to explore what it is that they want, to help the client and coach or therapist break free of rigid thinking, to encourage creativity and to develop new perspectives, ideas, and perhaps even additional questions.

When using the FourGames cards for Five Card Coaching with Modifiers I will randomly deal two of the modifier cards and three of the regular cards so that you have five cards that you are working with. Similar to what you do with the regular Five Card Coaching is that you deal those cards out with a regular card, then a modifier, then the next regular card, then the second modifier and then the third regular card. You will then have a conversation with the client about these five cards.

So, you would have the first conversation about card one. Say card one is the Vulnerability card and someone has come to you because they would like to achieve success with a project they are doing. What you might do is talk about vulnerabilities the person has. Vulnerability is an orange card, so it is a Short-Game card. So, you may talk about what the vulnerabilities are that they have that are perhaps preventing them from making the necessary changes, taking certain steps, things that they feel could be areas where they just think, 'I don't know if I'd be able to do this, I don't know if I'd be able to do that'. Areas where they feel vulnerable, whatever vulnerability means to them. That's the important thing here in how I use the cards, that it's about what it means to the client, not what it means to you as the therapist or the coach.

They could talk about their vulnerabilities, like maybe they failed at a few projects before, maybe it's something to do with work and their boss has previously been very negative towards them when they've tried to do projects within work and told them, 'You are not very good at this', or whatever it happens to be. So, they're nervous perhaps about going through with doing this project.

The second conversation you would then have with the client connects the first card with the second card, the first modifier. So, say the modifier card is the Handy Quote card, you could explore what could be a handy quote, something that the client could write down, maybe something they could say to themselves that's in relation to that vulnerability that would help them to be able to address that. What would they need to hear? What would be something that would be really nice for

someone to say to them or for them to say to themselves that would help them to think, 'you know what, my vulnerabilities, despite the struggles, despite whatever's going on internally, despite all that, you know what, I can do this'. What would be that kind of motivating quote, saying or statement for that client?

And then you work with the client to come up with that motivating quote that they can use to support themselves and to encourage themselves, and maybe if it's written down and if you're doing this as self-help, you could do it for yourself and have it written down, maybe even on a business card sized card that you can keep on you in your purse or your wallet that you can then look at when you need to see it, depending on what it is you're working on. So, you would have them give you that.

Then you can move on to card number three, which for example could be the Compassion card. With this card you could explore that compassion with them. You could explore compassion in relation to the vulnerability, how can compassion play into that? So, you can link it back to something helpful that the card can teach in relation to the previous card. Looking at how it can connect back to that previous card?

You are always trying to look for things that are helpful. Because the previous card was vulnerability I would probably focus on how compassion can teach something that can help the client to think about that vulnerability in a different way, maybe in a way that turns the vulnerability into a strength.

If the vulnerability was actually a different card, like The Magician card, then it could be exploring compassion in relation to a magician mindset. A magician mindset could be that someone is able to almost create something from nothing, is able to work their magic, is able to have certain elements where it's like they are very, very good at creating something out of nothing with what they have, and how can compassion support and enhance or educate around this?

Your fourth question is based on the fourth card which is the second modifier card. So, say the modifier card this time is the

‘aha’ card. You would work from what the card means to the client you're working with or to yourself if you're doing self-help. So, say the client interprets the aha card as a kind of insightful, ‘that's interesting; kind of card, then you would look at how you can link that, aha thought to compassion, to what we've just been talking about around compassion. So, you're applying this compassion to the vulnerability. You're helping the client to look at the challenges that they have been facing, to look at the changes they need to make to be able to work towards and achieve their success. What insights they can gain, what kind of aha moment they can gain from those insights. So, you would then have a conversation around that idea. Every card is really great as a conversation starter.

And then you have the fifth card. So, if that was The Magician. The Magician is a green card. It is a Mid-Game card. With this card you perhaps are exploring what gadgets the client is using, what things they have got in their environment which they could perhaps use to help towards what it is they are trying to achieve, what things they could put together or repurpose or use in a different way, how can they think outside the box, maybe to turn something from the environment into something different or helpful or to take a different angle on things with their environment. So, it could be objects, it could be other things to do with the environment, but exploring what they can use.

And you can go through this as many times as you want, or swap cards for new cards if a card doesn’t resonate or help the conversation. You could then get another set of five cards and continue the session building on what you are doing with this next set. So, you're stimulating thinking through, using almost randomly generated questions, but they're not randomly generated, they are using what is going on in the relationship between the client, or you, and yourself, if you're doing this for self-help, and the cards that are in front of you, and then you are following almost like a cycle between all of those to follow the lead of where it all goes.

Therapeutic Storytelling with The FourGames Card Deck

An area I do a lot of work in nowadays is therapeutic storytelling. Using the FourGames Card Deck is a great way to help stimulate thinking and metaphor creation for therapeutic storytelling.

Again, I will work with five cards. This is just a preference of mine. You could use more or fewer depending on what works for you. Say for example I was planning on making a 60-minute therapeutic story, I would likely deal out perhaps 8-10 cards to give more variety to stimulate thinking across the story, whereas if I am thinking of developing a therapeutic story during a therapy or coaching session, then the section of the session where I would present the story is likely to only be perhaps 10-15 minutes long, and it would be rare in most contexts to need to create a story longer than 30 minutes.

Say the randomly selected words were 'Decay, Invention, Curiosity, The Trickster, and Ignorance', I would be thinking how can I use these for storytelling?

I would look through the words and then work through those words using them as prompts to stimulate my thinking as I then create a therapeutic story. This is a great way of being really creative, I think, about how I can use these words and concepts and turn them into metaphors? So, I would think about a decay metaphor, an invention metaphor, a curiosity metaphor, a trickster metaphor and an ignorance metaphor. Then I would ask the client to take a moment to close their eyes and would begin to ad-lib the story, weaving the metaphors together, saying something like "take a moment to allow your eyes to close as I now create a story using these five cards, and it'll be a therapeutic story to help you, so just follow along in your mind's eye as you hear me talking to you, and sometimes you may drift off, you may find your mind wandering and maybe almost losing track of the sound of my voice or the words I am using, and while you listen to me, I'm just going to tell you a story about..."

And then I tell the story which could be about a man, woman, child, 'you', a cat, a dog, etc., whatever it happens to be that

seems to resonate best with the client and their problem and the information they have shared. So it could be, “I'm just going to tell a story about a man who's walking through the woods” and while you're telling the story, you want to mix in sensory language to absorb the person in the experience that you are guiding them through, so “and as this man is walking through the woods they notice the strangest thing, they notice that there's a lot of fungus around and a lot of fallen down trees and heavily decayed trees, and yet something about these heavily decayed trees and the space that they're clearing, brings a sense of peace and calm as if somehow this decay is allowing space for the sunlight to shine through down onto the ground below. And you notice in certain areas, there's already a few buds of different plants, even the first signs of trees starting to stretch their way up towards the sky overhead, towards that sunlight that's managing to penetrate down into those spaces. And as this man walks through this woodland absorbed in looking at these spaces where trees have fallen, where plants are decaying, where the fungus is devouring those plants, they start to develop this idea, an idea of a potential invention, but they don't yet know and haven't yet formulated fully what that idea would be. But as they carry on walking through this woodland, the sound of each footstep on the ground, they head deeper and deeper and start to move away from that decay. And while they move away from the decay, they notice a perfect looking toadstool near the path that they're following. And they reach down and pick that toadstool and with that toadstool, they look at the top, they look at its underside, they run their fingers around that and notice the smoothness of the toadstool realising that this toadstool could be at the heart of their invention, and they find a way of carrying that toadstool with them as they continue to walk and they develop a certain level of curiosity continuing through this woodland. And while walking through the woodland with that curiosity, hearing the sounds of birds singing in the background, their mind is still pondering that invention that they know is somewhere inside them to develop, and they can see the way that the woodland is now starting to

get more dense as they move away from that decaying area, noticing the shards of light just breaking down through the canopy, almost like swords, jabbing through the leaves overhead, dancing on the path in front of them, and they carry on walking along this path into this denser woodland, and while walking through this denser woodland, they start to hear the sound of running water. They notice they're getting closer and closer to this running water, and as they get closer to the running water, they can see through the trees that there's a bit of a clearing, there's a bit more light down there, and they can notice what looks like a bridge. And as they approach that bridge, they see a man sitting on the bridge and the man on the bridge poses a riddle. And as they pose this riddle, the man tells them that the mushroom is only four feet high, it's not two inches. And they continue to look confused, their eyes glaze over and while their eyes glaze over, the man begins to walk across the bridge. And as they approach the other side of the bridge, they look back and realise that in their ignorance, they had become the trickster, they had tricked, and they placed that toadstool down the other side of this bridge, and they realise that this toadstool starts to plant its roots, starts to dig its way down into the ground, as if it was just waiting to be planted in the right place. And it grows and it grows larger and larger until eventually it's so large, it's almost the size of a house. And the man walks around the toadstool and notices there's an entrance, like a doorway into it. They open that door, they walk into the toadstool, descend the steps inside the toadstool, and as they descend the steps, they notice streams of pulsing coloured light around them. They realise that this is the mycelium network and it is connected with all things here in this woodland passing messages around the woodland between all the life, all the trees. the plants in this woodland and at the foot of the stairs, as they walk out through a door, they find themselves in a room, and in that room they see a sheet of fungus on one wall that seems to be absorbing the liquid that's running down that wall, perhaps some of the water flowing through the ground from the river, and they make a protective item of clothing out of the fungus

here under the ground that weaves the mycelium network around the outside, so they have pulsing light travelling up their arms, around their body, around the outside of the clothing they've created, and then when they just touch the wall, the mycelium network here under the ground connects with the mycelium network suit they've created, and they notice a charge of information and knowledge flood in that can help them on their journey and it teaches them something insightful. And after gaining this insight, they head back out of this mushroom and they continue their journey a little further, until eventually they arrive at their destination, and here at their destination, they settle down and relax, and they allow themselves to just think a little bit more about what this could all mean to you, and after thinking about that, only when the time is right and all the inner work is completed, do they then drift out of this state, knowing they can carry some knowledge with them from this, and also knowing they can work on this in everyday life and they drift out of this state as you drift back comfortably in your own time, in your own way, over the next minute or so, taking as long as you want to drift back to the here and now, fully and completely, but only when you know that inner change work is taking place, to achieving what it is you want to achieve."

You can use each card to creatively encourage and facilitate the development of metaphors that will be therapeutic and useful with the person that you're working with. For example, you can use the Short-Game cards to create more Short-Game metaphors, Mid-Game cards, perhaps to create more Mid-Game metaphors, Long-Game cards to create more Long-Game metaphors and Deep-Game cards to create more Deep-Game metaphors and just weave them creatively together, remembering that silence is incredibly powerful. So, while you are thinking and processing what you'll do with each card, you can just be silent in your mind for a little while and allow the person you are working with to just drift a little bit more internally.

Using The FourGames Card Deck in Workshops and Meetings

The FourGames cards can be a useful tool to use in a wide variety of contexts. For example, it could be that you are a coach who holds group courses or workshops and you are looking for a creative and novel idea to use within your training. You may have a number of decks of FourGames cards and you ask the students to pair up, you give each pair a deck of cards, have one person take on the questioning role for perhaps 20 minutes and then change this over after 20 minutes, before coming back to the room to discuss for 20 minutes.

The person taking on the role of questioner can shuffle the deck and lay down five cards and use these five cards as the basis for creatively asking questions of the other person about whatever the exercise is and writing down the responses from their partner, before then swapping roles and doing the same again and at the end the whole group can share what responses came out for them.

It could be that you are a manager, again you have a number of decks of FourGames cards and so in a meeting about a project where you are going to want ideas from people and you want to stimulate creative thinking outside of the box, you hand out the FourGames decks, pair everyone up and do similar to the group coaching or training example, you have them come up with responses to the cards, similar to how I mentioned when sharing about the five cards method, and have them write down whatever ideas they think of associated with that card and that realm.

So, if a Long-Game card was chosen perhaps the person is stimulated to think about how the project has Long-Game relevance in relation to the card, if it was a Mid-Game card perhaps they share about how the project could fill the role of a helpful gadget, or it could be that they think of how there is a specific block in relation to the Mid-Game which impacts on the projects potential success.

The idea is to think 'how could I use these FourGames cards? What situations would they be a useful gadget that could

encourage flexible thinking and creativity, or would encourage novelty?'

So, what we've covered here during this chapter is how I like to use the FourGames card deck when I'm working therapeutically with people or doing coaching with people, or when I'm teaching people about using the FourGames card deck for self-help and also how I use the FourGames card deck and others can use the FourGames card deck for therapeutic storytelling and in workshops and meetings. I've taught two different ways that I use the deck for therapeutic and coaching work or self-help work using a five-card process of three deck cards and two modifiers, and a five-card process where I use just five cards from the deck. So now it's time for you to see how you can apply this and practise this.

A brilliant way of practising is to just keep shuffling the deck, turning out five cards, and imagining a scenario that someone could want help with, and then going through those five cards with that scenario and doing the same when you're doing it with modifiers. Just turning out three cards, two modifiers, and working with that. And the same with metaphors. Just turn over five cards and then tell stories based around those five cards and just practise doing that over and over again. You can do that on your own or find someone to practise with.

TEMPORAL REPROCESSING TECHNIQUES

Introduction

In this chapter I'll be sharing about temporal reprocessing. Temporal reprocessing is about doing change work by manipulating the perception of events in time. In this chapter you will learn a range of different temporal reprocessing techniques, and as you become familiar with these techniques, you can get used to combining them and perhaps mixing and matching techniques based on clients and their needs, for example, you may uncover a hidden root cause of a client's problem and discover that there are many memories that are supporting the problem, so you decide to smash those memories to pieces, to clear them. This will make sense as we go through the various techniques, so hopefully you find these helpful. They are really just more advanced ways of doing some change work to build on what you've learned in previous chapters.

Temporal Exploration

One thing that can happen with problems, especially stubborn problems which don't seem to resolve from therapy is that they are programmed into your brain for your survival and the cause often gets overlooked. This is usually the case when the

presenting problem results in anger or another 'towards' emotion.

Often what you find is that there was a situation where you experienced two emotions, one expressed at the time, the 'away from' emotion, and one suppressed, the 'towards' emotion. So usually the away from emotion, like anxiety or fear is remembered when you think about that memory, but the towards emotion, like anger is forgotten. For example, it could be that you were bullied as a child and felt scared, and you remember the memories and how you felt scared, but when you focus on the memories in detail you notice that you were also angry, but because you were scared you didn't express this anger.

Following these memories, it is common that the unexpressed emotion becomes a driver for protecting you in the future from experiencing the expressed emotion. So, anything which pattern-matches to the experience of being bullied for example, can trigger anger as a way of protecting yourself from the anxiety. So it could be that someone touches you in a specific way, or uses a specific tone of voice, or wears specific colours, etc, which could trigger anger.

This technique also works well for stubborn problems where the person perhaps doesn't know how the problem developed, but knowing this might give insight or something to work on. For example, I worked with a client who wanted to overcome a fear of flying. They had flown on planes many times before perfectly comfortably, frequently flying between the UK and Australia, but now they were weeks from having to fly back to Australia and they suddenly discovered that they are terrified by the thought of flying. Thinking about flying put them in a panic. The problem was that they didn't know why they were suddenly scared of flying and the approach I would normally use to quickly treat something like a fear of flying involves addressing the pattern of the problem, usually by having the client work on the first or worst memories of having the phobia, yet this client had no memories of flying with fear, they just knew that they were now scared of flying, so there was nothing for me to work

with.
At this point I used this technique to uncover how the problem developed. I discovered that many months earlier they had gotten on a train between the UK and France and as the doors shut, they sounded like airlock doors and the client thought at that time 'these doors are like the doors on aeroplanes. They were nervous boarding the train, and even more nervous on the train. Their main fear was that they were trapped on the train while it travelled under the sea between England and France.
This is the experience which had caused the fear of flying, but until they next thought about flying, they didn't know they had now developed a fear of flying. Thinking about being on an aeroplane and the plane doors closing, while being scared on the train with the train doors closing and making that connection between the two had caused the fear of flying. Now that I knew this, it was quick and easy to help this client, we just detraumatised the train memories using a technique called the rewind technique (Human Givens Institute, n.d.) and a few weeks later they flew to Australia and let me know they had no anxiety at any point and months later they reported the same again after making the journey back to the UK and since then they have made further trips without issue.

How to do Temporal Exploration:

- Focus on the emotion the client experiences when they think about the problem in the present (closing their eyes may help with their focus)
- Have them imagine a tunnel in front of themselves, like a wormhole, which has a connection, following that emotion back into the past, all the way back to the first connected memory to it
- Have them enter that wormhole and follow it all the way back until they find themselves exiting in the first connected memory
- Allow that memory to play out from before the event started, through to after it concluded.

Observe closely to see if there was a second hidden emotion in that memory that matches the emotion they experience in the present

- Often just uncovering this emotion helps to reprocess the memory in full stopping that hidden emotion from driving future responses, but it can be helpful to have them just tell themselves what would be helpful for them to hear back then, perhaps about coping, about how the situation doesn't last, but changes, or whatever other helpful comments they feel could be made. This can be done with the coach, through questioning about the situation now they know what they need to work on
- After working on the past memory/memories, then travel back through that wormhole to the present, have them imagine themselves sat in a comfortable chair with a large screen in front of them, watch potential future situations where the problem response would have been expected to happen and see how things play out differently now.

Temporal Mapping

Something which can be helpful is to have clients map out the future in a way that encourages them to automatically follow that path. This is like active post-hypnotic suggestion, rather than actually using suggestions. The way it works is by having the mind identify triggers in the future which, when they occur, encourage the client to automatically respond in the planned way in those situations.

Clients can do this technique by sitting somewhere comfortably, closing their eyes and going through the technique in their mind, or they can make the technique more effective, by physically acting this technique out. This technique can be done alone, or perhaps following along to a recording of the process, or used by coaches and therapists with their clients in sessions.

The process of Temporal Mapping is:

- Have the client imagine a temporal path laid out before themselves. Where they stand now is their present and off in the distance is their future.
- Have them think of that thing they would like to achieve or how they would like to be, imagine seeing that them who has achieved that off in the distance along their temporal path at the point on that path into the future where that them is comfortably living with that as something they have achieved in their past.
- From this perspective, before they head over and into that them, what do they notice about that them that lets them know that they have achieved that?
- Now head along the temporal path to that them in the future and step into that them. Notice what it feels like to be this version of themselves, what the world looks like through this them's eyes, what internal dialogue or thinking this version of them has and how they have that internal dialogue or thinking. What does this version of them believe about things relating to what they have achieved, what has driven them and kept them on track, why did that them want to achieve this, what have they gained because of this achievement/what was the purpose of the achievement, how does this achievement fit with how they plan on continuing their journey, what are their hopes and dreams and aspirations beyond this point.
- From the perspective of this version of themselves, look back towards the past, what are some of the steps they had to make to get from that them off there back in the past, to this them here now?
- See those steps form between that them in the past and this them now, with each step represented by a version of themselves who had just passed each

milestone.

- Now have them step into those versions of themselves between this them now and the them in the past and as they step into each one, they can take some time to notice what that them achieved, think about how they achieved that, what they are like as a person at that stage, what thinking, feeling and behaviours they have, what their environment is like, what help and support they have, what opportunities, how they notice and take advantage of relevant opportunities, what is driving them and keeping them motivated.
- Do this with the key steps that they took to get to where they have achieved that as they journey back along the temporal path to the them at the here and now.
- Once back at the them in the here and now, they can look forward at all of the them's into the future at the various stages of achieving what each version of themselves needs to achieve and notice a golden thread weaving all versions of themselves together and connecting them all, like a lifeline that tethers them together.
- Now they can follow this golden thread slowly through each of those versions of themselves from the present to the future, integrating each version of themselves as they go.
- At the final version of themselves, they can step outside of their temporal path and look at that path of them's and think about a few words or ideas which summarise how they think and feel about what that them has achieved, the journey they take and the meaning this has to them.
- With this knowledge, they can head back into the version of themself in the here and now where, if they are doing this in their mind, they can open their eyes.

Temporal Restructuring

This technique is useful for people that have created negative beliefs, opinions or behaviours which are preventing them from achieving those things that they want to achieve. It is especially useful with people that, over time, have created beliefs that prevent motivation or cause a lack of self-confidence, or events that have led to low self-esteem or prevent them from doing or achieving something. The technique works by metaphorically shattering these limiting beliefs, opinions or behaviours. When you do this technique, it isn't necessary to know the specific events that formed those beliefs just to create a fixed location for those events.

The stages of temporal restructuring are:

- Ask the client to close their eyes and create a positive image of what they want to be like after the limiting beliefs, opinions or behaviours are destroyed that have prevented them from already achieving those things (it could be an image of them confidently talking in a social situation, etc.)
- Tell them to imagine this on their temporal path (a mental path created in the mind with all past events behind them and all future events in front of them) just in front of them at a future point.
- Tell them to drift up above their temporal path floating gently up so that they can see their whole path and see the past.
- Then see a number of brittle slides, appearing along the path representing every event where a limiting belief, opinion or behaviour was created that had prevented achieving the desired goal.
- Ask them to nod their head to let you know they have completed each section. Then ask them to float back to just before the first brittle slide so that they are hovering just above it at an angle looking down on it diagonally down in front of them.

- Tell them to begin to create a spinning feeling in their body that is a powerful feeling of success and motivation, or whatever other strong feeling they feel would be the helpful alternative feeling for those situations, and to give this a strong colour.
- Tell them to spin this faster and faster. To really charge up that strength and to charge up power to generate rapid speed like a car wheel-spinning before shooting off or like a bullet about to be fired.
- Tell them that when you say 'now' you want them to shoot down into the first slide and then fire along the temporal path exploding each slide as they pass through them. Shattering each slide into billions of little pieces that fly off in all directions as if the temporal path is in space where those tiny pieces will continue to travel away from the path indefinitely. And that as this happens you want their unconscious to fill in each newly made space with a positive beneficial belief and to fill the temporal path with that strong colour that can follow them down the path.
- Tell them that when they reach the present time on their path they can stop and experience that colour power past them and out into the future. Tell them that perhaps they could hear it rush past like a strong coloured wind.
- Then once the path is full of that powerful colour, have the client go to the future to imagine the improvements and situations in a desired way and to view what they look like in those situations as if floating above the situations, then to lower into the situations and experience them, seeing what they will see and hearing what they will hear. Have them enjoy experiencing many different future situations before drifting back from the experience.

Temporal Life Reprocessing

This process is a process for creating bulk changes within the temporal path. It is best suited for those who have a lot of problems, perhaps ingrained behaviours and beliefs and many negative life experiences which have shaped who they have become and to try to address everything individually would be difficult to do and it may be very unlikely that you would be able to uncover everything you would need to address.

The stages for temporal life reprocessing are:

- Have the client float and drift up out of their body so that they are looking down on that memory they were currently developing.
- And as they look over from that position, they can notice that all of their memories are lined-up before them stretching way back into the past.
- They can begin to float back over all of those memories right back to the beginning.
- When they reach the beginning, they can begin to work through every single memory of their life.
- As they enter each memory, they can save all the learning from that memory whilst healing any memories that need resolution.
- They don't have to know how to do this, just have a sense of this happening and leave responsibility for how to do this to the deeper part of themselves.
- They work through each memory and can begin to fill each memory with a healing light.
- As they enter each problem memory they can notice that some memories have a pleasure or anger aspect that builds up in the memory before being cut short with another emotion that is anxiety based like embarrassment or fear or helplessness that they want to get away from, and other problem memories will have anger or pleasure that was a problem, and other memories will be anxiety

based, and they can find that they have all the skills, knowledge, and resources to resolve any issues and heal every memory.

- They can take plenty of time to make each memory a present and work through all those presents until they arrive back at this present here and now.
- Once they have done this process and arrived back at the here and now then they can take some time to imagine future situations which aspects of their past would have negatively impacted on and watch how those future situations go differently, what they see and hear, how they know those situations are going in a more desired way, what others are noticing, what is different about the situations because things are going in this more desired way.
- Then drift into those future situations and experience them going in this more desired way, noticing what they see, hear, feel, what inner dialogue and thinking they have, so that they experience what it is like to live with these changes.
- Following this the client can reorient to the here and now in their own way and in their own time.

Temporal Detraumatisation

This temporal detraumatisation process is a based on the rewind technique (Muss, 2002) but works for tackling multiple traumatic events with a single process. The problem at times with the rewind technique is that you normally use it on the first or worst scenario, but if you are working with someone who has experienced significant traumatic experiences, like prolonged abuse, then they may not know the first as it may be something they think of as always being present, and they may not have a worst time they can think of because many of the worst times were as traumatic as each other or many blend together into just one big traumatic experience over an extended period of time.

With situations like this it isn't so likely that just trying to pick a

memory to work on is going to tackle the whole problem and so ordinarily you may well end up doing many sessions of the rewind technique to detraumatise a few significant memories in each session. This can have the person focusing on these traumatic memories longer than they perhaps need to, so I have found doing a technique where you address many or all of the memories at once seems more effective for me.

The stages of the temporal detraumatisation process are:

- Have the client imagine that they are on a temporal path with all of their past memories stretched out behind them and potential future memories stretched out in front of them. With each memory being like a 3D movie taking place in a box.
- Have them drift up above this path and have them notice all memories not related to the trauma or problem fade from the path leaving just the memories to be worked on.
- Have them have a sense that each of these memories is like a discreet movie, playing from before the events relating to the trauma or problem, through to after the events have completely passed, and each of those discreet movies is playing from start to finish and then playing from finish to start.
- Then have the client begin to speed up the movies and to notice that as the movies speed up, so they seem to compress together more and each movie becomes more of a blur as they move so fast. Perhaps the client can notice a whirring increasing as the movies speed up (the therapist or coach can mimic the sound of the whirring to deepen engagement in the process).
- Then have the client float down to some distance from the last movie and just taking a second or so, they pass through the movies from the last one to

the first one, passing through the first movie and rising up above the temporal path again.

- They can then increase the speed further still, making those movies play even faster, so that each movie becomes even more of a blur and the movies compress together even closer, perhaps being just a small fraction of the length those movies used to take up, as they continue to flash from beginning to end and then end to beginning.
- Then the client can go back to that position beyond the end of the last movie and taking a fraction of a second, they can pass through those old movies from the last one to the first one and then rising up above the temporal path again.
- Then one last time they really crank up the speed of those memories, so much that the memories compress to just a slither of a line with each memory playing so fast it is barely a flash of light.
- Then again, for the final time, they can go to that position beyond the last movie and travel in a flash back through those movies before rising up above the temporal path.
- From above the temporal path, they can then increase the speed of those movies so fast that they explode and disintegrate into dust, leaving a sense of peace, quiet and calm, and as the dust disperses, they can notice the temporal path forming again like new, with new versions of those old movies.
- They can watch some of those new versions of the old movies while feeling calm and relaxed.
- They can then look to the future and see movies which in the past would have distressed them and watch them while feeling calm and relaxed, before drifting back down into the them in the present and looking to the future and seeing themselves in future situations responding in a desired way.
- Then travelling into those future versions of

themselves to experience responding in a preferred way.

- Then in their own time, they can drift back to the present and open their eyes.

The Temporal Healer

This technique is about having the client meet the healing self or the therapist or coach at various points through life. This approach is for clients who perhaps have a lot of challenges which have occurred throughout life which need to be addressed. The idea is that they get to meet a healer every few years from a young age, having that healer say and do what was needed at that point in life to help them overcome or cope with what had been going on in life for them over the preceding few years and doing this all the way up to present day. This can be a very powerful and effective technique.

I worked with someone many years ago where someone's husband asked if I would help their wife. Their wife had tried working with many therapists and none had been able to help at this point. This wife was nervous about hypnosis and worried that I would hypnotise her and make her do things against her will, so I said I would record a track for her if she is happy to listen to that, then I am not present to manipulate her and if there is anything on the track she is uncomfortable with she can just stop listening and turn it off.

She agreed to listen to the track. I didn't really have any information to go on, so I thought perhaps the best option would be to do this technique to have a healer visit her every few years of her life and help her with whatever had been challenging over the preceding few years.

It took her a couple of weeks before she listened to the track and after she listened to it, she contacted me saying she was willing to work with me and saying that as soon as she opened her eyes, she no longer felt depressed and wasn't in the same place in her mind. She felt hopeful and optimistic about the future and her family and time with her family.

A few years later she told me that what I didn't know about the

day she listened to the track, she had said she would listen to the track, so her husband had said that he would take their child out to give her the chance to listen to it uninterrupted. She had planned on ending it while they were out, but decided that she had said she would listen to the track, it won't make any difference, but at least if she listens to it, she will know she tried everything.
She said, but on listening to the track, she opened her eyes and no longer wanted to end it and had a totally different outlook on life.

The process for this technique is:

- Have the client close their eyes and get comfortable, you can do some relaxation with them at this point.
- Then tell them that you would like them to find themselves on their temporal path, with the past stretched out behind and the future stretched out in front of them.
- Have them rise up above their path and float back in time all the way back to very early childhood to the first time they would have found it helpful to have someone to talk to who could help them with things going on at the time.
- Lower down into that point in time and talk with that them back then in that moment in an age-appropriate way and share with them the support which they will find most helpful and reassure them that everything will be okay and that they will see you again.
- After they know they have been helpful to that younger self, tell them that you will be guiding them through meeting themselves every few years across the years and when they have done this up to present day, they can let you know they have now reached present day again.

- Then ask them to flow through the temporal path until they arrive perhaps a few years later at another time when they could do with support, and again, then take a moment to give the support they needed, to say and do what will be helpful in that moment and reassuring them that they have the strength to cope with things and that they will see you again in the future.
- Repeat this process for every few years of the client's life until they let you know that they have reached the present day. Have them move forward a few years until they next need the support, be there for them, giving them that support, reassuring them and letting them know they have the strength to cope and that they will meet you again.
- Once they reach the present day have them have a sense of being relaxed in the here and now, in the present, before just taking all the time they need over the next few minutes to drift forwards in time to explore a future going how they would like it to go, with them responding in life how they would like to respond.
- After they have completed this, they can take a few more moments to relax, and you can say that they can then drift back to the present and open their eyes when all the change work is complete.

IMPLANTING THOUGHTS & INFLUENCING OTHERS WITH YOUR BREATHING

What I'm going to teach in this chapter will likely offer a whole new way of understanding communication to most readers. Something that will influence your success is whether you believe or not. As someone autistic I became obsessed with studying communication when, as a teenager I came across the work of the incredible psychiatrist Milton Erickson (1901-1980). Among other challenges Milton Erickson had, he was tone deaf. In a paper he wrote during the 1960's (Erickson, 1980) he described how when people were watching a singer sing the crowd of people listening started breathing the same as the singer.

Erickson enquired about this but was constantly told that this is rubbish, people don't do that. But the more Erickson observed the more he noticed this happening. As no-one took Erickson seriously, he decided to start experimenting for himself. He learned breathing patterns of popular songs; he would sit down quietly beside different classmates in school pretending to be absorbed in reading a book and he would do the breathing pattern of a song. As he got good at this, he noticed that people would start humming, whistling or singing the song he was breathing. He tested breathing and quietly humming the song.

He found that both of these elicited the same outcome but the difference was that when he breathed the song the person who started singing assumed they had started the singing, when he hummed, they attributed their singing to him humming the tune.

Erickson continued practising and refining this skill. He learned the breathing pattern of yawning and practised triggering the breathing pattern of a yawn within himself to make others yawn. Erickson thought about how everybody breathes, but nobody pays attention to their breathing or the breathing of others unless they are ill. Erickson observed that breathing was connected with vocalisation of any sort and that people didn't seem to recognise this. One vocalisation Erickson learned in school was that of a classmate who stuttered. He practised using this stuttering breathing pattern when classmates were reciting and he found that it made the classmates hesitant and uncertain in their reciting. This frightened him and convinced him that people communicate on a 'breathing' level of awareness unknown to them.

Pacing and Leading

An important process you need to learn for influencing others is that of pacing and leading. You also need to know the goal; you need to know what you are leading towards.

Pacing is connecting with where someone is here and now. So, to influence with your breathing you would start by breathing the same as the person you are going to influence. Once rapport is formed that person will start following your lead. Rapport is something that develops naturally when people like each other, including synchronising breathing. You can observe this when you go 'people watching' in cafés and public places, you can notice how people meet and are out of sync with each other and if they get on, they start to fall into sync. They will stand or sit in similar positions; they will move in similar ways and their behaviour will look choreographed. This rapport helps people to deepen their understanding of each other.

When it comes to influencing breathing, you can match the

breathing of the other person in a number of different ways depending on what the goal is. For example, you can cross match, which is where you match one thing with something different. So, for example, if you want to be similar to someone but not come across like you are just copying them, if they cross their legs, you may cross your arms, if they are tapping or jiggling a foot, you may tap or jiggle a finger. With breathing, you may match someone's breathing with your head movement, so you may move your head up as they breathe in and down as they breathe out. Erickson described himself doing this very thing to an English lecturer who didn't like their job. He sat at the front of the class so that he could easily be seen, he then started to nod in agreement with the lecturer in time with the lecturer's breathing. He knew that the lecturer would see the nodding as a student agreeing with him, which increases the connection. Once rapport was developed, he would speed up or slow down his head movements which would cause involuntary changes in the breathing pattern of the lecturer causing speech difficulties and these speech difficulties would then become stimuli themselves for further speech difficulties.

You can directly match, which is the most effective way if you are going to do something subtler than just alter the speed of the other person's breathing. By matching the breathing, you can build rapport and then just like Erickson with the singing, you can breathe what you want the person to think.

A note of caution. If you try to use these techniques taught here for negative reasons where you are trying to influence others to do things against their core beliefs and values that negativity will come back at you. Often people will suddenly become irritated with you or angry, or they will suddenly have a feeling that they don't like you. They won't do what you are trying to manipulate them to do. They won't necessarily know why they suddenly feel negative, angry or uncomfortable towards you, they just will.

Noticing Breathing Patterns

A question I'm often asked is how do you notice breathing

patterns? If you are going to be matching breathing or learning a breathing pattern you need to be able to notice it. As mentioned earlier all vocalisation involves breathing, so anytime sound is coming out of someone's mouth they are breathing. So, this is easy to match. If you are in conversation with someone, while you are listening to them you can breathe the pattern they are breathing based on the words they are saying. The challenge is when you are newer to this you still need to be following along to the conversation so that you can respond. If they are talking to someone else or talking on a telephone then you don't have to worry about following what they are saying, as you won't have to respond. Something interesting is that if someone is talking to themselves in their mind, they will have the breathing pattern as if they are talking out loud.

To match the breathing of someone not talking you need to find signs of their breathing pattern. You can notice things like their shoulders rising and lowering, their chest moving in and out, their stomach moving, their head moving in time with the breathing.

How Do You Implant Thoughts?

Thoughts need to be implanted in a very specific way. When implanting thoughts with breathing you need to think about what you specifically want the person to say to themselves in their own mind. So, it wouldn't be natural to say "make me a cup of tea" what they would be saying is something like "would you like a cup of tea?"

So, what you are doing is essentially implanting inner dialog that you want them to say or think.

So, the process of implanting thoughts is to breathe the same as the person you want to influence. If there is a significant difference between how the person you hope to influence breathes and how you breathe then you can be flexible, but you want to connect with their pattern of breathing. So, if they are a fast breather, you may do one breath for every two of their breaths. If they are a slow breather, you may do two breaths for every one of their breaths.

Once you have paced the breathing you can test whether you are able to lead them by making a small change, like perhaps doing one slightly longer breath. Once you do a test and the person follows the lead then you move into doing the influence you want. This should be simple. So, you can focus on just implanting a single sentence or idea. You then do the breathing pattern for that sentence over and over again until they pick up on the message and it starts going around and around in their mind and they think it is just a spontaneous thought that has developed within them from their non-conscious.

To know how to do different breathing patterns you can watch people's breathing while they are talking, and in other situations. So, there is a breathing pattern for calmness, a breathing pattern for anger, for anxiety, and many other states.

In my FourGames eCourse you can see me demonstrating matching the breathing of someone, and then changing my breathing pattern to guide them into hypnosis without saying a word to them.

With dedicated practice you can master this skill. With intense practice and experience, Milton Erickson was able to implant thoughts and ideas directly into the minds of others. He was also able to match the breathing patterns of others and to read their throat and lip movements while they were talking to themselves so that he was effectively mind reading what they were thinking.

COMMUNICATING HIDDEN MESSAGES

In this chapter I'm going to share a powerful way to plant ideas into the minds of others covertly which can help with coaching or therapy, similar to implanting thoughts and ideas using breathing, this helps to encourage clients to have a sense that change is coming from within themselves, rather than because someone else has told them what to do or think.

The brain is essentially a pattern matching machine, the brain is always on the lookout for patterns. This happens outside of your conscious awareness. So, if for example someone has a fear of snakes, the brain will be looking for anything which resembles a snake.

If it sees something, the instinctive response the person gives will be a survival response. So, if you are walking along a country path and there is a stick on the path which perhaps looks like it resembles a snake, you are likely to jump, only to calm down once you have evaluated what you saw.

Most of our lives we respond to the patterns around us completely non-consciously, with no conscious awareness that this has happened, so it could be for example that you hear a police car in the distance. You perhaps don't notice this police car consciously, but you respond to it non-consciously with your heart rate speeding up.

Or perhaps you catch a glimpse of someone you find attractive,

but again, you don't consciously register this straightaway, yet you pull your stomach in, you push your shoulders back, you smile, your eyes widen and your heart rate increases, then as you get closer to the person, suddenly you consciously notice them and you recognise that you find the person quite attractive.

The neuroscientist I run The Mind Changers YouTube channel with, Dr David Lewis has done research into neuromarketing using eye tracking glasses and equipment monitoring brainwaves and heart rate to demonstrate this happening in relation to desired items, where someone's neurology will respond to a desired item noticed peripherally, say shoes in the window of a shoe shop in a shopping mall, long before the person consciously heads to the shop and consciously registers the shoes. These kinds of experiments are a large part of neuromarketing (Lewis, 2013).

I worked with a family where the mother said that her son had 'flipped out for no reason the other day'. Instead of asking why he flipped out, which only ever gets an opinion response, I asked what was happening when he flipped out.

I was told that he was playing his Gameboy and then suddenly he just felt angry, and then he got angry, threw his Gameboy, and started to smash up the living room. I asked what was happening around him at this time.

I was told that the TV was on and that on the TV was a chat show about absent fathers. This child hadn't consciously registered what was on the TV, but as a child whose father had left and seemed to have shown no interest in him, this made him really angry. All his conscious attention was on the game that he was playing, but his ears could still hear the TV, even if it wasn't registering with him on a conscious level. So, understanding that people pick up and respond to patterns non-consciously, means that you can learn to use this natural instinctive process that we all have.

Most people don't consider the way that we communicate. We have patterns in our communication. We do hand gestures to mark out important information. We use different tones of

voice to mark out our communication. And the brains of others pick up non-consciously on these patterns. What you will learn here is something called the interspersal technique (Erickson M.D., 1966). The interspersal technique is marking out suggestions or commands in some way for the brain to pick up on. So that the brains of others notice this pattern taking place. They pick up on that pattern and they start to instinctively respond to the pattern.

So how you do this is to mark things out with a tonal shift, pause, gesture, head movement or eye movements. The important thing is to be consistent so that you are using the same pattern throughout the communication. You can use more than one of these techniques at once. Which can help in different contexts, for example, I frequently hypnotise people so they may close their eyes and with their eyes closed, they obviously can't notice the gestures that I'm using or notice eye movements that I'm using. So, I may use tonal shifts and head movements when I'm doing hypnosis. The head movements change the location my voice comes from, so people can pick up on it even when they close their eyes.

Before you use embedded commands or suggestions it is important to think about what the goal is. You want to know what it is that you hope to get from the communication. If you don't know what you want to achieve then it will be difficult to achieve anything. You may also want to practise and have some ideas of the types of suggestions or commands that you may want to get across and think about how you can deliver these.

When you give these commands and suggestions what you are doing is packaging them within a sentence. So, for example, the illusionist Derren Brown did a routine where he had people on the London Underground forget what stop they were getting off at (Brown, 2016). To do this he said things like "you know what *..stop, thinking about it now...* what *...stop, thinking about it now...* you are getting off at?" and so he was giving the suggestion *stop thinking about it now* and he was doing that in the middle of what he was saying, but the person consciously thought he was just asking a question "you know what stop you

are getting off at?"
That is what they thought they were being asked. And he continues this same suggestion when he asks them to recall the stop, so after they say something like "yes, I think I know what stop I'm getting off at" He then says "so what *stop thinking about it now*, what *stop thinking about it now,* are you getting off at?"
And the person consciously thinks that they've just been ask again what stop they are getting off at, so they try to answer this question, only to discover they can't find the answer because they non-consciously picked up on the pattern and recognised that there was another message contained within the communication about developing amnesia. This was embedded within the broader sentence. This was also reinforced by Derren's use of hand gestures where he wiped his hand across in front of their eyes. So, he would say "what (gesture) *stop thinking about it now* are you getting off at, what (gesture) *stop thinking about it now"*, as if he is wiping it from their mind.
So, with tonal shifts, you can shift your tone when giving the suggestions, and it is good to be congruent, so that just means that your verbal and nonverbal behaviours match up. So, if you are giving suggestions for confidence, your tonal shifts may be to a confident tone of voice. If you are suggesting relaxation then you may make relaxed tonal shifts.
It is also useful to do a slight pause before and after the suggestion, this again just helps to mark that suggestion out a little bit more. And generally, the more subtle you can be with this the more effective it is, as long as the person can still pick up on it.
So, an example I could use during a training course or talk to encourage people to purchase my books could be "thank you for coming to this talk today, *by (buy) my books over there*, there is some additional information about my books and my YouTube channel if you want to take a look later".
People would hear the sentence without consciously noticing the embedded suggestion (unless they are on a training course where that is what I'm teaching them, or they are skilled and

knowledgeable about this). It is important to be congruent and stick to the same pattern.

Head movements are a great way of suggesting ideas. We all move our heads when talking to each other and we mark things out which are important to us, but we don't consciously notice until someone points it out. It is helpful to decide on a way that you will do this, and always do it that way. So, it could be for example, that you will always move your head to the left when you are talking normally and to the right when you are embedding ideas.

Say for example, you are holding a talk and interacting with participants and you are going to use this, you would stick to that same pattern with everyone you talk to individually and while presenting, you would talk leaning your head slightly left and then when embedding something you would lean your head slightly to the right.

You can be even more subtle than this, you can use eye movements. So, you look into one eye when talking normally with someone and the other eye when you are embedding ideas or suggestions. I've never known anyone on the receiving end of this to actually notice what I'm doing, even other hypnotists. So, your patterns could be to look in the eye on your left when talking normally and the eye on your right when you are embedding ideas. This is very very difficult for people to pick up on, but if you watch a TV drama where they do a lot of close-up face shots you will notice that the actors' eyes are darting left to right as they shift their gaze from one eye to the other of the person they are talking to. There is an interesting video of Michael Caine talking about acting where he talks about this issue and the importance of actors to not do this (Caine, 2014). We all do this all the time; you are just learning how to do this skilfully and with intent so that you can suggest ideas to people which they don't consciously pick up on.

The advantage of people picking up on and responding to suggestions and ideas non-consciously is that they then feel like the idea was theirs all along. Not an idea given by someone else. They don't feel manipulated or influenced, they feel like

everything came from within them.

You can also use gestures and anchoring. Gestures can be used to clump things together, so you may talk about something someone doesn't want and about a problem and you may link all of these together with one gesture (say with the left hand) and talk about what someone wants and positive things and link this with another gesture (say with a right hand gesture), like David Cameron, the ex UK Prime Minister did during the 2010 election, where he said something like, "you have a choice, (gesture with his left hand, palm up) you could have the same old government, you could have these problems and you could look to the past, or (gesture with his right hand, palm up) you can have a new Government, one which can bring you benefits and you can look to the future."

As he spoke, he linked *past, problem and labour* with his left hand and *future, solution and conservative* with his right hand. He ended his party-political broadcast by saying (right hand gesture) "it is up to you to decide which government you want", and he gestured firmly with his right hand.

This was an example of anchoring, which is something that gestures are great for. Anchoring is just linking a stimulus and a response. So, if you always embed ideas with the same tone of voice, then this tone of voice being used will be the trigger, and will become an anchor itself. So, when you are using that tone of voice, even without saying any suggestions, it will trigger all of those past suggestions, or if a certain head movement is linked to the suggestions, then just moving your head will end up anchored to triggering those suggestions again. This is something which happens with those who do hypnosis or meditation, the therapist starts to talk in that meditative way, or say a specific sentence and this is enough for someone who has been through the process a number of times for them to respond before the therapist has started doing their work.

Many people have experienced this with going on holiday and using for example coconut suncream every day of the holiday, which can then become anchored to the feelings of being on holiday so that when you smell coconut when you are at home,

or when you are in your normal everyday life, you instantly feel like you are back on holiday.

In my FourGames eCourse you will find a demonstration of me using this approach to hypnotise someone. In the demonstration I talk about someone asking me how you do hypnosis and while I'm sharing the story, I'm hypnotising the person in front of me.

With all of these techniques it is important to practise them regularly, write them down, practise in a mirror, practise with friends, and notice how these techniques are used in everyday conversations and begin to add them to your own conversations.

THE POWER OF IMPLICATION

One of the most powerful techniques we all use without realising it is implication. We say 'I'll try' without realising that we are giving ourselves the message that something will be difficult and increasing our chances of failure. If I say to someone "try and open that door" or "try and lift up that box" they will assume and prepare for some level of difficulty. They won't assume that the box is light and easy to lift, or that the door is easy to open.

Implications like this happen continuously in everyday speech without people recognising it. For example, there is a difference between saying to someone "what would it be like if you could do that?" and "what will it be like when you can do that?" The second sentence implies success, it is just a question of when that success will happen, the first sentence doesn't make it real to the listener.

So, implication is where something is assumed without directly saying it, and it can take many forms. If I say "can you close the curtains" this implies the existence of a window without mentioning the window. There are certain words which I call implication words, words like before, during, after, while, as, and when.

All of these words imply something:

- Before you relax... I would just like to learn a little

more about you

- After you relax... you can think about how things will be different
- During relaxation... you can find your mind wander to pleasant thoughts
- While you are relaxed... I'm going to ask you some questions
- As you relax... your mind can wander
- When you relax... you can start to develop great insight

So whatever else is in the sentence I am letting the person know that they will relax, but most people will focus on what comes in the second part of the communication, the second part sounds like instructions, guidance or a suggestion, whereas the first part sounds almost incidental.

If you do this too overtly or in a way which sounds like you are trying to get something out of it then people can react negatively towards you and feel they don't like you, even if they don't know why. So if a salesperson says "before you sign the contract I'll just talk you through some of the features of this product" or "do you want this one or this one?" where the implication is that you want one of the presented items, the question is just which one, then the customer is likely to feel like they are being manipulated and so the communication they are receiving isn't what the sales person is intending, instead they are pushing their customer away from making a purchase.

Implication can be used for pacing and leading. You can use a technique called linking suggestions. This is where you link two parts of a sentence together as if they are connected when in reality there is no actual connection. Another word you can use with linking suggestions is the word 'and' or using a pause.

Linking suggestions are great for pacing and leading: "while you take a look at this (pacing), you can gain some insight (leading)." There isn't necessarily a connection between looking at something and gaining insight, but by linking them together in this way implies that there is, so if they follow the pacing part of

the sentence, they are more likely to automatically follow along to the leading part.

It is always best to start with where people are at and pacing what they are doing now, or can be doing now, and then leading, and using the leading as the next part of your pacing. So, you could follow up on the last sentence with: "and as you gain insight (leading), I'm curious what your understanding will be?"

So, this is leading just one step on from looking at something, to gaining insight, to understanding that insight.

Depending on what the goal is, that is what you would aim for. As a hypnotherapist my goals are often for hypnosis and for therapeutic outcomes like helping someone to quit smoking, lose weight, stop being anxious, or overcome depression. So, my sentences are always in the direction of these goals.

You can offer illusory choices. These are choices which aren't really different. You can offer the choices consciously or in a way that bypasses conscious awareness and communicates to the person non-consciously.

A conscious choice could be "which of these do you want?" Which implies that they will want one of the options, but they decide and say which they want.

A non-conscious choice would be phrased more like "I wonder whether you will have this one or that one", or using a negative, which can help to de-potentiate the person's negativity and encourage them to respond positively "I don't know whether you will have this one or that one" This also implies that if I don't know, someone must, and that someone is likely to be the person I'm talking with, but again I'm not asking them to choose consciously.

This type of communication works well when you want to offer choices but with a single outcome. So, in training classes I may say "do you want to sit in this chair or this chair to go into hypnosis" if I'm giving the person a conscious choice. Or more likely to say, as the person is walking up to the chairs "I wonder which chair you will sit in to go into hypnosis." This doesn't ask the volunteer to consciously choose a chair, they just sit in

whichever chair they want, but the act of sitting in one of the chairs means they agree to go into hypnosis.
Using curiosity helps because with curiosity you are just throwing ideas out there out loud but they all have an implication.

- "I wonder whether you will x or y as you z"
- "I'm curious to discover how you will x when you y"
- "Before you x, I don't know whether you will y or z"

All these examples offer options which means that the person you are communicating with feels like they are making decisions. When you aren't asking for conscious decisions, these decisions feel natural and instinctive, not manipulated, and there is an implication which they follow without paying attention to the fact they are following something you have told them to do.
I hold the view that however someone responds to me is the correct response for them to have, nothing is wrong, it is just a flow of information. You want to accept what people say and do as being the correct response for their journey to the goal, and then allow a way to develop from where they are at this moment in time.
As a hypnotherapist, if my goal is to have the client in hypnosis and I go to do an arm levitation and their arm doesn't move I won't see this as failure, it is the behaviour that is right for that client in that moment on their journey into hypnosis. So, I will accept and use this by suggesting something like "or are you already drifting so deep into hypnosis that that arm just won't lift?"
Now if it lifts that means they are following my previous suggestion and are going into hypnosis, if it doesn't lift it means they are already in hypnosis and going deeper because I've tagged on the suggestion that their behaviour means they are deeper in hypnosis.
I recommend you take time to listen to people talking and recognise their implications. Notice your own implications,

those you use with yourself and with others. It is surprising how many people do things like having a headache and they tell themselves 'My head hurts' giving themselves additional suggestions and implying something ongoing rather than telling themselves something like 'I wonder how quickly that pain in my head will pass?'

In my FourGames eCourse you can find a demonstration of me using implication to hypnotise someone. I am just observing their behaviours and responses and pacing and leading them into hypnosis.

THE POWER OF VAGUE LANGUAGE & METAPHOR

Have you ever stopped to think about what people are really saying? We listen to people talking, we nod in agreement or shake our heads, we act like we understand others, but much of what we hear other say is vague language and metaphors, the meaning given to what they were saying is what we have created in our own minds, which may or may not be the same meaning that was meant by the person speaking.

Vague language is used by all of us a large amount of the time, we just don't think about what we are saying as being vague, because to us it is specific, and most people assume that everyone else gives things the same meaning. So, when someone says they are depressed, they know what they mean by depression and assume that others know what they mean by depression, but depression means different things to different people. Likewise, if someone says 'be careful' the person hearing this may respond saying that they will be careful, but both people may well have different ideas of what 'be careful' means.

There are people who use vague language intentionally. As a therapist, vague language is helpful to use when I don't know specific details and I just want to guide a client's thinking by letting them fill in the blanks. Vague language is naturally hypnotic because the only way for someone to make sense of it

is to go inside their mind and find their own interpretation and understanding of what was said. Politicians often use vague language so that people create the meaning they want to hear.

Some examples of vague language use could be:

"The National Health Service is in chaos, we need to make the NHS work better, we need to ensure the right people are doing the right jobs, we need to have systems in place that give us the NHS we want, under our government we will make the changes to ensure the NHS works for everybody, that the necessary money goes into the NHS."

What this politician could be talking about is adding additional Government funding and hiring extra staff, or they could be talking about laying off staff, privatising the NHS and adding patient fees.

Another example perhaps from a new age retreat could be:

"You have come here today to discover truth, freedom and love, to find out what your purpose is, what the meaning of life is, how to connect with your deeper self and find true inner wisdom and peace and a connection to something greater than yourself. By being here you will gain great insights into the power of your mind and how to find the path to enlightenment."

This is the kind of language used by many influential cults or cult-like trainers, nothing that was said has any meaning other than the meaning the listener gives it, and it is all very hypnotic, it is hard not to go into a hypnotic-like trance listening to someone speak like that, and if you are on a day or week long course where this way of speaking is used throughout your time on the course and the occasional direct command is dropped in, you will be creating the meaning you want to hear, spending your time on the course in a hypnotic-like trance and being

receptive to suggestions given. It is very hard not to be drawn in by this way of talking.

So vague language is language where you aren't revealing specific details, you are letting the listener fill in the blanks. It is language which sends people on an internal search for meaning. In every day interactions you are unlikely to communicate in vague language to the extent I did a moment ago, not every sentence you say will be vague, instead you will integrate it into what you say when either you don't know details but want to guide someone's thinking without saying something which mismatches their perspective, or you want to absorb their attention around an idea.

Vague language helps when you are using metaphors, especially stories or guided experiences where you don't know what is going on inside the mind of the listener or you are presenting the story or metaphor to multiple listeners. So, if I talk about "imagine yourself on a beach" The listener could imagine a rough beach, or a calm beach, it could be daytime, or night time, it could be stony or sandy. There are many options, so I don't want to be specific in what I say unless I have stated something up front. So, if I said "imagine yourself on a beach with white sand and calm blue water", then I know these details are part of the listeners experience, but these may not be what the listener likes, they may like a rough sea and stones. So instead, I can use vague language and inquisitive questions like "you can gaze out over the sea and notice what colour it is, and whether it is rough or calm, and what the horizon looks like, and the colour of the sky." What I'm doing here is suggesting where to focus, not telling the person what their experience will be. To increase how responsive someone is to you, you want to narrow and focus their attention. I am doing this by directing their attention but leaving them to fill in the details.

We all use metaphors in our speech, often without realising it. We can listen out for metaphors others use and use these metaphors back in some way. So, if someone talks about being stuck in a rut, we can create a story or analogy around the idea of being stuck in a rut, and if we are doing this therapeutically

then in our story, we can have a resolution to being stuck in a rut.

So, it could be talking about how your car got stuck while driving down a muddy road, and one of the wheels just kept spinning and digging the hole deeper, so you got out in the pouring rain to sort it out. It was well and truly stuck in there. To get out you had a thick plastic sheet in the boot of your car, so you got this out, put it in front of the wheel and wedged it as best as you could under the wheel, then tried to drive again, and your car managed to gain traction on the plastic and you got your car back on the road again.

What you are doing with metaphors is laying down patterns. The brain works like a pattern matching machine and it takes patterns from one context and applies them elsewhere. So, a pattern given metaphorically can be interpreted in relation to the context. If I start talking about the Ugly Duckling story (Andersen, n.d.) with a random person in a café it is likely to have very little meaning. If I tell the same story to someone who feels they don't have purpose in life, or who lacks confidence, then because the context is one where the conversation is about that topic the story will be interpreted as being related in some way.

People don't just communicate verbally with metaphors, but they also use metaphors physically. Knowing this will transform how much information you get from people. Sometimes they will do things which reveal thoughts they don't tell you. For example, someone may say that their partner is a pain in the neck, using 'pain in the neck' as a metaphor for finding their partner irritating and annoying. They may also develop symptoms of neck pain which no-one can find an organic cause for because they have internalised and embodied the metaphor. This is common when people don't address the problem, and they try to block it out and so it manifests by turning the metaphor they think into real symptoms.

They also may be in conversation with you and when you ask, so how is your husband, what is he up to? They rub their neck but say he's doing well. They don't tell you that they have been

finding him annoying lately, but unconsciously they have given this information away.

If you want to take your metaphor skills to a whole new level you can look out for real-life examples like this, and also think about things you can convey metaphorically through your behaviours, like gestures and actions, rather than having to say things.

Metaphors are great to use to lay down or trigger neurological patterns. So, if you would like someone to be more generous, then you can use metaphors which have a pattern of generosity like stories of people selflessly giving. These could be stories you've heard, or anecdotes from your own life. If you want someone to have a new perspective on things you can share metaphors around new perspectives – like climbing a mountain, flying, or 'standing back to look at the new extension'. If you want someone to like you more you can talk about things associated with the idea of warmth – like sunny holidays.

You can use physical metaphors, there is a lot of research on a topic called priming (Molden, 2014), which is where you subtly suggest an idea to someone which then alters their behaviour, for example, if someone handles something warm they will warm to you, if someone holds something cold they will feel more distant (Williams & Bargh, 2008), if someone pulls on something while looking at something, they like it more because they feel like they want to 'pull it closer', if someone pushes on something at the same time as looking at something they like it less as if they want to 'push it away' (Cacioppo et al., 1993), if someone sees a briefcase they act more 'business like', if they see a backpack they act more casually and friendly (Kay et al., 2004), if someone sees money they act more selfishly and are less likely to help others (Vohs et al., 2006), if they see something resembling a doctor or nurse they act kinder, if they are presented with stereotypes these trigger patterns around those stereotypes, so seeing supermodels reduces intelligence, seeing scientists increases intelligence whereas seeing a single scientist or single model has the opposite effect, you compare yourself to them rather than identifying with them (Dijksterhuis

& Bargh, 2001), seeing children increases creativity, reaction times and memory, seeing elderly decreases reaction times and memory.

These ideas can be primed physically in some way, like having a magazine or book lying around which shares the idea, or offering someone a hot drink, or even just having them hold your hot drink for a moment while you get something from your pocket. Or they can be primed through talking, like talking about a science article and about scientists, or talking about something to do with children, or about pulling something open, so that the neurological pathways in the brain for that pattern are activated.

Knowing this information can transform how you see people communicating. For example, job interviews go better when the interviewer is drinking a hot drink, if they aren't, then giving them the idea of warmth will help the interview go better, it could be you mention the weather if it is a warm day outside, or you find an opportunity to talk about a summer holiday. People do better on tests and exams if they think about scientists. People feel more confident and are 'looked up to' when they are taller than those around them, so if everyone is seated in a situation you could perch on a stall or stand so that you are taller making others non-consciously see you as more of an authority figure.

TRANCE-FORMED REALITY

Most people experience reality as feeling so real, as if what you experience is reality. But we all have our own reality which is viewed through trance.

Trance is one of the most fundamental aspects to being. We are always in a trance, so the question isn't: is someone in a trance or not, it is what trance are they in and how deep?

Depth of trance is just how absorbed someone is within a trance, or how pure that trance is. So, a light depression trance could have someone in a low mood, they would start to see negative things as happening more often and positive things as happening less frequently, they would start to take the blame for the negative things and assume the positive things would be due to luck or external factors. But because they are in a light trance it is easier for other things to interrupt and change this trance, when someone is in a deep trance they pay no attention to things outside of that trance, someone in a depression trance like this is much more difficult to interrupt, to create change and help the person out of this trance and into a different trance, you need to gain access to the trance and work from the inside out.

Through all of human history people have strived to access positive trance states. People have danced, watched flickering flames, used music, drumming and rhythms, used isolation and sensory deprivation, used drugs and mind-altering substances,

and chanting and focusing, like focusing on the sound of a bell ringing, used repetition, shapes and patterns, used rituals, and many other ways to access healing or therapeutic trance states. Shaman and witch doctors would enter specific trance states before healing others. Clairvoyants claim to use trance and it is used in various spiritual practices. Martial arts use movement, breathing and focus, religions and spiritual traditions use praying and meditation, sports people try to access 'the flow' state, and doctors use hypnosis.

The names and methods may change through time and cultures, but they are all doing the same thing, trying to influence the trance state we are in, to one which is helpful for what we hope to achieve. Trance is a full being experience, the trance you view the world from within dictates what thoughts, feelings, beliefs and behaviours you will have, and your perceptions.

For example, in various studies done with people who believed they were lucky and people who believed they were unlucky, those who believe they are lucky are more likely to notice and take opportunities than those who believe they are unlucky (Wiseman, 2003).

Different trance-states have different effects on our body, for example when we are happy our immune system functions better and we have a higher tolerance for pain (Coyle, 2017). When we are depressed, we feel pain more (Carter PhD et al., 2002) and our immune system is weaker (Stuart, 2022).

We are all connected, it is impossible not to influence others. We all live in our own unique trance reality. When we are in the company of someone else our trance realities overlap and can have some influence on each other if the people are paying attention to each other. When you understand the trance nature of reality you find yourself communicating with others differently, you realise that their reality is as real to them as yours is to you. If you try to tell them their reality is wrong, they will defend it as much as you would yours. There are very few things which exist as true reality, most of reality is what we perceive it to be.

This leads to some highly effective and interesting ways of communicating with people. We start from a place of acceptance. That doesn't mean you have to agree with the other person, but you accept that their view is true to them, and you work from his starting point.

So, in my therapeutic work with parents one issue which would occur was children saying to their parents "you love my brother more than you love me." The parent would reply "no, I love you both equally."

This would cause an argument. Had the parent accepted the reality of the child, and accepted that in the child's reality the parent doesn't love them as much as their sibling, then things would play out differently. Rather than stating that they love both children equally, which mismatches with the child's reality, they would respond by asking "what is it I do that makes you think that?" or a similar question. Instead of creating something to argue over, this gives the parent access to the trance reality of the child, it identifies what behaviours they are doing that the child is interpreting as the parent loving the other child more, and the parent can use this information to create change. It could be they need to change their behaviour, or they need to help the child change their perspective or understanding of something.

This collaborative communication approach where you accept the reality of the other person as being as real to them as your reality is to you is a really powerful communication idea. The great psychiatrist Milton Erickson said that the most flexible person will have the most influence. If you are willing to adapt and blend into the trance realities of others you will have the most influence and gain greater understanding of others. Instead of directly challenging people you will come alongside people and explore their reality with them, and change it from the inside.

Part of our trance reality is what is inside our minds. What I have learned over the decades is that what is in people's minds isn't there at all, it is outside their mind overlaying the real world. When you ask someone what colour their front door is,

they look at their front door. Some will say 'they look at their front door in their mind' but if you watch the person, you will notice they look at it somewhere overlaid on top of reality. In therapy when they describe a problem as being overwhelming, they will react as if it is in front of them up in their face overwhelming them, if they talk about how a child was small, they will gesture in the real world to show the height and perhaps look down at the imagined 'small child'.

Because the inner world is actually outside of people's minds and overlaid on reality you can influence this. For example, when things are nearer to us, they often feel more emotional, so when the other person or yourself are talking about negative things you can gesture away from the person as if pulling that away from them. When you are talking to someone about something you want them to feel more you can gesture towards them, you can use erasing gestures and throwing away gestures to remove and reduce things in their experience, like Derren Brown erasing memories when saying "what stop thinking about it now, are you getting off at?"

When things are larger this often increases emotion, and when smaller this often decreases emotion. So again, you can gesture making something larger when you want emotions increased, and gesture smaller when you want emotions decreased.

The experience changes with other sensory alterations, so if you have someone change the voice of their internal dialogue in some way, so it could be having the voice speaking with a different tone or rhythm or speed, or it could be a different voice entirely, this changes the experience. For example, if someone was harshly telling themselves that they are useless and a failure, and then they started doing this with a slow relaxed Mickey Mouse voice, it wouldn't have the same impact on them.

Often the language and gestures people use reveals how you can best alter their inner reality experience. You can listen and watch out for this in social situations, in café's bars, colleges or universities and in public places, and notice the gestures people use and the language people use.

You can talk and influence colour, contrast, brightness, size, shape, location, closeness, associated or disassociated – so whether they experience something as if seeing it through their own eyes – which has a greater emotional impact, or seeing it from a third person perspective which usually reduces emotional intensity.

You can observe when people are talking about something they like and notice where in space they are looking and where they look when they are talking about something they dislike. You ideally want to be standing in the location where they look when they like something. But this simple bit of knowledge also allows you to alter how much they like things, you can have something – whether it is something real and tangible, or just an idea you are sharing, and you can have it in one hand where they dislike things, and then move it over to the like location so that it increases the chances of them liking that thing.

HEALING COMMUNICATION

There is a theory called Panpsychism (Hurt, 2021) which suggests that consciousness, or the essence of consciousness is within every atom in the universe and arises as full consciousness in sufficiently complex states of matter. One idea could be that consciousness is the electromagnetic force, which means consciousness is light and we are luminous beings. This chapter shares speculation and perspectives about panpsychism and consciousness, something which scientists treat as the hard problem (Chalmers, 2017), so these are just my views and thoughts on the topic from my learning and experiences.

Consciousness arises in the same way that a single drop of water can move and vibrate and billions of drops of water can create waves hundreds of feet high with water molecules working in synchrony with each other. It isn't the individual water molecules moving across the ocean, it is the energy moving in an orderly way. In the same way that in the brain, it isn't the neurons moving, synchronised waves of energy move in harmony and consciousness arises from the waves of energy (Inchingolo, 2022).

The idea of panpsychism is that every atom in the universe contains the essence of consciousness, and using this knowledge and the skills and insights you have learned from the previous chapters you can communicate healing on a deep level.

Information transduction is about how information is moved from one place to another and how it transforms on its journey (Rossi, 1996). So, if I help someone with pain in their right elbow there is a flow of information. Energy is just the carrier of this information. There will have been information flowing electrically within my brain about what I may do and about my observations with the client, once I know what I plan on doing to help I may communicate this verbally, so the electrical impulses in my brain direct towards creating physical movement of muscles related to speaking and communicating, my patterns of moving my tongue, lips, mouth and breathing pump out a pattern of airwaves that contain the information I am hoping to convey, these reach the clients eardrums moving the eardrums, passing this information to the bones in the ears and vibrating the hairs in the cochlea, which turn these movements of the hairs into electrical signals carrying that information to the brain, from here it passes around to the relevant parts of the brain, this could lead to telling the parts of the brain which create our own natural opioids to send those chemical messengers to that elbow, which then passes on the message to numb or desensitise that part of the body.

This is a very simplistic view of the process, but what is happening is that there is a constant flow of information which for this section is being carried from my brain as electrical wave patterns to the cells in the elbow of the client. In reality there is a cycle of information. I am responding to the client, not making a decision independently of the client. This movement of information has taken many forms to get from my brain to the client's elbow.

Using what you have learned previously you can ensure that what you are communicating gets the message to where it needs to go. If the client for example is distracted and thinking about other things, then these thoughts will dilute my message, if they have tension or other messages flowing at the time in a similar location these will impact on the effectiveness of what I am communicating and may well block my message. So, you communicate in a way that opens up the path to create the least

resistance possible. You do this by grabbing, focusing and holding attention, this can be by the tone of voice you use, the eye contact you use to hold their attention, communicating in patterns, like through metaphors or through the way you are breathing, or through implications and other techniques you have learned so that the other person's mind picks up on the communication bypassing any conscious interference.

You can also use healing communication with yourself. People often over-complicate things, they try to find conscious understanding and think that if they know why about something then they will know how to overcome a problem. In reality the why and the how are two very different questions. Someone can know why they have a fear of spiders and they will still have a fear of spiders, someone else may not know why they have a fear of spiders yet they find out how to be comfortable around spiders and so no longer have the fear.

The psychiatrist Dr Milton Erickson was in excruciating pain in the later years of his life. He breathed with half a lung, had muscles which had spasmed so much they tore from his bones, his tongue had dislocated, and yet he would eliminate his pain and smile and taught students right up to his death.

When asked how he dealt with the pain he described how he had tried many different ways, none of which gave lasting relief. He eventually found a way that worked. Erickson let go of his conscious self and trusted the deeper part of him, his unconscious self. He just thanked the deeper part of himself for giving him the pain as a signal to look after parts of his body, then asked it to remove the pain by lunchtime. Then at some point around lunchtime he would notice he hadn't had any pain for a while, and he would thank that deeper part.

Erickson believed that you should trust that deeper part of you, and that many problems we have are because of the conscious part of ourselves. So if you want to do healing with yourself, you don't need to have any complicated ritual, just connect with that deeper part, show it respect, if for example you wanted to be more confident thank it for making you anxious in those situations you want to be more confident, understand that it was

only making you anxious because it thought those situations could be a threat to you in some way, then let it know how you would like to be in those situations and ask it to work on helping you achieve within a given time frame – remember that the time frame needs to be realistic for it to make the changes through your neurology. Then carry on with your day like normal, and when you notice the changes have happened thank it for helping you in making those changes.

For this to work you need to use what you have been learning. If you are busy in the middle of something else and not really making time to dedicate to communicating with your deeper self then this won't work. Although it isn't necessary, sometimes it can help to create a ritual that helps focus your attention. So, one of my favourites is to stand in the bathroom with just a couple of tea lights lighting the room and gaze into my eyes in my reflection in the mirror under the low light and wait for the person looking back at me to change so that it doesn't seem like me anymore. Once I see that *other me* looking back at me then I communicate with my deeper self. This helps me to shut down all other mental chatter and stop my focus on other things, and just focus on what I am doing at that moment.

It is important to also recognise your natural rhythms and the wave nature of reality. From a cellular level all the way to how we live our lives we have cyclical waves of existence (Lloyd, 1992). Every 90-120 minutes or so, and more frequently when we are learning things, we drift into a daydream state to update our neurology – a bit like auto saving a Word document regularly so that it doesn't accidentally get deleted (Kleitman, 1982). Many people try to push through this daydreaming, they drink coffee to 'snap themselves out of it', they get told off in school for gazing out of the window during the lesson and daydreaming, yet daydreaming helps you learn and retain information better (Koch, 2013). By 'working through' that feeling of wanting to take a break, rather than taking a break you become more forgetful, it reduces your immune system and your concentration, and makes it harder for you to learn, remember and recall information. But if you go with your

natural rhythms, you will learn better, and improve mental and physical health and wellbeing.

There are many things which trigger healing within people. Caring touch (Dobson, 2006), showing compassion and close proximity to those we perceive ourselves to be close to triggers healing changes on a genetic level (Rossi, 2012) which cascade to other changes over a three month or so period (Rossi & Rossi, 2010) to create lasting healing changes in someone, as do changes which occur within daydreams or within periods of meditation, healing introspection, or hypnosis.

Stroking yourself on your arms can trigger these healing changes (Sumich et al., 2022), so these ideas can be used with yourself, or with others to communicate healing from deep within.

OPENING UP YOUR AWARENESS

Many of us aren't aware of how little we are aware of. There are many times when it is helpful to be more aware of the world around us and there are reasons why we lack awareness.

As someone autistic I didn't instinctively learn to understand non-verbal behaviour. Most children as they grow up learn non-verbal behaviour from those around them in the same way that they learn to speak. They learn to read and interpret this non-verbal behaviour. I didn't have that experience, it wasn't until I saw the hypnotist Paul McKenna on TV in the early 1990's where he presented a documentary about hypnosis and taught that hypnosis was about communication, about looking for non-verbal behaviours and knowing what these behaviours mean that I realised there was more to communication than just the exact meaning of the words used. This was a lightbulb moment for me and started me on a journey of discovery where I started studying and learning about the meaning of various non-verbal behaviours.

For many years in my early 20's I worked in an environment which had high levels of violence. During those years I was involved in over 1000 violent incidents with about 300 of these being potentially life-threatening. I have had someone try to hang me with a homemade noose, I've been attacked with knives, broken glass, baseball bats and various other weapons.

In all my time managing these sorts of situations I have rarely sustained any injuries, and where I have been injured it has only been minor. Having a relaxed heightened sense of awareness has been helpful in these situations. It increased my reaction times, allowed me to know what was likely to happen before others seemed to know, and helped me to make better decisions, often doing things others never thought of doing, sometimes things which on the surface seemed illogical, but which were in fact very logical.

Opening up my awareness has also been helpful in my work as a therapist. When I am working with a client I want to gather as much information as possible about what is going on for the client. People try to say what is going on for them, but words are limiting, so you have to read between the words. You have to read body posture, hand movements, facial expressions, vocal information like changes to volume or pitch and more. All of this gives far more information about the problem the client presents than they themselves know consciously or can express in the words they use, although one thing I am paying attention to which they often aren't is their choice of words as well as how they say those words.

Throughout this chapter I will share with you how to open up your awareness and how to improve and hone your senses.

The first step to opening up your senses is to access a heightened state of awareness. In a later chapter I will share an open awareness meditation which you can use to help you to open up your senses further still. The meditation is also available to listen to in my FourGames eCourse.

To develop an open awareness state there are some simple steps you can take.

Firstly, you can open up your visual field of awareness. We have two types of vision, central or foveal and peripheral. Most of the time we focus on our central vision, this is the narrow, sharp vision we have in front of us. We have just a small area of our vision which is clear and in focus. Most of what we see is out of focus, and we have an area in front of our eyes which we can't see at all because we don't have the receptors at the back

of our eyes to create a representation of that space. We rarely notice this blind spot because our mind fills in the blanks. In fact, a lot of what we think we see is created by our minds rather than a true representation of what we are observing (Adelson, 2020). We jump our eyes around using this central vision to focus on one thing after another. Our central vision is good with detail but not so good at picking up movement.

Our peripheral vision is the vision which is good for picking up on movement or changes. By defocusing your eyes you use more of your peripheral vision, you also broaden your awareness out, so if you focus on a spot in front of you and hold your arms out to the side like this while continuing to focus your attention on that spot and see how far back you can move your hands and still see them when you are focusing on that spot, and then defocus your eyes so that you are gazing towards that spot but the spot is out of focus you will notice that you can now move your hands further back and still see them. You are aware of a far wider area around you and you will be sensitive to movement within this wider area.

With this vision you will be more sensitive to movement and will notice changes easier than if you focus on one thing at a time with your central vision.

Something that can help with defocusing the eyes and accessing the peripheral vision and also help you to be more aware physically is relaxing your body. You can let your facial muscles relax, the muscles around your eyes, your forehead, your cheeks, your jaw, let your shoulders relax, and let the muscles throughout your body relax. By doing this you are allowing yourself to be more sensitive to physical sensations. We are more aware of things around us than we give ourselves credit for, you need to let go and relax physically so that you can increase your awareness of pressure changes, or temperature changes and touch.

You can have a sense of stretching out your awareness. You can start to feel the energy field from things.

Finally, you want to quiet the mind. If your mind is noisy then you will struggle to hear what is coming in from the outside.

One good way to quiet the mind is to focus on your breathing. Focus on breathing in and out in a deep and rhythmic way with each out-breath being slightly longer than the in-breath.
If you find your attention wanders you can bring it back to the breathing. The idea isn't to stay focusing on the breathing, but to use the breathing as a transition from how you were thinking to a state of being present and just in the moment without thoughts, just awareness.
When you enter this state, you can hear better because you aren't also talking to yourself in your mind, you are giving your attention to what you perceive in the moment. You will be more receptive to the way that people say things rather than just 'hearing' the words and the meaning you expect those words to have when people talk to you.
By entering this relaxed heightened state of awareness, you will not only increase what you are aware of but you will also be better prepared to react to things that happen around you, and your reactions will be faster and more appropriate.

VISUAL ACUITY

In this chapter we will explore visual acuity, what it is, what you can notice, times increased visual acuity can be helpful and how you can practise it.

Visual acuity is how well you can notice visual information. Most of the time we pay attention to the world using our central vision which is like having a narrow torch shining the light on just one bit of information at a time. This has its uses, but we can also benefit significantly by expanding our awareness with our peripheral vision.

The peripheral vision is great for detecting movement and changes. When you are observing people, they reveal a lot of information we don't normally pay attention to. Although by focusing on one single area with your central vision you can increase your awareness of what is going on in that one area, by doing this you are missing the bigger picture and not noticing what else is going on. With your peripheral vision you can notice ongoing changes as they happen.

What Can You Notice?

When you look at someone there are many things you can observe. You can notice the pulse in the centre of their neck and in the side of their neck, and sometimes in the temple. If you can see the person's arms sometimes you can notice the pulse in the wrist, and if the person is seated with their legs

crossed the top foot will often be beating in time with their pulse. If their pulse is beating hard often their head will also beat in time with their pulse.

You can notice someone's breathing pattern, their head will move with each breath, nostrils will flare and contract as air passes in and out of the nose, the shoulders will rise and lower, this will make the arms rise and lower a little, the chest will expand and contract and the stomach will move in and out.

You can notice changes to the colour of the face, which could get redder or become paler. Changes to the vertical lines on the lips which can almost appear to disappear as the lips fill with blood and swell, and can become more noticeable as the blood flows away from the lips and the lips shrink.

You can notice eye movements. It is often taught that specific eye movements correspond to doing specific things in the mind like looking in a different place when visually recalling information, compared to when visually creating information. Although people do move their eyes in specific ways depending on what is going on for them internally the pattern for this isn't as rigid as many body language books will teach, but everyone will have their own pattern and this pattern is likely to be fixed for that individual.

You can also notice when someone's pupils get larger and smaller, this happens based on changing light levels, but also on where they are focusing and on how interested they are in what they are focusing on. For example, if someone is attracted to you their pupils will get larger as they take in more information.

By noticing where the eyes look you can also begin to notice where they position things which are inside their mind on the outside. So, they may always look to a specific location when looking at things they like, and at another location when talking about things they dislike.

You can notice momentary expressions, micro expressions. So it could be that you are talking to someone about something and they are smiling and nodding and showing interest in what you are talking about but then something you say gives them a feeling of disgust and for a split second they show a disgusted

facial expression. They may not even consciously register that they had a disgust reaction, it could have happened for any number of reasons, but this is useful information to be aware of.

And you can also be aware of how they are moving, so when you open up your visual field you can be aware of the slightest movement. It could be that you notice tension in their hands if they are beginning to become aggressive, it could be that you notice some movement in their legs or their feet.

When Can This Be Helpful?

It can increase your safety because you can be aware through your peripheral vision of oncoming traffic as you are trying to cross the road for example.

By having this wider visual awareness by gazing at people, by allowing your visual awareness to expand, and your visual acuity to increase and by being aware of how much you can notice, this can really help with communication.

It can help you to understand what is going on in a person you are talking to. What you are doing is gathering even more information and then it is your job to piece together what that must mean.

So if you notice for example that their heart rate is beginning to speed up and their breathing is beginning to speed up, then you can think, what is going on in this moment that could be triggering that, what is their experience of this moment. You can then start interpreting what is going on inside that other person.

The psychiatrist Milton Erickson was great with his sensory acuity. There was a story told about when he was working in a hospital and he said that a member of staff came into work that morning and they walked down the corridor and as they walked down the corridor he watched them walk past his door and watched them carry on walking down the corridor and he said he noticed something and so he made a prediction, he wrote it down on a piece of paper, he then put it in an envelope, sealed the envelope, gave it to his secretary and asked them to sign it

stating he was just testing a prediction.
The signed and dated envelope was locked away. A few months later the woman who he saw walk past his door that day announced that she was pregnant. Erickson said that he already knew that, he got the prediction which said she was pregnant. The woman asked how he knew. Erickson replied that as he saw her walk past that day, he noticed she was walking differently, noticed her hips were moving differently and so he could tell her body was preparing to give birth which changes the way you walk. He said he also noticed her eyebrows had moved a couple of millimetres apart. He named various changes he had noticed as she walked past and he knew from these changes he noticed; it was likely she had become pregnant.
When you hone your visual acuity skills, if you match that with knowledge and studying various subjects like anthropology, psychology, physiology, body language, suddenly you can notice many things which previously you didn't notice in your awareness.
Increasing your visual acuity helps you to be more aware of the world around you and those people who are in that world.

Exercise
I'm going to give two practice exercises; you will need a friend for these.

Exercise 01
Sit opposite the person and ask them to think of three different things, two are true and one is a lie. What you do is you then say 'I want you to think of the first thing', they can do this in any order, so two truthful and one lie, 'I want you to think of the first thing,' give them a moment to do this, 'now look around anywhere,' you want them to break state for a moment, 'and now look back at me, and now think of the second thing,' give then time again, 'and now look around again and then look back and me and think of the third thing.'
And what your job is, is to look at them and notice what was

different, so with the two truthful things there will be a similarity in the pattern and with the lie there will be something different and your job is to notice the lie and reveal which one of the three options was the lie. Then you can repeat this with them jumbling up the three things so that you don't know which time will be the lie and you practise noticing the difference between the lie and the two truths.

Exercise 02

The second exercise is to sit opposite the person again and this time have them think of something which makes them really happy and then have them think of something they don't like, it could be something which makes them sad or angry or annoyed, but nothing too serious, so something which gets a reaction from within them, but isn't too negative.

So, they have two things they are thinking of, a positive thing and a negative thing. You then ask them to think of the happy memory without telling you anything, then look around the room and then think of the negative thought and they think of that.

What you are doing is picking up the visual information of what they look like as a whole being when thinking about the positive and negative thoughts and noticing the differences.

Then you ask them to randomly think of either one and your job is to say 'you are thinking of...' and then name which you think they are thinking of, and then repeat this a number of times to practise and test that you can notice the difference between how they look thinking of one or the other.

Have them think of one at a time. Between thinking of one of the thoughts, you have them look around the room to break the state. So, you are noticing the differences and learning to notice different internal states.

AUDITORY ACUITY

In this chapter we will explore auditory acuity, what it is, what you can notice, times increased auditory acuity can be helpful and how you can practise it.
Auditory acuity is how well you can notice auditory information. Most of the time we pay attention to what people say, but don't really pay attention to how they say what they say. Most people instinctively pick up on some of this information and have 'gut feelings' about things. So, someone could be smiling and saying words which sound kind and friendly, and yet somehow you feel something is wrong. You don't know what, and don't realise that you are picking up on the subtle aggressive tone in their voice which they are trying to hide.

What Can You Notice?
When you listen to someone there are many things you can observe. You can notice the pitch of their voice, the tonality, the speed they speak, the rhythm they speak with and the clarity of their speech. You can also notice the sound of their breathing and notice other sounds.
If you are talking to someone on the telephone where you can't see them you can close your eyes and notice what sounds are in the background on the other end of the phone call, you can pay closer attention to the sounds they are making including the way they are speaking rather than just noticing the words that they

are saying.

When Can This Be Helpful?

When you are talking with someone, they will use certain words to convey what they are talking to you about, but there is also information carried in the way that they are saying things. Feelings and emotions are carried through the sound of the voice. If there is tension in their body this can restrict their breathing which in turn can make them use fewer words between breaths. If they are relaxed, they may be doing long and comfortable breaths and so able to do far more words between breaths while they talk.

You can get an idea for what is going on inside the mind and body of the person you are talking with or listening to. You can recognise when someone is beginning to get annoyed, angry or anxious by the changes in their voice before perhaps even they consciously realise they are starting to get angry or anxious.

You can also learn to identify other information from the way people talk. For example, are they marking out any specific words or phrases or syllables which have relevance and are revealing to the current conversation or situation they are in?

The psychiatrist Milton Erickson had a medical doctor that he knew come to him for therapy. The doctor walked in and sat down, and as soon as he was seated Erickson asked how long he had been cheating on his wife for and who the woman was that he was seeing.

Erickson had picked up on cues which led him to this conclusion. The doctor knew Erickson and so didn't hide that he was having an affair, but said he wasn't going to reveal any details to him about who he was seeing.

They began talking about what the doctor wanted therapy for, then part way through the session Erickson picked up his phone, made a telephone call and asked for the person who the doctor was having an affair with.

Erickson had noticed that as the doctor was talking about what he was in therapy for he was trying not to reveal who he was having an affair with, but by trying not to reveal the name he

inadvertently put extra emphasis on certain syllables which Erickson picked up on and recognised they formed a name.
As well as noticing auditory changes within people and the way they speak you can notice changes within other sounds and what these mean.
As a teenager the psychiatrist Milton Erickson was struck down with Polio. His parents were told he would be dead by the morning, but he didn't die. He slipped into a coma for a while. After coming out of the coma he was paralysed so he spent a lot of time listening to the world around him. He taught himself to identify the sounds of various family members approaching his room. He listened to their footsteps and mastered this, so he took his self-learning to the next level. He started to pay attention to variations in the sounds of their walking to work out what mood they were in. As months passed, he was able to get a lot of information just from the sound of people walking to his room.
And so it is with you, you can practise and hone your skills so that you can pick up an incredible amount of information from the sounds around you.
Increasing your auditory acuity can help you make judgments about things happening around you. You can notice for example changes to walking patterns of people around you, which could be relevant for example if someone was following you. You can get better at noticing what direction sounds come from and how the sounds change depending on other changes in the environment.
Sounds travel differently through hot air versus cold air, they travel differently through different materials, you can notice that running hot water sounds different to running cold water.
As with what was taught about visual acuity you can set up situations so that you know what to look out for to help you identify information, so for example if you are trying to identify whether someone is telling the truth about something you can ask them a series of questions you know the answer to already and know they will answer honestly before asking them the question you don't know they will answer honestly or not.

Exercise

There are two exercises you can do to practise and improve your auditory acuity. They are similar exercises to the ones we covered in the visual acuity chapter but focusing on auditory acuity. You will need to have a friend or someone to practise with.

Exercise 01

For the first exercise sit with your back to the person you are practising with, then ask them to think of three different things, two of those things are to be truthful and one of them is to be a lie. Each thing should be something they can say in a short sentence, like thinking of three things they have done, and two are true, one is false. They then say these three things in any order and your job is to notice the auditory differences between the true statements and the lie. Sometimes it can help to close your eyes while you listen to them talking so that you can pay the auditory information your full attention.

It doesn't matter if you don't get it right at first, you are practising and learning to notice differences. People often find themselves better at detecting certain sensory information over other information. So, some people are good at visual acuity, some better at auditory acuity and others better at kinaesthetic acuity.

Exercise 02

The second exercise is to sit back-to-back with someone, and this time have them think of a positive, happy memory, and a negative memory but not something which could significantly upset them. Once they have thought of both memories ask them to think of the positive memory and while they have that memory in their mind ask them to count out loud from 1 to 10. Then ask them to look around the room and break the state, and then to think of the negative memory and once this is in their mind count out loud from 1 to 10.

Once they have done this, you can ask them to do it again a few

more times if needed, but when you are ready, ask them to think of either the positive or the negative memory and once they have that memory in their mind ask them to count out loud from 1 to 10 and then your job is to listen and identify which memory you think it was - either the positive or the negative memory that they were just thinking about while counting.

The more you carry out these practice exercises the better able you become at recognising subtle auditory changes when people are communicating.

KINAESTHETIC ACUITY

Kinaesthetic acuity is how well you can notice kinaesthetic information. This is something most people don't often think about, that you can gain information from kinaesthetically. What I'm going to include here is not just about physical touch, but also emotional touch.

What Can You Notice?

When you are physically in contact with someone you can notice temperature changes from the other person, you can pick up on their micro-movements, pressure changes and changes to muscle tonicity. You can also feel what feels like an energy field around the person.

Even when you aren't touching the person you can feel what feels like an energy field around the person and you can hone in on this and pick up on changes to this energy field. You can even use this energy field and touch as a way of helping to heal someone using an ideo-dynamic approach, which is an approach that uses automatic, rather than conscious processes.

When Can This Be Helpful?

There are many forms of martial arts which have practices to help build kinaesthetic awareness where you make physical contact with the opponent and you feel the movement and respond to what you are feeling. Building up kinaesthetic acuity

can help you in situations where someone is being aggressive and you are in physical contact with each other.

In these moments you can feel through the point of contact you have with each other where tension and relaxation is within the body of the other person, you can feel signs of movement and you can feel sensations based on thoughts and emotions the person is having. Through all this you can respond and adapt faster to the person and change what you are doing to counter what they are doing at the earliest stages of them doing something different. You can also begin to feel the presence of people around you and notice this increase the closer they are to you.

You can increase your ability to recognise emotions in situations, so you can walk into a room and feel the emotions from those in that room, and if your mind is clear and you don't have emotion at the time, you can pick up what those emotions are.

Some of the ways that your kinaesthetic abilities can be used to help others include communicating through touch. If you touch someone on the shoulder who is tense, in a firm comfortable grip, breathe in at the same time as them and then breathe out at the same time as them while also softening and relaxing your grip and your muscles you can communicate this into the person and they relax also. This kind of approach can also work well for helping children to relax, as can stroking their arm in time with their breathing and then making the strokes longer or slower so that their breathing begins to slow and deepen.

When you read muscle movements what you are doing is something called psychophysiological thought reading (Banachek & Burlingame, 2002). This is what you see magicians like Derren Brown do when doing tricks like asking someone to hide something, and then holding their wrist lightly, or holding their shoulder lightly and asking them to think about the object they have hidden and focus on where it is and keep that location and that object in mind. While they do this the magician will gently move the person or their arm around and

will notice changes to the muscles when they are in the right direction.
Another change you can notice in people is how strong or weak they are. In some disciplines this happens as muscle testing, where you ask someone to hold their arm out and if you push down on their arm while they are thinking about something negative their arm will be significantly weaker than normal. Push down on their arm when they are thinking about something positive and their arm will be significantly stronger than normal and thinking about neutral thoughts their strength will be somewhere in the middle.
You can use this as a therapeutic approach where you have someone focus on their problem, push on their arm to demonstrate the person's current strength, then ask the client to rest their hand on the palm of your hand and to draw healing energy from you to heal that problem, and then after they have done their inner healing, you can have them hold their hand out again, test the strength of their arm now and they can notice how much stronger they are when thinking about that thing they have just worked on having addressed their problem.
Being aware of this connection between positivity and strength, and negativity and weakness can give you insights if you are touching someone while talking to them. If there are negative 'away from' thoughts, like thinking about problems, or anxieties, then they will show weakness at those times, whereas when they are thinking about positive 'towards' thoughts the muscles will be stronger. It could be that you are talking to them while shaking hands, or you could be holding a partner's hand while the two of you are talking.

Exercise
There are two exercises you can do to practise and improve your kinaesthetic acuity. They are similar exercises to the ones we covered in the previous acuity chapters but focusing on kinaesthetic acuity.
You will need to have a friend or someone to practise with.

Exercise 01

For the first exercise sit facing the person you are practising with, then ask them to think of three different things, two of those things are to be truthful and one of them is to be a lie. In this exercise you will be only asking them to think these things, there is no need for them to say anything out loud. Once they have thought of three things, put out one of your hands and have them put out the hand opposite your hand. Touch your hands together so that your palms and fingers are touching. Then let them know they can think of the three things in any order. Have them think of the first thing, then tell them to look around the room for a moment and stop touching hands for a moment to break state, then have them think of the second thing, and again then ask them to look around the room and stop touching hands to break state, and have them think of the third thing, then tell them which you think was the lie. It is sometimes easier to do this with your eyes closed so that you can pay the physical sensations your full attention.

It doesn't matter if you don't get it right at first, you are practising and learning to notice differences. People often find themselves better at detecting certain sensory information over other information. So, some people are good at visual acuity, some better at auditory acuity and others better at kinaesthetic acuity.

Exercise 02

The second exercise is to sit the same again, both face to face and again you will have the palms of one hand touching, and this time have them think of a positive, happy memory, and a negative memory, but not something which could significantly upset them. Once they have thought of both memories, touch hands like in the last exercise and ask them to think of the positive memory, while they are doing this you will pick up what that feels like. Then ask them to look around the room and break the state and stop touching hands for a moment, and then touch hands again and ask them to think of the negative memory while you pick up what this feels like.

Once they have done this, you can ask them to do it again a few more times if needed, but when you are ready, touch hands and ask them to think of either the positive or the negative memory and then your job is to feel and identify which memory you think it was - either the positive or the negative memory, that they were just thinking about.

The more you carry out these practice exercises the better able you become at recognising subtle physical changes when people are communicating.

NOTICING PATTERNS

All communication contains patterns, so when you are watching someone, to be able to apply all of the sensory acuity skills and knowledge you have been learning, you are going to want to put it together somehow, so you will be recognising patterns within their behaviour and you will be looking for those patterns.

One thing which is very common is patterns being metaphorical. We are used to the idea of metaphors being used through speech, we are used to people saying things like 'I feel stuck in a rut' or 'I'm a bit like a car alarm, I'm so sensitive to these things, it is like my anxiety levels just keep exploding at the slightest incident.'

And so, we use metaphors in our everyday speech. What people often don't focus on is how we use metaphors physically and non-verbally. So, when you are observing people, you can notice metaphorical patterns play out. In a therapy situation it could be that I'm sat opposite a client and I'm talking to them about something and I'll notice them push back on their chair and I'll realise that they have just dug their heels in. They are nodding to me, they are smiling and they are trying to show that they are engaging with me and that they are behaving how they feel they are supposed to be behaving in therapy, but they are also digging their heels in. So, I know that whatever that issue is that we were just talking about, something about it means that they are digging their heels in, and that only comes from

watching them as a whole being, watching them from their head, right down to their feet and seeing what is going on and being mindful of exactly what I'm saying and doing at the time and what is going on in the communication between us.

Another example is that I could be working with someone and I may ask a question about their relationship and they might rub the back of their neck and perhaps even grimace a little as they tell me that everything is fine in their relationship. Yet there may be something about the relationship and the person we are talking about who is a pain in the neck, despite them saying everything is fine and there are no problems in the relationship. But by watching them you notice the way they rub their neck, and are aware that pain in the neck is a common metaphor people use, and this client seems to be acting out the metaphor.

It could be that I'm working with a parent who is talking about their child and they start doing a 'wringing something out with their hands' metaphor and so I wonder whether they are physically acting out the metaphor of wringing a child's neck.

Or when someone is feeling guilty and they do a hand washing movement with their hands perhaps down on their lap and so you notice that they may be trying to wash the guilt away, they are trying to clean their hands.

Or maybe someone presents with a pain in their shoulder and states they struggle to move it much due to the pain and it turns out it is a metaphor in relation to them wanting to give someone a 'cold shoulder' but they aren't expressing these views and actually doing this, so they internalise it and develop the cold shoulder as a psychosomatic expression.

There are all of these metaphors which go on which we use verbally in our everyday communication, and so from an auditory acuity perspective you would be listening out for these throw away remarks and certain words that they use that you think could be linked to specific metaphors, especially common metaphors.

Visually you are looking for visual representations of metaphors, which could be things like people having a sense of

being stuck in a rut and they may try to shift their chair where they are sat and yet they don't seem to move it, or they may stumble over their feet, so you are looking for the person physically acting out metaphors.

Something else which you can look for visually is hand gestures. Hand gestures are very important. We do hand gestures where we mark things out, we may say 'right I've got these three things which I need to do' and they do three gestures marking the three things out.

So, you can then think that those three things seem to be important to the person. Maybe they say something like 'I've got to get some kind of a hold on things' and they seem to gesture as if gathering everything up or grasping something, which can give away more details about what they are thinking about and meaning or wanting as help.

You can notice what hand gestures people are using and what this can teach you, as it is information they are conveying, but not necessarily through words.

People may also gesture pushing things away, or pulling things towards them, or marking out their perspective of time, like the past behind them or to the left and the future in front or to the right. And you can notice how they mark out words with slight tonal shifts or vocal changes or with other ways of marking things out, like head movements.

Milton Erickson worked in a psychiatric hospital and while he was in the hospital there was someone there who just spoke word salad, so that is essentially someone just seeming to say random words. And this was one of the patients, and they were just saying random words and no-one could understand him and he also just wrote random words, so no-one could understand what he wrote.

Milton Erickson was fascinated by this and wondered what was going on here, he wondered whether there was meaning that nobody had noticed or understood. He looked at the person's written work and noticed that the person had gone over some of the words with his pen slightly rougher or harder than the rest of the text, so Erickson took those words and put them

together and realised that it formed a sentence that this person was trying to convey.

Erickson started to write out word salad back to this person, but used the person's own pattern of writing certain words with the same emphasis in reply to the sentences. He gave this to the person and the patient would read that and would then write more pages of word salad and some of the words would be emphasised in this word salad and Erickson would then reply to this with his word salad with emphasised words and they developed a word salad dialogue where Erickson and the patient would write their word salad messages with emphasised words within the random words. Over a number of months, they started holding normal conversations with each other and the patient got well enough to leave the hospital and go home.

There are ways that people communicate that they often don't even realise. So, when you are looking at text, say someone writes you pages of notes they have taken during a course, you can look through the notes and notice whether there are certain words written in a different way to the rest of the text, and if there are, what does that mean? What was being communicated at that time, what was going on in those moments which meant those words ended up being written differently? What did that mean to that individual?

It isn't like graphology books which would teach you that when you see this type of writing it means this, it is, what does this mean to this individual that you probably know. What do you know about them and what does this mean in context with them as a human being?

You can start to look for patterns, look for clusters of behaviours and draw together all of your sensory acuity. What are the feelings you are getting, or if you are in physical contact, what are the physical feelings you are getting? What auditory information are you picking up on? What visual information are you picking up on here? And then you can put all of that together and combine it and look for what is really going on with the client. You are looking for the patterns across all of the senses. And as you keep practising this, you get better at

noticing it and you get better at noticing patterns that go on and noticing these clusters of patterns.

The important thing is to keep practising those exercises and ideally practising those exercises with different people as often as possible and then starting to use these techniques, just observing, become a people watcher, sit down in cafes and restaurants, bars and other public places and just observe people.

And while sitting in parks or other outdoor spaces, you can practise closing your eyes and just listen to people walking towards you and with your eyes closed, listen to the person walking and think, what can I discern about that individual based on hearing them walking towards me? And as they approach and get near to you and are perhaps in front of you, you can open your eyes and see how accurate you were with what you had worked out or assumed about them as they walked nearer to you.

OPEN AWARENESS MEDITATION

In this chapter I'm going to finish off sharing a guided meditation with you which you can record for yourself to help you to open up your senses, help you to increase your awareness. This meditation is also available to listen to in my FourGames eCourse.

Make sure when you experience meditation that you are in a location where you can sit down, close your eyes and just drift and relax for a moment. Only listen to meditations when you can pay them your full attention.

Meditation

Take a moment to sit down, close your eyes, make sure your legs aren't crossed, because if you have your legs crossed, sometimes you can shut off some circulation and it can get uncomfortable. So, you just want to be comfortable while you listen to this, and as you sit there listening to me, just allow yourself to breathe in and breathe out.

And make each out-breath slightly longer than each in-breath. Breathing in and breathing out. Making those out-breaths slightly longer than each in-breath. And as you continue to breathe in that way, so you can begin to drift into your mind and begin to notice the top of your head, notice what it feels like.

And just allow your attention to move down the top of your head around your forehead, relaxing the muscles down the side of your face, around the back of your head, relaxing the muscles further, around the cheeks, around the eyes, around the jaw, relaxing those muscles deeper and deeper. And allowing that relaxation to pass down through the neck almost like a healing warm light of relaxation passing down through your neck to your shoulders, and then as you breathe in and breathe out, allow that relaxation to pass into your shoulders, down towards your fingertips. Down both arms towards your fingertips, relaxing you deeper and more comfortably, and then allowing that attention to pass down your back, down your chest, down your front, all the way down through your body.
Having that relaxation pass comfortably down through your body, deeper and deeper through your body, that's it.
Deeper and deeper.
And then allow that relaxation to continue down your legs, down both legs, all the way down to the tips of your toes, all the way down both legs. And then just imagine and have a sense of a light passing in the top of your head, passing down through your body. All the way down and out of your feet, out of your hands, connecting back with the earth beneath you.
And then starting from your heart, just imagine your heart beating and pulsing. its magnetic field out from your body, pulsing that magnetic field wider and wider around your body, gaining awareness through that magnetic field of your surroundings, like you have a force field just around you that helps you increase your awareness through your senses.
And have a sense of turning up awareness, turning up awareness to your vision. Imagine almost like you can see things magnified. It's like you can see dials in front of you and on that screen in front of you with those dials, you can turn the dials up. So ordinarily they're set to around a hundred and you can turn them up a bit more, increasing your visual awareness. Making it so that you can see finer distinction between colours, a broader range of colours. You can see finer details like your attention is drawn to those details as you enter a relaxed,

heightened state of awareness, and this can happen here and now, and it can also happen at those times where you decide to relax your shoulders, defocus your eyes, and allow yourself to enter that heightened state of awareness.

And you can allow yourself to enter that heightened state of awareness, perhaps by counting down in your mind from 3, 2, 1, accessing that heightened state of awareness. And at any time you feel a need to have that heightened state of awareness, you can defocus your eyes, take some deep breaths, relax your body and just count in your mind from 3, 2, 1, and accessing that heightened state of awareness where you can see clearer, where you notice movement easier and effortlessly. Where your ears can hear a broader spectrum and differentiate finer detail and notice subtle shifts and changes in tonality in the way things are said. Where physically you increase your ability to sense the world around you. You feel energy. You feel pressure. You can notice pressure changes, atmospheric pressure changes. You can notice pressure changes of objects near you, and you increase your physicality, your ability to sense the world around you.

You increase your sense of touch. Like being able to touch some glass and slide your fingers along a sheet of glass, and rather than feeling that glass as being smooth and flat, when you touch that glass, your fingertips can be so sensitive that you can feel the lumps and bumps on that glass. You can increase your sense of smell, being able to differentiate a far wider spectrum of smells, being able to smell things far more sensitively. and all of your senses can be increased, can be heightened, and you can allow those changes to happen within you. allow those changes to happen and I don't know whether that will happen more with each out-breath or the spaces between my words or with each in-breath as you drift into that heightened state of awareness.

As you access that heightened state of awareness where when you open your eyes, colours can appear sharper, more vivid, light can appear brighter, where your ears can hear clearer. And all of your senses are enhanced, and you can always keep in

mind that to enhance all your senses significantly, all you have to do is breathe in that calm way, defocus your eyes, and count from 3, 2, 1 in your mind, counting from 3, 2, 1, in your mind, that it.

And in a moment, holding on to this heightened sense of awareness, you can open your eyes and notice the world around you. Notice the brightness of the room. Notice the crispness of colours, the clarity of sounds. Notice the changes. And you can undo this effect by counting 1, 2, 3. And you can induce this with 3, 2, 1. That's it. And so you can take a moment of silence, and after a moment of silence you can drift back to the room with that heightened state of awareness, opening your eyes and experiencing that. That's it. Coming back to the room with that heightened sense of awareness now and opening your eyes. That's it.

LIVING IN BALANCE WITH THE WORLD

In this chapter we are going to look at how to live in balance with the world. We will look at why this is important, what can be gained by living in balance with the world around you and how living in balance can increase happiness, health and wellbeing, and reduce the chances of experiencing anxiety conditions, depression and other psychological and wellbeing problems.

The way we approach life influences our experience of the world. Some ways of thinking and being promote wellness and reduce the chances of experiencing depression, anxiety and other conditions. Throughout the next few chapters, we will be looking at what those ways of thinking and being are and the benefits of this.

All Things Are Connected

Many people think of things as all being separate. They talk about 'them and us', 'mind and body', 'life and inanimate', 'man and beasts'. This isn't really the case, within ourselves we aren't a mind and a body, we are a whole being, we have a philosophical, spiritual element to ourselves, this can influence and drive how we live our lives, what we see as important and how we connect to the world around us, so our spiritual, philosophical self influences thoughts and behaviours and our

experience of reality, our mind expands and learns and the thoughts we have influence our spiritual and philosophical self, and influence our body.

Think that you will be ill or unfit or that you are getting old, and you increase the chances of being ill, unfit and ageing faster. Spend your time worrying about things and this can disrupt the digestive system and the sleep system leading to conditions like irritable bowel syndrome and insomnia. The behaviours you do and what is going on with your body can influence your mind. You can sit around all day, never doing any exercising or physical activity and this can lead to depression, reduced IQ and increased worrying.

As well as being connected as a mind-body-spirit we are part of the world around us. A smile when walking past someone can create changes in that other person and increase their wellbeing, deciding to litter and pollute harms the environment and effects the balance of the environment, which can lead to species we've never paid attention to dying out due to our interaction with the world around us and due to our beliefs and values we place on the world around us.

Many years ago, I allowed someone to hypnotise me and in a deep trance I was asked questions about the nature of reality (the transcript of one of these sessions is included in the chapter 'Teachings from the Unconscious'). One of the insights from the non-conscious part of me was how all things are connected, the non-conscious part of me said that a fish is in water, but the fish isn't the water, whereas everything is in the universe but the universe doesn't stop at our skin, like water stops near the skin of the fish, we are part of the universe, and if you zoomed in with a microscope you see everything in the universe is made up of the same fundamental elements, the only thing that makes things seem different is how those fundamental elements are organised. At the smallest scales space, including the space within all things, is a foam of particles continuously appearing and disappearing. If I move my arm, my arm doesn't move through space, my arm is space.

There is an idea that tries to link physics and consciousness

called panpsychism which states that the fundamental ingredients for consciousness are contained within all things. I believe consciousness is the electromagnetic force and when it is organised in a way that allows for synchronised organised electromagnetic waves consciousness arises.

Electromagnetism permeates everything in the universe. We are all connected and we all started out as energy, which eventually became single atoms and as time progressed, went on to become more complex combinations of atoms, until the complexity increased enough to create life.

All things have value, both living and inanimate. We are in a careful balance with everything around us. Life has significant value and comes with responsibility because life can transform the world around it, and more intelligent life can have a significant impact on the world around it, so having that ability to impact on the environment and on other life-forms comes with responsibility to respect the world around us and our role in that world, and to do what we can to create and keep harmony or balance in the world.

Every one of us is the product of a series of miracles. If the conditions of the universe were slightly different, we wouldn't be here. If a planet hadn't crashed into the early Earth and created the moon we probably wouldn't be here. If many of the extinction events that have happened over the billions of years of life evolving on Earth we probably wouldn't be here. It was only when the dinosaurs were wiped out that mammals had the opportunity to start filling new niches and growing into larger mammals and eventually humans.

And even over the last few generations your being you is a miracle, your mothers dad's father had to meet your mothers dad's mother, your mothers mum's father had to meet your mother's mother's mother, your father's dad's father had to meet your father's dad's mother, and your father's mum's father had to meet your father's mum's mother, they all had to have children with the exact eggs and sperm and at the exact time that they did as anything different would lead to a different child being born and a child at a different age who would then

lead a different life and so those children would be unlikely to all grow up and all meet and become your grandparents.

Your mother's father and mother's mother had to meet and have a child exactly as they did, and your father's father, and your father's mother had to also meet and have a child exactly as they did. Then the conditions had to be right for your mother and father to meet, and they too had to have a child, you, exactly as they did. If there were any differences you wouldn't have been born.

This is only describing the three generations that came before you and there had to be exact events occurring for eight people in your great-grandparent's generation, four in your grandparent's generation and two in your parents' generation. If you trace back one generation further there are 16 people who had to have exact events occurring for them to be your great-great grandparents, a generation before that and it is 32 more people requiring exact events, a generation before that and it is 64 more people, and the one before that is 128 more people requiring exact events if they are to be your ancestors, and this is only 8 generations, which probably spans about 200 years of family history. The number of people requiring exact events to meet and conceive at just the right times doubles with each generation, so you can imagine as you track back over hundreds and into thousands of years of ancestors how many events had to happen exactly as they did for you to be born as you, and how remarkable and miraculous this is that all of those events happened leading to you.

When you talk to your parents, grandparents, or great-grandparents you can hear their stories about life events and things which happened which could have gone differently. Sometimes very differently, sometimes just slightly differently, and if any of those things happened you wouldn't be here. For example, it could be that one set of your grandparents met at a school dance. Your granddad may say he looked across the dance floor and saw your nan there and so went over to speak to her. What would have happened if just as he looked across the dance floor someone got in the way of his line of sight and

so he didn't see your nan? Or if she had to wait a bit longer in a queue to get into the dance hall and so ended up standing somewhere else because the space she stood in wasn't the space she found this time? So just this one event could have gone so differently and with a small change they wouldn't have met, one of your sets of grandparents never would have been together so one of your parents never would have been born.

Not only is it a miracle that you are here existing as you, but we are all only here for a short time, so it is good to ask yourself what will be your legacy? How do you want to be remembered, what contribution do you want to have made to the world around you, what do you want to have done with your life?

It is good to behave like the person you want to be even if this isn't the person you are currently. When you behave as if in this way it begins to alter you as a being, and you begin to become the person you are acting as if you are.

I remember reading about the psychiatrist Milton Erickson working with someone with schizophrenia, they said he wouldn't be able to treat them, many doctors had already failed to help him, Erickson agreed, and said 'as you know I can't help you, and I know I can't help you, and you don't want to be sent to any more psychiatrists and I have a reputation to uphold would you be willing to pretend to be well whenever you are in public? You can continue to display your schizophrenic symptoms when you are alone at home, but at least when people see you, they will think you are better.' The patient agreed to this, then months later the patient contacted Erickson to say he has a problem, he is struggling to know whether he is the schizophrenic with problems, or the person without problems. Erickson asked him which he wanted to be, he said the one without problems, and this is what he became.

MINDFUL LIVING

In this chapter we are going to look at the importance of mindful living, at attachment, living in the moment and being aware of future potentials.

Attachment

Attachment is about what we allow ourselves to connect with. Often people are taught about non-attachment. This is something which isn't ideal for most people in everyday life. I prefer to talk about guided attachment. It is about learning to master what you are attached to and what you decide not to attach to. With non-attachment the aim is to detach from earthly desires, so you wouldn't have hate, anger, jealousy, or love. If you are living in an environment which is compatible with being able to live a non-attached life then this could be fine, but most of us live in a world where we need to have some attachments, and where we may want to have other attachments. For example, we may decide we need to be attached to earning money because we need to pay bills and need to keep a roof over our heads, we may have reasons for wanting to live in the property we live in, we may have to work to earn that money even though we would like to be giving our attention to leading a more non-attached way of life.

We may be attached to learning and so want books, DVDs, or internet access to access knowledge, we may be attached to a

loved one, or loved ones, like a partner or family and friends and we may not want to let go of these attachments.
I teach guided attachment as an alternative to non-attachment. The idea is that you practise attaching to healthy things which bring you contentment and detach from, and don't do things which bring you negative feelings. You may decide to be attached to those you love, and to a few things which benefit you and bring you contentment, and decide not to attach to those things which lead to negative feelings. Some things may not make you happy but you may have to do them anyway. It could be that you do a job which you dislike, but you decide you have to do the job for the benefits it brings, and perhaps it's not a job which goes against your morals and ethics, so you do the job, but detach from the negative feelings you have about the job. You don't spend your non-work time thinking about the job and while you are at work you focus on doing the job, not on thinking about the job, or feeling about the job.

Living in the Moment

Every minute of the day you have a choice about what you are going to think about and where you are going to focus your attention. You could focus on the past, on the present or on the future, and focusing on the present you can decide to focus on the experience you are having here and now, or on what may be going on elsewhere.
There is nothing wrong with reminiscing and remembering the past, or imagining future possibilities, or being curious about what may be happening elsewhere, but you want to spend most of your time focused on this moment now, and on just doing what you are doing in this moment, not analysing this moment and questioning what you are doing and how you are doing it, and giving judgements to your experience of this moment now, but just being in this moment and accepting this moment for what it is and just doing.
When you do decide to reminisce, this is best being positive rather than anxiety-based. If you look back over negative memories you get more value out of it when you are looking

back at what you can learn and what would have been helpful to know back then which would have made a difference. Remember, the past has been and gone and no longer exists, the future hasn't happened, and the present is the gift you are given now.

If you worry about the future and negative things which may be there you are robbing yourself of the present. It is good to plan. Many people think worry is bad, in fact all emotions have their place. Worry is the first half of the problem-solving process we have evolved to do. It is just that some people get stuck in this stage rather than moving on from the identifying potential risks stage and into the 'what can be done to remove or minimise these risks' stage.

Depression stops you in your tracks to give you the opportunity to address issues you haven't been dealing with in your life, anger helps you have the strength to tackle a threat and get safe, anxiety helps you to escape threats, and addictions use the brain's processes for habit formation. All of these problems are helpful when they are in the correct context, and only a problem when these processes have become faulty or unhealthy for some reason.

So, thinking about what someone may think of you and letting this build up into anger is a faulty use of anger, developing a habit of smoking because you think smoking helps you to relax is a faulty and unhealthy habit, and being depressed but not taking that opportunity to address and solve your problems will keep you depressed.

Learning how to detach from things which are unhealthy and faulty can help prevent and lift some of these problems. For example, recognising that you have started thinking about what you think someone thinks about you and so deciding to detach from this thinking and focus on this moment here and now instead, will stop that thinking and so will stop the progression towards anger.

The easiest way to create attachment and non-attachment is to focus on what you want to attach to, give it your full undivided attention, allow yourself to become absorbed in the moment.

This stops your attention being on anything else, and if you notice your attention drift away from exactly what you are doing in this present moment and what you want to attend to in the present moment, then recognise this and bring your attention back to where you want to be focused. It doesn't work to push something out of your awareness, as pushing it means you are paying it attention. You want it to be like watching clouds drift by in the sky whilst you are just relaxing under a tree gazing up at the sky. Not attaching to any clouds or giving any clouds meaning, but being aware that they are there and that they don't require your attention, and so attending to just being in the moment relaxing under that tree.

If something keeps coming up in your mind because it needs addressing, think about the time you will take action and address it, then you can focus on what you want to be focusing on in the moment and that thing you need to address will have its own moment when you will address it in the future.

Aware of Future Potentials

Being mindful and living in the moment, doesn't mean neglecting the future. If you dismissed the future, you would have no purpose, nothing you are trying to gain with your life. You would also potentially not see problems coming and so not be able to work out solutions. In life we have regular future events which we have to be mindful of, but we don't have to give them our full attention, or an excess of attention. We will have bills to pay, we may have to give some time and thought to where we will get the money from to pay those bills, if we have children they may be going back to school at the end of the summer holidays and some time will need to be given to preparing for this, to sorting out school uniforms and equipment and back to school plans, but you don't want to spend the whole summer holiday thinking about the children going back to school and none of the summer holiday living in the moment with your children here and now. You can be aware of future potentials, of different possibilities and how you can best respond to those different possibilities, but not get

stuck focusing on the future at the expense of the present.
As an exercise you can think about who you want to be? Think about what your life's legacy will be, and act as if you are the person you want to be. To live mindfully and live in the moment you need to have a sense of who this person you hope to be is so that you don't have to spend all of your time thinking about this, you just have a sense of it and know that what you are doing moment by moment is in line with who you want to be and how you want to be remembered. If you want to be remembered as someone kind and compassionate, who put others first and showed respect to others and all things, then knowing this means from moment to moment you can lead a life doing things which are authentic and congruent with that version of yourself. You don't have to be always thinking about how you want to be remembered or who you want to be, you just need to do the thoughts and behaviours which are in line with this and people and yourself will know you as this person.
If you find your thoughts getting drawn to unhelpful thoughts or strong emotions you can use breathing as an intermediate stage, you can bring your attention to your breathing, focus on breathing slowly and calmly in and out with each out-breath being slightly longer than the in-breath. This triggers the relaxation response which helps to calm and focus your mind on the present moment. Once you have done this and moved your thoughts from what you didn't want to be thinking about, you can now focus on what you are doing in this present moment.

FORGIVENESS AND COMPASSION

Over the twenty-five plus years that I have worked in the caring profession I have encountered a wide range of individuals from a variety of backgrounds. I also have a lifetime of personal experiences all of which have required me to make decisions about forgiveness and compassion.

One lesson I've lived my entire life by has been to forgive everyone, but not to forget. When you don't forgive people, the only person holding onto the anger is you. This anger can start to eat away at you, it can start to affect your immune system, how your body functions, the stress of holding onto the anger can even begin to accelerate your ageing.

Very often the person you are angry with and haven't forgiven has moved on and is unaware that inside your head you are filling your time with negative thoughts relating to them.

I remember when I was about 20 years old a work colleague became homeless following the loss of his job so I let him live with me. A couple of weeks later he stole lots of my property and left. I didn't hold anything against him, I forgave him for this straightaway and hoped that he found somewhere to live and got back perhaps closer to his home town.

I have been cheated on and left by people I have been in a relationship with. I have always forgiven straight away. It doesn't change anything or benefit anyone to be angry and to hold on

to that anger in situations like this.
By forgiving everyone I don't hold on to any anger or hate, I don't cloud my thinking and my judgements. By not forgetting I protect myself from future harm or problems. I learn and know what I will and won't do in relation to different people. I know that although I would give that person a roof over his head again if he needed it because that is the compassionate correct thing to do, I would be aware of what he did before and so may not leave him alone in my home, or might make some other decisions about making sure the same thing doesn't happen again, and I would be unlikely to end up back in a relationship with someone who cheated on me because I would be aware of what they did and aware they may do the same again, and if I did decide to get back into a relationship with them I would be aware it is a possibility and think about what I can do to minimise the chances of it happening again, for example, maybe because I am autistic and so I struggle to be as emotionally close to a partner as perhaps they would expect in a relationship and maybe this was one of the key reasons for them cheating on me and leaving me I may work on what I can do to demonstrate emotional closeness to them.
What I wouldn't do is spend my time in the relationship worrying about whether they are cheating on me or not and getting jealous or paranoid as this is very toxic to a healthy relationship. I would trust the person as much as I always did and wouldn't judge them based on their past.
In work situations I have had to work with people who have done some of the most horrific crimes and sometimes boasted in graphic detail about their crimes. I have seen other members of staff I have worked with get angry by what they have heard and what they are aware of about the person and this has clouded their judgement and their ability to show compassion, kindness and respect to the person. This not only has an effect on the person they are working with, but it has a detrimental effect on them as well.
I've worked with wonderful people who have lost their jobs because of their anger, because they hated some of the people

they were caring for because of what those people had done. They let those people get into their mind, which is what some of them tried to do by revealing in graphic detail what they have done and how they felt at the time and the terror and pain that was experienced by the other person. This has got into the mind of the staff member, making them cause pain intentionally to those people. It has clouded the judgement of those staff towards the individuals, so they stop treating them with the same level of kindness, respect and compassion that they would have for someone else and they stop believing those people are deserving of the same human rights as the rest of us.

These members of staff lost their jobs, they held on to their judgemental views and their anger, but were now also angry at the employers who sacked them, despite being sacked because of the harm they caused. They carried out harmful behaviours unaware that these behaviours were clouded by darkness. They felt they hadn't done anything wrong, and didn't see their acts as wrong.

In many cases the same people they hurt in anger, had backgrounds that mirrored the people they said they would help. So, they would be angry at abusers ignoring the knowledge they had about how that abuser had grown up severely abused, while saying they have compassion and want to help those who have been abused.

By forgiving people and having compassion for all living things and the world around you, you automatically give everyone the same level of respect regardless of what they have done or who they are. This reduces negativity in yourself, you don't attach to, or cling on to anger, hate or fear.

Research into happiness has found that doing things for others and giving to society increases happiness (Mental Health Foundation, n.d.). So, by holding on to an attitude of helpfulness and approaching life and the people you meet in life with an attitude of 'how can I help you?' Rather than thinking about what you can get from a situation, will increase your levels of happiness, it also impacts on the perception others have of you.

It is important to remember that you are you, so don't let events change that. We all change as we grow and develop over time where we refine and improve ourselves, but you don't want events to change who you are fundamentally as a being. If you have a bad relationship, that was a bad relationship, look at what you can learn from it, how you can learn from it, but don't let it make you cynical or stop you deciding to have future relationships, or make you decide 'all men (or women) are like that'. It was a moment in time which you can learn from and develop from, but don't let it cloud your future or lead to judgements and decisions being made from a place of fear, anxiety, anger or hate.

You can focus on love and on attaching to being in love, and accept that loss is an inevitable part of life, and once accepted you can deal with it whenever loss happens, but focus on love and compassion and forgiveness.

You can look for the good in others, look for deeper understanding, and recognize that even in people who seem to do the most horrendous things there is a backstory, there is something behind that act, and there are reasons for their acts. You don't have to accept, like, or agree with what others do, but you also don't have to let anger or hate cloud your judgments and drive your actions. Instead focus on love and compassion as the driver for your actions.

EVERYTHING HAPPENS FOR A REASON

There are some things we have control over and can affect and other things we can't. Many problems arise when we start trying to control the things we can't control, and begin expecting the things we have no control over to be different to the way they are.

When you let go of trying to control the uncontrollable and accept that where you are right now is where you are supposed to be, at this moment in time, it is like having a weight lifted from you. It can reduce how often you get frustrated or angry with things not going your way, instead you can feel a sense of acceptance of your situation and of curiosity about why this moment is happening. Instead of focusing on what you don't like about the moment you can start to wonder what this moment means in relation to your story and your purpose.

When we are in moments which we find unpleasant it is common for them to become all-consuming and to feel like they have been going on forever, and to start thinking that they will continue without end. We can get drawn into focusing on the past of the moment and into the perceived future of the moment. This itself increases the intensity of the negative feelings about the moment because you have past remembered negative feelings, current negative experienced feelings, and future perceived negative feelings all taking place in this

moment in time, which is the only true part of our experience. The past has been and gone, the future hasn't happened, so there is only now.

When you think with curiosity about what any given moment means in your personal story and how this aligns with your purpose you can notice things about your situation which at first may not have stood out. Neurologist and Psychiatrist Victor Frankl endured years in a concentration camp during the holocaust in the second world war. One day while walking miles in the cold being pushed along by the butt of a rifle any time he slowed down, and having himself and the man walking next to him leaning on each other just to keep standing, the man next to him commented that he hoped their wives were having a better time than they were. This got Frankl thinking about his wife and started his mind on a train of thought which shaped his future as a psychiatrist. He realised the importance of meaning (Frankl, 2004). He had a lot which was out of his control, he didn't know if he was going to survive, he didn't know if he was going to be punished, starved, or what was going to happen to him, but that didn't mean he couldn't find meaning in the moment. Frankl felt that those without meaning often fall into depression, addiction and aggression.

To know your purpose helps you know your story and where any given moment in time fits within your story. Many people if asked what is the meaning of this negative moment that they have experienced or are experiencing will say something negative, like 'that I need to get out of this job', 'that my manager is a bully and not to be trusted', 'that I don't like doing what I am doing'.

All of these may be true statements, but they aren't accepting that where the person is in this moment could be thought of as where they are supposed to be, and that there is something to be learned from this moment in-line with their story.

Alternatively, the person's purpose could be to help enrich the lives of others, so their story is heading in this direction and the question is how are these same experiences a part of that story, what purpose does this moment in time serve within the larger

story?

It could be that the reason they need to get out of the job is mainly because of the bullying manager. They are looking at alternatives and are willing to put in time and hard work, so they will get out of the job at some point, but they don't know when this will be able to happen, so for now perhaps they are learning how to manage challenging people - if they decide to help others, they will encounter many people who don't agree with them, who are stuck in their problem situation because they push everyone around away and don't accept help. So, this gives them the opportunity to get used to being able to remain calm with these people and develop ways of learning how these people think about things and how to create change with them.

It could be that they just learn how to manage themselves, learning how to remain calm, how to not let the negativity and behaviours of others get to them, or to learn how to leave work and work issues at work, so that they can focus on enjoying home-life and the company of loved ones, or perhaps the situation feels bad so that it helps to motivate them to keep working on their dreams so that they can get out of their job and live their dream, whereas if they didn't mind work, and had a great boss, but had this other dream, maybe they would be the type of person who struggles to motivate themselves and take calculated risks, settling instead for the comfort of familiarity and low risk.

It is important to look for what can be learned from the moment that is helpful and in-line with your personal story. It isn't about dismissing negative experiences as not being bad or wrong, or taking away the severity of the situation, or saying that you shouldn't be upset by situations or angry at the time of some situations etc., it is just about learning to take time to find meaning. I have known people who have been abused, which is wrong and never should have happened and was devastating for the person who was abused, but they have then gone on to find meaning and find how it fits with their story and purpose and they fight for rights, awareness and change, and fight to prevent others being in the same situation they were in.

Victor Frankl found meaning in the concentration camps and helped thousands of people with the psychotherapy he created based on his knowledge and experiences.

I faced workplace discrimination as someone autistic and decided I wanted to try to prevent the same kind of thing happening to others and so educate people about what it is like to live with being autistic and what friends, family, teachers, work colleagues and employers can do to help autistic people rather than discriminate against them. Even the worst moments and our darkest moments can be turned around when we find meaning and a personal positive reason for what is happening to us in that moment.

Although you can't control what happens and what others think and do, you can control how you think, feel and behave. In any situation, somebody else in that same situation may well handle it differently. So, if someone stands up in front of a crowd and feels anxious, a different person standing up in front of that crowd may do so feeling calm and confident. This means it isn't standing up in front of the crowd that makes someone anxious or calm, it is how both people are thinking about the situation differently. By focusing on what you have control over, which is how you are thinking, how you are feeling, and how you are behaving, and deciding how you want to think, feel and behave and then doing this, you take control of the situation. You decide how you interpret the situation, whether you interpret it as negative or a problem, or as part of your story that will help you grow and develop and help you on your journey towards your purpose.

You can practise thinking in a way that will help you find the reason for what is happening in any given moment, and help to reduce negative emotions by thinking of these two questions:

- In relation to my story and purpose, what can I learn from this situation?
- What do I need to think, feel or do in this situation so that I feel content with this moment?

Feeling content isn't the same as accepting what is happening and taking no action, it is taking the action you deem relevant, and thinking and feeling in a way that you feel is relevant for this moment and being content with your decision, so for example, if someone was being mugged, running away towards a busy area with lots of people may be the most appropriate response, or it may be too dangerous to do this and so accepting this and allowing the mugging to take place while taking no action may be the best response, so your 'no action' response is taking action, you are deciding this is the safest and best response to have. Then how you think about it afterwards will be important so that you learn from the experience and think about it in a way that doesn't lead to fear, anger, hate or negative behaviour change.

And then once you have thought about these questions and have an answer to them in your mind you can begin to do the answers you have thought about even if at first you are 'acting as if' rather than believing what you are thinking, feeling and doing.

In this chapter I have used examples which aren't common everyday experiences because people often say 'but that wouldn't be possible in this situation, or in that situation' I wanted to share some situations which are more extreme than most people will be that likely to encounter. I have used examples from my own personal experiences in work, in relationships, and based this last bit on my experience of when a gang tried to mug me.

HUMILITY, GRATITUDE AND ACCEPTANCE

In this chapter we are going to look at the ideas of humility, gratitude and acceptance.

Humility

There is nothing wrong with knowing you are good at something, the key is accepting that you will never be perfect and there are always things to improve, and accepting that whether you are good or 'the best' is irrelevant, you don't want to buy into hype about yourself. The trouble with arrogance is that it spreads. It could be that you are at the top of your game at a sport, people start idolising you because of how good you are, you buy into this hype and start telling yourself you are the best, then people invite you to give talks for lots of money and even though you are an average speaker, which would be expected given you haven't had any training, people are excited to meet you and they praise you and tell you good things and you believe you are an incredible speaker. As time goes on you find yourself in more and more situations where people make you feel like the centre of attention and you begin to increase your perspective of your own self-importance and start having demands and expectations on how people should be around you and who should be allowed to see you, and who has to go through your manager, and how much people should pay for

the privilege of seeing you.

Although this is obviously an example in relation to someone becoming famous and buying into an idea of entitlement, this same process happens among people all the time, it just isn't normally this noticeable or extreme, and it usually starts with somebody receiving lots of praise for something they genuinely are good at.

I remember when I was in my early 20's, I was working in children's homes. I think about things differently to other people so I often found solutions others didn't think of, and even when I didn't find solutions others hadn't thought of I was largely able to calm down or defuse situations, and if situations became violent I was able to handle them with calmness and clarity in a way that was more effective than other staff which made staff want me on their shifts and made me get called to work in homes across England to sort out problems those homes were having with the teenagers.

After a number of years of doing this job, often in excess of 80 hours per week with no days off sick and no significant injuries on shifts, I had a shift where it had reached about 3am. I had been on shift since 8am without a break. The teens were being aggressive and causing trouble. I had tried everything I could think of and nothing was working. I was getting annoyed because I'm Dan Jones. I arrive and sort out everyone's problems and never fail, how can I be failing this time, what am I doing wrong?

I was annoyed with myself for my failure. I telephoned the manager who was on-call that night and explained the situation and asked for their advice. They suggested something really simple and insignificant, which was something I hadn't tried, and hadn't even thought of. I tried what they suggested and it worked, it resolved the situation. This experience taught me to let go of arrogance, let go of my ego, and accept that everybody fails, nobody is perfect, and to ask for help when I need it. I learned that the people I am helping are the important ones, not trying to find ways to make myself look good and to reinforce my image, or to buy into my image, but to accept, like

everyone, I have limitations. It is easy to get so confident in yourself and your abilities that you forget the basics and end up making mistakes.
This is a reason why airline pilots have to do checklists. They are highly skilled people, they may have flown thousands of times and know their job inside out, but air crash investigations have found often the cause of crashes is pilot error. When something is routine, obvious and basic knowledge, it is easily overlooked and it is easy to get it wrong because you don't pay it as much attention as you should. This is why it is important to frequently practise basic skills, because although these will be familiar, they will also be what you are likely to make a mistake about without noticing.
Being humble takes your focus off of yourself and your self-importance, and allows you to put your focus on others and their importance. You are less likely to preach at them about what they should do and how they should do it and how you know best. But instead listen to them and help them find their own path with you just being a guide.

Gratitude

In today's western society which places a lot of focus and emphasis on materialism it can be easy to forget to be grateful for what you have, and to focus on what is truly important. A number of years ago I was involved in a study looking at what adults thought of as happy childhood memories. None of the adults named items they owned as being at the heart of their happy memories. Except for one person the memories were all about playing with parents, or carers and siblings or close friends and family. The one exception was someone recalling the first time they saw the nose cone of a jumbo jet when they were on their way on holiday with family. This was a unique and exciting experience for that individual.
The study was being carried out because of the increasing prevalence of computer games consoles and the reliance on technology for entertainment rather than spending time with family that has been increasing since the late 1970?s.

Participants from 18 to over 60 were involved so about half of the participants would have grown up with computer games and the increase in technology and the conclusion was that if things continue to progress as they are and people spend less time together doing fun activities, like flying kites, or playing in a park with their families, then this could have an impact on current children and teens.

Being grateful helps to reduce stress and improve happiness and wellbeing (Khorrami, 2020). You can be grateful for the life you have had, what you have learned, what you have currently, and for what your future potentially holds. It can be liberating to experience gratitude, to know you are truly grateful. The gratitude shouldn't be focused on material possessions, but on what you have as a being, and grateful for your experiences. There is a story about a Buddhist monk who comes home one day to find a new pair of shoes he bought had been stolen, he was asked if he was annoyed. He replied that he was grateful to have been able to help someone who needed those shoes.

To increase wellbeing and happiness, when you wake up you can start the day telling yourself three things you are grateful for, saying 'I am grateful for... I am grateful for... I am grateful for...' and then you can repeat this when you go to bed, stating what you have been grateful for.

When you wake up you can also say three things you are looking forward to, ideally that day, and they don't have to be large things. Some people who are very depressed, or struggle with very negative thinking may initially have to think further into the future for things they are looking forward to, stating 'I'm looking forward to... I'm looking forward to... I'm looking forward to...'

You can either do this verbally in the morning and evening, or record this in a gratitude journal every morning and evening (Emmons & Stern, 2013).

Acceptance

Many of us recognise parts of ourselves we aren't happy with. This can be aspects of how we look, or it could be aspects of

how we are. Someone may decide they hate the way they worry, or they may hate that their nose isn't straight.

To increase well-being and contentment we can accept ourselves and recognise that all aspects of yourself are natural and a part of who you are. From this place of acceptance, a lot is possible. Many people think that they have problems, when often problems are actually someone's solution to a problem. If you accept yourself for who you are then you can accept that what you perceive as a problem was your own instinctive way of solving the actual problem. If you don't accept yourself for who you are you may decide 'I don't like my anger' for example, and then you may try to cover the anger up or to change the anger, rather than accepting the anger is a part of you, and anger is a natural and valid part of you which is about trying to protect you from something you see as a threat. The question is not whether the anger is good or bad, but about what the anger is being a solution for. It could be that the anger someone experiences as road rage is actually to protect them from a fear of embarrassment of turning up somewhere late. Until accepting that anger is a natural part of the person and that it has a purpose to protect the person from harm the person may not look deeper at themselves to discover this and address the anger problem.

Many people talk about how we shouldn't have or express certain emotions, or that certain emotions are negative, yet we evolved a range of emotions to help us manage the world around us in a way that protects us. The problem is if someone develops an attachment to certain emotions.

Many emotions often seen as negative are natural, healthy responses which are necessary for our survival when they occur at the correct time and place, for the right reason. Anxiety helps us escape threats quickly, freezing in fear helps us 'play dead' when we feel there is very little chance of success out-running or fighting the threat, anger helps us fight the threat so that we have an opportunity to escape. And many psychological problems which are a part of someone are also often solutions to a problem, or hijacking a natural part of who we are.

Depression stops us so that we take time to address what we need to deal with, worry helps us identify risks and things we need to problem-solve, addictions help us make things we do regularly turn into automatic non-conscious habits, and they have often hijacked the reward pathways in the brain which is the part of us that gives us a high when we achieve something, make progress, or discover something new, and this reward process weakens in relation to what we achieved or discovered, so we have to achieve more or discover more to get the high again. This craving for the high can drive the progress of humanity from one discovery or development to another. Obsessive Compulsive Disorder gives us a sense of control, and often safety and security, so if someone starts developing OCD behaviours it is often a sign that there is something in their life which is out of their control, or something they feel is a risk to them or someone they love or care about unless they carry out the behaviour.

GETTING YOUR INNATE NEEDS MET

We all have certain needs which have to be met to lead a balanced life (Maslow, 1943). Our most fundamental needs are making sure we have air to breathe, water to drink and food to eat, then we require shelter, which includes clothes to keep us safer from weather, predators and other threats so that we have somewhere safe that we can relax. When we don't even have these needs met it is very difficult to start looking at building up quality of life beyond this because we still need to be in survival mode to try to survive, rather than being in a place where we can start to thrive.
Our needs can be fulfilled appropriately or inappropriately, and problems can arise when needs are over-met, or under-met.

Some of the main innate needs are:

- To give and receive attention
- To have a sense of security
- To have a sense of control
- To have emotional intimacy
- To feel part of a wider community
- To have a sense of privacy

- To have a sense of status
- To have a sense of competence and achievement
- To have meaning and purpose
- To have a healthy mind-body connection

Everyone has their own unique relationship to these needs. For example, I have a very low level of needing to give and receive attention, so I can go a long time without giving any attention to others and without receiving attention from others, and it isn't a problem to me. Other people need to socialise or mix with people far more frequently. Up to a point this is healthy, but beyond a certain point it can become a problem where the individual demands too much attention to a level which is difficult to fulfil by others.

As an individual you will have your own level of how much your needs require to be met, as will everyone around you. I have worked with families where the main problem is created because the parents expect their teen to want to spend lots of time with their family and are worried because the teen is spending all of their time in their bedroom. They push and push trying to get the teen to leave their room, the teen says they are happy and fine and just want to be in their room, but because they are staying in their room the parents continue to think something is wrong and so continue to harass the teen. When I talk to the teen, they say that the problem is all the parents, that all they want to do is chill-out in their room in peace and have their own space, but the parents keep pestering them.

What I recommend is for parents to knock on the bedroom door, ask if the teen is alright, if the teen says they are okay then say something like 'if you want to talk about anything just come and get me and we can talk' and then leave the room. If there is an issue, which is what they are worried there may be, then the teen has been given a way to address this if they choose to address it, whereas if they continue to try to harass the teen, they will push the teen away more. They are impacting the teens' sense of control over their own situation, their sense of

privacy by always pestering, as well as the level of attention they feel they need in that moment.

If someone isn't getting as much attention as they need then they can start seeking that attention in some way. This could be in a healthy way, like just going to where friends or family are and trying to interact, or it could be an unhealthy way by acting out or creating drama around themselves, or developing a problem where people start to feel sorry for them and although they don't like the problem they have developed, they struggle to overcome it because keeping it gives them attention. They won't have developed the problem necessarily consciously or by choice, but more likely an automatic non-conscious development of the problem. It is a common saying that negative attention is better than no attention at all, and if someone is in need of attention this is true.

We all need to feel a sense of security. As you will probably notice, I often describe these needs as having a sense of, rather than having. This is because the person may not have security, or control as far as an objective observer would see it, but they need to feel like they have these needs met. A sense of security comes in many forms, job security so that someone is comfortable that their income will remain steady and they can pay bills and pay for somewhere they can live, security that where they live is stable, so they don't feel like they could be told to leave their home at any point, they can settle in, make where they live their home and safety from harm. When people don't have this need met, they may experience anxiety and spend most of their time on edge never feeling like they can settle. They could try to escape this uncomfortable feeling of uncertainty by taking up an addiction like drinking alcohol which can take their focus off of their situation. Or they may end up craving the security and get this need over-met in the future with excessive security to make themselves feel safe and their situation feel secure. Often this can be to do with a fear of loss, or due to a fearful situation occurring in the past.

We all need to feel a sense of control within our lives. Some of this crosses over with the security need, being on a zero-hour

contract may make someone lack a sense of control over their lives because they don't know what hours they will get week to week and yet they know how many hours they need to work but have very little control over how many hours of work they get offered. We have very little control over many areas of our lives. Some people are better able than others to accept and be comfortable with uncertainty.

If the need for control isn't met enough some people may crave control and could develop ritualistic behaviours and beliefs, or obsessive-compulsive disorder as a way of having a sense of control and of giving meaning to the areas which they don't have control over.

We all have a need for emotional intimacy. This could be from a close friend or family member, or partner. Everyone has their own level of how much this need needs to be met, some people may need to just know they have someone they can turn to when they are going through emotional challenges, others may need to get that emotional intimacy need met on a regular basis.

We all need to feel a part of a wider community. Many people spend their time trying to show how individual they are, yet at the same time they do things to fit in, so their individual style of clothing is a specific style of dressing which others, even a minority group of people, identify with, few people dress exclusively just in their own style unlike anyone else. They will identify with people who share similar political or spiritual beliefs, or with people who do the same hobby or interest. They will feel like they belong somewhere among some group of people.

When people don't feel like they belong or feel like they fit in with any group they can become depressed and feel lonely and often end up becoming more isolated which makes the problem worse.

People have a need for privacy, they need to have their own space, their own environment, and the freedom to have their own thoughts and feelings and behaviours which they can keep to themselves. Part of this allows the person to have their own identity separate from others so that they can know who they

are, not just who they are when they are around other people. Not getting privacy can lead to craving it and people can start shutting themselves away and cutting people off so that they give themselves privacy. Unfortunately doing this can then reduce them getting other needs met.

We all have a need to have a sense of status. It could be that we are praised in work for how good we are at an aspect of our job, or maybe we have a talent we are known to be good at within our social circle. When this need isn't being met people can do things to create their own status, sometimes in unhealthy ways, so it could be that a teen in school becomes the class clown because they need to have status for something, or someone drinks a lot of alcohol on nights out because they want to be the one who can drink the most, or they overeat to be known as the one who can eat the most.

It can also become a problem when the person is only known for this and as their status, and are dehumanised beyond this, so no-one asks how they are, or what they have been up to, or what they have got planned, all everyone focuses on is having them do what they are known for. Some people like this, others become depressed and start avoiding interacting with people.

We all need to have a sense of competence, achievement, stimulation and creativity. We need to know we are good at something and that we have, are, and will achieve things. Striving to achieve or creating something gives us a high, we want to achieve this stimulation or high. This high reduces with time meaning we only get the same boost of pleasure by achieving slightly more next time or creating something new. If someone leads a life where they aren't trying to achieve and aren't being creative, and where they don't believe they are good at anything and have very little stimulation, they can become depressed and despondent and complain of being bored. Achievement and creativity often leads to meaning and purpose. If what we are trying to achieve or create is too hard this can also cause problems and make us lose motivation, rather than empowering us and increasing motivation.

We have a need for meaning and purpose. We want to know

why we are here, what is the point of it all. If we don't know this, we can find life empty. If we can work this out for ourselves people can end up seeking out external sources to give life meaning and purpose. By not having meaning or purpose we can feel there is no point to any course of behaviour. Why be kind and caring and put others first if there is no reason for doing so? Why not just be selfish and do as you want?

And finally, we have a mind-body connection need. This is about being aware that the mind and body are connected, not two separate entities. If you don't look after your body this can impact on your mind and what you do with your mind can impact on your body. If you worry excessively this can impact on your ability to sleep properly which can impact on the functioning of your immune system, cell repair and other bodily functions, including the functioning of your brain making learning and remembering and being motivated and focused all more difficult. Obviously, the cycle also occurs starting with the body, where you don't sleep for some reason, perhaps an infection, or being too warm at night, or drinking alcohol or coffee, and this has an impact on your mind.

An exercise you can do is to write down these innate needs and go through them and see whether you have any need which you feel isn't being met in a healthy way, and for those needs think about what you can do to begin to meet those needs. Think about any needs which are being over-met which may be causing a problem, and identify what you can do to get those needs back in balance in a healthy way. And what needs are being inappropriately met, like smoking as a way of giving and receiving attention, or to relax (which is a mind-body connection reason), and think about what you can do to get this need met in a healthy way instead.

An example of this is, I worked with a young teenage girl's family. The girl was mixing with inappropriate adult males because she found this exciting and stimulating. The parent had tried everything they could think of to try to get the daughter to stop mixing with the men, but nothing worked. I asked what she

is good at that she enjoys that gives her the same kind of excitement. I was told she was very good at football but hadn't played for a long time because of her behaviour. I suggested they encourage her to go to football regularly. The daughter started attending football regularly and she naturally stopped spending time with the men. She was now getting her need for stimulation met from the football, but also her status need, she was asked to play in different matches and so was getting meaning and purpose from what she was doing, she was giving and receiving attention, she felt part of this community of players. So, this one activity was a compelling alternative to her inappropriate behaviour. She stopped the old behaviour without needing to be told to stop it because she no longer had a need for it.

IDEO-DYNAMIC HEALING - INTRODUCTION & HEALING PRACTICES

Over the next eight chapters we are going to explore ideo-dynamic 'psychocellular' healing. Ideo-dynamic healing is mind-body healing where you engage with non-conscious processes rather than communicating conscious to conscious.

You are bypassing conscious awareness to evoke change and healing from within the individual, so that change happens from the inside out, rather than in the style of most psychological therapies, which work by encouraging change from the outside in.

Ideo-dynamic healing is about using automatic non-conscious responses as the healing modality. So, you have ideo-motor which are automatic, non-conscious movements, ideo-sensory, which are automatic, non-conscious sensations, ideo-cognition, which are automatic non-conscious thoughts, and ideo-affective, which are automatic non-conscious feelings.

I'll give a little background to healing, sharing about healing practices and the healer's role. Then I'll share about trance and healing and about inducing trance. Following this I will share about the mind-body-environment connection and natural rhythms of life before finally sharing about ideo-dynamic healing itself, about the different ideo-dynamic modalities and

how they can be used to facilitate healing.
Healing has been around for as long as humans have existed, healing has taken many forms. Back in ancient time's people would heal with plant extracts, they would heal by rubbing on herbs and by using leaves, they would heal by chanting, they would heal by using a whole variety of different techniques.
So, the actual art of healing has been around for as long as humans have existed. And to some extent or another it is probably around in other species as well. It is known for example that touch can be very healing. And even in other species like whales, dolphins, elephants and all of the apes, you see them touching each other. And that touch could be just for comfort, or it could be intentional, as if the animal somehow instinctively knows that touch has healing powers.
A lot of recent research into psycho-neuro immunology and other mind body areas have discovered that touch can actually stimulate genetic expression (Rossi, 2012). By that I mean that it can actually turn certain genes on and off. It used to be thought that genes were very static and that your DNA was what it was and that it didn't change. Whereas now it is known that the expression over certain genes does change and adapt to life events. So, if someone touches you in a loving, kind manner, that stimulates different hormones in your body, it stimulates different chemical responses, which filters down and has a knock-on effect with individual genes.
As well as touch, sound is known to be very healing (Wei, 2019). Throughout history people have used rhythms, and drums and the sounds of nature like thunderstorms, waves, rain, the sound of sand moving in deserts, all as ways to stimulate healing. They have used chanting and singing, and in other animals you see this also. You see that animals use sound to convey messages and at the same time, as well as conveying messages about danger or trying to attract a mate, they will use sounds to comfort, and in a way, the way we speak and the fact that we have language and words is almost like just an advanced form of what has been going on for millions of years in nature. We can talk to somebody in a way that conveys love. We can

talk to somebody in a way that conveys relaxation, and we can talk to people in ways that allow healing to take place.

If you talk to somebody and you help them to relax, as that person begins to relax, their stress levels begin to reduce, and as their stress levels reduce their healing response increases. The way we speak has the power to turn that healing response on or off. Whereas if you talk to somebody very aggressively and abruptly, it immediately begins to cause a subtle stress response, and so whoever you are, even if you are someone that isn't seen as a threat, if you talk to someone in that way you begin to reduce the other person's ability to heal themselves.

The healing arts themselves date back to about four or five thousand years ago to the Egyptians and other ancient civilisations. They would try and understand nature and the world around them; they would try to understand how things worked. Around that time, they began to create medicines, they began to realise that plants had healing properties. People had known about this long before that. Many tribes have known for generations about plants in their local area that had healing properties. But about 4500 to 5000 years ago people began to have an intense curiosity about this area and were actually beginning to record what they were discovering. As well as the healing power of plants they were also beginning to focus more on the healing power of chanting and the healing power of trance.

All ancient tribes and shamanistic tribes and practices, all involved trance inducing techniques for healing. All over the World, people were beginning to learn how to generate healing in others, and all of this was long before medical science was around.

You had tribes out in Australia, America and Africa, and they all knew something about healing. They would often have a wise person. They would call them different names, some would call them shaman, some would call them a witch doctor, but that person held a key responsibility. They would be the person you would go to, to get healing. And the process of healing, wherever you went was pretty similar, firstly there

would be a belief that this person knows what they are doing and that they can actually heal you. There would be a belief that if you did as you were asked and you followed along with the process and honestly took part in the process the healing would take place.

As in modern medicine the healing didn't always work on everyone. The placebo effect played a large role in a lot of ancient healing. Over the years placebo has developed a negative reputation for something that disrupts people's experiments. When in reality placebo is an individual's self-healing ability taking effect. It doesn't matter whether the positive effect is because that person believes it is going to work, or for some other reason, it is still that person's own self-healing ability healing them. So, for example, when placebo has been tested against antidepressants, the difference in success between antidepressants and placebos has been found to be so slight that it is generally assumed many antidepressants are mainly working as placebos (Simons, 2022).

The power of placebo can heal you of a wide range of psychological, emotional and sometimes even physical problems. There have been cases of people being healed of cancer and of genetic diseases and all they were on was placebo, so no-one intentionally healed them (Rossi, 1993).

For example, there was a case of a Doctor, Dr Albert Mason who thought a patient had warts across his whole body. Dr Mason had learned hypnosis and thought he could heal warts so he hypnotised this person and made the warts disappear, not realising he had just got rid of an incurable genetic disorder, meaning he had created change on a cellular level (Mason, 1960).

In the 90's a man went to his doctor, he had throat cancer, he was put onto a placebo for treatment, this man wasn't expected to respond well to the treatment and was given a few days to live and his throat cancer went away (Rossi, 1993). When he saw the news and saw that the medication he had taken was found in trials to be ineffective his throat cancer returned. He went to the doctor again who put him on another placebo, telling him it

was stronger medication, and his cancer disappeared again. Sometime later he saw another news report saying this treatment has been found ineffective, following this the patient died.

So, the power of placebo is a useful tool for the therapist or healer to know. People are often ashamed or scared to admit that they use placebo. People try to debunk therapies that use placebo by saying 'oh they are just using placebo'. Whereas the way to look at it is if that therapist is skilled enough to generate the placebo effect so that the client heals themselves rather than the therapist doing the healing then that should be a valuable person to be out there. Obviously, it is important that people aren't forgoing recommended medical treatments, for example, you wouldn't want someone deciding not to have their cancer treatment because they are going to see that therapist who does healing or evokes the placebo response and there needs to be a lot more research on the subject and even these therapists need to make sure what they are doing actually works, ideally by doing practices which have scientific literature to back up that they work, not just saying they get results when they don't. So, you want the therapist to be honest with clients about what they do and how they do it and that it is an adjunct to whatever their regular treatment is, not a replacement for their regular treatment.

IDEO-DYNAMIC HEALING - THE HEALERS ROLE

Part of the skill of being an ideo-dynamic healer is to be an intuitive healer, to be able to help people to trigger their own inner healing response, whether it is for psychological healing or physical healing. As well as shamanism and tribal healing where they will predominantly use chants, dancing around fires, potions and lotions, praying, music, or offerings to the gods, they might use touch or dancing, there are also the meditative healing practices where someone trains themselves to go inside their mind and quieten themselves down and allow healing to take place in its own way.

Unlike the other types of healing where the perception of the person being healed is that someone does something to them to heal them, with meditative forms of healing people can do it to themselves. People can guide others through meditation. This could be done individually or in groups, perhaps helping people to relax and enter a meditative state.

Nowadays many people believe they don't have the time to be able to shut everything out and meditate, they believe that to truly meditate takes a lot of hard work, they have to be able to sit there, they have to be able to close down the mental chatter and then remain in that state for a period of time. There are also religious healing practices. In some parts of the world this can be quite a big thing. People will attend ceremonies or

religious gatherings, and they will believe that in some way the healing is done via a God or gods, or a spirit that is channelled through the priest or religious leader and then into the person that needs the healing.

If you ever watch religious healing taking place, you'll notice that very often it starts with a congregation all becoming lively or building up emotion, because to do good healing work you often need some sort of emotion there or at least intense focus, and one way of focusing is to create emotion. So in many of these religious healing situations everyone sings together, everyone gets excited or starts chanting, they will have words that they regularly say, like 'amen' and then they will perhaps have people go up to the front and those people may get touched in a way that causes the individual surprise or shock which triggers the individuals orientation response to trigger trance, the same as stage hypnotists do when they tip someone off balance which triggers the orientation response, then they give a firm command or suggestion, like the word 'sleep' which the individual then latches onto as they drop into a deep trance.

In a healing situation people may be dancing and drawn into the experience as they go up to the healer at the front who suddenly slams their hand onto the person's forehead and says something like 'demons get out' which shocks the individual, they enter trance instantly and take this sentence as a direct command for the problem to go away. The shock of someone grabbing hold of the shoulders or head triggers the trance for the command that comes a few moments later.

In many cases this can lead to a positive healing response, it obviously has its limitations, it isn't going to grow a leg back or suddenly make someone who is unable to walk, able to walk, or someone who is blind suddenly able to see, but there are many types of problems which can be helped.

Your role as a healer is to be a guide. Your role isn't to do the work for the client, it isn't that you do something to the client; it is that you walk alongside the client as they do the work themselves. You are there just to keep them on track to allow the healing to take place. That is partly where this form of

therapy differs from most therapies, as an intuitive healer the idea is for you to observe and utilise what happens, you watch what goes on, you watch for changes in the clients' patterns that lets you know that something has just changed inside them.

You use this by acknowledging to the client that they are doing the right thing, by being supportive and letting them know to stick with what is happening inside. You let them move forward and you just stay alongside them.

Sometimes you may need to educate clients a little, for example if they have been brought up in a situation where their parents have never been angry so the person grows up without learning how to deal with anger and they get angry but haven't learnt how to handle it. If they have no reference or link in their mind about how to deal with anger, or about how to calm down, or about how to prevent anger taking hold, this sort of approach may not work instantly because the person doesn't have the patterns in their mind to deal with the anger, so they might need educating.

They don't necessarily need to be directly told what to do but strategies could be presented to them, like walking away to calm down. This could be done directly or indirectly. It isn't about them taking what you say literally, it is about presenting ideas for the type of strategy that could be useful. So, they could walk away in their mind in a situation rather than really walking away, or they could count in their mind to separate from the situation and give themselves distance from the situation.

The pattern for the route to success could be laid down indirectly through a story or metaphor. The way I work is to find out what the person wants instead of the problem, rather than what they don't want. So not 'I don't want to be angry' but 'I want to be calmer and more relaxed'. Once they give you this positive you have somewhere to work towards and know where you are going and what you are working towards. This is the pattern required for 'not' having the problem. They don't have to know how to achieve this right now; they just need to have access to the part of them that knows what is wanted.

By working intuitively, you will be able to guide them towards

that outcome by responding to their non-conscious behaviours. If the client struggles to give you this kind of information, if they can't tell you what will be there instead, they may need a bit of education. I usually do this by using stories or metaphors, perhaps talking about being by a beach or walking through woodland, something that lays down the pattern the individual needs but in a different context. If this appears to sink in and it appears that they have learnt from it then you may not have to do anything else, you can then move straight onto doing ideo-dynamic healing work.

If they need more than that then you can perhaps offer them examples, like saying 'I had someone that came in to see me a few weeks back and what they found useful was...' and then give ideas or patterns.

So, there are lots of options for laying down patterns and helping the client. As a therapist or coach, you won't know everything, you won't know every pattern so you want to offer as little as possible because you are likely to be wrong. What you are learning throughout these next chapters should allow you to develop your own style and your own approach that encompasses utilising what your client gives you, or you could specialise. For example, you could set up as a healer specialising in doing healing with dreams, or healing through storytelling, or healing through 'energy' and then use the energy in the body for healing.

There are so many different forms of healing so you can decide to do just the part you want. Some people may do past life healing, they may take people back to a past life, whether they or the client believes it is real or just metaphors from within the client, do some healing then bring them back to the present, or they may use future progression, or healing light, or touch, like healing massage. By the time you have learned everything over the next few chapters, and especially if you build the content of this on what has been taught previously, you will be able to decide whether you want to use this information generically or you may wish to specialise so that you can single yourself and your approach out from the competition.

It also depends what market you want to target, so if you target a new age market you may create a style based on that market, or you may develop a style based on people's beliefs in your local community, so if you are in a religious community you may write healing prayers for people to read at night for healing, or if there is a local belief about offerings or ceremonies being at the heart of the local community you may develop an approach that uses ceremonies or offerings.

However, you take up the information, the important thing is for you to learn to observe everything and learn how to utilise what you observe. If you observe twitches or tension in the muscles or changes in words people use, you want to utilise this. Whatever it is, even if it is something that they see as failure you can use it as success.

I had a smoker see me some time ago; her husband came along as well and sat in on the session. After the session the husband said to me that his wife had never been through therapy like that before yet she seemed to get everything right and seemed to know what to do, even though she had never been through the therapy before. The reason she got everything right was because I acknowledged everything as positive. So, for example, if I asked her to sit and relax and she said her shoulders were tense I would say something like 'that's right, just allow that tension in those shoulders, as you let other parts of your body relax'.

If I asked her to imagine something, whatever she said she imagined was correct. I didn't let anything be a failure. If I said, 'imagine you are walking through the woods' and she said she can't visualise clearly, I said 'that's it, and just allow the part that can experience it, experience it, whilst the conscious part of you can remain unaware of what is going on back there in the unconscious part of the mind'. So, I turned it around. Rather than failing, she was doing the right thing by being unaware because the work is taking place non-consciously, out of her awareness.

I also allow time and silence; this gives thinking time and deepens their state as they focus on waiting for what you will be

saying next.

Eliciting the problem and then keeping it in mind in some way is important. Every time a memory gets recalled it gets altered based on the state of mind that the person is in when they recall that memory and on the context they are in. The problem should be kept in mind as it is altered; this is the key to effective treatment of many psychological problems.

The Rewind Technique involves keeping the memory in mind as it is being manipulated. I do many techniques with representations of the memory or problem in mind being manipulated. Many of the Neuro-linguistic Programming (NLP) techniques need the problem to be in mind for them to work. Emotional Freedom Technique (EFT) involves the memory being kept in mind as the tapping takes place. If someone else is there it can externalise it (creating disassociation) whilst that person can also influence it whether it is with something to do with their presence (like a sense of being loved, or supported, or being made to laugh etc.) or to do with what they comment on and what those comments are (like saying 'that's right' every time the person's mind wanders from pain, or every time an internal change in state occurs etc.). And many other therapies or treatment approaches have the problem in mind, like Eye Movement Desensitisation and Reprocessing (EMDR), and many CBT approaches.

Some of the less successful forms of therapy are where the therapist has a belief (for example that the cause of the problem isn't what it is) and so they take therapy away from the actual problem and associations to that problem down a line of questioning that may sound logical or plausible but really aren't correct and so the areas on the mind aren't relating to the actual problem so healing doesn't occur so effectively.

To do good therapy you need to access the problem to be able to work on it. Problems are state-bound so you need to access it so that it can be worked with. You also want to have a marker for the end of therapy so you can scale the problem 0-10 at the beginning when you have evoked the symptom, and then scale 0-10 when you try to evoke the symptom at the end of the

session and the client finds it isn't there, or it is greatly reduced. If you didn't access it at the start, they wouldn't have a reference point and you wouldn't have anything to work with.

Evoking a symptom can annoy people so can doing paradoxical task setting like telling people to stay awake all night if they aren't asleep twenty minutes after going to bed. You need to give some explanation or exploratory context (with sleep it could be doing an experiment to learn more about the nature of the problem etc.)

IDEO-DYNAMIC HEALING - TRANCE, HEALING AND INDUCING TRANCE

Trance is a focused state of attention. Trance happens naturally in everyday life, it is probably most associated with either mystical practices of some sort or another, or hypnosis, yet it actually happens day to day, from moment to moment. You are always in some form of a trance. The more focused the trance, the deeper it is. Some examples of trance; depression is a trance state, the more focused the depression is, the deeper the depression is the more in a trance the person is.

Each trance has its own thinking style, its own set of beliefs; it will be a very specific state of mind. For example, if someone is in a depression trance, they view the world through the filters of depression, positives are likely to become something that don't happen very often and when they do happen, they are thought of as one-off or flukes, negatives often get generalised so the person believes 'this is the way things always are'. These are aspects of the depression trance, so the deeper the person goes into the depression the more focused they become on experiencing the world through that perception.

If someone is in an anger trance, they may see things very black and white, 'they are right, the other view or person is wrong' there isn't any 'real' logic to their argument, even when

information that proves they are wrong is pointed out to them they won't take it on board as the alternative view point and any contradictory information doesn't exist from within their anger trance.

There are problem trance states; there are also healing trance states and positive trance states. For example, if someone is very happy, they are in a trance, in that state often good things become generalised, bad things become specific, for good things the person thinks that things are always good, bad things the person sees as one-off incidents, again they are also very focused in this trance.

Trance focus can be enhanced through sound, using your voice, touch, finding what the person is interested in, for example when someone is reading a good book they go deeper and deeper into a trance the better the book is, they become more and more absorbed in the book the better the story. The same happens when watching TV programmes or films, the better the programme is the more absorbed they become in that film and the deeper in a trance in relation to that film they become.

One common feature mentioned about trance is that the person in trance suspends belief. In a sense this is true, in reality each trance contains a set of beliefs. So, in an anger trance the person believes they are right and everyone else is wrong, in a depression trance the person believes that everything is bad and good things rarely happen. If someone is in a trance focusing on a book or focusing on a film on TV they get 'sucked in' and they buy in to what is going on, so they jump if there is something scary, or their heart speeds up at suspenseful scenes, or they laugh at humorous scenes.

Healing trances are best triggered by keeping the problem in mind, using the problem as the starting point. So, when talking about trance in the context of healing, you want the person to be very focused, with you involved in the trance, all of these other trances, for example if someone enters a trance playing a computer game, they can become so absorbed so that even if you try to talk to them, it is as if you aren't there.

With a healing trance you want to be a part of the experience, you don't want to be separate from it. You want the client to have a dual reality, so a part of them is aware of being in a session with you here and now and a part of you, like your voice is associated with their inner experience, like your voice being a background sound in their mind. You are like a Mid-Game element of their Short-Game.

To develop a trance within a healing context it is best to start with the problem. People very often want to know how to induce a trance or hypnosis, the fact is, that is the easy part. For years people have come to me asking me for scripts for inducing different trance states or for working with different types of clients.

In reality, inducing a trance state isn't the difficult part because people are always in a trance of some sort or another. Once you know this all you have to know is that you are going to guide them from where they are now into a state that includes you in their experience, a state that includes the problem in the experience and it includes them in the experience.

You want the client to be able to keep the problem in mind. For example if someone smoked, you are not likely to get success by meeting them in the street and talking to them about something in the hope that they will stop smoking, whereas if the same person comes into the therapy room, and they are there because they want to stop smoking, even if neither of you mentions smoking during the whole session and you work completely metaphorical talking about someone living in the city, with congestion, smog, busy roads, everything smelling, being a very stressful place to live and so this person moves to the countryside and enjoys the fresh air and the open space and the freedom and being able to do what they want and you use lots of detail so that they become absorbed in the story, neither of you have mentioned smoking but you have laid down the pattern for quitting smoking and starting a fresh and moving forward.

If they have come in aware they are seeing you to stop smoking the problem is in mind, they have that awareness even if it

never gets mentioned. You both know what they are there for, so any patterns you lay down will be responded to as being related to the problem. They will unconsciously think that whatever you say must be related to the reason they are in the session.

The problem is a good place to start for trance induction, so in that example with the smoker, you may start by telling a story. If I was working with that client, I wouldn't tell them to close their eyes or to relax, I would just start telling them the story and use this to gain and hold their attention. The client would already have the problem in mind so they are already locked on that problem whether they know it or like it, and while a part of them is focused on that problem you can start telling them the story or whatever approach you are taking and the person will lock onto that and will naturally drift into a trance as you talk to them. If you use sensory language, communicating visual, auditory, and kinaesthetic information this will help them to form that experience in their mind.

Because trance is associated with every problem, trance is a good place to start with healing. If someone smokes, this happens automatically. If they were consciously deciding to have the cigarette then they could always decide not to have the cigarette and so wouldn't have a problem. Whereas if they try to stop smoking but have an urge that they struggle to overcome then they are in a trance, there is a part of them that has taken control of their experience that is saying 'look I want you to have a cigarette whether you like it or not', so because trance is a natural part of problems, if you start with the trance you can begin to adjust it or change it or break it down. It could be that the triggers that trigger the smoking trance, in this example, could be reconfigured to trigger a healing trance. Or the triggers could be altered in some way.

The ability to encourage, develop and deepen trance states is important because trance is at the heart of all problems. You need to be able to develop the trance state and keep it open whilst you do some work. It is a bit like walking up to the client's house and the front door is their problem and

everything that is inside the house is everything that is behind the problem. You can't do anything unless you can open the front door, and once you have the front door open you need to get into the house. Once you are in the house you need to stay in there to do the work, it is no good running in and out of the house or staying outside the house, you need to be in the house and stay there whilst you do the change work.

To maintain trance, you want to become a part of the clients' experience whilst at the same time you don't want to intrude on the clients' experience. As soon as you see someone go into their mind, or enter a trance state you want to keep, you need to lower and relax your voice and say as little as possible so that they can remain in their state and your voice just remains in the background, they let your voice in because it isn't intruding, it just becomes a subtle part of their experience.

You don't want them to have to keep coming out of that trance to listen to you and then get back in again as this would be very ineffective. Once they go inside you want to go with it and stick with it and just let their experience develop.

Entering a Healers Trance

As the healer you want to go into a trance as well. This is an idea that is contrary to most other forms of therapy where you don't become involved or absorbed in the experience, part of that is true, the difference is that here you are going into a trance focused on the client, so they become the most important person in the world to you in that moment. While they are going into a trance inside their mind, you are going into a trance watching them.

What happens is that the deeper you go into a trance the more observant you become. The more observant you become the more information you receive from your non-conscious observations or intuition about what you should do next to help that client, which is all based on your prior knowledge and experience. And as you get better at entering trance focused on the client you begin to almost seem to mind-read because you are matching their breathing, pulse rate, blinking, body posture,

you are observing their minimal cues in great detail and recognising many of these non-consciously.

Because you become so similar to them physiologically you begin to have similar thoughts to the client. As thoughts run through their mind, they also begin to run through your mind. This is the point it becomes intuitive; you suddenly reach a state of mind where you get ideas and don't know where they have come from. When working with the client you aren't going to say many words, you may just say 'that's it' or 'that's right' or 'just continuing to work through that' and so you will be saying very minimal words yet the few words you do say match the client's inner experience.

One of the best ways to develop this externally focused trance is to develop intense curiosity, really pay attention to the client, pay attention to every small detail, and as you pay attention to all of these details you will begin to become more absorbed into a trance. The psychiatrist Milton Erickson used to say he would notice small details and as he notices all of these small details he would go deeper and deeper into a trance.

Another way of developing this trance is to imagine you are hypnotising yourself. So, when you are sitting talking with the client, imagine that you are the client going through the experience.

For example, if you were doing a body scan hypnotic induction and you say 'begin to be aware of the top of your head' you would begin to be aware of the top of your own head, and you may continue 'and I wonder whether you notice the feeling of the hair on your head, or perhaps the cool air on your forehead' you will pay attention to what you notice within you so that you enter trance as well and this also helps you to describe what the clients experience might be.

Everyone will have their own unique way of inducing their own trance state; some people may set up a post-hypnotic suggestion. So, if they use a therapy room, they may set up a post-hypnotic suggestion that whenever they sit in their usual therapists' chair, they will go into a trance state and become hyper alert and hyper aware of the client and the signals they

give off. Using post-hypnotic suggestions allows them to immediately enter that state by carrying out the post-hypnotic behaviour, like sitting in their therapist's chair. Everyone will develop their own unique way of doing this, but it is important that everyone enters this trance. If you remain 'conscious' so to speak, you will miss so much information.

Consciously you can only be aware of about 7 bits of information at any one time. So, by staying in a conscious state, you remain unaware of so much information, whereas non-consciously you can manage vast amounts of information simultaneously, you have access to this in deep trance, you don't have access to this when you are conscious.

As well as having access to this when you are in a trance, you also feel more comfortable trusting what comes through from your unconscious because you have a greater connection with what you have non-consciously noticed that led to your specific response, whereas consciously you may get a gut feeling but you may not recognise it or acknowledge it. It is important to frequently practise putting yourself into that healing trance state.

Rhythm and Music

Rhythm is an excellent trance inducing tool. All trances have a specific rhythm. When you talk you talk with a specific rhythm, you talk with a specific bounce to your voice, with a specific rate of speech, and you talk differently depending on the message you are trying to convey.

As with music the rhythm changes depending on the message you are trying to convey, so the rhythm may relax and slow down when you are helping people to relax or slow down their experience and enter a deeper trance. Whereas when you are keeping them in a more energised alert state you may talk in a more bouncy, upbeat manner. So, the rhythm you use conveys information.

Rhythm is an important part of the process of developing trance. Something I have always found very interesting is how different rhythms create different trance states, and different frequencies create different trance states. It could be an

auditory rhythm, or it could be binaural beats, which are two sounds at different frequencies with one beat going to one ear, and the other beat going to the other ear and the brain responds to the difference between the frequencies, so if one beat is at 120 hertz and the other beat is at 128 hertz then the brain synchronises with the 8 hertz difference.

This works with light and sound. Difference brain states or trance states are associated with different frequencies in the brain, so some frequencies create a trance state good for creativity, or hallucination, or anxiety, or happiness, or sadness. Using different frequencies you can create designer trance states, because every trance state is different, whether it is by using frequencies or just by creating different trances in different ways.

For example, if you tell the beginning of a nursery rhyme the person will go inside their mind to finish the nursery rhyme, which creates a trance. And every different nursery rhyme, and every different sentence that you say, that the person finishes, especially rhythmic phrases like; A, B, C, D the person finishes - E, F, G in their mind.

Or 'ba, ba black sheep', the listener finishes with 'have you any wool' and each time this creates a mini trance. You can create audio tracks that create designer trance states, so you can have an on-going trance state being produced with other mini trance states being added to it, and unlike normally when the person would finish the nursery rhyme in their mind and then come out of the trance, if there is an on-going trance these additional bits add something unique to the on-going trance, it is only subtle but each time it adds something different and new. In the same way that each different way you induce a trance creates a different trance. If you induce a deep relaxation trance this creates a different trance state to a rapid induction trance.

You can use fractionation which is where you take someone in and out of a trance over and over again, and each time you take them into a trance they go deeper and deeper than they did previously. For example, you could do a deep relaxation induction and have them relax their muscles and then go to a

relaxing place in their mind, then they could be asked to open their eyes and focus on a spot on the wall and an induction could be done having them focusing on that spot, which would add this trance to their current trance, then they could be asked to open their eyes again and you could do a handshake induction and each trance would build on the previous trance when they are done in succession like this so you create a designer trance state.

Using this same process, you can create designer drug states. So, if someone smokes cannabis and wants to stop but still wants to have the effects of cannabis, you can use the process that they use to get stoned and have them tell you what it is like to get stoned, and they could do this with their eyes closed. It could be having them imagine rolling the joint, then imagine lighting it, then imagine taking the first drag, and asking them 'then what happens' and as they go through the process of imagining what it feels like this can be used as a trance induction. The trance they can get from this would then be the ability to experience being stoned without having to smoke cannabis. One advantage of this is that they are not 'stoned' by a chemical so at any point they can come out of this trance state.

The same technique can be done with smoking, which could be linked to a breathing technique, so that they have the same feelings they used to get from smoking, from doing this breathing technique.

Someone that wants to stop drinking but still wants to experience being drunk can be guided through the process of buying a drink, raising the glass to their mouth, having the first sip, feeling the drink go down their throat, and following this through to when they are drunk. The difference is that because there are no added chemicals the person can exit this state at any time. Using designer trances can be useful with people with a wide range of addictions. These people can be helped to be able to access this designer trance state automatically with a trigger linked to it or a specific process that they can follow in the future.

Light and sound can be used for inducing trance states; it could

be binaural beats of light or sound, or it could be a light flashing with a specific rhythm, for example a light flashing at eight beats a second, or eight hertz would trigger the brain to take on an eight hertz frequency. Eight to thirteen hertz is associated with the brain entering an alpha state. Flickering candles and flickering flames can be used to induce trance. This has been used for millennia; people have sat around campfires and watched flickering flames dance as they drift into a trance.

They don't have control over the speed of the flickering flames, but it still works, they just don't know exactly what trance will develop. Different things burning may well create different flickering and so they may have a little control over this aspect. So as a therapist or healer you could specialise in using light or sound for therapy.

It could be using the light and sound machine devices or you could develop your own way of using light or sound. You may have the person think about the problem with a light and sound device on and you may ask them to just let their mind wander as they think about the problem and have the light and sound playing and to come out when they feel their inner wisdom has completed the work it will do for today. The light and sound induces the trance, you don't tell them what to do other than having them enter trance, and then giving them a cue for when they will know the internal work is done.

Music puts people into a trance, it can begin to hypnotise people. People can listen to music and they can latch on to the rhythm, a lot of music in tribes and in a lot of our ancient history has been around what pulse the listeners should be experiencing in that moment. If people should have a fast pulse, say 120 beats a minute, the rhythm of the music will be fast paced, leading people to want to get up and dance, which in turn leads to their pulse speeding up, so it energises. Whereas if you want people to slow down and relax the beat becomes gentler and more relaxed. That begins to slow down the pulse and people begin to relax more.

The night before tribal wars, people might dance around a fire with upbeat, fast music playing so that it builds up the emotion

level and raises the pulse. It could also increase anger and focus. In many armed forces they use bands or drums so that everyone marches in rhythm with each other.

If everyone is synchronised with each other they will all go into a trance and all feel a part of a whole, they will all feel connected in a shared trance. When you become one with someone else by entering a trance state focused on the other person, and join them in their view of the world you begin to think similar to them. For example, if you have 1500 troops walking the same, hearing the same beat, all beginning to breathe the same, with their pulses beginning to become similar, they all start to think in a similar way.

If they are all thinking in a similar way, they all begin to respond in a similar way. They all begin to understand things each other quicker and easier than if they have to meet them under 'normal' circumstances.

You could specialise in using music or rhythms and play drums as you watch the person and you play along whilst closely observing their minimal cues and use the music to respond to the minimal cues like their pulse rate, and speed up if their pulse speeds up and slow down when it slows down, or using other musical instruments like guitar or piano or synthesiser.

By working in this way, you don't do anything; the individual does all of the work themselves, you are just facilitating and supporting the client and helping to keep the client on track while they do their inner work.

Movement and Touch

Movement can also be used for trance induction; dancing has been used for years to induce trance. When Franz Anton Mesmer used to do mesmerism, he would use passes of his hands across the clients' face and body. The movement of his hands would induce a trance. To induce trance, you could use passes of your hands, there are healing methods out there that use movement and touch, and close passes, things like Emotional Freedom Technique, Thought Field Therapy, Acupressure all use touch to induce trance.

Techniques like Reiki and many energy field therapies use close movement of the hands, massage induces trance. Trance can also be induced by asking the person to move, like doing arm levitation. It could be having the arm raising to induce trance, or lowering to induce trance. It could be having the hands move towards or away from each other as if there is a magnetic force.

Any movement can be used to induce trance. You can even induce confusion to induce trance by saying up as you lower a client's hand down, down as you lift the hand up, left as you move the hand right, right as you move the hand left, clockwise as you move the hand anti-clockwise and anti-clockwise as you move the hand clockwise. So, the movement and the words conflict and create confusion and trance and then give a solid suggestion or idea to follow, like 'and close your eyes' as you notice confusion set in, so that you give them a clear escape from the confusion.

You can induce trance completely non-verbally because touch focuses attention. You can focus attention on where you are holding, for example, you can hold on to someone's wrist very lightly, almost as if you are not holding onto their wrist and you can move it subtly in time with their breathing, and then move it so that each downward movement is enhanced each time they blink, and then move it side to side occasionally in an ambiguous way so that the arm doesn't know whether it should be cataleptic or should be still moving to the main movement that you are doing.

By doing this movement process you can induce trance very rapidly and all you are doing is moving the hand. The person eventually non-consciously understands that each time they breathe out the hand lowers down, and each time they blink the hand moves down further. This leads to their eyes getting heavier and their breathing getting deeper when you lower their arm down further.

After a few minutes their eyes close, their breathing relaxes and their arm remains cataleptic and remains where you put it. And all of this is done without having to say a single word to the

client; it is all induced with this movement.
Trance is fundamental to healing and is simple to induce, it is a natural phenomenon of life experience and by understanding trance you can develop your own style and approach to healing and mark yourself out from the crowd.

IDEO-DYNAMIC HEALING - MIND, BODY, ENVIRONMENT CONNECTION

Ideo-dynamic 'psycho-cellular' healing is largely based on Psychoneuroimmunology (Nes & Segerstrom, 2017) and Psychoneuroendocrinology (Rubinow et al., 2011). Psychoneuroimmunology is about how the mind, the psychology and thinking processes and the neurology, so the way the mind is made up and the mental processes, affect and influence the immune system. It is a two-way process, so it is also about how what happens with the immune system can have an effect on the neurology or psychology. So, if someone has ill health, they may feel bad, or feel down.

Psychoneuroendocrinology is about how psychology, neurology and the endocrine system interact. Within psycho-cellular healing it is useful to know about both because you want to work with individuals as a whole. The mind-body connection is something that in many eastern philosophies and cultures has been quite well accepted, whereas in western culture we have separated them out and we talk about a mind and a body and the two never meet. So, in the western world we haven't put so much work in until recently to try to discover how the mind and body interact and are connected. We have treated them as separate systems.

As a healer it is interesting to learn about how our own process can influence ourselves. For example, if someone is always saying 'I am always in pain' or saying 'I am always depressed', the body can act on what that person is saying 'as if' it is true. By having awareness of this you can begin to work with it and help people as a whole being. Likewise, if the person is physically ill this can generate negative thinking. So, you can understand that the presenting problem isn't always the real problem. It could be that someone presents with depression and is always thinking depressed and they may have a chemical or hormonal imbalance in the body which is causing the depression, or they could present with the same problem and the cause could be environmental, so it isn't a chemical or hormonal imbalance it is an environmental stimulus creating certain thoughts that are then creating hormonal changes in the body which then shuts down the immune system, yet in this case the body response is caused by the psychological response to the environment. So, gathering a small amount of information can lead to establishing whether something is influencing the mind and the mind is influencing the body or the body is influencing the mind.

There are many examples of mind-body problems, for example. if you don't sleep, memory gets worse, hand-eye coordination gets worse and you struggle to communicate so effectively and can be more anxious and worry more. Likewise, you can worry lots and so not sleep. There are many examples of the mind and body influencing each other negatively. As a healer you want to use this knowledge to look at how they can influence each other positively.

Over recent decades more research has shown how changes can be made to how the genes are expressed - epigenetics (CDC, n.d.). Responses to the environment can create hormonal changes that create messenger molecules that change the expression of the genes. So, if someone is laughing that alters the gene expression, as does any other emotional state, be it depression, fear, anxiety, happiness or stress. This has enormous implications; you can work with the person to create

changes down to the genetic level.

It used to be assumed that brain cells died and you never grew new cells after your teenage years. Brain cells get pruned in early childhood and again during teenage years as people adapt to the world around them. There has been research (Maguire et al., 2000) carried out with London taxi drivers and as they learnt the 'knowledge' which is learning the streets of London they developed larger areas of the brain to do with spatial awareness from memorising the streets of London. So, the taxi driver's brains grew in certain areas due to the job they were doing. They grew more connections and extra neurons because of actions they chose to take. So, learning triggers new neuronal growth, the more you learn the more connections you form, the more someone repeats that learning the more solid or fixed that connection becomes.

The brain is constantly on a pruning process, keeping what is useful and cutting back on what is no longer needed. Unneeded links or pathways in the brain become more tenuous and regularly used pathways become stronger and more solidly fixed. Many of the seemingly miraculous cures that have happened, whether it has been in a spiritual context or whether it has been due to placebo, where people have had spontaneous remission is often where changes have occurred on an epigenetic level, changes have occurred within the DNA.

Our DNA is made up of many different pairs of DNA code. For many years it was thought that most of this DNA seemed to not serve a purpose and was termed 'junk DNA' (Mandal, 2022) yet when scientists investigated what genes do, they found that there were genes that are not used in humans but they are used in other animals. This brings in the gene expression, so a gene may not do anything in a human yet the same gene in a fish may be expressed in a relevant way that turns the bones used in a human ear into the gills of the fish. And likewise, there can be certain combinations of genes; people have often looked to see if there is a specific gene relating to a specific problem, like with people that seem to be naturally angry or depressed. The findings seem to point to combinations of

genes being involved rather than just a single gene, like playing a chord on a piano; it is a combination of notes that are played to make just the right sound.

Within DNA different combinations of genes could be turned on or off for different purposes. So, one gene could have multiple purposes when it is activated or not in combination with other genes. Genes can express themselves in many different ways in the same way that you can play middle C plus A which makes one sound. Middle C plus E and that makes a different sound. Each combination makes a different sound. It will be a different sound with any other note, and with any other two notes, or any other number of notes and combinations. So that one middle C note will be involved in different sounds depending on what it is played with.

It could be that by turning on a certain gene cancer is able to form, or if another combination of genes is expressed this could lead to cancer being fought or stopped. The turning on and off of genes is more like a dimmer switch, rather than a simple on/off switch, so genes can be expressed to varying degrees. All this leads to great complexity and a wide variety of combinations. It is only through trial and error and through being willing to work with as many people as possible with as many different conditions as possible and working in the psycho-cellular healing way that people can begin to see what can be affected and what can be changed and improved.

With many conditions that someone has had, someone else has overcome it. Whether it has been spontaneous remission or from some other means they have still managed to get over it.

The whole aim of doing psycho-cellular healing is to work at creating a way that helps as many people as possible to be able to heal themselves. It is important not to be telling people that you can cure cancer or that you can cure any other condition. For a start it isn't about the therapist doing the cure, the therapist is just the guide to help to stimulate people's own healing potential. What you want to do is to give people the opportunity to help themselves. For example, if someone had cancer and they are having treatment, you wouldn't tell them to

stop receiving treatment, which would be irresponsible, you wouldn't tell them to stop seeing Doctors, you may offer to be a complimentary service for them while they continue to engage with and follow the guidance from medical practitioners they are working with.

You would offer to do your best to help them heal themselves, and if it works then brilliant, the Doctor would be able to advise on what continued treatment or check-ups they would need to continue to have. On the other hand, if you had half a dozen sessions with the client and it didn't seem to have any effect, they are getting all the treatment that can be offered anyway, you have been just seeing if you can be helpful as a complementary therapy for the person.

One thing that crops up with a lot of healing because of people giving bad advice and telling people to use them and stop using medical treatment, is it is often thought of as immoral to say to people, 'why don't we try to help you heal yourself of cancer, or aids or Alzheimer's' or whatever it happens to be, and I think if you charge an affordable price or do it for free and the person wants the support and is willing to have a go, then it is another avenue for them to hopefully get healed or helped.

A close relative wanted me to help him with his cancer and his medical check-ups showed that the cancer wasn't getting larger. He was using a CD I made him and he put down the stability to using my CD and said that the Doctor commented about it being stable and how they didn't think it would be, they expected to need to start further treatment, but it wasn't getting larger. I don't know if my CD was helping, or if this would have been the case without the use of the CD, but he asked for my help, he was going to continue to do everything his doctor told him and I was happy to see if I could help.

Hypnotherapy trainer Stephen Brooks worked with an Aids patient during one of his Hypnotherapy Diploma courses (Brooks, 1994). The patient asked for his T-cell count to double, that was his goal for therapy. During the session he stated the timeframe for this to happen and it happened within this timeframe. He came back a few months later for a session

during a Hypnotherapy Diploma training course to work with Ernest Rossi (Rossi, 1994) and lived much longer than expected. Again, I don't know whether the sessions were the cause of this, but they were support for him in addition to him engaging with all medical support he was being offered.

What is really needed is research to look at whether these techniques help or not, or whether improvements that occur happen to be for reasons other than the mind-body treatment offered. Ernest Rossi was carrying out a lot of this research and Richard Hill and others are continuing to study therapeutic mind-body healing (Hill, n.d.).

How the mind works is through state dependent memory, learning and behaviour (Rossi, 2007). Very often problems are encoded within one state of mind, or trance state. Likewise, if someone suddenly has flashbacks it is normally encoded within one specific state of mind. In the same way that if someone goes out drinking and they get very drunk and they wake up the next morning and don't remember anything, or just have a hazy memory of the night before, part of the reason for this is that the memories are associated with that drunken state, not with the sober state of mind.

It could be that a week later when they are out drinking, they can remember everything that took place a week earlier when they were drunk, because they are now remembering it from the drunken state. This is the reason why within therapy you want to make sure the client has the problem in mind and if possible, exhibits some of the problem. For example, if they smoke it is useful if you can encourage the client to get a craving for a cigarette while they are sitting with you. That way you have access to all the memories and learnings that are associated with that memory. In the same way as the drunken person has access to their memories and learnings from when they were previously drunk.

Obviously if you had an alcoholic client, you wouldn't want them to genuinely get drunk again in the therapy room or an angry client getting angry in the therapy room, but they can imagine what it is like leading up to that problem. As a

practitioner you could discover that the problem isn't the actual problem. In many cases the problem is the client's cure. It is a coping mechanism that they have developed to 'self-treat' their own problem. An example of this could be a smoker smoking due to boredom or to deal with stress or anxiety.

The main aim is to create a connection between the therapist and the problem part. One way of doing this is to develop a trance in the client and talk to the problem part as if it is a separate entity, or the therapist could use ideo-dynamic techniques to communicate with that part, this could be using a signal when inner work has started and when that inner work has stopped. The therapist's aim is to guide the client into a state associated with the problem. Depending on how this is done it could be emotional for the client. In many conditions there are things that are related that seem not to be related. These are often things that neither the therapist nor the client knows those things are related, yet their inner wisdom can still work on this and address everything that is connected.

One way of overtly discovering related aspects of the problem, or root causes is to have the client imagine a thread that flows from the current problem back to anything that is relevant even if they are consciously unsure how those things are related. This is a way of linking back to all aspects which can then be worked on non-consciously by the inner wisdom.

When working with people, very often people wonder how they will know that they will get any benefit. People don't like paying for something that may not work, so it is always nice to give them something to take away with them that can be achieved within the session. This could be a sense of wellbeing, or the client discovering that they can relax, or that they have been pain free for an hour and they now have a technique that they can use in the future. If there is something that can be achieved in the session, even if this isn't the main issue, it is worth addressing this and resolving it. For example, if someone has a phobia or trauma which is making it more difficult to focus purely on the problem, this can usually be resolved in a session and yet it can make a huge difference to people's lives.

It is important to remember that no-one can cure everyone, never mind how good they are and how much they want to. The role of a healer is to offer people the greatest chance possible for success that you believe you can help them to achieve.

IDEO-DYNAMIC HEALING - FLOW OF INFORMATION

Another useful aspect within healing is information transduction. Information transduction is about the flow of information, it is about how information changes and develops as it flows. Generally, this flow goes from simple to complex. Some examples could be water flowing down a stream, that water turns a miller's wheel, and that wheel turns into the grinding cogs which grind the grain to make flour. So that would be an example of information passing along and changing from the movement of water to the creation of flour.
Information generally gets more complex, for example, energy in the empty universe developed into matter, this matter became more complex, from atoms, and then combined atoms and into more complex structures. This all led to the development of life eventually and as time passed life went from single celled organisms to more complex organisms to plants, through to higher forms of life like great apes, dolphins and whales and other intelligent life and this intelligent life may well go on to develop artificial intelligent life which could continue on the flow and increasing complexity of information. This is a process of information transferring and becoming more complex over time. This complexity and transferring of information has also continued for human achievements, from using hands, then sticks, then harnessing fire, to using stone,

then metal, then creating machines and computers and continuing to develop information over time, which continues to become more complex.

So how does this apply to therapy or healing?

When I talk, my voice vibrates air molecules, these molecules vibrate more molecules until the molecules in your ears vibrate and interact with the ear drums of the listener, this then turns into an electrical nerve impulse to the brain, this is turned into thoughts, then if I have given an instruction to help the client with a pain in the elbow these nerve impulses will follow the necessary path to make the necessary changes in the elbow of the client. The information will have transferred from electrical impulses in my brain generating the thoughts I have, through to creating my speech, to travelling through the air and into different signals in the client. So it isn't that energy is moving around, it is that information is transferring and moving and flowing.

When you do ideo-dynamic healing and you observe a client's finger make a non-conscious movement and you acknowledge it, this information transduction process is transferring information to say they did something correct. By having that joint relationship with the client allows the process to occur, it allows them to know that the information you are conveying, whether this is by thoughts of love or thought of a healing universal power, or by what you do or say, that information is conveyed from the healer to the person being healed.

All of this takes place at a deeper level than conscious awareness. Within the healing context it comes down to intent, so the healers' intent becomes known and has this healing effect. This is partly how the placebo response happens; the placebo response happens by the person having a strong belief on a non-conscious level that what is happening is going to work. One way to stimulate someone having that belief within a therapy context is to convey intent, to convey the intent that 'this is going to work and this is going to happen'.

In healing sessions, you can't say 'I can cure you' but you can

communicate with intent and convey this intent that you strongly believe that this is going to work, that you have faith in your abilities. That information transfers via the way that you speak and act through to the senses of the listener. It isn't the energy conveying alone, three sound waves could contain the same level of energy yet convey three different bits of information.

Using the techniques and skills learned here you can heal a range of psychological problems and physical problems; you only ever want to deal with problems that you are trained to treat and that you feel comfortable and confident treating. Likewise, if you start working with a client and then something during the sessions leads you to being concerned and feeling you may be out of your depth then you can pass the client on to a therapist or coach that has the relevant skills.

These skills and techniques are all designed for you to help clients do the work themselves rather than techniques and skills for you to do the work for them. Other than establishing where the client is at now and what they hope to achieve, you don't do a lot of talking, you just acknowledge the work they are doing whilst they are doing it.

If it is a psychological problem that involves other people, for example if someone isn't sleeping because they are stressed from work, and the work problem is that they are given too much work by their boss, they are not going to leave the session cured, they may leave the session with all the right patterns laid down, but because it involves a third party the only way to resolve the problem will be after they have resolved the issues involving the boss.

Likewise, if someone smokes due to stress they won't stop smoking if they don't deal with the stress. As a therapist or healer, it is useful to know that change work often happens between sessions rather than in the sessions, although you can make a change, you may not see the change immediately, and the client may not link the change to your involvement.

There is research that shows in a one year follow up a single session of therapy is about as effective as having 20 to 30

sessions of therapy, but a year later clients don't realise the change was created from work done in that single session (Woolfe et al., 2003), so you have to be very humble and accept that you may not get any credit for how you have helped. You could meet someone a year later and they may tell you how things have changed, and they may say everything that you would expect based on the therapy you had with them, yet they don't associate what you did with how they have changed.

I had a client come to see me for a single session. She wanted to teach English as a Foreign Language abroad but was too scared to take the leap, give up her job, be motivated enough to complete the relevant courses and find a job abroad. She didn't feel that the session had made any difference, yet a year or so later I spoke to her through a mutual friend who had told me how she was now teaching English abroad and everything she told me matched with what I expected her to say based on our session. The thing was that the changes were all things which were going to take time. She wasn't going to leave the session instantly teaching English abroad. She didn't 'feel' any different, so she thought it hadn't worked, but then went and made all the changes she needed to make over the time period established in the therapy session and carried everything out as expected.

With physical problems like pain or arthritis or any other problem, you need to be aware of what the potential outcomes will be. The same with psychological problems, not everything is wanted in every context and the healer or therapist has a responsibility to check this out. For example, if someone wanted to be more assertive and then was assertive with everyone, they may ruin their marriage due to being too assertive with their partner. With physical problems if you get rid of someone's pain in a leg for example, they may over use the leg and cause further problems. So, you need to be aware of positive and negative possible outcomes and make sure that this is addressed where necessary.

I really like the late Ernest Rossi's approach (Rossi & Hill, 2018). Many therapists use ideo-motor responses as signals to let them know what is going on. Rossi has just gone one stage

further and uses ideo-motor responses and observation skills to track what the client is doing. He trusts that the client has the relevant resources in most cases to heal themselves. If after doing this process or a version of it if the person needed to do some talking then he would have them talk and would often suggest they can tell him what he needs to know to help them further.

There is considerable research referenced in Rossi's work about the autonomic nervous system and the endocrine system and cellular healing, and about research into gene expression and healing at the genetic level. His way of working based on his research into the subject is to recall the problem and be very specific in this so that you will be dealing with as pure a form of that memory as possible. Memory is fluid so every time you recall memories you alter them even if you don't mean to.

Ernest Rossi would ask if the client's unconscious is willing to work on the problem and would make this question contingent on something observable happening, like the arms moving, or eyes closing, if it is willing. He would then let whatever comes up come up and would just respond acknowledging minimal cues that he observes; this could be the client working through difficult memories that have led to their immune system working less efficiently than normal for example. Then when the work is complete another signal is given, it could be that all signals stop or a feeling the client gets or opening the eyes. He will grade the problem at the start of a session and at the end so that the client can notice the difference in score pre and post therapy.

There are many cases of people believing so strongly in a treatment that even if it is a useless treatment, it has still worked. In *The Psychobiology of Mind Body Healing* by Ernest Rossi there is a story of a man that begged his doctor to let him go on a drug trial. He didn't meet the criteria because the criteria included the person being expected to live at least three months. This person was given days at most. The Doctor gave in and decided that as he will be dead in days someone else can carry on from him when he dies and he won't have had too

many of the drugs allocated for the trial.
This man was on a respirator, was bed bound and was untreatable. The Doctor gave him the first pill on the Friday afternoon and came back in on the Monday morning to find the patient walking around all happy and cheerful; his cancer had reduced by around 50%. Within a few weeks he was discharged from hospital.
A few months later it was in the news that the drug didn't work. The patient suddenly went downhill and his cancer came back more aggressively. The Doctor noticed what had happened and so decided to lie to the patient and told him that a stronger strain of treatment is being shipped in which has the problems ironed out, he said it was due-in in a few days (so he was building expectancy). When he gave the patient this 'new' drug (which was just a placebo) the patient got better twice as quickly as previously. Many months later it was in the news that the drug trials had finished and the findings had been collated and the drug has been found to not work at all. The patient fell ill again and died within 48hrs of this news.
Other research Rossi looked into was that despite the problem and the cause, the underlying physiological response is the same whether it is stress, depression, anxiety, cancer, or aids etc. This was called the General Adaptation Syndrome (GAS). It was first noticed and researched in the 1940's and 1950's (SELYE, 1946). Research still continues and theories have been updated to include things like how messenger molecules work and State Dependent Memory Learning and Behaviour (SDMLB).
Some claims are over exaggerated or untrue but the idea that people can heal themselves is nothing mystical or rubbish. Your own body knows how to heal itself when it gets cut, or can learn to fight infections. Part of the problem is that therapists often try to make it seem like ‘they’ are doing something ‘to’ clients. It isn't the therapist 'doing' anything. It is always the client that is in control. With healing it is the client speeding up their healing abilities (just like if you imagine white blood cells in your body multiplying and fighting infection your immune system boosts).

Research shows that our genetic expression isn't 'static'; the genes can be turned on and off. This can't be done consciously, only non-consciously so in some cases with placebos that work the person is changing at a genetic level (changes in expression, rather than changes to the genes; it's not mutation but switching on or off of certain genes) which probably explains some of the cases of people getting better with placebos from problems like cancer or genetic 'incurable' diseases.

Any healing that takes place whether it is epigenetic changes or just hormonal or chemical changes are happening from within the client in their own way, not because a therapist is making those changes occur.

IDEO-DYNAMIC HEALING - NATURAL RHYTHMS OF LIFE

Within your healing practice it is ideal to do coaching or therapy sessions of about 90-minutes to 120-minutes long. Typically people offer a 60-minute long session or less. The 'therapy hour' is usually 50-minutes. The difficulty with this is as a practitioner you could miss out on that client going into their own healing response. We all have natural ultradian rhythms; ultradian rhythms are biological rhythms that are shorter than a 24-hour period, whereas the circadian rhythm is your 24-hour sleep-wake cycle.

One of your ultradian rhythms is the basic rest and activity cycle, this is a 90-to-120-minute cycle of alertness and inner focus, at the peak you are more alert and focused, in the trough you are more internally focused on day dreaming and inner thoughts and reflections. When we enter the trough, we are in a natural healing trance state.

In therapy this would be a state the client has put themselves into, so by having 90–120-minute sessions the client will enter this natural healing trance state during the session, so your job is even easier because you don't have to induce it, when you notice it naturally developing, for example they become stiller and their eyes appear more glazed over, in this time you can just give them time to be absorbed in this state. It will last about 20 minutes and in this 20-minute period, new neural pathways

will be developed and new patterns of responding will be developed.

It is useful to utilise these 20-minute periods, you can also help clients by allowing them to be aware of when their problem occurs if it is a problem linked to this cycle. For example, many smokers will take breaks and smoke during the 20-minute rest period because they will be thinking that they are getting tired and need a break and they have associated breaks with smoking. Alternatively, people may take a break and drink coffee in this period as a way of trying to 'wake themselves up' when they should be going with it and relaxing into it. If smokers are aware of this, they can still take a break but instead of smoking they can take a break and go and relax for 10 or 20 minutes and use the 'craving' as a sign they need to take a break, rather than as a sign that they need to smoke.

Every day of our lives we follow certain patterns unaware of their significance. How many of us truly pay attention to our lives, to what we do, what actions we take, and to what our instinctive behaviour is that guides us towards innate wellness? As Humans we are very good at being unaware of our natural processes and becoming unwell due to behaving in ways that work against our own wellbeing.

How many people are hardworking, motivated, driven to achieve success for themselves or to support their family? People that have best intentions, that wake up early, barely see their family before everyone goes off for the day, whether it is the children going to school or the parents going to work. Only to arrive at work with a list as long as your arm of things you need to do today, and more to do as the day goes on. You have a 'working lunch', not stopping to take a proper break, instead just eating lunch at your desk whilst you check your emails and make and receive phone calls.

Then at the end of the day you rush to your car to try to avoid all the traffic, only to find yourself stuck in the same jams as you do every day. Arriving home in the evening with just enough time to have dinner and put the children to bed before going to bed yourself where you feel tired but are thinking about all the

things you should have done today, and all the things you have to do tomorrow, before eventually falling asleep. Then when you wake to the alarm in the morning you feel tired, like you could have done with more time in bed sleeping and you go through this process again and when you do have a day off you fall ill, or feel drained, or under the weather and so many of your days off and holiday time just feel wasted.

This is a common scenario for many people, they have bills to pay, commitments, and debts and they believe they have to spend their days a certain way to be most productive. With the scenario above this person may find themselves feeling stressed, rundown, or anxious at times. Over time they may end up feeling depressed, they may drink alcohol in the evenings and coffee throughout the day, they may develop migraines, they may feel like they lack motivation or energy and may often feel tired.

When I say this, it is easy to see that a person leading this life is likely to get stressed and rundown and all the other problems mentioned. It is easy to see that they would be likely to drink coffee to keep stimulating themselves to keep alert through the day, to smoke to manage stress, to drink alcohol in the evenings to wind down and relax. What most people don't notice are the times of the day these attempted solutions happen, and what the significance is in the timings.

If somebody wakes up at 7:00 naturally they won't feel tired, they will feel alert and awake. If they have been woken at 7:00 by an alarm clock and the alarm has gone off at a slightly different time to when they should have woken up then they are likely to feel tired and likely to have a coffee within 20 minutes of waking, if they smoke, they are likely to also smoke about this time.

They may leave for work at 8:00 and start work about 9:00. On arrival just before starting work they may have another coffee, and again if they smoke, they probably have a cigarette between 08:30 and 9am. Between about 10:30 and 11:00 they will often start feeling a little tired and in need of a break, so they may again have a cigarette or a coffee, or both. Around 12:30 to 1:00

they will likely want to take another break. They may feel hungry; they may feel like they just need another coffee or cigarette, then around 2:30 to 3:00 they are likely to want another break with a coffee and/or a cigarette.

Then just before finishing work about 4:30 to 5:00 they are likely to think about wanting a coffee and/or cigarette again but may decide that as they are finishing shortly, they will wait. If they smoke, they will probably light up a cigarette once they are out of work, and then get home and want dinner about 6:30 to 7:00 followed by a cigarette and now they are home, possibly a drink of alcohol.

About 8:30 to 9:00 they may have 'one last drink before bed' and another cigarette, and then try to get to bed about 10:30 to 11:00.

This is a generic example, but a standard pattern of behaviour. Here in this example, I have used a hypothetical case of someone that drinks coffee, smokes and drinks alcohol daily. Every individual is different and will have their own attempted solutions. The pattern many people miss is how each time they feel compelled to carry out their behaviour, like smoking or drinking coffee, is actually associated with a natural biological 90–120-minute rhythm that runs day and night in each and every one of us. As mentioned previously, this rhythm involves a rise to a peak of arousal, this is when we feel most alert and full of energy, and then heads down to a trough of introspection and relaxation, this is when we find our mind wandering and we feel tired and drowsy. It is in the trough period when people often turn to addiction. People often feel that they are losing focus when they are in the trough and try to fight it.

This biological rhythm has purpose. It swaps the dominant hemisphere in the brain that we are using, increasing blood flow to the opposite side of the brain, in the relaxation phase it triggers healing and cell growth, it consolidates what you have been learning over the last 90-120 minutes or so and rather than being a loss of focus it is just a change of focus, from external to internal.

By acknowledging this cycle, you can work to achieve a state of

optimal performance, health and wellbeing. The build-up to the peaks are increases in activity and optimal performance. As you reach a peak you become increasingly effective at focusing on tasks and responding to the external world. Following the peak, you drop into a trough where you are internally focused. This is ideal for healing and rejuvenating your body and consolidating memories and learning. It is in this state that you can creatively explore problems and develop solutions.

The troughs are where daydreams occur most. Children in school are often disciplined for daydreaming in class, yet a daydreaming child may well be consolidating what they are learning and is in the optimal state for absorbing the learning being taught. This daydreaming state bridges the gap between the external world, our mind and our body, it is the bridge between our Mid-Game and our Short-Game, that works with our Deep-Game to help us towards our Long-Game. It allows us to take the information that has been coming in through our senses and create new neural pathways and if necessary new brain cell growth to develop our thoughts, memories and learning and other 'mind' processes, whilst also triggering the release of messenger molecules within our body that interact with our genes to alter which genes are turned on and off and other 'body' processes.

This mind-body response can be positive or negative depending on what the stimulus is from the environment and what trance state we happen to be in at the time, which would influence how that information begins to be processed.

Life consists of a wide variety of biological rhythms which fall under these headings:

- Infradian Rhythms – which are processes that cycle over a longer than 24-hour period
- Circadian Rhythms – Which are processes that cycle over an approximate 24-hour period
- Ultradian Rhythms – which are processes that cycle over a period of less than 24 hours

Below is a list of some of the main ultradian rhythms that take place including the average time it takes for the rhythms. There is a connection between how long periods of inner work take, which fit into the longer periods of natural processes. Many genes are expressed during these rhythms. Initially you have the immediate early genes, activated within a couple of minutes, through to early response genes becoming active after a couple of hours, and then the late response genes becoming active 2-8 hours later. Following this, changes continue to take place up to about three months later.

- Panic Attack Duration (15-20 minutes)
- Typical Period of Self-Hypnosis (15-20 minutes)
- Creative & Spiritual Inspiration (20 minutes)
- Typical Meditation Period (20 minutes)
- Mother Milk Relaxation Response (20 minutes)
- Basic Rest & Activity Cycle (90-120 minutes)
- Cerebral Hemisphere Cycle (90-120 minutes)
- Appetite and Gastrointestinal Cycle (90-120 minutes)
- Memory & Learning Cycle (90-120 minutes)
- Immune Cell DNA Synthesis (90-120 minutes)
- Human Social Rhythms (90-180 minutes)

IDEO-DYNAMIC HEALING - IDEO-DYNAMICS AND HOW TO WORK WITH THEM

Ideo-dynamic healing is a term to cover all of the ideo-dynamic methods. There is:

- Automatic unconscious movement – ideo-motor
- Automatic unconscious sensations – ideo-sensory
- Automatic unconscious thoughts – ideo-cognition
- Automatic unconscious feelings – ideo-affective

As all of these are automatic and non-conscious they can be used for therapy or coaching that bypasses consciousness.

Ideo-motor

When a therapist is doing ideo-motor healing what they are doing is focusing on linking automatic unconscious movements with the therapy. This could be induced automatic movement or naturally occurring automatic movement. An approach the therapist could decide to do could be to ask the client to hold their hands out and gaze between their hands and ask whether the unconscious is willing and able to work on helping the client to overcome their problem. They can ask for the unconscious

to allow the hands to move together if it is willing and able to do that work, and to move apart if it is unwilling at this time to be helpful.

Sometimes the hands make a movement that is different to the movement asked for but the client says that the movement means yes or no. I normally wouldn't ask a question quite like this, I often ask something like 'I wonder whether those hands will begin to move together or apart when your unconscious is able to start working on helping you to resolve the problem' and then wait and see what happens. I like to assume that the client's unconscious is willing to help, rather than giving it too many options not to help.

Once it is established that the unconscious can help, the therapist can ask for a movement to signal the help is beginning, and a movement that signals the help has been completed. Any movements or changes in the client whilst they are working through their problem can be recognised and acknowledged appropriately by the therapist to let the client know they are doing the correct thing and progress is being made.

Other ideo-motor signals can be used, for example, the therapist could use a pendulum, or automatic writing, or finger signals, or utilise natural automatic movements like gestures the client does, or head movements.

Ideo-sensory

Another ideo-dynamic approach is to use automatic sensations. These are normally automatic sights or sounds or physical sensations experienced within the client. The therapist can ask for something automatic, or could set a scene, like having the client imagine a TV screen in their mind, or a chalkboard and then have the unconscious communicate through this. Or they could encourage the client to have somewhere in their mind where they can communicate with the unconscious in a form, like the form of a wise person. The advantage of this is often the therapist can get greater communication going between the client and their unconscious.

The therapist can ask the client questions about starting inner

work and finishing inner work, but can also ask about whether there are any learnings or understandings that would be useful for the client to know to be revealed on the chalkboard or TV screen or by that wise one, and this can be clearly communicated from the clients unconscious to their conscious awareness.

Inner work can also be creative, so a therapist could have the client imagine being in an art gallery and have them go up to a blank canvas and then put their hands in paint and paint the therapy they need onto that canvas, and have them keep painting the problem, and then painting over the problem with the solution until the painting is just right.

The therapist can have the client see or hear things, so the client may say they don't see anything in their mind but they hear a voice and then this voice can be worked with. If a client comes up with their own experience this is more effective and better to use than ideas dictated by the therapist.

The therapist may also work with dreams, the client would talk about a dream, or perhaps recurring dream and the therapist can work with that dream and help the client to make adjustments to the dream until the dream ends with the required resolution, or is understood, or whatever the goal of therapy happens to be.

Ideo-affective

Another ideo-dynamic approach is ideo-affective, to use automatic feelings. People always have feelings in their body. These can often be very subtle, but sometimes they can be strong. There are specific areas where feelings or bodily sensations are more or less depending on the emotion (Nummenmaa et al., 2013).

For example:

- Anger – has most feeling in the arms, chest and head, with the areas of most feeling being the hands, heart and face.

- Fear – has most feeling around the heart area with a little bit of feeling around the chest and head and hands.
- Disgust – has most feeling in the pit of the stomach with the feeling also in the oesophagus and throat area, and in the mouth, with some feeling in the hands, shoulders, chest and head. There is also a reduced feeling, or slight numbness in the groin area.
- Happiness – has feeling throughout the whole body, especially the heart, head and hands.
- Sadness – has a little bit of feeling in the chest, throat and eyes, with reduced feeling in the arms and legs.
- Surprise – has most feeling in the eyes with feeling also in the head and chest and some reduced feeling in the legs.
- Anxiety – has some feeling in the sides of the head and around the top of the head, but most feeling is in the chest spreading up to the throat and down towards the stomach with some reduced feeling through the legs.
- Love – has most feeling from the groin area up through the body to the top of the head, with feeling also in the arms, and a little bit of feeling in the legs.
- Depression – has no increase in feeling, but has numbness or a reduction in feeling mainly in the legs and arms, with a reduction of feeling in the lower body, shoulders and head.
- Contempt – has an increase in feeling in the head and down into the throat, and a little bit of increase in the hands, and a reduction of feeling in the groin area.
- Pride – has most feeling in the upper chest above the diaphragm and into the head, with some

increased feeling in the arms.

- Shame – has the most increase in feeling in the cheeks and quite an increase in the face, with some increase down the centre of the body, and a numbness or decrease in feeling in the legs and lower arms.
- Envy – has a slight increase in feeling in the top of the head, with a little bit of increased feeling in the head and neck and heart area, with a slight numbness around the waist down into the thigh area.

For any feeling to stay in awareness it has to keep shifting. We habituate to anything constant. So, if someone says they have constant pain then that means they have a pain which will seem to vanish. In reality the pain isn't constant which is why they are aware of the pain. So, a therapist can focus the client on what the experience of the pain really is, and work with this.

Therapists can ask clients to notice the feeling and describe how it moves, where it starts, where it goes, how it continues. An example could be someone says they feel panic, so they are asked where it starts and they say it starts in their chest, they then say it moves up to their throat, before cycling down to the pit of their stomach, and then coming back to their chest again.

This cycle can then be worked with. The therapist could use a technique similar to the spinning emotions technique developed by NLP founder Richard Bandler (Moya, n.d.). They could ask the client to experience that feeling cycling around faster and faster, and then taking it outside their body, still having it cycling fast, then flipping it over and keeping the movement going, and putting it back into their body cycling in this new direction. This can be enhanced by asking the client to give the feeling a colour, and maybe a sound, and a different colour, and maybe a different sound for when it changes direction.

Clients can be asked to notice feelings in relation to questions, so they could be asked to have a feeling communicate with

them, like having a feeling appear to let you know work has begun, and a feeling to let you know work has successfully been completed.

Ideo-cognitive

Ideo-cognitive healing is working with the automatic thoughts that arise within the client. So rather than it being about something they specifically see or hear as a sensory response it is their own automatic thoughts that are being worked with. For some people it is automatic thoughts that are the problem, they 'say' things to themselves that upset them or demotivate them; they perhaps call themselves stupid or useless.

A therapist can work with these thoughts, they can ask the thoughts to communicate with them (the therapist) and have a dialogue, or they can do a similar process to the one previously discussed, of asking for a response to start the inner work, and a response to say the inner work is complete.

The client can also learn to work with the automatic thoughts, can learn to listen to them and understand that the unconscious most likely wants what is best for them and just needs to be communicated with to work out a way forward. So, the client can have a dialogue to look at what is behind the automatic thoughts. For example; the automatic thoughts maybe 'you are useless, don't bother even trying'.

This may sound negative but it may be a way of trying to protect the person from getting hurt or disappointed. It could be that in the past, perhaps in school, the client did something and made a mistake and as a result had other children call them names and pick on them, and they felt bullied and humiliated and upset. So, in the present their unconscious gives this message to stop them doing things that may put them in the same situation again.

Once the client gets to this realisation, they can work through with their unconscious to look at a way forward. It could be as simple as them sharing with their unconscious that they don't need that automatic processing anymore, that they are confident at certain things and so unlikely to make the same

kind of mistake, and in situations where they do make mistakes, they are a different person and have new and updated coping skills so that the situations wouldn't make them feel humiliated, or bullied. If it turned out they didn't have the relevant skills to handle the situation in a new improved way then they can be taught this in therapy or coaching or see if these skills or this knowledge can be found in another area of their life.

Working with symptoms

Another way of using ideo-dynamics is to use symptoms as the technique. A therapist can take the symptom that a client is presenting with and use this as the technique for helping them. It could be that a smoker talks about the craving, so the therapist can ask the smoker to develop the craving, and then during the session the therapist can work with that craving, they can ask it to communicate with them, or to increase, or decrease, or go slower, they can find out where in the body the craving is and ask it to move to a different part of the body.

If the symptom was tension in the hands as someone talked about their anxiety then the therapist can talk directly to that tension in the hands as if it is a separate entity and work with it directly. Or they can again, ask it to move to another location, or to change in some way. Once the therapist and the symptom are working together, they can ask it questions, or ask it to change in some way, or even ask it to give the same message but in a new way. So, if the tension was a message to say be careful in this situation, then it could do that with a warmth, or a finger twitch, or another signal, and as long as the client knows the meaning of this new signal then the symptom is giving a message and so is happy, and the client is receiving the message and not experiencing the unhelpful symptom, so they are also happy.

Almost anything that develops in the session can be used as a technique. It is the coach or therapist's role to notice what the client brings and use it. If a client keeps rubbing their shoulder as they talk about their husband, they could be asked to close their eyes and just keep that rubbing going, and as they do, they

can be asked to allow it to develop into thoughts, and ideas that they can work on here in this session. The therapist can then work with whatever responses they get from the client.

What often happens is that the client starts talking about their husband being a pain in the neck, and how they don't really talk about it, and so haven't addressed what it is in the relationship that needs addressing. Sometimes they need to talk through with the husband, but other times now it is out in the therapy room it can be talked about and the client can have a different perspective on this issue and it may get reframed, or they may figure out a way forward with the issue, or they may decide that on reflection the problem isn't really much of a problem, most of the problem came from not addressing it. Like when someone thinks that someone else doesn't like them, and then they tell themselves all the bad things they think that person thinks about them, and then decide they don't like that person back, and actually the two people haven't spoken to know if any of this is true, it is just a perception.

IDEO-DYNAMIC HEALING DEMONSTRATION AND CLIENT COMMENTS

This is a transcript of an ideo-dynamic 'psychocellular' healing demonstration which took place on one of my hypnotherapy training days. Like all of my demonstrations, I didn't know who was going to volunteer for me to work with them or what their problem was going to be or how they would respond. I just ask the audience who would like to volunteer and then select from those who raise their hands, and ideally select someone who hasn't already volunteered that day.
You can watch this session in my FourGames eCourse. 'D' is for Dan and 'C' is for Client.

D: So, I'm not going to gather much information. I've got no intention of gathering more information, but there are things that need to change within you.
C; Mm-hmm.
D: Kind of thought processes, feelings, perhaps ideas around how to handle things in the future, et cetera. And I don't need to know those things because obviously it's within you. So, you may have seen this before or done this before. I can't remember? What I'd like you to do is rub your hands together, get a bit of energy going, open your hands up and just gaze

between those hands and you can move them around just a very little bit. And you'll probably notice there's perhaps some tingling.

> When using this approach, I like to have clients rub their hands together. I find this helps to speed up the process as rubbing the hands together gives a sensation between the hands almost like there are magnets in the hand and clients can often quickly experience what feels like the hands squeezing on opposing magnetic fields as if there is an object between the two hands. While I'm guiding the client through this process and asking the client to do things, I am doing the same so that I can have a better sense of experiencing what they may be experiencing.

C: Mm-hmm.
D: Maybe some sensations between those hands. That's it. And just gaze between those hands. And if your(you're) unconscious now is willing to work on those different issues, in its own way, just allow those hands to either move towards each other or apart. That's it. That's it. And those hands will do what they need to do, perhaps there is some energy down in the fingers. That's it. That's it. And if your(you're) unconscious is willing to start that work. It can allow that to happen through the hands or perhaps between the hands. That's it. That's it. That's it. Having the inner strength and wisdom to work on that. That's it. That's it. Continuing that work inside.

> I use an embedded suggestion 'you're unconscious now' to suggest for the client to be hypnotised. I pause a little and change how I say those words. Most clients would focus on the full sentence, thinking I mean 'your' and not 'you're' and that I am just asking if the unconscious part of them is willing to do the work now, not realising I

> was actually suggesting that they enter hypnosis. I also give the embedded suggestion to 'work on those different issues' and then a double bind linking this work with the hands moving towards each other or apart, so that if either option happens, this is a sign for the work taking place.
> Every time I say 'that's it' it is because I have noticed an unconscious or automatic response I want to continue; it could be a twitch or a subtle movement. I also comment on my observations, like the movement of the fingers giving me a sense that the client had some energy there, but just in case I'm wrong I say 'perhaps', so I'm not saying there is, but if I am correct then this is very meaningful to the client and more impactful on the experience they are having.
> When I notice the client getting emotional and engaging in that inner work, I offer some words of encouragement and support around having the inner strength to work on that and suggesting that they can continue that work inside their mind.

D: That's it. That's it. That's it. Seeing what you need to see, hearing what you need to hear, feeling what you need to feel. That's it. That's it. That's it. That's it. Allowing that work to continue. That's it. That's it. All the way. That's it. Just making all those changes. That's it. Having the feelings you need. That's it. And when you've made all the necessary changes, the fingers can start coming back, but not until you've made all the necessary changes. That's It. That's it. That's it. Gathering all those resources up, applying it in your own way. That's it. So how do you feel now? Is there anything you want to share?

> This session was about 15 minutes long. The length of the session was whatever length it ended up being and for this client and this bit of inner work, this is the length that it ended up being. I

didn't say too much during the session, most of what I did was just acknowledging the client's ongoing experience and offering support to help the client to keep on track and engaged in their inner work.

When it looked like the client had started to visualise, I acknowledged this and offered some comments around this. As it looked like the client was now engaging in some deep and meaningful inner work, I commented to support this continuing and then as they appeared like they were becoming even deeper absorbed in the experience I commented on this by suggesting 'all the way' and then 'that's it' when it appeared they were going even deeper into the experience and as they appeared to be continuing to do inner work, I suggested they could continue to make those changes. I noticed some emotion, so I suggested they can have the feelings they need.

When I started noticing that it looked like they were beginning to come to the end of their inner work and start to reorient back to the room because of movement in the fingers and the quality of the fingers - they appeared to be becoming less waxy, I suggested that once they have made the necessary changes their fingers can come back. I followed this up with a suggestion using negative phrasing and frustrating the return, to suggest they will reorient only when all the inner work is done.

Often, I find that if I just say 'you can come back once you've made the necessary changes' clients often rush back and open their eyes. Whereas if I frustrate it a little and essentially suggest to take a little time over this, then they don't rush back and seem to have a better experience.

I noticed it looked like the client was almost

> gathering something up, so I suggested gathering up resources and vaguely suggested they can apply these in their own way. Once the client fully reoriented back to the room, I asked them questions and we move into the client describing their experience and answering some audience questions. This bit is about 30 minutes long, all of which can be watched in my FourGames eCourse. Next you will see a section from this discussion.

C: Well, this is just a really, very gentle, subtle. The whole process was very gentle and subtle, and there's a part of me observing it as it was happening and slightly embarrassed about the fact that I could see it happening in front of me, as it were, and not sure where I was going to go or what was going to happen and whether I was doing it right. And, I just observed. Just observed. And it was, I saw a train and then that disappeared. That was the first thing. But not a modern train, a train from a different, almost as if it was a train from the past. From a past era, and then, then that was it. It was the, the mind was off. It was all sorts of visual imagery. And, in terms of preference, I'm not visual. I'm kinaesthetic, auditory, and so then that was it. It was like fireworks going off. There were all sorts of different images that didn't make sense, just firing off and then, I suppose the last thing that I saw was it was, it was like a pathway opened up and I could see my way forward and there was loads of moss on this path as if it was overgrown and to some extent, but that's my own interpretation. And then in terms of resources, it seemed like there was a world of opportunity, symbolically. So, I saw the world as if I was an astronaut and the sun just appearing from behind it. And I got the sense that there was a world of opportunity had occurred in a sense but I knew the direction I, there was a direction. And it showed itself, even though it was overgrown, it had shown itself. And then all this stuff, other stuff, it was as if it was put in place. It was almost like it was put in it in the right order or. It was, it was bizarre. It was, it was, things would appear that didn't make

sense and they didn't really need to, but it was, it was almost like they were being reordered or something, something significant appeared to be happening with all these, you know, like fireworks going off, but imagery in various different parts of the visual field, and then there was a part of me, which I don't like, which showed itself and it showed itself and then it just disappeared. It just, it just completely, like in a puff of smoke, it disappeared. And then there was a sense of elation and then the ordering kept going on. Then I saw the path. The path and I said the globe and the sun, the glinting behind the globe. So, it felt like there was, it was very subtle and it felt like, and I feel I'm conscious. I'm, I feel emotional, and I feel it in my, uh, from about here. There's, there's something, something that I feel that I may let go of or that I have already let go of yet it's just expressing itself. Um, psychosomatically, if you wish, you know, through the body, through the visceral tissue. So, yeah, that wasn't bad. You set the process in motion very gently, very subtly, and, and I was convinced it wasn't going to happen, and it did. And then it went even further than that. I kind of, there was a part of me that was observing it consciously as it went on, and then I indulged in the orchestra of visual imagery like fireworks displaying that. Thank you very much.

> The client continues to give descriptions and explanations about their experience and I share with the students some of what I was doing during the session and together we respond to students' questions.
> What is interesting is that I never told the client to close their eyes, they just spontaneously did this when they felt it was right for them. I never suggested for them to think of trains, moss, space or any of the metaphors or inner experience that they had. All I did was ask them to rub their hands together, gaze through their hands and if they are willing to do that inner work, for the hands to signal that.

They had this spontaneous inner healing response that was far more complex and detailed than I would ever have been likely to come up with, and in this case I had pretty much no information to go on. The client had mentioned just a few sentences as they walked to the front of the room and attached their microphone, but even these few bits, I never referenced and so didn't need to know, but it also wouldn't have been enough information for me to be as creative as they were in their own mind, doing their own healing.

In ordinary therapy or coaching sessions, I also wouldn't have asked the client or had an audience asking a client about their inner experience, so I wouldn't have known that the client had done any of this as their own self-therapy. I would have just done the process and noticed the non-verbal behaviours and then continued to the end of the session without knowing what their inner experience was like.

THE FOURGAMES OF GENIUS - INTRODUCTION

One of the interesting things about the FourGames model is that it allows you to have a structure for understanding human experience and you can use this structure to explore others human experience.

Each and every one of us has our own unique FourGames fingerprint but it is probably a better metaphor to say that we have a set of FourGames fingerprints. Each print has elements of similarity, for example the Deep-Game that we have may drive many of our FourGames fingerprints across many areas of life.

We may be driven by an alignment with nature and with trying to live in harmony with the world around us, and so our FourGames family fingerprint, how we parent, how we do relationships, may be guided by that fundamental principle of living in harmony with nature. The career path we choose, the jobs we are willing to do and not willing to do, may be shaped by this fundamental principle. The way we approach our diet and exercise may all be driven by this fundamental principle of living in harmony with nature.

Yet each FourGames fingerprint may well have different but perhaps overlapping long, mid or Short-Games. We may have certain goals or roles which cover many areas of life and others specific to individual areas, like work or home life. We may

have an environment shaped to be aligned with our Deep-Game but aspect or specific areas of the environment may be specific to certain areas of life, so we may have a work environment set up in a way which helps to do our best work, a home environment which helps us to do our best parenting and relationships and perhaps specific environmental elements which help us to do the best at looking after ourselves.

We may have different Short-Games for different situations. We may be naturally assertive in our thinking and behaviours and have specific feelings within work that helps us to get the best out of ourselves in that context, but that kind of assertiveness and those specific types of thinking, behaviours and feelings don't, or rarely are a part of our home life Short-Game. And if you did start doing the workplace Short-Game at home it would probably negatively impact on relationships and family life, and so if something happened to make the two perhaps overlap, clash or conflict like if you normally work in a workplace but suddenly have to work from home, then it could lead to relationship problems as you are perhaps your work-self accidentally with family and loved ones and are too assertive with them, or negatively impact on work life as you are not assertive enough and have the wrong attitude for doing your job.

When you are looking at the FourGames of others you want to try to be specific about what you want to know. Do you want Tesla's FourGames fingerprint for socialising? Probably not. If you wanted to know Tesla's FourGames fingerprint, you probably want to know how he was so creative and insightful. How did he develop his ideas? So, this is the FourGames fingerprint you would explore.

When talking about the FourGames of Genius and uncovering FourGames fingerprints, it could be the FourGames fingerprint of an individual, like Tesla, or Einstein, or a successful entrepreneur or sports person, or even that person at work who seems to just be incredible at a specific aspect of the job that you wish you could emulate. Or it could be the FourGames fingerprint of a successful business where the whole business

tries to run like a whole being with a Deep-Game philosophy that drives everything the business does, Long-Games within the business which align with the Deep-Game, Mid-Game environment which helps facilitate the desired Short-Game to help everyone work in harmony towards the Long-Games and in line with the Deep-Game, and each individuals Short-Games are similar in certain ways, yet with flexibility depending on their specific role, almost like cells in a body working in harmony with the whole to keep the body functioning in a healthy way.

To uncover the FourGames fingerprints of specific individuals or businesses it is about learning and identification of the FourGames fingerprint of the person or business you want to model. I don't know anything about golf and so off the top of my head I wouldn't be able to give you the FourGames fingerprint for Tiger Woods golf strategy. I wouldn't be able to tell you what his Deep-Game is, what his Long-Game is, what his Mid-Game is or his Short-Game. I could try to have educated guesses, based on what I think someone would need to play golf well, but they would only be guesses. If I wanted to know Tiger Woods' FourGames fingerprint for playing golf I would have to research this.

During the research I would go in with an open mind. I don't know what is going to be important. I would have a blank FourGames mandala to take notes on and perhaps something to record additional notes in, in case I wanted to record more details than I would be able to put on the mandala. I would see if he has ever written or spoken specifically about how he plays golf. Has he written or created any courses about this topic? I would compile a library of content to explore.

You may not need all of the content you gather up because a lot of it may be repetitive, but in the initial stages you want to get a library of everything you can find. Then I would explore that content and be looking for his patterns as well as where he mentions things which can be recorded on the FourGames mandala. For example, maybe he doesn't drink alcohol or take any substances from a week before he needs to be at his peak

performance, so this would be part of his pattern that if you were to emulate it, you would also not drink or take any drugs within a week of you wanting to perform at your best.

Perhaps he changes his sleeping habits to get more sleep and changes his diet, eating and exercise habits in the run up to needing to be at his best. So, as well as these things being mapped onto the FourGames mandala, like perhaps uncovering one Long-Game goal of being match-fit so to speak, maybe some Mid-Game areas like ensuring his environment doesn't have temptations or distractions in it, the Mid-Game gadgets could include only having healthy food and drink available around him, exercise equipment, maybe he stays somewhere with a golf course so that he can wake up and practice every day.

Maybe you map onto the FourGames mandala, the thinking he is doing, like his assertiveness with himself about what he will say no to and what he will focus on and encourage himself to do, his behaviours of eating and drinking healthy, exercising and getting to bed at a reasonable time every night. Maybe as you continue to explore Tiger Woods' FourGames fingerprint for excelling at golf, you get to learning about the day he has to play at his best perhaps under pressure, you learn about how he prepares himself for this, what thinking, behaviours and feelings he has at this time, what environment he likes to be in.

It may well be that his Long-Game has shifted now slightly, from being match fit on the day, to playing his best or being in the zone while playing. In his Long-Game, he still obviously has a match-fit Long-Game, but the aspect of his Long-Game he is focusing on now, or which is driving him now is, the day has arrived and he wants to play to win. These may all align with his Deep-Game, whatever that happens to be. It could be to be a provider for his family, it could be to be a positive role model to others, or focused on how he wants to be remembered.

Then as you continue on exploring Tiger Woods' FourGames fingerprint, you get to when he is actually playing golf. How is he thinking while playing golf, what does he think about, where does he focus his attention, how does he behave, what is he

feeling, what clubs does he use, what does he wear, etc. You may even break this down into different areas, like focusing on his mindset while playing golf, the thinking he is doing, his behaviours, and how he feels, and Mid-Game elements like the clothes he is wearing, any other gadgets, the clubs he is using, support he has etc.

And how he actually takes shots. It could be that he has described how he judges or learns about the wind speed and direction, how he learns about the intricacies of the golf course, how he chooses the club to use, how he holds the club, how he swings the club, where he focuses his attention and his eyes. For example, does he focus his eyes and attention in a pattern, like looking at where the ball has to go while he aligns himself with the place and gets an idea of what it will take to get the ball to that location, an idea of the required strength, the best club to help him strike the ball as he needs to, where and how he needs to hit the ball to compensate for the weather, etc.

Then does he focus his eyes and attention on the ball, before getting himself physically back into the planned position, constantly checking with the location he will be hitting the ball to, before moving the club a little to ensure everything is lined up and while looking at the ball, keeping his focus on the ball as he swings and then following the ball as it is struck and keeping his attention on the ball until it comes to a rest.

There are many aspects of the FourGames fingerprint for excelling at golf which you can explore. Some of what you uncover may not be relevant. For example, the psychiatrist Milton Erickson, who was one of the world's leading psychiatrists was in a wheelchair, he would occasionally utilise his disabilities in therapy, but the fact that he was sat down all of the time, or in a wheelchair isn't a part of his FourGames fingerprint which made him effective at what he did. But at the same time, if you research Milton Erickson, you will learn that when he was a wheelchair-bound old man this would disarm some level of resistance among some clients who otherwise would have been more resistant, just like his status as 'the best' helped with his outcomes.

People came to him expecting him to be successful. They often saw him as this frail and kind old man. So, you could uncover these elements and think that although being in a wheelchair isn't necessary for effective therapy, he used this to his advantage, which is part of his Short-Game, where he was using the client's perspective and this Mid-Game gadget to increase his effectiveness. So, you may think, is this something I could replicate, is it necessary to replicate this, what is it about this which makes it effective at increasing therapeutic outcomes?

What you can do is initially test out all aspects of the FourGames fingerprint that you have uncovered, and then if there are bits which seem like they aren't relevant, test without those elements. For example, if Tiger Woods says something like he always wears his lucky pants, this clearly isn't a necessary step to excelling at golf, but if he says he wears pants with a certain fit because it helps with range of motion and comfort, then this may add just a few percentage points to your effectiveness if you were to do the same.

One thing you have probably noticed is that once you learn how to do this and you uncover people's FourGames fingerprints for success, if you are competitive, like if you are a sports person and you come up against this sportsperson who you have uncovered the FourGames fingerprint of, you could use this to your advantage. Say for example, you were a professional snooker player and you have uncovered your opponent's FourGames fingerprint and this player likes a quiet, focused environment to play, and they like to play in a specific strategic way. You may perhaps take on the role as a player of moving more while playing this person so that out of their peripheral vision they notice the movement and just feel a little uncomfortable. Maybe you sniff a little as if you have a slight cold, just to disrupt the environment they play best in. Maybe you decide that your playstyle will be one of putting them in a position where they have to take certain types of shots they are least comfortable with, or that disrupt the flow of the game they like.

Maybe you sometimes take turns very quickly so that they

barely have time to sit and compose between shots, and other times taking a slightly uncomfortably long time on an aspect of a shot so that they struggle to be in the rhythm they play best in.

In the next few chapters, we will explore the FourGames of Genius approach. This approach has 8-steps. The first four steps are the identification steps, the second four steps are the application steps.

THE FOURGAMES OF GENIUS APPROACH - PART ONE: IDENTIFICATION

In this chapter and the next we will explore the FourGames of Genius approach. In this chapter we will focus on the first four steps and then in the next chapter we will focus on the four application steps.
We have already touched on this during the introduction, but here we can take a look in a more structured way.
The FourGames of Genius Approach has eight steps. The first four steps aren't four back-to-back steps, you will likely complete these steps in whatever order you gather information. The first four steps are to identify in relation to the FourGames fingerprint you are uncovering, the:

- Stage One: Short-Game elements
- Stage Two: Mid-Game elements
- Stage Three: Long-Game elements
- Stage Four: Deep-Game elements

To do this you will want to know as much about the person as possible in relation to the fingerprint you are uncovering.
You may get this information from books, interviews,

biographies or documentaries. You may get some of the information from personal observation of watching that person doing what it is you want to learn. You may observe the person in the run up to doing what you are learning and notice the environment they are keeping themselves in, the clothes they are wearing, the tools or gadgets they are using, their breathing, where they seem to be focused, how they interact with people around them.

When they are actually doing the thing you want to learn, you can notice their behaviours, their tools and gadgets, if there are any clues about the preferred environment, where they focus their attention, what they attend to and what they seem to ignore.

You will want to gather information in relation to their FourGames of the past. Did they have a specific mind-set, or specific Deep-Game or Long-Game which has been a driving force for them since they were a young child? How did they get into this thing they are a genius at? Is this relevant? For example, a work colleague may be a genius at presenting, but they got into it because they were told at work that they had to teach this specific course and since then that is what they have done. So, they didn't necessarily have a driving force or desire for this. It could be that once they were doing it, they found that they just naturally had a talent for storytelling and so this is their backstory to why they are so good at presenting, so learning about storytelling would be key to emulating this individual.

It is important to note that you wouldn't be able to for example, be a person who has never played guitar and then you learn the strategies of an incredible guitarist and now you can copy them. A bit like with the example I just gave, sometimes you will uncover areas of skills you need to learn. Other times, what you are trying to emulate isn't the thing the person does, but rather how they do it. So, you may find someone who seems to be incredibly creative. You may not want to necessarily emulate that person's specific area of creativity, but you would like to know how they are so creative and then see how you can apply that within the area that you would like the creativity.

I gave Tiger Woods as an example previously. But it could be that you don't have any experience with golf, you don't plan on learning golf. Obviously, if you did, hopefully by modelling an excellent golfer you would be able to learn better and faster because you could be applying the person's FourGames fingerprint to what you are doing. But maybe what you want is to learn their fingerprint for success. So, for Tiger Woods. You aren't so interested in how he holds the clubs, how he swings them, how he actually plays. You want to know what it takes to get to a Tiger Woods level. So, a lot of the other stuff I mentioned. If those were things you uncovered, you would look at it from the perspective of what it teaches you or means to you about his journey to being so successful at what he does.

Maybe it is that his area of interest dominates his mind almost all day every day, especially as he was learning and rising to the top. Maybe the hours he put in and how he put those hours in is important. So, you want to know who you want to model, why you want to model that person, what it is about them you want to be able to do for yourself? Then how did this person start on their journey to mastery, what was their short, mid, long and Deep-Game back then?

Not everything will necessarily be relevant, but these are useful areas to explore. Then you want to know the present situation and potentially how they keep themselves improving and developing their mastery. So, with the Tiger Woods example, I mentioned up to the point of him playing golf and what he is doing while excelling at playing golf. But if you want to know how he plays and masters golf, then you are likely to want to explore what he does after he has played as well. Does he mentally analyse his play, does he then do targeted practice off of the back of this, where say he didn't perform at his best on a few examples of a specific type of shot, does he then set the task of practising this one type of shot over and over again, analysing it, going back to basics with technique etc to make sure everything is right and only moving forward to more general practice once he has that shot at the same level as everything else.

With a therapist, say Milton Erickson, after client sessions does he analyse how the session went, review the session in his mind, listen to a recording of the session, explore areas where he felt he missed something or didn't do as well as he would have liked and then practise this area until he has mastered it so that in future situations he will do better.

So, by the end of the identification stage, you will have completed the first four steps, you will have identified who you want to model, why or what about them you want to model, how they got into and have been motivated enough to remain in their area of interest to the point of mastery. What the person's short, mid, long and Deep-Games are. Depending on what you are hoping to gain from this, you may have identified this for their early journey as well as around the pattern they have, like in the run up to carrying out the thing they are genius at, when they are in the situation they are a genius in, when they are doing what they are a genius at, and how they continue to remain at the top of their game after they have done what they are a genius at.

THE FOURGAMES OF GENIUS APPROACH - PART TWO: APPLICATION

In this second part of the FourGames of Genius Approach we will look at stages five to eight. Unlike stages one to four, which were completed as you had information to place under each of the four stages you were gathering information: short, mid, long and Deep-Games, these stages are completed in order.

The four application stages are:

- Stage five: Try each game on
- Stage six: Become that person
- Stage seven: Anchor this FourGames fingerprint
- Stage eight: Integrate this FourGames fingerprint

Following these stages you may go back through them, gathering and adding more information as it arises or you may make some changes, try on this FourGames fingerprint with these changes and test this until it is how you want it and based on the experiences you are having. So going through each of these four stages.

Stage Five

The fifth stage is trying on each of the FourGames in turn. Depending on what you are doing, this could be trying on the Short-Game for example which the person had when they started out, or it could be that what is relevant is just to try on how they do what they do when they are doing it, so you just try on the Short-Game of doing the thing this person is genius at. It is helpful to move around or look around a little between each step. So, you may close your eyes and absorb yourself in the Short-Game, try this on, see what it is like to have a sense of thinking, feeling, behaving with this Short-Game. Then open your eyes and look around, or if you are doing this physically, open your eyes and move to the next location, then close your eyes and absorb yourself in having a sense of taking on this person's FourGames fingerprint Mid-Game, and then repeat this process for the Long-Game and Deep-Game.

If there are things you feel you would change, for example, maybe an aspect of it doesn't resonate with who you are as a being, you can try on those areas again, but making your changes to them. For example, as someone who does hypnosis, my personality is calm, quiet, slow and methodical. It isn't loud and flamboyant or dramatic etc. So, other than if I am demonstrating it on training courses, I rarely do shock or surprise rapid hypnotic inductions, instead preferring gentle and calm inductions. If I was trying on someone's FourGames fingerprint and it had something like this, like trying on a famous hypnotists FourGames fingerprint, then I would want to explore alternatives which perhaps meet the same function but fit me as a person, or explore whether those elements are really necessary or are perhaps just an expression of the personality of the individual.

Stage Six

After you have tried on each of the FourGames individually you want to have a sense of what it is like to be like that person, to take on their full FourGames fingerprint. Step six is where you

become the person. You absorb yourself in their FourGames, you have a sense of viewing the world from within their FourGames. You imagine yourself applying this FourGames fingerprint, taking on their short, mid, long and Deep-Games.
If you continue to be comfortable with this you can move on to the next step. If you identify areas which don't fit you or don't feel right or that you think need tweaking now you are experiencing this all together, now is when you can go back and do that. Perhaps going back to the previous stage and tweaking a single game, or going back to identifying more about one or more of the games if needed, and then working back through the stages you have altered until you get to this stage and are happy with it.

Stage Seven

Once you are happy with this stage, you can move on to stage seven. Stage seven is where you anchor this FourGames fingerprint. Anchoring is where you connect a stimulus and a response. You are essentially setting up some triggers which you can use to evoke the onset of this FourGames fingerprint. It is useful to set up a physical trigger or anchor and a verbal trigger or anchor.
The physical trigger could be touching the forefinger and thumb of one hand together, or gently pinching your ear with a thumb and finger. The verbal trigger isn't something which needs to be said out loud, you could say it to yourself in your mind, but it is ideally a statement or phrase which encapsulates for you that FourGames fingerprint. Once you have thought about these anchors or triggers you can practise using them. You can close your eyes and set off the triggers and allow yourself to be absorbed in that FourGames fingerprint. And then open your eyes, look around the room before closing your eyes again as you fire off those triggers and allow yourself once again to be absorbed in that FourGames fingerprint. And repeat this process a number of times so that it becomes easier to absorb yourself in that FourGames fingerprint using those triggers.

You can end by setting off those triggers, absorbing yourself in the FourGames fingerprint and then while in that FourGames fingerprint, you can slowly and gently open your eyes and hold on to the experience and see what it is like to be in this fingerprint, what you can observe about your experience. You can practise this as much as you need to until you can comfortably move around remaining within the FourGames fingerprint. Obviously, the more you practise this the easier this process gets, for doing this with this FourGames fingerprint and then with other fingerprints.

Stage Eight

Once you can do this, then you can move on to the final stage, stage eight, which is integrating this into your life. In this stage you will continue similar to what you have been doing, but instead of doing all of that in the present, you will imagine situations in the future where you want that FourGames fingerprint to be activated. You can see yourself in your mind's eye as if on a TV or cinema screen in situations in the future where you trigger this FourGames fingerprint. You can observe how you know that you on the screen has triggered the FourGames fingerprint and what you observe now it is active.

You can see yourself on that screen triggering the FourGames fingerprint at the right time and then experiencing how things go with the FourGames fingerprint active. What can you notice about how that you behaves, their body language, the way they interact with others, their tone of voice, how others are reacting to them?

You can notice what their Mid-Game is like, observe the environment, gadgets, systems. Notice as much as you can about what is going on in that movie and how it goes when that you in the movie has that FourGames fingerprint active.

If you are happy with how having that fingerprint active makes that future potential situation go, you can then imagine the scene changing to another future potential situation, doing the same again, and then another and another. The idea is that you want to see how things go in a more preferred way because that

you in the movies has that FourGames fingerprint active.
Once you have done this disassociated in this way, where you have seen yourself with that FourGames fingerprint, experiencing this from the outside in, you now do the same again, but this time associated. So, you restart the movies on that screen, only this time, imagine walking over to the screen and stepping into that you on the screen, so that you can experience this from the inside out.
Notice what you can see, hear and feel. Be aware of what inner dialogue you use and how you use that inner dialogue. Notice the environment around you, how you think about things, beliefs you feel that you are holding, and as much else as you can about this experience of now going through those movies again triggering that FourGames fingerprint and then having that FourGames fingerprint active.
As one movie ends, start the next, and then the next, changing the scenes like you did before, only this time you are in those scenes, seeing what you will see, hearing what you will hear, feeling what you will feel, experiencing what you will experience. With each scene, have a sense of triggering the FourGames fingerprint at the correct time and then experiencing the scene with that FourGames fingerprint active.
Once you have done this and feel you have practised enough that you feel you know how you need to respond in future situations and have an idea of when it is helpful for that FourGames fingerprint to be active, then you can drift back to yourself here in the present and open your eyes and move around a little as you have completed this final stage of the process. At the end of this process, you may decide to use implementation intentions, which are self-suggestions to respond in a specific automatic way in the future when certain environmental cues occur, as a way of enhancing the effectiveness of the FourGames fingerprint becoming activated where needed in the future
These suggestions take on the form of 'if...then'. So, you may say 'if I find myself in x situation or setting, then the y FourGames fingerprint will become active'. And you make sure

while you are giving this self-suggestion that you are absorbed in what you are doing, you are paying it your full attention and that you repeat this a number of times, perhaps half a dozen times when you set it up, then a handful of times per day over the coming weeks to help you to know this is important to you. Then I often remind myself of this once I'm actually in a setting as well.

You can do this process in your mind, or if you are a coach or therapist, you can guide someone through this approach in their mind with them just perhaps sitting in front of you or on the other end of a video call etc. But you can also be more active which can help with embodying this experience. You can have five FourGames symbols on the floor, the short, mid, long and Deep-Game symbols and the symbol of all the games together. And then rather than just have the person sitting static you can have them stand on the Short-Game symbol when absorbing themselves in trying on the Short-Game, the Mid-Game symbol when trying on the Mid-Game, Long-Game symbol when trying on the Long-Game and Deep-Game symbol when trying on the Deep-Game. Then they can stand on the symbol of all the games together to try on what it is like to have the full FourGames fingerprint active.

They can also stand on this symbol when they are guided through mentally rehearsing and practising what it is like to take on this FourGames fingerprint, when they anchor it and when they test it out.

THE FOURGAMES OF GENIUS APPROACH - TRY IT OUT

In this chapter I'm going to guide you through the FourGames of Genius Approach. To do this I'm going to use Nikola Tesla as an example. You can record yourself saying what I have written so that you can be guided through the experience, following along to your narration, or you can find me narrating this on my FourGames eCourse if you want to hear me guiding you through the process.

Nikola Tesla had two incredible abilities, one was to foresee future potentials, the other was his visualisation skills, to be able to create inventions in his mind and only when the mental creation worked would he then build the real thing. Here I will explore the FourGames of Genius Approach based around what I know of Tesla. There are many different angles which could be taken to get a Tesla Inventor FourGames fingerprint depending on exactly what it is you want to model.

Stage One: Short-Game

Tesla was naturally blessed with an incredible ability to visualise. He described how he struggled when he was young because realistic, vivid mental images of actual experiences would uncontrollably appear in his mind's eye so realistic that he would sometimes question whether it was real or not.

He shared about struggling to remove these mental images, that

he would physically try to push them away to no avail. He said this happened with images of anything real, so if he had seen something distressing this could appear in his mind's eye as real as the original event was and would be distressing and traumatic.

Tesla shared that he didn't have the ability to bring to mind mental images of made-up things, but to tackle his problem he trained himself to do this. So, Tesla has a natural ability which many others may not possess and so may take a long time to develop through practice, but if we start looking at the Short-Game at the point where Tesla started developing his imaginative mind, that would likely be a helpful place to start.

Tesla shared about how he initially tried to think about other things he was familiar with, but what ended up working best was to think about novel, new things, things he had never encountered before. It took him a very long time to develop the ability to visualise in this way, but through daily dedication and practice he managed to master being able to create vivid, realistic mental experiences of things he hadn't encountered before. He absorbed himself in the inner experience of visualising so that it was more than just visual, he would find the visualisation evoked emotion in him, it would have sound and movement. He was able to manipulate his visualisations and have control over them rather than them having control over him.

In his Short-Game Tesla would sit still and close his eyes. With his eyes closed he would allow a dark uniform blue background to develop in his mind's eye. After a few seconds the scene in his mind would become animated and green flakes would fall around him in layers, before colourful parallel lines would appear, everything would get brighter and brighter turning into a field of twinkling lights before passing across his vision, leaving behind what looks like a cloud of grey billowy clouds. At this point Tesla would be able to work on exploring his inventions in his mind. He would think of what would solve a problem or be helpful for humanity.

He would visualise this existing and working in his mind's eye

and examine and explore what he is visualising, looking at how it works and tweaking it and testing it in his mind until he is satisfied, and then he takes action and builds it where he would put in many hours per day dedicated and obsessing about his work.
For this approach, perhaps you would like to come up with and develop ideas in your specific field of work, so you close your eyes, visualise a world with the solution to a problem. You examine that solution, notice how it works, how it is helpful, etc. To help with visualising this, perhaps you allow a similar transition from external focus to internal focus to Tesla, where you allow your mind to settle and be ready before you start visualising. Then you visualise the development of the ideas or developments, tweak them and when they seem correct and you feel that they are correct, then you can take action on those ideas.

Stage Two: Mid-Game
Tesla's Mid-Game in relation to developing ideas and inventions was that he would be alone in a quiet location with minimal distractions where he could comfortably close his eyes and focus on what he is doing.

Stage Three: Long-Game
Tesla's Long-Game would be to invent things which aligned with his Deep-Game desire of improving the world. So, he would have an idea of what he wanted to achieve, he would develop this in his mind, then work out what he has to do to be able to make it in real-life, this might for example, involve having to raise funds and find a workspace. He would then go through the stages of developing and testing that idea or invention and finding a way for it to be out there helping people. So, one Long-Game could be to create x invention and make it available for people.

Stage Four: Deep-Game
Tesla's Deep-Game seemed to be to be helpful to mankind, he

often spoke about wanting to bring free energy to everyone no matter where in the world they lived. He spoke of wanting his ideas and inventions to help people, rather than focusing on profit and what he could get from things.
So, once we have been through these identification steps, we move on to the application stage where we try this out for ourselves. It is helpful to move around or look around a little between each step. So, you may close your eyes and absorb yourself in the Short-Game, try this on. See what it is like to have a sense of thinking, feeling, behaving with Tesla's Short-Game. Then open your eyes and look around, or if you are doing this physically, open your eyes and move to the next location, then close your eyes and absorb yourself in having a sense of taking on Tesla's FourGames fingerprint Mid-Game, and then repeat this process for the Long-Game and Deep-Game.

Stage Five: Try Each Game On
So, firstly the Short-Game. Take a moment to close your eyes. And with your eyes closed just notice what is going on internally for you, just be an observer. Notice what colours, shapes and patterns appear within your visual field. What you are doing is just letting your mind settle, from external focus to internal focus. Allow that to happen in its own time. Then once your inner visual field seems to have settled, allow an idea of the future within an area that you can be helpful in to develop and allow the solution for that future situation to develop. Or whatever would be right for you. So, if it isn't so much about developing an idea which could solve a problem, but perhaps about developing some other idea, then just gently hold your focus on the idea of being helpful and whatever idea develops in your mind, just begin to let it form.
And as you let that form, you can continue to relax, allowing your body to relax, your breathing to relax. Just being absorbed in this experience. Notice what you can hear, feel, and see internally within this inner experience. And then open your eyes, look around for a moment and then close your eyes.

And with your eyes closed, imagine yourself in a quiet, relaxing location. Explore what that is like as a location to engage in this process, to engage in Tesla's Short-Game. And then open your eyes, look around for a moment and then close your eyes.
And with your eyes closed, have a sense of the Long-Game of having your idea a reality, fully completed and in use or whatever the end result is for that item. Notice some of the steps required to get from the beginning to this stage. Notice how the completion of this Long-Game makes you feel, what it means to yourself and others and the impact of this Long-Game being achieved. And then open your eyes, look around for a moment and then close your eyes.
And with your eyes closed, have a sense of almost meditating on the Deep-Game, on the idea of being helpful to others and how that has been a gently guiding focus through those other games, almost like it has been holding the ship on course. And now finally open your eyes, look around a moment and then close your eyes.

Stage Six: Become That Person
And with your eyes closed, have a sense of trying on all of Tesla's Inventor FourGames fingerprint, trying on having your Short-Game of visualising, of creating, etc, aligned with the calm Mid-Game environment, perhaps sitting in the most comfortable Mid-Game chair. Aligned with the Long-Game of achieving that success with your idea, which is aligned with your Deep-Game of being helpful to others.

Stage Seven: Anchor This FourGames Fingerprint
And now, while you allow yourself to be absorbed in the full Tesla Inventor FourGames fingerprint, just let the thumb and forefinger of your right hand come together as you also think of a word or short phrase which you can say to yourself in the future as a trigger to enter this FourGames fingerprint any time you bring that thumb and forefinger together and say that trigger word or phrase.
And bring that thumb and forefinger together as you say that

word or phrase. And now relax that thumb and forefinger and gently allow your eyes to open, look around a moment and then close your eyes and repeat the same again. Bring the thumb and forefinger together as you say that word or phrase and allow that Tesla Inventor FourGames fingerprint to develop. And then again relax that thumb and forefinger and gently allow your eyes to open, look around a moment and then close your eyes and repeat the same again.

Bring the thumb and forefinger together as you say that word or phrase and allow that Tesla Inventor FourGames fingerprint to develop. And then relax that thumb and forefinger and gently allow your eyes to open, look around a moment and then close your eyes and repeat the same for a third time. Bring the thumb and forefinger together as you say that word or phrase and allow that Tesla Inventor FourGames fingerprint to develop.

And now slowly and gently open your eyes and hold on to the experience and see what it is like to be in this Tesla Inventor FourGames fingerprint, what you can observe about your experience, what does this feel like? What do you notice about the way you are thinking and perceiving the world? And you can practise this as often as you need to until you can comfortably move around remaining within the FourGames fingerprint.

Stage Eight: Integrate This FourGames Fingerprint

But for now, just allow your eyes to close again and imagine that you are relaxing back into the most comfortable chair and you can see yourself in your mind's eye as if on a TV or cinema screen in situations in the future where you trigger this Tesla Inventor FourGames fingerprint. You can observe how you know that you on the screen has triggered the FourGames fingerprint and what you observe now it is active.

You can see yourself on that screen triggering the FourGames fingerprint at the right time and then experiencing how things go with the Tesla Inventor FourGames fingerprint active. What can you notice about how that you behaves, their body language, the way they interact with others, their tone of voice,

how others are reacting to them?

You can notice what their Mid-Game is like, observe the environment, gadgets, systems. Notice as much as you can about what is going on in that movie and how it goes when that you in the movie has that Tesla Inventor FourGames fingerprint active.

If you are happy with how having that fingerprint active makes that future potential situation go, you can then imagine the scene changing to another future potential situation, doing the same again. And then another. And another. The idea is that you want to see how things go in a more preferred way because that you in the movies has that Tesla Inventor FourGames fingerprint active.

Once you have done this disassociated in this way, where you have seen yourself with that FourGames fingerprint, experiencing this from the outside in, you can now do the same again, but this time associated. So, restart the movies on that screen, only this time, imagine walking over to the screen and stepping into that you on the screen, so that you can experience this from the inside out. Notice what you can see, hear and feel. Be aware of what inner dialogue you use and how you use that inner dialogue. Notice the environment around you, how you think about things. Beliefs you feel that you are holding, and as much else as you can about this experience of now going through those movies again triggering that Tesla Inventor FourGames fingerprint and then having that FourGames fingerprint active.

As one movie ends, start the next. And then the next. Changing the scenes like you did before, only this time you are in those scenes, seeing what you will see, hearing what you will hear, feeling what you will feel, experiencing what you will experience. With each scene, have a sense of triggering the Tesla Inventor FourGames fingerprint at the correct time and then experiencing the scene with that FourGames fingerprint active.

Once you have done this and feel you have practised enough that you feel you know how you need to respond in future

situations, and have an idea of when it is helpful for that FourGames fingerprint to be active. Then just before you drift back to yourself here in the present, you can say to yourself 'If I find myself in situations the Tesla Inventor FourGames fingerprint would be helpful, then the Tesla Inventor FourGames fingerprint will instinctively activate'

And then just repeat that with conviction to yourself a second time. 'If I find myself in situations the Tesla Inventor FourGames fingerprint would be helpful, then the Tesla Inventor FourGames fingerprint will instinctively activate'

And one final time. 'If I find myself in situations the Tesla Inventor FourGames fingerprint would be helpful, then the Tesla Inventor FourGames fingerprint will instinctively activate'

And now you can gently drift back to yourself here in the present, open your eyes and move around a little as you have completed this final stage of this process.

So, it is important that you now make sure you are fully back to the here and now, so stretch a little, perhaps move about and look about a bit. And you can use this anytime you like to practise and improve. This has been just a quick example of using this FourGames Genius Approach to give you a taste of what it is like whether you decide to use it for yourself for personal development or to help others in coaching, therapy, training or teaching.

DAY-DREAMING FOR SUCCESS

When I looked at highly successful people in their chosen fields from Entrepreneurs like Richard Branson & Peter Jones to Geniuses like Albert Einstein & Leonardo Da Vinci, and creative people like Beethoven & Walt Disney I discovered that they all had one thing in common. They all spent time daydreaming about their area of success.

For example:

- "When I get an idea, I start at once building it up in my imagination." Nikola Tesla
- "When I heard the music, it made pictures in my head...here are the pictures." Walt Disney (Describing the film Fantasia)
- "I...go over again in the imagination the main outlines of the forms previously studied, or of other noteworthy things conceived by ingenious speculation; and this exercise is entirely to be commended, and it is useful in fixing things in the memory." Leonardo Da Vinci
- "I would sit in my father's office chair and pretend I was in charge of a big company – a big dream for a school boy but one that ultimately came true...I believe a vibrant imagination is the lifeblood of a

> successful entrepreneur." Peter Jones (From his book 'Tycoon')

Every person I looked at had daydreaming as a part of their strategy for success. I discovered that you really do seem to get what you spend most of your time dreaming about.
From this discovery I began to look further into research on dreaming. I found that dreaming enhances creativity, updates patterns in the mind (retention of new information) and bypasses the critical factor (so that you don't question the likelihood of what is happening in the dream, you just go with it). These discoveries led to my understanding of what makes daydreaming so important for success.
When you daydream, anything is possible and unlike night-time dreaming there is a greater sense of malleability (often in night-time dreaming you just experience it without control unless you can 'lucid dream'). You can slow down or speed up time, zoom in or out, be associated or disassociated, add or take away what you like, alter the laws of physics, and so much more. As dreaming updates patterns in the mind, what you dream about becomes a part of who you are. Dream of being successful and you're more likely to become successful. I discovered that how you dream is important. It isn't about just dreaming once; it needs to be so compelling that you can't stop yourself dreaming about what you want to achieve until you have got it. It has to motivate you into action.
I found that these dreams take a specific form. Firstly, the BIG dream; what do you REALLY want? Then dreaming how you will get there or what the stages are, followed by frequent dreams of the bigger picture and what you need to do over the next few stages towards success. This pattern of dreaming leads to increased motivation and an increase in 'luck' or opportunities.
Part of becoming successful is to be able to learn a chosen subject successfully. For successful learning I found that people need the opportunity to daydream about what they are being taught. Sports psychologists use visualisation. Studies have

shown that those that use visualisation outperform those that use practice alone (Hinshaw, 1991).
Teachers tell pupils off for not paying attention or daydreaming in class; they should instead be encouraging and facilitating daydreaming. As long as the daydreaming is related to the subject rather than to something like 'what will I be doing later' the pupil will be updating patterns in their mind adding the new learning to what they already know.
I discovered a number of ways to encourage this daydreaming. I found that once something has been taught the mind needs to update the patterns within about 20 minutes; and it takes about 10 to 20 minutes for this updating to be completed. If you take longer than twenty minutes before starting to update the patterns much of what was learnt has drifted from the mind. It will still be there somewhere but it would now be very difficult to recall it (unless it has strong emotion attached to it).
Ways to encourage this updating include:

- Using relaxation and pleasant guided imagery (this stimulates a daydream state when done correctly)
- Allowing the person to doodle (as they doodle, they drift into a daydream state)
- Facilitating natural daydreaming (allowing it to happen when it is observed)

To help you to achieve success you can use the 'Six Step Success Plan'
Before I show you the 'Six Step Success Plan', here is a collection of some more people that have, or do use dreaming to achieve their success:
"I imagine a vast web of possible future paths in my head, like trails on a map. I mentally explore paths that catch my interest. After I find the ones that motivate me, I revisit them often and get fascinated about what would have to happen and who I'd have to become to make it real. Then I wonder how great all of that would feel, where I could start, how proud of myself I'll be for starting, then I realize that these very thoughts are the

beginning and I then get awestruck and delighted by the elegance of the universe and get cracking." Jamie Combs (American Entrepreneur; Founder of 'Natural Balance Foods')
"I wake from dreams and go, 'Wow, put this down on paper.'...I feel somewhere some place it's been done and I'm just a courier bringing it into the world." Michael Jackson
Paul McCartney dreamt he heard the Rolling Stones performing a song. When he woke up, he realised the song didn't exist so he wrote it down and recorded it. The song was 'Yesterday'
Einstein imagined travelling on a beam of light and worked with his various imaginings to create his theory of relativity.
The story of Newton was that he was relaxing under a tree when he saw an apple fall to the ground, giving him his moment of understanding about gravity.
The story of Archimedes was that while relaxing in a bath he became aware that the water that overflowed as he got in could be the same as the mass of his body.

The Six Step Success Plan

This Six Step Success Plan can be used in a variety of situations. The idea behind it is to have a technique that helps to structure your thinking. Daydreaming is a highly effective way of creating ideas, focus and motivation. The problem is that most people struggle with spontaneous useful daydreaming. The Six Step Success Plan involves conscious processes that make you drift inside and daydream for short periods of time as you build up ideas in sensory rich language and descriptions (which can only be obtained if you daydream).
Through the stages you are writing things down so that there is a conscious element that you can see in reality and use as a guide, and the non-conscious element of daydreaming the various stages. The more involved and absorbed you can get in the process the more successful you are likely to be.
The final stage is to make a guided meditation that when listened to allows your mind to follow along easily and effortlessly in a daydreaming state encoding what you want to

achieve and the main markers on the way to that success in your neurology. It isn't enough to just dream. The dream needs to be enough to compel you to take action. Through this process you have a greater chance of feeling compelled to take action and achieve success.

Stage One: Make Goals Realistic and Achievable

For a goal to stand any chance of success you need to be in control of it. If you say you want to win the lottery you are likely to fail. If you say you want to make a million pounds by a given date a good amount of time in the future, you are more likely to succeed. Also, it is important that everything you write is positive stating what you want not what you don't want (so you don't want to write 'don't each chocolate' you want to put what you want instead of eating chocolate).

You can start with a challenge, then as you explore your goal over the next few steps you can work out what is really possible. I often set very challenging goals then go through this process to see how realistic and possible they are. I allow them to be 'possible at a push' so that I really have to put in effort to achieve them. So, the first step is just to come up with what you want and write it down.

Stage Two: Write the Goal Down

The second stage is to write the goal down giving the exact date you want to achieve it by (write it at the bottom or to the right of a piece of paper). Looking at this goal it may seem a million miles off and very unlikely and impossible. Now is when you begin to make it reality.

Stage Three: Write Down the Key Stages to Achieving the Goal

The third stage uses a natural talent your brain has. That is the NEED to fulfil patterns. Have you ever watched a TV programme that ends on a cliff hanger and you just HAVE to know what happens next; or read a real page turner of a book. These all use this natural ability you have to NEED patterns completed. Another natural talent is that the mind has to

generalise; delete and distort information so that it doesn't get overloaded. All the information goes in but only a small percentage of it gets dripped into conscious awareness. Your unconscious decides what it thinks is important to you to be aware of based on other things you spend your time thinking about. For example; have you ever heard about a company that you hadn't been aware of before only to suddenly see they have vans everywhere.

With this stage you want to create a pattern for your mind to focus on and have a NEED to complete.

Start by writing down key stages between now and your ultimate goal. It really pays off in the long term to take time to do this stage. Write down what the last few stages will be just before you have achieved your goal. Ask yourself 'What do I have to do to make that possible?' as a way of working from your goal all the way back to the present. Other questions may be 'Who would you have to meet?' 'What situations will you need to get into? (Like specific social situations)' If you set a goal but then do the same as you've always done, you'll get the same as you've always got. The more vivid and detailed you can make each stage the more compelling it can become. Write as many stages as you can think of.

Once you have all these stages add approximate, realistic dates to them. This is where you may find that it could take longer than expected or it may be quicker and simpler than expected. Feel free to adjust the goal as you wish. It may be that on paper it will take 18 months to achieve your goal but you may want to achieve it in a year. You could either change the goal or keep the goal as one possibility knowing you will do your best to achieve the goal quicker.

Stage Four: Describe Your Life 'As If' You Have Achieved Your Goal

Stage four you will need another sheet of paper. Write down a description of your life 'as if' you have achieved your goal. What will it be like, who will be around, what will they say, what will they notice, what will you see, hear, feel, be as descriptive as

possible. This is where you find out whether this is the life you want.

Stage Five: Add Diary Entries

Stage five is the stage where you begin to make your dreams firmly fixed in reality. In this stage you need to go through your diary placing all the dates and events you have come up with throughout the year.

A few years back I decided to do some 'home study' courses. I could do these in my own time so I had to be self-motivated. The only way to remain motivated was to create my own timetable so that it was in a diary and if anyone asked if I was free, I could look in my diary and see that I had a 'lesson' at that time so I could say I was busy with the lesson. I made my goals as important as other diary entries.

Stage Six: Programme Your Mind for Success

The final stage; stage six; is the stage where you programme your mind for future success and achievement of your goals. Because you will have written everything down previously this stage is easy to do. It is the most important stage as it is the stage that will fix your goals in your mind in a way that will make your mind feel compelled to complete the patterns and achieve your dreams.

By doing this stage fully; you begin to make the goal achievement more instinctive and more a part of who you are as a person.

In this stage you are going to make your own success achievement audio track. To do this; sit down comfortably with an audio recording device (like the audio recording feature on your mobile phone); then just talk into it 'as if' you are talking to someone else about them (so you are saying things like 'you....' rather than 'I...').

Start by saying:

'Now as you close your eyes and relax you can listen to me and let your mind wander; and as your mind wanders you can

integrate everything I say fully and honestly or discover in the future that everything I said became an integral part of who you become, and you can fall asleep while you integrate what I say or you can stay awake as you listen and absorb what I am saying to you...(pause for about 15 seconds)...Now talking to you in the future as someone that has achieved what you wanted I'm going to recap what you say your life is now like (then read what you wrote for stage four in present tense 'as if' it is the current reality) ...and I understand that you got where you are today by putting in time and effort and dedication and commitment...and that it all started when you set your mind to it back in (add the month/year you set the goal initially) and that you then...(Then describe in as much detail as possible (including dates/times etc) everything you have written from the very first thing you need to do all the way through to actually achieving the goal. Read it as if it has already happened and is being recalled. For example: ...wrote a list of people you needed to contact back in January 2023 and in February 2023 you contacted the people on the list and arranged to meet with those that responded...etc...)'

Once you have read all of the stages end with:
'And now you are here in the future aware of the events that have passed knowing that you can drift back to the present, to the place on that journey you know you are currently at, being aware of all that has passed and aware there is more yet to come, having knowledge that the present is a gift and that the future holds many more presents for you to discover...and you can relax in the knowledge that each time you listen to this you are one step closer to making your dreams reality and as you listen to this track more and more frequently you can become more used to listening to the voice on here...and when you are ready and comfortably back in the present I wonder whether you will open your eyes feeling refreshed and relaxed; or drift into a comfortable sleep'

Stage six works by accessing the REM (Rapid Eye Movement)

state. This is the state of mind used for laying down patterns and instinctive behaviours in the mind. Anyone that has learnt something consciously that now does it automatically without thinking has been through this process to make the learning instinctive so that it happens without thought or effort.

Some examples of the types of goals people may set and some stages they may include could be:

Weight loss
To weigh 12 stone in July (perhaps losing 3lbs a month to achieve this weight)
Stages: Eat healthy (daily), take frequent breaks at specified times (daily), walk to work (daily) attend the gym 3x per week, swim 3x per week.

Quitting Smoking
To be healthier and more relaxed (if you quit smoking but haven't addressed the 'cause' you will probably start again. So, if you smoke due to boredom, focus on the boredom as a goal, if it is due to stress, focus on ways to relax at stressful times, if it is just habit look at alternative behaviours at these times etc...)
Stages: Take regular breaks (daily), get fresh air and do deep breathing (daily)

Become self employed
To have a successful therapy practice by August (would need to define 'successful' in detail)
To have 2 weekend courses running a month and 8 clients a week.
Stages: Write a business plan (January), Write a cash flow forecast (January), Put together a marketing plan (January), contact local papers and radio with a story (January)

TEACHINGS FROM THE UNCONSCIOUS

This chapter is written based on what my unconscious mind had to say on topics like, reality, healing and success. Non-consciously, we have far more depth and wisdom and knowledge than we do in our conscious awareness. Due to this I allowed myself to be put into a state of mind where my unconscious could communicate freely with the person hypnotising me.
I have done this same process with a number of different people where I have hypnotised them and asked them questions, as well as where people have hypnotised me and asked me questions, and everyone seems to give similar answers. This has been edited to make it easier to read.

Transcript of My Trance Responses

Energy and Information

Energy is movement. It's a transferring from one place to another of information. Some examples are; like gas moving through the sky or like a wave moves towards the shore the water stays where it is the energy moves. Or more precisely it is the information that is transferring along from place to place.
All energy is the same, it just appears to be different. If you go

to a small enough level, it's all the same. In the same way that you can look at a tree and see it is a tree, you can look at a person and see it is a person. Yet if you could zoom right in on a tiny particle from that tree; or zoom right in on a particle from that person, you can even zoom inside the particles and you'll see that deep down they're the same. Fundamentally we are all made of the same components.

It is from the way that they are organised that changes what they appear like to us. The more organised they are from chaos the more different they look. Even a small initial change can lead to a large difference in how something turns out.

What leads to such variety is that there are many combinations; in the same way that you can get a box of Lego and put the blocks together to form different objects but all of the blocks are the same. So, on a fundamental level everything is the same; yet a myriad of different possibilities can be created.

All of this takes energy. The more there is in a space the more energy there is. And if energy is information, then the more energy there is in a space the more information is contained in that space. This can lead to highly complex developments. Everything has to 'know' how it is supposed to interact with everything else.

It is how you organise the energy that makes it look different.

Energy is like a perception; you look at something and to explain it you know it has moved or changed and so it can appear to flow, energy, the term energy is like a perception in the same way that you can say that a flower grows, and if you speed up the footage it appears to move considerably and it appears that it is actually moving but it isn't. What is actually moving is information.

Energy is like the perception of the information moving, like when you look at an illusion on a piece of paper and it looks like the lines are moving, it's not lines moving, and you know that consciously yet it still looks like the lines moving. Information does the same thing; as if everything talks to everything else and passes on a message that alters something further along the chain and that looks like movement like when

you have a big spring and when you flick it at one end it looks like a wave travels down the spring yet all the parts are still in the same location it's just every little part told the next part to move slightly and to look a certain way.
Everything reacts to something, it doesn't know how it's going to react until it happens and then it reacts to whatever it is, like a football doesn't know where it is going to go until someone kicks it, and that person would have the intelligence, yet the ball wouldn't.
Every possibility is a possibility and no possibility happens until something happens to create that possibility. An 'Intelligence' might know what the likely possibility is but that intelligence is further up the chain.
Humans have intelligence, we're not the only things that have intelligence but we have intelligence. That intelligence is based on the organisation of all the particles in our minds that allow for signals to be passed around in specific patterns and that allows us to be catalysts to things that don't have intelligence that don't know how they're going to respond. Something in the chain has to make the choice or every possibility is a possibility and everything is chaos.

Intelligence and Chaos

Everything is chaos even when it seems organised. Chaos is so chaotic it can appear smooth and organised like stirring milk in a cup of coffee; jumbling it up more and more until actually it is more organised than chaotic, until it's actually less random and you wouldn't know which parts are coffee and which parts are milk, but you know that if you took a chunk from two different places they'd look fairly similar but everything would be chaotic, smooth eventually and organised from chaos and intelligence controls that, intelligences has an influence on chaos.
We have a knock-on effect on things, it is difficult to maintain stability because we influence everything yet we're made up of everything so we're influenced back. So, we can be hot and cool off and be too cold and go back to the hot to warm up. We need change to always happen. If we weren't in the universe

and no intelligence was in the universe everything would be smooth and boring and wherever you look everything would be the same; there would be subtle variations but if you took two parts from different places in the universe, they would look about the same.
We need intelligence, it breaks up some of that randomness; it's like rolling a weighted dice; if you roll a dice a million times the answers would end up smoothing out and it would appear like order in chaos. Each answer was random, yet enough answers make it look organised. If you have a weighted dice, you'll have more answers coming up by the choice of the weight.

Information Transduction and Mind-Body Communication

For communication between the mind and body it is the passing of information. Many people get hooked on this idea of energy and energy therapies. They follow a belief or a path that is only a surface story rather than a deeper understanding of what is really going on. To master healing; whether it is for yourself or to help others you need to learn how information transduction works. How information spreads rather than the out-dated notion of energy.
It's like a baton race where you pass the baton on to the next runner and they pass the baton onto the next runner; only the baton is a message and the message has to be slightly different to apply to the next person along the chain.
For example if you asked me to move my finger the sound waves from your voice carry a message that creates movement to the hairs in the ears, and that movement creates electricity, and that electricity passes its way through from one place to another, passing the electricity on following a specific route, and that mixes with passing on to a chemical signal, that then passes on to another electrical signal and the chemical signal does that by; it's almost like tickling a cell that jumps creating an impulse, another bit of electricity that passes down and keeps passing that message along the line and then spreads it out to make sure that different muscle groups know to tense up or relax and then

the movement just happens.
All of this happens very quickly. Consciousness isn't involved, everything knows what to do based on the signal it receives, if a finger needs to move, the sound waves at the ear trigger the route to the finger not to the leg, yet at the ear there's multiple routes that can be taken, multiple variations, but the specific nature of the sound waves carry the one meaning.
Information gets passed along the right route, if an individual interferes, they can block the route, they can be slightly too tense in an arm and the signal wouldn't get through that tense spot, it works better when the individual is somewhere else, focusing on something else, and that leaves the signal free to just go and do it.

Consciousness
For healing you want to get the individual to keep out of the way of the process so that the change work can happen non-consciously. You want the person to know what is being worked on but then to be distracted or occupied while that change takes place or sets in.
The more aware something is, the more it tries to control chaos, not just with the conscious mind but with unconscious minds, and not just in humans but in animals and plants. Most things don't feel a need to control anything; they just transform from one thing to another; from energy to matter, to different kinds of matter.
Essentially, they are all the same thing so without consciousness they just are, with consciousness we want to control and we want to organise and we want to stay in a stable state, the seeds of consciousness are in everything and the more consciousness the more stable something wants to be, a plant will try to stay stable; will try to stay as a plant; will try and reach out for water and sunlight to survive because it wants to stay in that stable state in that time.
We want to stay in our stable state. Our stable state is life. We want to control matter and the world around us to stay in our stable state, we evolve to know how to control the information

in the universe, how to direct it, the universe doesn't have healing power, what looks like healing power is us and other consciousness's controlling the information. We control information to transform particles into different particles, to transform one chemical into another, one signal into another, if we had some cells that might harm us, we can transform them, we can change the DNA in the cells, and how the DNA's working. We can give other cells a template of what we want there and those cells will go there knowing what's there isn't right, dismantling it and building something new. We organise chaos.

When cells go wrong it's because of the information. Every cell has a small level of intelligence and as a whole we work like a bee hive or an ant's nest, and a cell that turns from being like all the others to being a cancerous cell is just following a different path of information, and it will have its own survival reasons for following that path, and that's how stress can cause cancer, and certain cells can respond to the response in the body of stress to try and survive.

Healing with Peace and Love

What is interesting is how peace, love and harmony can help with the healing process of things even deep in the cells; but only if the person who 'owns' the cells gets that experience. This gets interpreted as feelings or emotions in that person. For the peace or loving kindness to heal it has to be targeted at what needs the healing. It needs to be focused.

Where it's going has to be known. If it was cancer in an arm it would have to get to that cancer in the arm; no good just getting to the heart and that could happen by having the consciousness knowing that that's what it is for.

If you are in a therapy session or in any relationship and you're talking about an illness or you're there because of an illness, or there's any reason for that communication taking place to be linked to the illness the message will be targeted to the illness. And that wouldn't happen if they said the same thing to you just bumping into you on the street if the illness wasn't in your

frame of reference at that time and there was no link between what they were saying and no reason for it to be linked to the illness.

We all need to stand to one side. If self-healing is needed then the consciousness needs to step away and let it happen, if it's healing of someone else, they need to between them know the direction that is needed and then step aside and let the healing take place.

Too much effort is like creating a blockage, almost like cars on a motorway going at the same speed just carrying on constantly until someone slows down to observe an accident and that creates a blockage and all the traffic that's behind it slows down and grinds to a halt, and the ambulance that's trying to get through to help at the accident is stuck in a traffic jam, if everyone focuses on what they're doing and just keeps driving, the ambulance gets there quickly.

Chaos is not as bad as it seems, controlling chaos is difficult; controlling it in the right way is even harder. As well as healing and understanding how energy and information works and creates the world we live in within our day to day lives we need to have a level of success and fulfilment.

Success is getting what you set out to achieve. Achievement is the act of completing something. Success and achievement gives a sense of motivation. People don't do anything without having something to go for. It gives us something to do with our lives; something we feel in control of.

The question people always ask is how do you become one with everything? This is an important question because by becoming one with everything you begin to understand reality and the universe and the meaning of your life.

To become one, you need to learn to become absorbed in everything you do. Becoming absorbed is like joining frequencies with the world around you. It's like making your energy/information waves the same as everything else. Understand that, that energy that information and those waves are all one, and when they're one and the same frequency as the waves around them they're the same as everything around

them and the body is an illusion; you're an illusion; your seat is an illusion; everything around us is an illusion, because it's all the same.

Reality is Perception

Reality is just perception. Nothing is technically real or false, just perceived. Our perception of reality is all that exists; if you perceive reality, it exists because you perceive it to exist but in reality, it doesn't exist because it is just a perception; if you become one with the perception rather than just looking at it then it will stop existing, in the way that you understand.

If you achieve that you could be anywhere, be anything, you could move without moving, you could make things there that aren't there, things that to other people's perception would appear to come out of nowhere, but they don't.

You can understand that energy can't be destroyed or made only moved or transferred. If I walk people think they see me walking but they don't. It's just a perception they have and if I take control of that I don't even have to walk there's no need to walk, just transfer the information elsewhere then be somewhere else and not here.

It is useful to remember that the conscious mind can't understand how to do non-conscious things the conscious mind can't make the heart beat, the conscious mind can't decide to multiply cells or make blood clot or run freely, never mind how much it would want to, only the unconscious mind can do that, the conscious mind wouldn't understand, it would be too complex.

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